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Deuteronomy

Deuteronomy - Introduction

Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Deuteronomy

1. The author's introduction of Moses' speech (1:1–5)
2. Moses' first speech (1:6–4:40)
3. Cities of refuge selected for the Reubenites, Gadites, and Manassites (4:41–43)
4. The author's introduction of the Law (4:44–49)
5. Moses' second speech (5:1–26:19)
6. Moses' third speech (27:1–28:68)
7. The author's summary (29:1)
8. The covenant renewed (29:2–30:20)
9. Last words of Moses, the Song of Moses, and his death (31:1–34:12)

What is the book of Deuteronomy about?

In the book of Deuteronomy, Moses repeats the laws of the covenant that God made with the people of Israel. The people of Israel are about to go into the land that Yahweh had promised them. Before they enter the land, Moses reminds them of what Yahweh did for them and what he expects from them. Moses warns the people about worshiping idols and no longer trusting Yahweh once they settle in the land. Yahweh promises to judge those who disobey him and to bless those who obey his law. (See: covenant)

How should the title of this book be translated?

The name "Deuteronomy" means "Second Law" or "the retelling of the Law." Translators may decide on a title such as "A Repeat of the Law" or "Moses Explains the Law Again." (See: How to Translate Names)

Who wrote the book of Deuteronomy?

The writers of both the Old and New Testament present Moses as being very involved with writing the book of Deuteronomy. However, many scholars think that Joshua wrote chapter 34, which tells how Moses died.

What are the important features of the book of Deuteronomy?

The book contains a series of speeches that Moses gave to Israel before he died. He spoke these things just before the people entered the land that Yahweh had promised them. (See: Promised Land)

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

Why does Yahweh command the Israelites to completely destroy the Canaanite people who live in the land that Yahweh had promised them?

As Yahweh prepares the Israelites to enter the land that Yahweh had promised them, he commands them to completely destroy the Canaanite people who live there. The Israelites will then not be tempted to join them in worship of their false gods.

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

"the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay," and "the place that Yahweh your God chooses to put his name"

The author uses these two phrases, and several other very similar phrases, in Deuteronomy chapters 12, 14, 16, and 26. In them God's name represents his reputation and presence. These phrases indicate that God would choose a place and make his presence and reputation stay there. That place would be the future temple. (See: Metonymy)

Can this book be translated before the rest of the Pentateuch?

The books of Genesis and Exodus help to explain what happens in Deuteronomy. For this reason, those books should be translated before the book of Deuteronomy.

One direct quotation inside another

Since this book consists of Moses' speeches, many parts of this book are direct quotations. Within his speeches, Moses directly quotes what others said. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate or format these passages so that there are not quotations within a quotation. (See Quotes within Quotes)

Introducing direct quotations

The author of Deuteronomy often uses the word "saying" or "said" to introduce direct quotations even when there is another word describing speaking or commanding. Some languages do not use a word like this. Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language. (See Quotations and Quote Margins)

Speaking about a future event using the past tense

In Deuteronomy, Moses and Yahweh often speak of a future event using the past tense. For example, speaking of the land that Yahweh had promised them, Yahweh tells the Israelites in 1:8 "I have given the land to" you. In 1:21 Moses tells the Israelites "Yahweh your God has given the land to" you. At the time Yahweh and Moses said these things to the Israelites they had not yet occupied the land that Yahweh had promised them. Moses and Yahweh are using the past

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tense in order to refer to something that will happen in the future. They are doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. Another example is 2:24, where Moses quotes Yahweh's words "I have given into your hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land." Yahweh is using the past tense to emphasize that, in the future, he will certainly enable the Israelites to conquer Sihon and his land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the future tense, instead of the past tense, in these three passages and in the other passages in Deuteronomy where the past tense is used to refer to a future event. (See: Promised Land; and Irregular Use of Tenses)

"your God," "my God," and "our God"
Throughout this book, Moses refers to Yahweh with possessive forms such as "your God," "my God," and "our God" when he speaks to the Israelites. By using these possessive forms, Moses is not saying that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh. Rather Moses is using these words to indicate that Yahweh is the God whom the Israelites worship. Also, when Moses says, "your God," he is referring to the same God that he also worships. He is not distinguishing between the God of the Israelites and his own God. (See Possession)

Moses' audience
In his speeches, Moses speaks to the Israelites who will enter into the land that Yahweh promised to give to them. Moses reminds them about events that happened to their ancestors and to them. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could state explicitly that Moses is talking about their ancestors even when he directly addresses the living Israelites as "you." (See Pronouns — When to Use Them)

"you" and "your" singular and plural
Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he often addresses them as "you" singular. Moses wants each of the individual Israelites to think about what he is saying. If it would not be natural in your language to address a group with a singular pronoun, you can use the plural "you" when Moses is speaking to all the Israelites. (See Pronouns — When to Use Them; and Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

"to the face of"
Often the author or character use the expression "to the face of" to mean "before," "in front of," or "in the presence of" a person or thing. This is by association with the way one can see the face of a person who is present and the way people typically face forward, toward what is before or in front of them. (See: Metonymy)

"in the eyes of" and "eyes of"
The author and characters often use the common expression "in the eyes of" to mean in someone's estimation, opinion, or judgment. For example, Moses speaks of the Israelites doing "evil in the eyes of Yahweh" in 4:25, meaning doing what Yahweh considered wrong. (See: Idiom)

"seed"
12 times in Deuteronomy the term **seed** is used with the meaning "offspring" or "descendants." This use is a word picture. Just as plants produce seeds that grow into more plants, so people can have offspring. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture. Alternatively, you could express the meaning plainly. In Deuteronomy all uses of the word "seed" refer to descendants except in where this term refers to literal seed that is planted in the ground. (See: seed; and Metaphor)

"listen"
In this book the term "listen" normally, but not always, means complying with what someone has said. When humans "listen" in this sense, the term means "obey," as when the Moses says to the Israelites in 1:43 "I spoke to you, but you did not listen." Moses means, "I spoke to you what Yahweh had commanded me to tell you, but you did not obey." When Yahweh "listens" in this sense, it means that he does what someone asks in prayer. For example, when Moses says regarding his prayer to Yahweh in 3:26 in which he requested that Yahweh let him cross the Jordan and see the land that Yahweh had promised them, Moses says "But Yahweh was angry with me because of you, and he did not listen to me." Moses means that Yahweh was angry with him and did not comply with his request to enter land. (See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

"voice"
In this book the word "voice" is often used by association to mean what God or a person said by using their voice. For example, in 8:20 Moses said to the Israelites, "because you would not listen to the voice of Yahweh your God" by which he meant "because you would not listen to what Yahweh your God said to you" or "because you would not listen to the commands that Yahweh your God gave you." (See: Metonymy)

"go up," "went up," "went down," and "brought down"
In Hebrew, writers and speakers generally indicated whether people were going up to a higher elevation or going down to a lower elevation when they traveled. For example, in 34:1 the author records that "Moses went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo." In

1:41, the Israelites say "We ourselves shall go up and fight" by which they mean "We ourselves shall go up to the hill country to fight." If your language does not mark travel for change in elevation, you can translate instances such as these simply as "go" or "went" instead of "go up" or "went up" or "went down."

"to this day" or "until this day"
The author used this phrase to refer to the time when he was writing. The translator should be aware that "to this day" or "until this day" refers to a time that is now in the past. He must avoid giving the impression to his readers that "to this day" means "to the present day." The translator might decide to use an equivalent phrase such as "at the time of this writing." (See: Metonymy)

Deuteronomy - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter forms a continuation with the last chapter of the book of Numbers. In this chapter is Moses' first speech to the Israelites.

1. The author's introduction of Moses' speech (1–5)
2. Moses reminds the Israelites of Yahweh's instructions at Mount Horeb to leave Mount Horeb and begin possessing the land that Yahweh had promised them (6–8)
3. Moses chooses judges and military leaders (9–18)
4. Moses recounts the Israelites leaving Mount Horeb and traveling through the wilderness and coming to the hill country of the Amorites and sending out spies to survey the land (19–25)
5. The Israelites unbelief and fear (26–28)
6. Moses' encourages the Israelites and they persist in their unbelief (29–33)
7. Yahweh's response (34–40)
8. The response of the Israelites (41–45)
9. Moses' summary statement (46)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Possessing the land
Moses reminds the Israelites of Yahweh's command at Mount Horeb to enter and possess the land that Yahweh had promised them. He reminds the Israelites that Yahweh promised he would give them the land of Canaan if they obeyed him. Other people lived in the land, but Yahweh promised to give the Israelites victory over them. (See: faithful, faithfulness, trustworthy; and Promised Land)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

One direct quotation inside another
In this chapter, Moses gives a speech in which he quotes what others have said. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate or format this passage so that there are no quotations within quotations. (See Quotes within Quotes)

Time background
In his speech, Moses reminds the Israelites about what happened to their ancestors when they were camping at Mount Horeb. Throughout his speech, Moses repeats the phrase "at that time" to refer to new topics that occurred during that time period. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could state this information explicitly. (See: Introduction of a New Event)

Deuteronomy 1:1 (#1)

סֹוף

"Suph"

Both the identity and location of **Suph** are unknown. Because of this is it best to simply translate this word as **Suph** without describing it, as both the ULT and UST have done.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:1 (#2)

בֵּין & וּבֵין

"between & and between"

Here the text repeats **between** to describe the relative positions of cities. If it is unnatural in your language to repeat a preposition, you could use a form that identifies an area between cities. Alternate translation: [between ... and]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:2 (#1)

אַחַד עָשָׂר יוֹם

"It is} 11 days"

The implication is that the journey takes **11 days**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [It is a journey of 11 days]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:2 (#2)

מֵחֹרֵב

“from Horeb”

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also known as Mount Sinai.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:3 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

Moses is using the word translated **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [And it came to pass]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 1:3 (#2)

בְּאַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה בְּעַשְׁתֵּי־עָשָׂר חֹדֶשׁ

“in the fortieth year, in the eleventh month”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the fortieth year** or **in the eleventh month**, you could represent these numbers in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [after 40 years, in month 11]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 1:3 (#3)

בְּעַשְׁתֵּי־עָשָׂר חֹדֶשׁ

“in the eleventh month”

The **eleventh** month of the Hebrew calendar includes January on Western calendars. You could convert the Hebrew day and month into an approximate date on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the date will be different every year and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may wish instead to give the number of the day and the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar and say in a footnote approximately what time of year that is on your calendar.

See: Hebrew Months

Deuteronomy 1:3 (#4)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” Moses is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Israel] or [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:3 (#5)

בְּנֵי

“the sons of”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, the author is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [the children of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 1:4 (#1)

הַכֹּתוֹ

“he defeated”

The implication is that Yahweh caused the Israelites to defeat Sihon and Og under Moses’ command. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh caused the Israelites to defeat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:4 (#2)

הַכֹּתוֹ

“he defeated”

Here the pronoun **he** refers back to Moses in verse 3. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the person’s name here. Alternate translation: [Moses defeated]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 1:4 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־יוֹשֵׁב בְּעַשְׁתָּרֹת בְּאֶדְרֶעִי

“who lived in Ashtaroth, in Edrei”

The implication is that King Og ruled from both **Ashtaroth** and **Edrei**. **Ashtaroth** and **Edrei** were towns that were close to each other and he lived in both places. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who ruled from Ashtaroth and Edrei]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:5 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 1:5–6 (#1)

הוֹאִיל מֹשֶׁה בֵּאֵר אֶת־הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת לֵאמֹר: יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ דִּבֶּר אֵלֵינוּ בְּחֹרֵב לֵאמֹר

“Moses began explaining this law, saying,“Yahweh our God spoke to us at Horeb, saying”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Moses began explaining the law that Yahweh spoke at Horeb. Yahweh said,]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 1:6 (#1)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ

“Yahweh our God”

By using this possessive form, **our God**, Moses is not saying that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh. Rather Moses is using these words to indicate that Yahweh is the God whom the Israelites worship. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God whom we worship]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 1:6 (#2)

בְּחֹרֵב

“at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of the mountain which is also known as Mount Sinai. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 32.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:7 (#1)

פְּנוּ ׀ וּסְעוּ לָכֶם

“Turn and journey yourselves”

Yahweh is using **Turn** as a common expression of his culture to mean to “start” or “begin” an action. He is not telling them to change directions. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Start your journey]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 1:7 (#2)

וּסְעוּ לָכֶם

“and journey yourselves”

The expression **and journey yourselves** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [and journey]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:7 (#3)

שְׁכֵנָיו׃

“their neighbors”

Here, **neighbors** refers to any people groups in the nearby areas. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people groups near them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:8 (#1)

רְאֵה

“Look”

Yahweh is using the term **Look** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Do not forget]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:8 (#2)

לִפְנֵיכֶם

“to your faces”

Here, **faces** represents what is in front of the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your

language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to you that is before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:8 (#3)

נִשְׁבַּ֣ע יְהוָ֗ה

“Yahweh swore”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first person form. Alternate translation: [I swore]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Deuteronomy 1:8 (#4)

לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם

“to your fathers”

Yahweh is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to your predecessors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:8 (#5)

וּלְזַרְעָ֖ם

“and to their seed”

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites’ offspring were **seed**. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this use of the term “seed.” Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to their offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:9 (#1)

וָאֹמַ֥ר

“And I said”

Here, **I** refers back to Moses in verse 5. If it would be helpful in your language, you could repeat the name “Moses” here. Alternate translation: [I, Moses, said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 1:9 (#2)

שְׂאֵ֥את

“to carry”

Here, **to carry** means “to lead” or “to govern.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to lead]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:10 (#1)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֖ם

“Yahweh your God”

Moses is not using this possessive form **your God** to indicate that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh but rather to emphasize that Yahweh is the God that the Israelites worship, including himself. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God whom we worship]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 1:10 (#2)

כְּכוֹכְבֵ֥י הַשָּׁמַ֖יִם לָרֹֽב

“as the stars of the heavens in number”

Here Moses says **as the stars of the heavens in number** as a generalization for emphasis. He means that God has greatly increased the number of Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [almost as numerous as the stars of the heavens]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 1:11 (#1)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֣י אֲבֹתֵכֶ֗ם יֹסֵ֤ף עֲלֵיכֶם֙ כָּכֶ֔ם אֶ֖לֶף פְּעָמִ֑ים וִיבָרֵ֣ךְ אֶתְכֶ֔ם כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֖ר לָכֶֽם

“Yahweh, the God of your fathers, may he add to you, as you {are}, a thousand times, and may he bless you, just as he spoke to you”

Moses is asking God to bless the Israelites. You could express this as either a blessing or a prayer, in whichever way is more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I hope that Yahweh, the God of your fathers, will add to you, as you are, a thousand times, and I hope that he will bless you, just as he spoke to you]

See: Blessings

Deuteronomy 1:11 (#2)

אֲבֹתֵכֶ֗ם

“your fathers”

See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:11 (#3)

יֹסֵף עֲלֵיכֶם

“may he add to you”

The implication is that God will **add** to the number of Israelites by births. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [may he add to your population]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:11 (#4)

אֶלֶף פְּעָמִים

“a thousand times”

Here, **a thousand** is a customary way of saying “very many.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different number or another phrase that indicates that something happens many times. Alternate translation: [many times more than you are now]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 1:12 (#1)

אֵיכָה אֶשָּׂא לְבַדִּי טָרְחֲכֶם וּמַשַּׂאֲכֶם וְרִיבְכֶם

“How will I carry by myself your loads and your burdens and your disputes”

Moses uses a question to emphasize that he cannot solve all of the Israelites’ problems by himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement and use the appropriate punctuation at the end of the sentence. Alternate translation: [By myself, I cannot carry your loads and your burdens and your disputes.] or [I cannot carry your loads and your burdens and your disputes while working alone.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 1:12 (#2)

אֶשָּׂא לְבַדִּי טָרְחֲכֶם וּמַשַּׂאֲכֶם

“will I carry by myself your loads and your burdens”

Here Moses speaks of the people’s problems and complaints that he needed to solve as if they were heavy physical **loads** and **burdens** that he needed to **carry**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will I make decisions by myself to solve your issues and your concerns]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:12 (#3)

טָרְחֲכֶם וּמַשַּׂאֲכֶם

“your loads and your burdens”

The terms **loads** and **burdens** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [your heavy burdens]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 1:13 (#1)

חֲכָמִים וּנְבֹנִים

“wise and understanding”

The terms **wise** and **understanding** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [very wise]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 1:13 (#2)

וִידֻעִים

“and well-known”

Here, **well-known** could mean (1) someone who is well known in the community he lives in and has a good reputation as being trustworthy. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and reputable] and [and respected]. Or it could mean (2) someone who is knowledgeable. Alternate translation: [and knowledgeable]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:13 (#3)

בְּרָאשֵׁיכֶם

“as your heads”

Here, **heads** means “leaders.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as your leaders]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:15 (#1)

אֶת־רָאשֵׁיכֶם & רָאשִׁים

“the heads of & as} heads”

See how you translated “heads” in 1:13.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:15 (#2)

וִידֻעִים

“and well-known”

See how you translated “well-known” in 1:13.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:15 (#3)

אֲלָפִים & מֵאוֹת & חֲמִשִּׁים & עֲשָׂרֹת

“thousands & hundreds & fifties & tens”

Alternate translation: [groups of 1,000 ... groups of 100 ... groups of 50 ... groups of 10]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 1:15 (#4)

לְשִׁבְטֵיכֶם

“for your tribes”

The implication is that Moses appointed leaders for each of the tribes of Israel. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from each of your tribes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:16 (#1)

שָׁמֹעַ בֵּין־אֲחֵיכֶם

“Listen in between your brothers”

Here, **Listen in between your brothers** means that the judge should hear and take into consideration the evidence given by each party involved in a legal case. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Pay attention to the evidence from both sides of the legal case]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:16 (#2)

אֲחֵיכֶם & אָחִיו

“your brothers & his brother”

Here Moses is using the terms **brothers** and **brother** to describe people who are descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelites ... his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:16 (#3)

בֵּין־אִישׁ וּבֵין־אָחִיו וּבֵין גֵּרוֹ

“between a man and between his brother, and between his foreigner”

Here Moses repeats **between** to describe different types of relationships that could require judgment among the Israelites. The first relationship involves two Israelites. The second relationship involves an Israelite and a non-Israelite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a form that describes relationships between individuals. Alternate translation: [between a man and a fellow Israelite, and also between a man and a foreigner]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:16 (#4)

אִישׁ

“a man”

The word **man** represents any Israelite in general, not one particular Israelite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any Israelite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 1:16 (#5)

וּבֵין גֵּרוֹ

“and between his foreigner”

The word **foreigner** represents foreigners living among the Israelites in general, not one particular foreigner. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [and between an Israelite and any foreigner]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#1)

לֹא־תַכִּירוּ פָנִים

“Do not recognize a face”

Moses is using **recognize a face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “to show partiality.” If this

phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall not play favorites] or [You shall not show partiality]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#2)

בַּמִּשְׁפָּט & הַמִּשְׁפָּט

“in the judgment & the judgment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in the legal case ... the result of the legal case]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#3)

תִּשְׁמָעֻן

“you shall hear”

The implication is that the judges will **hear** legal cases. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you should hear legal cases]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#4)

כַּקָּטֹן כַּגָּדֹל

“as the small and the great alike”

Moses is using the adjective **small** to describe people who are considered unimportant in society, who are often equated with the poor, and the adjective **great** to describe people who are considered important or rich. Alternate translation: [as the poor people and rich people alike]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#5)

כַּקָּטֹן כַּגָּדֹל

“as the small and the great alike”

Here, **small** and **great** refer to all of the Israelites by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of Israelite society. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all Israelites alike]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#6)

לֹא תָגֻרוּ מִפְּנֵי־אִישׁ כִּי הַמִּשְׁפָּט לֵאלֹהִים הוּא

“Do not be afraid from the face of a man, for the judgment, it {belongs} to God”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [The judgment, it belongs to God, so do not be afraid from the face of a man]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#7)

מִפְּנֵי־אִישׁ

“from the face of a man”

Moses is using **from the face of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of a man]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#8)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Here the masculine term **man** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [any person]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#9)

הַמִּשְׁפָּט לֵאלֹהִים הוּא

“the judgment, it {belongs} to God”

Moses is speaking of a **judgment** as if it were an object that **belongs to God**. Moses means that God decides what is right and wrong. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God knows which decision is right or wrong]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#10)

תַּקְרִבֻ֖ון

“you shall bring”

Moses is speaking of legal cases as if they were objects that the Israelites could physically **bring** to him. Moses means that the Israelites should tell him the details and let him decide the case. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you can explain]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:17 (#11)

וּשְׁמַעְתִּֽיו

“and I shall hear it”

The implication is that Moses will not only **hear** the legal case, but also decide on a solution. You could include this information if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and I shall hear it and choose a solution]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:19 (#1)

מֵחֹרֵ֔ב

“from Horeb”

Horeb is the name of the mountain which is also known as Mount Sinai.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:19 (#2)

וְהַנּוֹרָ֣א

“and terrible”

The implication is that the wilderness is **terrible** because it causes terror from being so dangerous. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and unsafe]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:21 (#1)

רְאֵ֗ה

“Look”

Yahweh is using the term **Look** to focus the Israelites' attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Surely]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:21 (#2)

רְאֵ֗ה & אֱלֹהֶ֙יךָ֙ לְפָנֶ֔יךָ & עֲלֵ֖ה רַ֣שׁ & אֲבֹתֶ֑יךָ לָ֙ךְ֙ אַל־תִּירָ֣א וְאַל־תֵּחָ֔ת

“Look & your God & to your face; go up, take possession & your fathers & to you. You shall not be afraid, and you shall not be discouraged”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, **you**, **your**, and the command forms are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 1:21 (#3)

לְפָנֶ֔יךָ

“to your face”

See how you translated the similar phrase “Look, I have given the land to your faces” in verse 8.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:21 (#4)

עֲלֵ֖ה

“go up”

By **go up** Moses implies “go up and fight.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [go up and attack] or [go up and fight]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:21 (#5)

אֲבֹתֶ֑יךָ

“your fathers”

See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:22 (#1)

לְפָנֵ֔ינוּ

“to our faces”

Here the word **faces** represents going in front. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before us]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:22 (#2)

וְיָשִׁ֨בוּ אֹתָ֜נוּ דָּבָ֗ר

“and return to us a word {about”

Moses is speaking of bringing back a report or **word** about **the land** as if it were a physical object that the spies could **return** to the others. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and report back to us about]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:22 (#3)

דָּבָ֗ר

“a word {about”

Here, **word** represents the report that the Israelite spies would give using words. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a report about]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:22 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר נַעֲלֶה־בָּ֖הּ

“which we will go up into”

In keeping with what is usual for his language and culture, Moses is marking travel for change in elevation. If this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language, you can shorten it. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “go up.” Alternate translation: [which we should go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:22 (#5)

נָבֹ֔א

“we will come”

In a context such as this, your language might say “go” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [we will go]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 1:23 (#1)

הַדָּבָ֖ר

“the word”

Here Moses is using the term **word** to represent the request that the Israelites made using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what they said]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:23 (#2)

בְּעֵינָ֑י

“in my eyes”

Moses is using **in my eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in my judgment” or “in my opinion.” See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “in the eyes of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in my opinion] or [in my assessment]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 1:24 (#1)

וַיִּפְנ֣וּ

“And they turned”

Here, **they** refers back to the “12 men” whom Moses chose in verse 23. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could clarify this information. Alternate translation: [And the 12 men turned]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 1:24 (#2)

וַיָּבֹ֖אוּ

“and they came”

In a context such as this, your language might say “went” instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [and they went]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 1:24 (#3)

נַ֣חַל אֶשְׁכֹּ֑ל

“the Valley of Eshkol”

Here, **the Valley of Eshkol** is the name of a valley in the Hebron region, which is south of Jerusalem.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:25 (#1)

וַיִּקְח֣וּ בְיָדָ֔ם

“And they took with their hands”

The expression **they took with their hands** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [And they took]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:25 (#2)

מִפְּרִ֣י

“from the fruit of”

In this verse, the word **fruit** is singular in form, but it refers to any fruit that grows in the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [a bit of fruit from]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 1:25 (#3)

וַיּוֹרִדוּ֙ אֵלֵ֔ינוּ

“and brought {it} down to us”

See the section in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the use of the phrase “brought down.” Alternate translation: [and brought it to us]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:25 (#4)

וַיָּשִׁ֥בוּ אִתָּ֖נוּ דָּבָ֑ר

“And they returned to us a word”

Moses is speaking of news (**a word**) as if it were a physical object that someone could **return** to someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and report back to us about]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:25 (#5)

דָּבָ֑ר

“a word”

See how you translated the term “word” in 1:22 where it is used with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [a report]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:25 (#6)

וַיֹּ֣אמְרוּ֮ טוֹבָ֣ה הָאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֔ינוּ נֹתֵ֥ן לָֽנוּ׃

“and said, ‘Good {is} the land that Yahweh our God is giving to us”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and said that the land that Yahweh our God is giving to us is good]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 1:26 (#1)

לַעֲלֹ֖ת

“to go up”

See how you translated “go up” in verse 21. Alternate translation: [to go and fight]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:26 (#2)

אֶת־פִּ֥י

“the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to Yahweh’s commands and what he says to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the commands of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:27 (#1)

וַתֵּרָגְנ֣וּ בְאָהֳלֵיכֶ֗ם וַתֹּ֙אמְרוּ֙

“And you grumbled in your tents and said”

The phrase **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [And you grumbled in your tents]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 1:27 (#2)

בְּשִׂנְאַ֥ת יְהוָ֖ה אֹתָ֑נוּ

“In the hatred of Yahweh against us”

Here the Israelites are using the possessive form to describe the **hatred** that they believe Yahweh is showing towards them. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a verb to show how **hatred** and **Yahweh** are related. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh hates us,]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 1:27 (#3)

בְּשִׂנְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה אֹתָ֖נוּ

“In the hatred of Yahweh against us”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hatred**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Since Yahweh hates us]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 1:27 (#4)

בְּיַ֣ד הָאֱמֹרִ֑י

“into the hand of the Amorites”

Here, **hand** represents by association the power of the owner of the hand, **the Amorites**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into the power of the Amorites]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:27–28 (#1)

וַתֵּרָגְנ֣וּ בְאָהֳלֵיכֶ֗ם וַתֹּ֙אמְרוּ֙ בְּשִׂנְאַ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה אֹתָ֖נוּ הוֹצִיאָ֑נוּ מֵאֶ֣רֶץ מִצְרַ֔יִם לָתֵ֥ת אֹתָ֛נוּ בְּיַ֥ד הָאֱמֹרִ֖י לְהַשְׁמִידֵ֥נוּ: אָנָ֖ה ׀ אֲנַ֣חְנוּ עֹלִ֑ים אַחֵ֙ינוּ֙ הֵמַ֣סּוּ אֶת־לְבָבֵ֔נוּ

“And you grumbled in your tents and said, ‘In the hatred of Yahweh against us he brought us from the land of Egypt to give us into the hand of the Amorites to destroy us. Where {can} we go up? Our brothers have caused our heart to melt”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you grumbled in your tents. You claimed that Yahweh hates you and brought you from the land of Egypt to give you into the hand of the Amorites. You asked me how you could go up, and you told me that your brothers had caused your heart to melt]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#1)

אָנָ֖ה ׀ אֲנַ֣חְנוּ עֹלִ֑ים

“Where {can} we go up”

The Israelites use a question to emphasize that they are afraid of the Amorites and do not want to go near them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement. Alternate translation: [We have nowhere safe to go.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#2)

אָנָ֖ה ׀ אֲנַ֣חְנוּ עֹלִ֑ים

“Where {can} we go up”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “go up.” Alternate translation: [Where can we go from this valley]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#3)

אַחֵ֙ינוּ֙

“Our brothers”

Here the term **Our brothers** refers back to the “12 men” in verse 23 who scouted the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Our 12 brothers who scouted the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#4)

אַחֵ֙ינוּ֙

“Our brothers”

The Israelites are using the term **brothers** to describe people who are descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Our fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#5)

הֵמַ֣סּוּ אֶת־לְבָבֵ֔נוּ

“have caused our heart to melt”

The speakers are using **have caused our heart to melt** as a common expression of his culture to mean “to feel weak and afraid.” It is saying that the 12 men who had spied out the land made the rest of the Israelites feel weak and afraid. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [have made my heart skip a beat] or [have made us very fearful]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#6)

אֶת־לְבָבֵנוּ

“our heart”

In this verse, the word **heart** is singular in form, but it refers to all the hearts of the Israelites. If it would be more natural in your language, you could use the plural form. Alternate translation: [our hearts]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#7)

לֵאמֹר עַם גָּדוֹל וָרָם

“saying, “The people {are} greater and taller”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting the people (level 2) who are quoting the spies (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation. Alternate translation: [when they said that the people are greater and taller]

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#8)

לֵאמֹר עַם גָּדוֹל וָרָם מִמֶּנּוּ עָרִים גְּדֹלֹת וּבְצוּרֹת בַּשָּׁמָיִם וְגַם־בְּנֵי עֲנָקִים רָאִינוּ שָׁם

“saying, “The people {are} greater and taller than us, {with} cities great and fortified to the heavens; and also, we have seen the sons of the Anakites there”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [by saying that the people are greater and taller than us, with cities great and fortified to the heavens, and also, that they have seen the sons of the Anakim there]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#9)

גָּדוֹל וָרָם

“are} greater and taller”

Here the term **greater** could mean: (1) “more powerful,” Alternate translation: [are stronger and taller] or [are more powerful and are taller] or (2) [greater in size.] In this case, the terms **greater** and **taller** mean similar things. The Israelites are using the two terms together for emphasis. Alternate translation: [are much bigger]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#10)

וּבְצוּרֹת בַּשָּׁמָיִם

“and fortified to the heavens”

The Israelites say **fortified to the heavens** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and extremely well-fortified]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 1:28 (#11)

בְּנֵי

“the sons of”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:29 (#1)

לֹא־תַעַרְצֻוּן וְלֹא־תִירְאוּן מֵהֶם

“Do not tremble, and do not be afraid of them”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [Do not tremble, indeed do not be afraid of them]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 1:30 (#1)

הַהֹלֵךְ לִפְנֵיכֶם

“who walks to your faces”

When Moses says that Yahweh **walks** to the faces of the Israelites, he is describing how Yahweh goes in front of them to lead them. Military commanders would go in front of their troops and lead them into battle and this is the mental image that Moses is expressing here. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who guides you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:30 (#2)

לִפְנֵיכֶם

“to your faces”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the similar phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated “to your faces” in 1:8. Alternate translation: [in front of you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:30 (#3)

לְעֵינֵיכֶם

“before your eyes”

Here, **eyes** represents the act of seeing. The Israelites could see physical proof that Yahweh fought for them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:31 (#1)

רָאִ֔יתָ & נָשָׂאֲךָ֣ & אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“you have seen & your God carried you”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 1:31 (#2)

נָשָׂאֲךָ֣

“carried you”

Here, **carried** means to be led and protected. If this word does not have that meaning in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [protected you] or [took care of you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:31 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֤ר יִשָּׂא־אִישׁ֙ אֶת־בְּנ֔וֹ

“as a man carries his son”

Moses is saying that Yahweh guiding and protecting the Israelites compares to how **a man carries his son**, because a father will help his son when the son is unable to do something by himself. A father will hold his son, protect his son, and help his son go where he needs to go. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [as a father carries his child who is too weak to walk]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 1:31 (#4)

הַמָּקֹ֥ום הַזֶּ֖ה

“this place”

Here, **this place** refers to the Moab where the Israelites were currently camped. See 1:5. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to Moab where you are camping]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:32 (#1)

וּבַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֔ה אֵינְכֶ֖ם מַאֲמִינִֽם

“But in this word you did not believe”

Here, **this word** represents what Moses had to the Israelites encouraging them that Yahweh would be with them and fight for them and help them defeat the inhabitants of Canaan and possess it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But regarding what I said to you, you did not believe]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:33 (#1)

לִפְנֵיכֶ֑ם

“to your faces”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the similar phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated “to your faces” in 1:8. Alternate translation: [before you] or [in front of you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:33 (#2)

בָּאֵ֣שׁ ׀ לַ֣יְלָה לִרְאֹתְכֶם֮ בַּדֶּ֣רֶךְ֒ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תֵּלְכ֣וּ־בָ֔הּ וּבֶעָנָ֖ן יֹומָֽם

“in fire {by} night to show you the way that you should go in it, and in a cloud {by} day”

These phrases refer to Exodus 13:21–22, which explains how Yahweh led the Israelites with a pillar of fire and pillar of cloud. After the Israelites left Egypt, they did not know in which direction to go. They needed

Yahweh to guide them, and Yahweh chose to guide them through the physical signs of fire and cloud.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:33 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר תֵּלְכוּ־בָהּ

“that you should go in it”

It might seem that this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you can shorten it. Alternate translation: [that you should go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 1:34 (#1)

אֶת־קוֹל דִּבְרֵיכֶם

“the sound of your words”

Here the phrase **the sound of your words** refers to what they were saying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what you were saying] or [what you said]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:34 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces direct speech. Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 1:34–36 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁמַע לְאִמֹר: אִם־יִרְאֶה אִישׁ בָּאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵלֶּה הַדּוֹר הָרָע הַזֶּה אֵת הָאָרֶץ הַטּוֹבָה אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי לָתֵת לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם: זוּלָתִי כָּלֵב בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה הוּא יִרְאֶנָּה וְלוֹ־אֶתֵּן אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר דָּרַךְ־בָּהּ וּלְבָנָיו יַעַן אֲשֶׁר מִלֵּא אַחֲרֵי יְהוָה

“And he swore, saying, ‘Not {one} man of these men of this evil generation shall see the good land that I swore to give to your fathers except Caleb, the son of Jephunneh; he, he shall see it. And to him I will give the land that he has stepped on, and to his sons, because {he is} wholly after Yahweh”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And he swore that no one from your parents’ generation would see the good land that he swore to give to your fathers except Caleb, the son of Jephunneh. He swore to give him the land that he steps on, and to his sons, because Caleb is wholly after him]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 1:35 (#1)

אִישׁ בָּאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵלֶּה

“one} man of these men of”

Although the words **man** and **men** are masculine, Yahweh is using these words in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [one person of these people of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 1:36 (#1)

יְפֻנֶּה

“Jephunneh”

The word **Jephunneh** is the name of Caleb’s father.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:36 (#2)

הוּא יִרְאֶנָּה

“he, he shall see it”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verb translated as **he shall see** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he will see it and not the others. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing that emphasis. Alternate translation: [he is the one who shall see it] or [only he shall see it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 1:36 (#3)

וְלוֹ־אֶתֵּן אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר דָּרַךְ־בָּהּ וּלְבָנָיו יַעַן אֲשֶׁר מִלֵּא אַחֲרֵי יְהוָה

“And to him I will give the land that he has stepped on, and to his sons, because {he is} wholly after Yahweh”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could move the last phrase to the beginning, since the last phrase gives the reason for the result that the beginning of the sentence describes. Alternate translation: [He is wholly after Yahweh, so to him I will give the land that he has stepped on, and to his sons]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 1:36 (#4)

וּלְבָנָיו

“and to his sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:36 (#5)

אֲשֶׁר מִלֵּא אַחֲרֵי יְהוָה

“he is} wholly after Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of obedience as if it were a path that one could follow **after**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he wholly obeys Yahweh’s commands]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 1:36 (#6)

אַחֲרֵי יְהוָה

“after Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking about himself in the third person. If this would not be natural in your language, you could use the first person form. Alternate translation: [after me, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Deuteronomy 1:37 (#1)

גַּם־בִּי֙ הִתְאַנַּ֣ף יְהוָ֔ה בִּגְלַלְכֶ֖ם

“Also Yahweh was angry with me because of you”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 20:1–13

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:38 (#1)

נוּן

“Nun”

The word **Nun** is the name of Joshua’s father.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 1:38 (#2)

הָעֹמֵד

“who stands”

The implication is that Joshua **stands** before the Israelites as a servant before their master. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who stands as your servant]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:38 (#3)

לְפָנֶ֔יךָ

“to your face”

Here, **face** represents the presence of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:39 (#1)

וְטַפְּכֶם֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֲמַרְתֶּ֔ם לָבַ֖ז יִהְיֶ֑ה

“And your children that you said would be plunder”

The implication is that the Israelites thought that they would lose the battles against the Amorites, and so their **children** would be captured as **plunder**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [And your children, whom you said would be plunder when you lost the battle]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:39 (#2)

וּבְנֵיכֶ֗ם

“and your sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Yahweh is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [and your children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 1:39 (#3)

לֹא־יָדְע֥וּ הַיּ֛וֹם טֹ֥וב וָרָ֖ע

“today do not know good or evil”

Moses is using **do not know good or evil** as a common expression of his culture to mean “are too young to be responsible.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are still young and innocent] or [cannot yet make responsible choices]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 1:41 (#1)

וַתַּעֲנוּ ׀ וַתֹּאמְרוּ אֵלָ֣י

“And you answered and said to me”

The two words **answered** and **said** express a single idea. The word **answered** indicates that the Israelites **said** the following quote in response to Yahweh’s anger. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [And you answered me]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 1:41 (#2)

אֲנַ֣חְנוּ נַעֲלֶ֔ה וְנִלְחַ֖מְנוּ

“We, we shall go up and fight”

Moses is quoting the people as stating the pronoun **We** separately, even though the verb translated as **we shall go up** already includes this meaning. They said that to emphasize that they had changed their minds and were now committing themselves to go up and fight. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing that emphasis. Alternate translation: [We now commit ourselves to go up and fight]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 1:41 (#3)

לַעֲלֹ֥ת הָהָרָֽה

“to go up to the hill {country”

See how you translated the phrase “go up” in 1:26 where it is used with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [to go up to attack the hill country]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֵלַ֔י אֱמֹ֥ר לָהֶ֖ם לֹ֣א תַעֲל֑וּ

“And Yahweh said to me, ‘Say to them, “Do not go up”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting Yahweh (level 2) telling Moses what to say to the people (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh told me to tell them, ‘Do not go up]

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#2)

אֱמֹ֥ר לָהֶ֖ם לֹ֣א תַעֲל֣וּ וְלֹא־תִלָּ֣חֲמ֔וּ כִּ֚י אֵינֶ֣נִּי בְקִרְבְּכֶ֔ם וְלֹאֹ֥ תִנָּגְפ֖וּ לִפְנֵ֥י אֹיְבֵיכֶֽם

“Say to them, “Do not go up and do not fight, and you will not be defeated to the face of your enemies, because I will not be among you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Say to them that they should not go up and fight, and they will not be defeated to the face of their enemies, because I will not be among them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#3)

לֹ֣א תַעֲל֣וּ וְלֹא־תִלָּ֣חֲמ֔וּ כִּ֚י אֵינֶ֣נִּי בְקִרְבְּכֶ֔ם וְלֹאֹ֥ תִנָּגְפ֖וּ לִפְנֵ֥י אֹיְבֵיכֶֽם

“Do not go up and do not fight, and you will not be defeated to the face of your enemies, because I will not be among you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could move the last phrase to the beginning, since the last phrase gives the reason for the result that the beginning of the sentence describes. Alternate translation: [I will not be among you, so do not go up and do not fight, and you will not be defeated to the face of your enemies.]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#4)

וְלֹאֹ֥ תִנָּגְפ֖וּ לִפְנֵ֥י אֹיְבֵיכֶֽם

“and you will not be defeated to the face of your enemies”

The expression **be defeated** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and your enemies will not defeat you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#5)

וְלֹאלֹא תִנָּגְפוּ לִפְנֵי אֹיְבֵיכֶם

“and you will not be defeated to the face of your enemies”

Here, **and you will not be defeated** is the goal or purpose of the instruction **Do not go up and do not fight**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [so that you will not be defeated]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#6)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of their enemies. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:42 (#7)

אֵינֶנִּי בְקִרְבְּכֶם

“I will not be among you”

As God, Yahweh is always everywhere. The implication is that Yahweh **will not be among** the Israelites in a special way to help them if they choose to disobey him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I will not help you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:43 (#1)

וָאֲדַבֵּר אֲלֵיכֶם וְלֹא שְׁמַעְתֶּם

“And I spoke to you, but you did not listen”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [And I spoke to you what Yahweh had commanded me to tell you, but you did not obey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:43 (#2)

אֶת־פִּפִּי

“the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to Yahweh’s commands and what he says to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the command of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:43 (#3)

וַתַּעֲלֹוּ הָהָרָה

“and went up to the hill {country”

The implication is that the Israelite soldiers **went up to the hill country** to attack the people there. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and attacked the people who live in the hill country]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:44 (#1)

וַיֵּרְדְּפוּ אֶתְכֶם כַּאֲשֶׁר תַּעֲשֶׂינָה הַדְּבֹרִים

“and chased you like the bees do”

Moses compares the Amorites to **bees** because large swarms of bees attack and sting people. So many Amorites attacked the Israelite soldiers that they had to flee from the battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a similar expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and chased you like a dog chases a cat] or [and chased you persistently]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 1:44 (#2)

הַדְּבֹרִים

“the bees”

A **bee** is a small, flying insect that may fly in a swarm; it stings people who threaten it. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of insect, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the stinging insects]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 1:44 (#3)

וַיַּכּתֻוּ אֶתְכֶם

“and caused you to scatter”

Here, **to scatter** means to retreat. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and caused you to retreat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:45 (#1)

וַתָּשֻׁבוּ

“And you returned”

The implication is that the fighting men returned from the battle to where the rest of the Israelites were camping at Kadesh Barnea. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And you returned to Kadesh Barnea]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:45 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of” in 1:42. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:45 (#3)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַע יְהוָה בְּקֹלְכֶם וְלֹא הֶאֱזִין אֲלֵיכֶם

“but Yahweh did not hear your voice, and he did not listen to you”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh did not listen to your voice, indeed he did not give ear to you]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 1:45 (#4)

וְלֹא־שָׁמַע יְהוָה

“but Yahweh did not hear”

When Moses uses **did not hear** in reference to Yahweh, it means that Yahweh chose not to do what the people had asked him in prayer. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [but Yahweh did not respond]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 1:45 (#5)

בְּקֹלְכֶם

“your voice”

Here, **voice** represents the words the Israelites spoke. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to what you said]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 1:46 (#1)

כַּיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר יְשַׁבְתֶּם

“according to the days that you stayed {there”

The phrase **according to the days that you stayed there** refers to the entire period of time that the Israelites wandered in the wilderness before arriving in Moab. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could indicate that explicitly. Alternate translation: [all the time that you remained there]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ first speech from the previous chapter.

1. Moses recounts the Israelites’ time in the wilderness (1–23)
2. Moses recounts how Yahweh helped the Israelites defeat King Sihon (24–37)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Possessing the land

Yahweh promised the Israelites that he would give them the land of Canaan if they obeyed him. Other people groups lived in the land, but Yahweh promised

to give the Israelites victory over them. (See: faithful, faithfulness, trustworthy; and Promised Land)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

One direct quotation inside another
In this chapter, Moses gives a speech and quotes what others said. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate or format this passage so that there are no quotations within a quotation. (See Quotes within Quotes)

Moses represents the Israelites
The singular pronoun "you" occurs when Yahweh speaks directly to Moses. The Israelites request that Moses speak to Yahweh on their behalf because the Israelites fear Yahweh and do not want to speak directly to him. Moses acts as a representative on behalf of all the Israelites. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could clarify that Yahweh wants Moses to tell the Israelites everything that Yahweh says.

Background information
The writer of Deuteronomy adds background information to help readers understand the historical context of Moses' speech. In the ULT, this information is enclosed in parentheses. Use a method that is natural in your language for indicating that a section of text is background information. (See: Background Information)

"you" and "your" singular and plural
The pronouns "you" and "your" are plural in this chapter unless otherwise noted. In those places, although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he addresses them as "you" singular. If addressing the Israelites with singular forms would not be natural in your language, you could use plural forms in your translation. (See Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 2:2 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

"saying"

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 2:3 (#1)

פְּנ֥וּ לָכֶ֖ם

"Turn yourselves"

The expression **Turn yourselves** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [Turn]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 2:4 (#1)

וְאֶת־הָעָם֙ צַ֣ו לֵאמֹ֔ר אַתֶּ֥ם עֹבְרִ֛ים בִּגְב֥וּל אֲחֵיכֶ֖ם

"And command the people, saying, "You will be crossing the border of your brothers"

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting Yahweh (level 2) telling Moses what to command the people (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation. Alternate translation: [And command the people to cross the border of their brothers]

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 2:4 (#2)

וְאֶת־הָעָם֙ צַ֣ו לֵאמֹ֔ר אַתֶּ֥ם עֹבְרִ֛ים בִּגְב֥וּל אֲחֵיכֶ֖ם

"And command the people, saying, "You will be crossing the border of your brothers"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And command the people to cross the border of their brothers]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 2:4 (#3)

בִּגְב֥וּל אֲחֵיכֶ֖ם

"the border of your brothers"

Here Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe **the border** around the land that is occupied by the **brothers** of the Israelites. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [into the land occupied by your brothers]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:4 (#4)

אֲחֵיכֶ֖ם בְּנֵי־עֵשָׂ֑ו

"your brothers, the sons of Esau"

The Israelites are descendants of Jacob, who was Esau's brother. The Israelites and the **sons of Esau**

are all descendants of Isaac. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your relatives, the sons of Esau]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:4 (#5)

אֲחֵיכֶם בְּנֵי

“your brothers, the sons of”

Here, **brothers** refers to their relatives and **sons** to the descendants of Esau. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your relatives, the descendants of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:5 (#1)

אַל־תִּתְגָּרְרוּ בָבֶם כִּֽי לֹא־אֶתֵּתֵּן לָכֶם֙ מֵאַרְצָכֶם עַד־מִדְרַךְ כַּף־רָ֔גֶל כִּֽי־יְרֵשָׁ֥ה לְעֵשָׂ֖ו נָתַ֥תִּי אֶת־הַ֛הָר שֵׂעִֽיר

“You shall not fight them, for I will not give to you from their land, {even} as {little} as a step of the sole of a foot, for I have given Mount Seir to Esau {as} a possession”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases, since the last phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [I have given Mount Seir to Esau, so I will not give you any of their land, even as little as a step of the sole of a foot, so you shall not fight them]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:5 (#2)

כִּֽי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces the reason why the Israelites **shall not fight** the descendants of Esau. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different a word or phrase that introduces a reason. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:5 (#3)

עַד־מִדְרַךְ כַּף־רָ֔גֶל

“even} as {little} as a step of the sole of a foot”

Alternate translation: [even as little as the length of a footstep]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:5 (#4)

לְעֵשָׂ֖ו

“to Esau”

Yahweh is using **Esau** to represent all of the descendants of Esau. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:6 (#1)

אׇכֶל֙ תִּשְׁבְּר֣וּ מֵאִתָּ֔ם בַּכֶּ֖סֶף וַאֲכַלְתֶּ֑ם וְגַם־מַ֙יִם֙ תִּכְר֣וּ מֵאִתָּ֔ם בַּכֶּ֖סֶף וּשְׁתִיתֶֽם

“You will buy food from them with silver, and you will eat. And also, you will purchase water from them with silver, and you will drink”

This verse contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the verse. Alternate translation: [You will buy food from them, and also, you will purchase water from them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for the Israelites not to take anything from Esau’s descendants without paying for it. They do not need to take things, because Yahweh has proven that he will provide for them. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [You do not need to take anything from them because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#2)

יְהוָ֤ה אֱלֹהֶ֙יךָ֙

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#3)

אֱלֹהֶ֙יךָ֙ בֵּרַכְךָ֔ & יָדָ֖ךְ & לְכׇל־מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה & אֱלֹהֶ֙יךָ֙ עִמָּ֔ךְ לֹ֥א & חָסַ֖רְתָּ

“your God has blessed you & your hand & your walking through & your God {has been} with you. You have not lacked”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#4)

מַעֲשֵׂי יָדֶךָ

“the work of your hand”

Moses is using one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of him in the act of working. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and in all of your own work]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#5)

יָדַע לְכְתְדְךָ אֶת־הַמִּדְבָּר הַגָּדֹל הַזֶּה

“He has known your walking through this great wilderness”

The implication is that Yahweh **has known** everything that happened to the Israelites when they were **walking through** the **great wilderness**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [He has known all that happened to you during your walking through this great wilderness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#6)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ עִמָּךְ

“Yahweh your God {has been} with you”

As God, Yahweh is always everywhere. The implication is that Yahweh was **with** the Israelites in a special way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God has been with you in a special way]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:7 (#7)

לֹא חָסַרְתָּ דָּבָר

“You have not lacked a thing”

Moses is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of his intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [You have received all things that you needed] or [Yahweh has supplied you with everything you need]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 2:8 (#1)

אַחֵינוּ בְנֵי־עֵשָׂו

“our brothers, the sons of Esau”

See how you translated “your brothers” and “the sons of Esau” in 2:4.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:8 (#2)

וַנִּפֶן

“And we turned”

The implication is that the Israelites **turned** away from the area where the descendants of Esau lived. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And we turned away from their land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלַי אַל־תָּצַר אֶת־מוֹאָב וְאַל־תִּתְגָּר בָּם מִלְחָמָה כִּי לֹא־אֶתֵּן לְךָ מֵאַרְצוֹ יְרֻשָּׁה כִּי לִבְנֵי־לוֹט נָתַתִּי אֶת־עָעָר יְרֻשָּׁה

“And Yahweh said to me, ‘You shall not trouble Moab, and you shall not fight against them {in} battle, for I will not give to you from its land a possession, because I have given Ar to the sons of Lot, {as} a possession”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh commanded me not to allow you to trouble Moab or to fight against them in battle. He said that he would not give to us from its land a possession, because he has given Ar to the sons of Lot, as a possession]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#2)

אַל־תָּצַר אֶת־מוֹאָב וְאַל־תִּתְגָּר בָּם מִלְחָמָה

“You shall not trouble Moab, and you shall not fight against them {in} battle”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [You shall not trouble Moab, indeed you shall not fight against them in battle]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#3)

אֶת־מוֹאָב

“Moab”

The word **Moab** represents the people of Moab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST. Alternate translation: [the people of Moab]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#4)

כִּֽי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces the reason why the Israelites were told not to fight the people of Moab. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different word or phrase that introduces a reason. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#5)

לֹא־אֶתֵּ֥ן לְךָ֖ מֵאַרְצ֑וֹ יְרֻשָּׁ֔ה כִּֽי־לִבְנֵי־לֹ֥וט נָתַ֛תִּי אֶת־עָ֥ר יְרֻשָּֽׁה

“I will not give to you from its land a possession, because I have given Ar to the sons of Lot, {as} a possession”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [I have given Ar to the sons of Lot as a possession, so I will not give to you from his land a possession]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#6)

מֵאַרְצוֹ֑

“from its land”

The pronoun **its** refers to Moab. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the name of the land here. Alternate translation: [from the land of Moab]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:9 (#7)

לִבְנֵי

“to the sons of”

Here, **sons** means the descendants of Lot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:10 (#1)

הָאֵמִ֣ים לְפָנִ֔ים יֵֽשְׁבוּ־בָ֖הּ עַ֣ם גָּד֑וֹל וְרַבִּ֥ים וְרָמִ֖ים כָּעֲנָקִֽים

“The Emites lived there previously, a people great and numerous and tall as the Anakites”

From this verse through verse 12 is all background information about people groups who lived in the area that the Edomites and Moabites occupy. This information helps readers understand what happens next in the story. These verses are not part of Moses’ speech to the Israelites. The ULT marks this information by putting it in parentheses. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 2:11 (#1)

רְפָאִ֣ים יֵחָשְׁב֔וּ אַף־הֵ֖הֵם

“They {are} also considered Raphaites”

The expression **are also considered** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [People refer to them as Raphaites]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 2:12 (#1)

וּבְנֵ֣י

“and the sons of”

Here, **sons** refers to the descendants of Esau. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:12 (#2)

וַיַּשְׁמִידוּם֙ מִפְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

“And they destroyed them from their faces”

The pronouns **they** and **their** refer to the sons of Esau. The pronoun **them** refers to the Horites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the names of the people groups here. Alternate translation: [And the sons of Esau destroyed the Horites from their faces]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:12 (#3)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

“from their faces”

Here the phrase **from their faces** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on their account” or “on their behalf,” Alternate translation: [on their behalf] or (2) represent [from their presence.] Alternate translation: [from before them]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:12 (#4)

עָשָׂ֣ה

“did”

Here the writer uses the past tense, **did**, to refer to events that happen after Moses said all these things. If it would not be natural to do that in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [would do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:12 (#5)

לְאֶ֣רֶץ יְרֻשָּׁתֹ֔ו אֲשֶׁר־נָתַ֥ן יְהוָ֖ה לָהֶֽם

“to the land of his possession that Yahweh gave to them”

The writer is using the possessive form to describe the **land** that **Yahweh gave** the Israelites to live in as a **possession**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [to the land that Yahweh gave them to live in as a possession]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:13 (#1)

עַתָּ֣ה קֻ֔מוּ וְעִבְרָ֖ו לָכֶ֑ם אֶת־נַ֖חַל זָֽרֶד

“Now, for yourselves, rise up and cross the wadi of Zered”

The implication is that Yahweh is speaking these commands. If it would be more natural in your language, you could: (1) use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. Alternate translation: [Then Yahweh said, “‘Now, for yourselves, rise up and cross the wadi of Zered.’] or (2) translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Then Yahweh told us to rise up for ourselves and cross the wadi of Zered]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 2:13 (#2)

קֻ֔מוּ

“rise up”

Yahweh is using the phrase **rise up** as a common expression of the culture to mean to “take action.” He is not telling him to get out of bed or stand up from a seated position. If this expression does not mean this in your language, you could use a comparable expression that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [start your journey]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:13 (#3)

אֶת־נַ֖חַל זָֽרֶד & אֶת־נַ֖חַל זָֽרֶד

“the wadi of Zered & the wadi of Zered”

Zered is the name of a stream that flows through a gorge into the Dead Sea. The stream goes from the southeast and creates the border between Edom and Moab.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 2:14 (#1)

וְהַיָּמִ֗ים אֲשֶׁר־הָלַ֤כְנוּ ׀ מִקָּדֵשׁ֙ בַּרְנֵ֔עַ עַ֖ד אֲשֶׁר־עָבַ֣רְנוּ֑ אֶת־נַ֖חַל זָֽרֶד שְׁלֹשִׁ֣ים וּשְׁמֹנֶ֔ה שָׁנָ֑ה

“And the days which we came from Kadesh Barnea until we crossed the wadi of Zered {were} 38 years”

Here Moses is using **days** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the time that had passed from when we came from

Kadesh Barnea until we crossed the wadi of Zered was 38 years]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:14 (#2)

עַד־תֹּם כָּל־הַדּוֹר אַנְשֵׁי הַמִּלְחָמָה מִקֶּרֶב הַמַּחֲנֶה כַּאֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע יְהוָה לָהֶם

"until all the generation of the men of war were finished from among the camp, as Yahweh had sworn to them"

The Israelites who were old enough to fight disobeyed Yahweh. As a result, Yahweh punished them so they would die before they could enter the land that Yahweh said he would give to them. See 1:19–45. Alternate translation: [until all the generation of men of war were finished from among the camp, according to the punishment of Yahweh for their disobedience]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:14 (#3)

תֹּם

"were finished"

Moses is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **were finished**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to death in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [had died]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 2:14 (#4)

מִקֶּרֶב הַמַּחֲנֶה

"from among the camp"

Here, **camp** represents all of the Israelites and anyone traveling with them in the wilderness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from among the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:15 (#1)

יַד־יְהוָה הָיְתָה בָּם

"the hand of Yahweh was against them"

Here, **hand** represents Yahweh's power and actions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh used his power against them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:15 (#2)

מִקֶּרֶב הַמַּחֲנֶה

"from among the camp"

See how you translated "from among the camp" in the previous verse 2:14.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:15 (#3)

תֻּמָּם

"they came to an end"

Moses is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **came to an end**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [they died]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 2:16 (#1)

וַיְהִי

"And it happened"

Moses is using the word translated **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Then]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 2:16 (#2)

תַּמּוֹת כָּל־אַנְשֵׁי הַמִּלְחָמָה לָמוּת מִקֶּרֶב הָעָם

"all the men of war came to an end, dying from among the people"

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The first clause uses a euphemism, while the second clause states the meaning plainly. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [all the men of war came to an end, indeed, they died from among the people]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 2:18 (#1)

אַתָּ֣ה

“You”

Here the singular pronoun **You** refers to Moses. Yahweh is speaking to Moses, but he is giving commands for all of the Israelites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could (1) use the plural form of the pronoun. (2) state the audience plainly. Alternate translation: [These are instructions for you and all the Israelites. You]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:19 (#1)

וְקָרַבְתָּ֗ & אַל־תְּצֵרֵם֙ וְאַל־תִּתְגָּ֣ר & לְךָ֔

“And you will approach & You shall not trouble them, and you shall not fight & to you”

Here the singular pronoun **you** refers to Moses. Yahweh is speaking to Moses, but he is giving commands for all of the Israelites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could (1) use plural forms of the pronoun. (2) state the audience plainly. See how you translated this in the previous verse.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:19 (#2)

בְּנֵ֣י עַמּ֔וֹן & בְּנֵי־עַמּ֖וֹן & לִבְנֵי־לֹ֥וט

“the sons of Ammon & the sons of Ammon & to the sons of Lot”

Like the Moabites, the people of **Ammon** are also descendants of **Lot**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the sons of Ammon, who are descendants of Lot ... the sons of Ammon ... to the sons of Lot]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:19 (#3)

בְּנֵ֣י & בְּנֵי & לִבְנֵי

“the sons of & the sons of & to the sons of”

Here, **sons** refers to descendants. Although the term **sons** is masculine, Moses is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:19 (#4)

כִּֽי

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces the reason why the Israelites **shall not fight** the descendants of Ammon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different a word or phrase that introduces a reason. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:19 (#5)

אַל־תְּצֵרֵם֙ וְאַל־תִּתְגָּ֣ר בָּ֔ם

“You shall not trouble them, and you shall not fight them”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [You shall not trouble them, indeed, you shall not fight them]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 2:19 (#6)

לֹֽא־אֶתֵּ֥ן מֵאֶ֛רֶץ בְּנֵי־עַמּ֖וֹן לְךָ֣ יְרֻשָּׁ֑ה כִּֽי־לִבְנֵי־לֹ֥וט נְתַתִּ֖יהָ יְרֻשָּֽׁה

“I will not give to you from the land of the sons of Ammon {as} a possession, because I have given it to the sons of Lot {as} a possession”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [I have given the land to the sons of Lot as a possession, so I will not give to you from it as a possession]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:20 (#1)

אֶ֣רֶץ־רְפָאִ֣ים תֵּחָשֵׁ֔ב אַף־הִ֥וא רְפָאִ֖ים יָשְׁב֣וּ־בָ֑הּ לְפָנִ֗ים וְהָעַמֹּנִ֛ים יִקְרְא֥וּ לָהֶ֖ם זַמְזֻמִּֽים

“Also, {it} is regarded as a land of the Raphaites. The Raphaites lived there previously, but the Ammonites call them Zamzummites”

Starting from this verse through verse 23, the author is providing background information about people groups who lived in the area that the Ammonites,

Edomites, and Caphtorites occupied. This information helps readers understand what happens next in the story. These verses are not part of Moses' speech to the Israelites. The ULT marks this information by putting it in parentheses. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 2:20 (#2)

אֶֽרֶץ־רְפָאִ֥ים תֵּחָשֵׁ֖ב אַף־הִ֑וא

"Also, {it} is regarded as a land of the Raphaites"

The expression **is regarded** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Also, people refer to it as a land of the Raphaites]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 2:20 (#3)

רְפָאִ֥ים & זַמְזֻמִּֽים

"the Raphaites. The Raphaites & Zamzummites"

The words **Raphaites** and **Zamzummites** are names for the same group of people. See how you translated "Raphaites" in 2:11.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 2:21 (#1)

וַיַּשְׁמִידֵ֣ם יְהוָה֮ מִפְּנֵיהֶם֒ וַיִּֽירָשֵׁ֣ם וַיֵּשְׁבוּ֙ תַּחְתָּ֔ם

"But Yahweh destroyed them from their faces, and they dispossessed them and lived in their place"

Here the pronoun **them** refers to the Raphaites. The pronoun **their** in the first clause refers to the Ammonites. The pronoun **their** in the second clause refers to the Raphaites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could repeat the names of the people groups. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh destroyed the Raphaites from the Ammonites' faces, and the Ammonites dispossessed the Raphaites and lived in their place]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:21 (#2)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

"from their faces"

Here the phrase **from their faces** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means "on their account" or "on their behalf," Alternate translation: [on their behalf] or (2) represent [from their presence.] Alternate translation: [from before them]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:22 (#1)

לִבְנֵ֣י

"for the sons of"

Here, **sons** means the descendants of Esau. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:22 (#2)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֔ם וַיִּֽירָשֵׁם֙ וַיֵּשְׁבוּ֙ תַּחְתָּ֔ם

"from their faces, and they dispossessed them and have lived in their place"

In the first clause, the pronoun **their** refers to the sons of Esau. In the second clause, **they** refers to the sons of Esau, while the pronouns **them** and **their** refer to the Horites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could repeat the names of the people groups. Alternate translation: [from before the sons of Esau's faces, and the sons of Esau dispossessed the Horites and have lived in their place]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:22 (#3)

מִפְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

"from their faces"

See how you translated the phrase "from their faces" in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:22 (#4)

עַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

"until this day"

Moses is using the phrase **until this day** to refer to a specific time, the time when he was writing this book. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. Alternate translation: [right up to this time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:23 (#1)

וְהָעַוִּ֗ים הַיֹּשְׁבִ֤ים בַּחֲצֵרִים֙ עַד־עַזָּ֔ה כַּפְתֹרִ֖ים הַיֹּצְאִ֣ים מִכַּפְתֹּ֑ור

“And the Avvites who lived in villages as far as Gaza, the Caphtorites, who came from Caphtor”

Here the author introduces **the Avvites** and then describes what happened to them. If your language has its own way of introducing new participants, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [And as for the Avvites who lived in villages as far as Gaza, the Caphtorites, who came from Caphtor]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Deuteronomy 2:23 (#2)

מִכַּפְתֹּ֑ור

“from Caphtor”

The word **Caphtor** is the name of a place. It may be another name for the island of Crete, located in the Mediterranean Sea.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 2:23 (#3)

הִשְׁמִידֻ֖ם וַיֵּשְׁבוּ֙ תַּחְתָּ֔ם

“destroyed them and lived in their place”

Here the pronouns **them** and **their** refer to the Avvites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [destroyed the Avvites and lived in their place]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#1)

קֻ֣מוּ סְעُ֔ו וְעִבְר֖וּ

“Rise up, journey, and pass through”

Even though Yahweh is speaking to Moses, the forms of these commands are plural. Yahweh wants Moses to tell these commands to all of the Israelites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use singular pronouns.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#2)

קֻ֣מוּ

“Rise up”

See how you translated “rise up” in 2:13 where it occurs with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [Begin traveling]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#3)

רְאֵ֗ה

“Look”

Yahweh is using the term **Look** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Surely]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#4)

בְּיָדְךָ֙ & הָחֵ֣ל רָ֔שׁ וְהִתְגָּ֖ר

“into your hand & Begin to possess {it}, and fight”

Here the singular pronoun **your** refers to Moses. The forms of the commands **Begin to possess it** and **fight** are also singular. Yahweh is speaking to Moses because Moses is the leader of the Israelites, but these phrases apply to all of the Israelites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use plural forms of the pronoun. Check for consistency with how you translated this in 2:18.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#5)

בְּיָדְךָ֙

“into your hand”

Here the word **hand** means “power” or “control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you power over]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#6)

אַרְצֹ֔ו

“his land”

Here the possessive form describes the **land** that King Sihon rules over. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [the land he rules over]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:24 (#7)

בּ֣וֹ

“against him”

Here the pronoun **him** refers to Sihon and his army. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against Sihon and his army]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#1)

פַּחְדְּךָ֤ וְיִרְאָתְךָ֙ & שִׂמְעָתֶ֔ךָ

“the fear of you and the terror of you & a report of you”

Although Yahweh is speaking about all of the Israelites, Yahweh uses the singular pronouns **you** and **your**. This is because Yahweh is speaking directly to Moses who acts as a representative for the Israelites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use plural forms of the pronoun. Alternate translation: [the fear of the Israelites and the terror of the Israelites ... a report of the Israelites]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#2)

תֵּ֣תֵּת פַּחְדְּךָ֤ וְיִרְאָתְךָ֙ עַל־פְּנֵ֣י הָעַמִּ֔ים תַּ֖חַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“to put the fear of you and the terror of you on the faces of the peoples under all the heavens”

Here Yahweh speaks of emotions as if they were something you could physically **put on the faces of the peoples**. He means that he will cause **the peoples** to feel **fear** and **terror**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to cause the peoples under all the heavens to feel the fear of you and the terror of you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#3)

אָחֵ֣ל׀ תֵּ֣תֵּת פַּחְדְּךָ֤ וְיִרְאָתְךָ֙ עַל־פְּנֵ֣י

“I will begin to put the fear of you and the terror of you on the faces of”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **fear** and **terror**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [I will begin to cause you to frighten and terrify the hearts of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#4)

פַּחְדְּךָ֤ וְיִרְאָתְךָ֙ & שִׂמְעָתֶ֔ךָ

“the fear of you and the terror of you & a report of you”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe how the Israelites will cause **fear**, **terror**, and **a report** about them. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression that describes cause and effect. Alternate translation: [the fear caused by you and the terror caused by you ... a report about you]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#5)

פַּחְדְּךָ֤ וְיִרְאָתְךָ֙

“the fear of you and the terror of you”

The terms **fear** and **terror** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [extremely great fear of you]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#6)

תַּ֖חַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“under all the heavens”

Yahweh is using **under all the heavens** as a common expression of his culture to mean “everywhere.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all over the earth]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#7)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר

“that”

Here the word **that** identifies what comes after it as the purpose of the clause that comes before it. Yahweh will cause the peoples to fear the Israelites in order that the peoples might tremble. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#8)

וְרָגְזוּ֙ וְחָלְל֣וּ

“and might quake and tremble”

The terms **quake** and **tremble** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and will surely tremble]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 2:25 (#9)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your face”

Moses is using **from your face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:26 (#1)

וָאֶשְׁלַח

“And I sent”

Here the pronoun **I** refers to Moses. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the person’s name here. Alternate translation: [And I, Moses, sent]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:26 (#2)

מִמִּדְבַּר קְדֵמוֹת

“from the wilderness of Kedemoth”

The term **wilderness of Kedemoth** is the name of a desert near the valley of Arnon.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 2:26 (#3)

דִּבְרֵי שָׁלוֹם

“with} words of peace”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe how his message to Sihon contains **words** that are characterized by **peace**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [with a peaceful message]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:26 (#4)

דִּבְרֵי שָׁלוֹם

“with} words of peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [communicating peaceably]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 2:26 (#5)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Deuteronomy 2:27 (#1)

אֶעְבְּרָה & אֵלֵךְ לֹא אָסוּר

“I will pass through & I will go. I will not turn”

Although Moses is speaking on behalf of all the Israelites, he uses the singular pronoun **I** here. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural pronouns as is modeled in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:27 (#2)

בְּאַרְצֶךָ

“your land”

Moses is using the possessive form to describe the **land** that King Sihon rules over. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [the land that you rule over]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:27 (#3)

בַּדֶּרֶךְ אֵלֵךְ לֹא אָסוּר יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאול

“On the road I will go. I will not turn right or left”

These two sentences mean basically the same thing. The second sentence emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the sentences with a word that shows that, in

the new sentence, the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [On the road I will go; indeed, I will not turn right or left]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 2:27 (#4)

בַּדֶּ֖רֶךְ אֵלֵ֑ךְ

“On the road I will go”

By beginning the sentence with **On the road**, Moses is emphasizing that he will only **go** by traveling upon the road and not off of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a word order or phrase that clarifies this information. Alternate translation: [I will go on the road only]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 2:28 (#1)

אׇכֶל֩ בַּכֶּ֨סֶף תַּשְׁבִּרֵ֜נִי וְאָכַ֗לְתִּי וּמַ֤יִם בַּכֶּ֙סֶף֙ תִּתֶּן־לִ֣י וְשָׁתִ֔יתִי

“You will sell me food for silver, and I will eat. And give to me water for silver, and I will drink”

Moses is assuring Sihon that the Israelites will not trouble Sihon and his people by stealing from them. Instead, they will pay for everything they need. Moses is communicating a polite request rather than a command. Use a form in your language that communicates a polite request. It may be helpful to add an expression such as “please” to make this clear. Alternate translation: [Please sell me food for money, and I will eat. And please give to me water for money, and I will drink.]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Deuteronomy 2:28 (#2)

אׇכֶל֩ בַּכֶּ֨סֶף תַּשְׁבִּרֵ֜נִי וְאָכַ֗לְתִּי וּמַ֤יִם בַּכֶּ֙סֶף֙ תִּתֶּן־לִ֣י וְשָׁתִ֔יתִי

“You will sell me food for silver, and I will eat. And give to me water for silver, and I will drink”

This verse contains expressions with extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [You will sell me food and water]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 2:28 (#3)

תַּשְׁבִּרֵ֜נִי וְאָכַ֗לְתִּי & לִ֣י וְשָׁתִ֔יתִי & אֶעְבְּרָ֖ה בְּרַגְלָֽי

“You will sell me & and I will eat & to me & and I will drink & let me pass through on my feet”

Although Moses is speaking on behalf of all the Israelites, he uses the singular pronouns **me**, **I**, and **my** here. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural pronouns or clarify to whom the pronouns refer. Alternate translation: [You will sell me and the Israelites … and we will eat … to us … and we will drink … let us pass through on our feet]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:28 (#4)

בְּרַגְלָֽי

“on my feet”

The messenger is using **on my feet** as a common expression of his culture to mean to travel by walking. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by walking]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:29 (#1)

לִ֣י & אֶעֱבֹֽר

“for me & I cross”

Here the singular pronouns **me** and **I** refer to Moses. Moses is speaking to Yahweh because Moses is the leader of the Israelites, but these phrases apply to all of the Israelites. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use plural forms of the pronoun. Alternate translation: [for us … we pass over]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 2:29 (#2)

בְּנֵ֤י

“the sons of”

Here, **sons** means the descendants of Esau. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:30 (#1)

אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ & בְּיָדְךָ֖

“your God & into your hand”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **your** is singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:30 (#2)

הִקְשָׁהוְ & אֶת־רוּחֹו וְאַמֵּיץ אֶת־לְבָבֹו

“had hardened his spirit and strengthened his heart”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [had hardened his spirit; indeed, he strengthened his heart]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 2:30 (#3)

הִקְשָׁהוְ & אֶת־רוּחֹו וְאַמֵּיץ אֶת־לְבָבֹו

“had hardened his spirit and strengthened his heart”

The messenger is using **hardened his spirit** and **strengthened his heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “caused him to be stubborn.” If these phrases do not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [had caused him to be stiff-necked and caused him to be as stubborn as a mule] or [had caused him to be resistant and caused him to be obstinate]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 2:30 (#4)

בְּיָדְךָ

“into your hand”

Here, **hand** represents someone’s power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:31 (#1)

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָהוְ אֵלַי רְאֵה הַחִלֹּתִיו תֵּת לְפָנֶיךָ אֶת־סִיחֹן וְאֶת־אַרְצֹו הָחֵל רָשׁ לָרֶשֶׁת אֶת־אַרְצֹו

“And Yahweh said to me, ‘Look, I have begun giving to your face Sihon and his land. Begin, possess, to possess his land”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh told me that he had begun giving to my face Sihon and his land. He commanded me to begin conquering and possessing his land]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 2:31 (#2)

רְאֵה

“Look”

Yahweh is using the term **Look** to focus the Moses’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Surely]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:31 (#3)

תֵּת לְפָנֶיךָ אֶת־סִיחֹן וְאֶת־אַרְצֹו

“giving to your face Sihon and his land”

Here Yahweh speaks as if he is physically **giving** Sihon to Moses. Yahweh means that he is enabling Moses to defeat Sihon and take over the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [giving you victory over Sihon and his land]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:31 (#4)

לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your face”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the similar phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated “to your face” in 1:21. Alternate translation: [before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:31 (#5)

אַרְצֹו & אֶת־אַרְצֹו

“his land & his land”

Here the pronoun **his** refers to King Sihon. Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe the **land** that King Sihon rules over. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [the land that he rules over ... the land that he rules over]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 2:31 (#6)

הָחֵ֖ל רָ֣שׁ לָרֶ֑שֶׁת אֶת־אַרְצֽוֹ

“Begin, possess, to possess his land”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **possess** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Begin taking possession of his land and fully possess it]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 2:32 (#1)

וַיֵּצֵא֩ סִיחֹ֨ן לִקְרָאתֵ֜נוּ

“And Sihon came out against us”

The implication is that **Sihon came out** of his main city, Heshbon, and went to Jahaz to fight against the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Sihon came out from Heshbon to attack us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:32 (#2)

עַמּ֔וֹ

“his people”

Here, **his people** refers to the fighting men whom Sihon led. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his fighting men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:33 (#1)

וַיִּתְּנֵ֥הוּ יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֑ינוּ

“And Yahweh our God gave him”

Here Moses speaks as if Yahweh physically **gave** Sihon to the Israelites. Moses means that Yahweh enabled the Israelites to defeat Sihon. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh our God gave us victory over him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:33 (#2)

לְפָנֵ֔ינוּ

“to our faces”

Here, **faces** represents being in their presence which implies being under their control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into our control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:33 (#3)

וַנַּ֥ךְ אֹת֛וֹ

“and we struck him down”

Here, **struck down** means to defeat in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and we defeated him]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:33 (#4)

בנו

“his son”

Many ancient manuscripts read “son.” The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read the plural, “sons.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Deuteronomy 2:33 (#5)

בנו

“his son”

The implication is that the Israelites killed Sihon’s heir, **his son**, so that Sihon would not have descendants that would try to take the land back from the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his son who was his heir]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:34 (#1)

וַנַּחֲרֵם֙

“and devoted”

The word that the ULT translates as **devoted** is a specialized term that describes the cultural practice of giving something over to Yahweh so that humans will no longer be able to use it. Depending on the context, the term can indicate either “destroy” or “preserve, but set apart.” In this context, the meaning is clearly “destroy.” You could indicate that in your translation if it would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and completely destroyed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:36 (#1)

שְׂפַת

“the lip of”

Here, **the lip** means the edge. In this case, **lip** specifically refers to the edge of the valley. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, as modeled by the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 2:36 (#2)

לֹֽא הָיְתָה֙ קִרְיָ֣ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר שָׂגְבָ֔ה מִמֶּ֖נּוּ

“there was not a city that {was} too high for us”

Moses is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression, **too high**, that has the opposite of his intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [we were able to defeat the people of every city even if the city had high walls around it]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 2:36 (#3)

אֶת־הַכֹּֽל

“the whole”

The implication is that Yahweh gave the Israelites **the whole** of the land described in this verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [all of the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 2:36 (#4)

לְפָנֵ֑ינוּ

“to our faces”

See how you translated “to our faces” in verse 33. Alternate translation: [into our control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 2:37 (#1)

רַ֚ק אֶל־אֶ֣רֶץ בְּנֵי־עַמּ֔וֹן לֹ֥א קָרָ֖בְתָּ כָּל־יַ֣ד נַחַ֑ל יַבֹּ֕קְ וְעָרֵ֖י הָהָ֑ר
וְכֹ֖ל אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵֽינוּ

“It was} only to the land of the sons of Ammon that you did not approach, all the hand of the wadi of Jabbok, and the cities of the hill {country}, and all Yahweh our God had commanded”

Moses means that the Israelites only traveled where Yahweh commanded them to travel, and not anywhere else. If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the phrasing of this verse. Alternate translation: [You only approached the land that Yahweh our God had commanded. You did not approach the land of the sons of Ammon, all the side of the wadi of Jabbok, and the cities of the hill country]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 2:37 (#2)

לֹ֥א קָרָ֖בְתָּ

“you did not approach”

Even though **you** is singular in this verse, Moses is referring to himself and all the Israelites. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use a plural in your translation. Alternate translation: [we did not approach]

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 2:37 (#3)

יַ֣ד

“the hand of”

Here, **hand** means “side” when referring to a wadi or river. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the side of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses' speech that began in Chapter 1.

1. Moses recounts how the Israelites defeated King Og and took land east of the Jordan River (1–11)
2. Moses allots land east of the Jordan River to Reuben, Gad, and Manasseh (12–20)
3. Yahweh forbids Moses from entering the land (21–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Possessing the land

Yahweh promised the Israelites that he will give them the land of Canaan if they obey him. Other people groups live in the land, but Yahweh promises to give the Israelites victory over them. The land belongs to Israel, but they have not yet entered it to possess the land. (See: faithful, faithfulness, trustworthy; and Promised Land)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

One direct quotation inside another

In this chapter, Moses gives a speech and quotes what others said. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate or format this passage so that there are no quotations within a quotation. (See Quotes within Quotes)

Time background

In his speech, Moses reminds the Israelites about what happened to their ancestors before they entered the land that Yahweh promised to give to them. Throughout his speech, Moses repeats the phrase "at that time" to refer to events that occurred during that time period. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could state this information explicitly. (See: Introduction of a New Event)

"you" and "your" plural

Throughout this chapter, when Moses is speaking to the Israelites, he uses the plural forms of "you" and "your."

Deuteronomy 3:1 (#1)

וַנַּ֣עַל

"and went up"

In keeping with what is usual for his language and culture, Moses uses **went up** to mark travel for change in elevation. If this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language, you can shorten it. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase "went up." Alternate translation: [and went on]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 3:1 (#2)

דֶּ֖רֶךְ הַבָּשָׁ֑ן

"the road of the Bashan"

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **road** that goes through the region of **Bashan**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different way to explain the relationship between **road** and **Bashan**. Alternate translation: [the road in the land of Bashan]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:1 (#3)

וַיֵּצֵ֤א עוֹג֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ־הַבָּשָׁ֔ן לִקְרָאתֵ֖נוּ

"And Og, the king of the Bashan, came out against us"

The implication is that Og **came out** of the city where he lived in order to fight against the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And Og, the king of the Bashan, came out from his city to attack us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:1 (#4)

עַמּ֔וֹ

"his people"

Here, **people** refers to fighting men. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his fighting men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:2 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֵלַ֔י אַל־תִּירָ֖א אֹת֑וֹ כִּ֣י בְיָדְךָ֗ נָתַ֤תִּי אֹתוֹ֙ וְאֶת־כָּל־עַמּ֣וֹ וְאֶת־אַרְצ֔וֹ וְעָשִׂ֣יתָ לּ֔וֹ כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשִׂ֖יתָ לְסִיחֹ֣ן מֶֽלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִ֑י אֲשֶׁ֥ר יוֹשֵׁ֖ב בְּחֶשְׁבּֽוֹן

"And Yahweh said to me, 'You shall not fear him; for I have given him and all his people and his land into your hand. And you will do to him as you did to Sihon, king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon"

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within

a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh commanded me not to fear him, for he has given him and all his people and his land into my hand. He told me to do to him as I did to Sihon, king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 3:2 (#2)

אֹתוֹ & עַמּוֹ & אַרְצוֹ & לוֹ

“him & his people & his land & to him”

Here the words **him** and **his** refer back to Og in the previous verse. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the person’s name here. Alternate translation: [Og ... Og ... his people ... his land ... to him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:2 (#3)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [this is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 3:2 (#4)

בְּיָדְךָ

“into your hand”

Here the word **hand** means “power” or “control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:3 (#1)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ

“Yahweh our God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh our God” in 1:6.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:3 (#2)

בְּיָדֵנוּ

“into our hands”

Here the word **hand** means “power” or “control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into our control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:3 (#3)

וַנַּכֵּהוּ

“And we struck him down”

Here, **struck him down** means to defeat him in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And we defeated him] or [And we slew them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:4 (#1)

לֹא הָיְתָה קִרְיָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־לָקַחְנוּ מֵאִתָּם שִׁשִּׁים עִירֹ

“There was not a city of 60 cities that we did not take from them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the repeated negative particle **not**. Alternate translation: [We took from them every city of 60 cities]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 3:5 (#1)

עָרִים בְּצֻרוֹת

“were} inaccessible cities”

The implication is that these **cities** were fortified, so they were hard to access. The walls, gates, and bars protected the city from attack. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [were fortified cities]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:5 (#2)

דְּלָתַיִם וּבְרִיחַ

“and} gates and bars”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **bars** tells what the **gates** were like. The city walls had gates with metal bars across them to keep enemies from coming in the cities. If it would be helpful in your language, you

could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use **and**. Alternate translation: [that had barred gates]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 3:6 (#1)

אוֹתָם

“them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the cities and towns over which King Og ruled. If this is not clear for your readers, you could include this information. Alternate translation: [the cities]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:6 (#2)

הַחֲרֵמְנוּ & וַנַּחֲרֵם

“And we devoted & devoting”

The implication is that the Israelites killed everyone in this city so that no person was left living there. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. See how you translated “devoted” in 2:34. Alternate translation: [And we destroyed ... destroying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:6 (#3)

כָּל־עִיר

“every city”

Here, **city** represents the people living inside the cities. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the people in every city]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:8 (#1)

מִיַּד

“from the hand of”

Here the word **hand** means “power” or “control.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [away from the control of] or [out of the control of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:8 (#2)

שְׁנֵי

“the two”

Alternate translation: [both of the]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 3:8 (#3)

בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן

“were} across the Jordan”

The implication is that the Amorites were **across the Jordan** from the rest of the land that Yahweh promised to give to the Israelites. The Amorites were east of the Jordan. Alternate translation: [were over on the east side of the Jordan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:9 (#1)

צִידֹנִיִּם יִקְרְאוּ לְחֶרְמוֹן שִׂרְיֹן וְהָאֱמֹרִי יִקְרְאוּ־לוֹ שְׂנִיר

“the Sidonians call Hermon Sirion, and the Amorites call it Senir”

This verse provides background information about the land that the Israelites conquered. This information helps readers understand what happened in the story. These verses are not part of Moses’ speech to the Israelites. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 3:9 (#2)

לְחֶרְמוֹן שִׂרְיֹן & שְׂנִיר

“Hermon Sirion & Senir”

The words **Hermon**, **Sirion**, and **Senir** are all names for the same mountain, which is at the northern border of Bashan. Alternate translation: [Hermon by the name ... Senir]

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 3:10 (#1)

הַמִּישֹׁר

“the plain”

The **plain** is an area of high, flat land between the Arnon River and Mount Gilead. You could include this information, as in the UST, if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:10 (#2)

עָרֵי הַמִּישֹׁר

“the cities of the plain”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **cities** that are located on **the plain**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could describe the location in a comparable way. Alternate translation: [the cities located on the plain]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:11 (#1)

כִּי֩ רַק־עֹ֨וג מֶֽלֶךְ־הַבָּשָׁ֜ן נִשְׁאַ֣ר׀ מִיֶּ֣תֶר הָרְפָאִ֗ים הִנֵּ֤ה עַרְשׂוֹ֙ עֶ֣רֶשׂ בַּרְזֶ֔ל הֲלֹ֥ה הִ֖וא בְּרַבַּ֣ת בְּנֵ֣י עַמֹּ֑ון תֵּ֚שַׁע אַמֹּ֣ות אָרְכָּ֔הּ וְאַרְבַּ֥ע אַמֹּ֖ות רָחְבָּ֑הּ בְּאַמַּ֖ת־אִֽישׁ

“For only Og, king of Bashan, had remained from the remnant of the Raphaites. Behold, his couch {was} a couch of iron. {Is} it not in Rabbah, of the sons of Ammon? {It was} nine cubits long and four cubits wide, by the cubit of man”

This verse provides background information about King Og. This information helps readers understand what happened in the story. These verses are not part of Moses’ speech to the Israelites. The ULT has used parentheses to mark this information as background. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 3:11 (#2)

הִנֵּה

“Behold”

The author is using the term **Behold** to focus attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 3:11 (#3)

הֲלֹ֥ה הִ֖וא בְּרַבַּ֣ת בְּנֵ֣י עַמֹּ֑ון

“Is} it not in Rabbah, of the sons of Ammon”

The writer uses a question to remind the Israelites that they could go to Rabbah and see how large Og must have been. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is in Rabbah, of the sons of Ammon.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 3:11 (#4)

אַמֹּות & אַמֹּות & בְּאַמַּת

“cubits & cubits & by the cubit of”

A **cubit** is a measurement of distance equivalent to 46 centimeters. Nine cubits is approximately four meters, and four cubits is approximately 1.8 meters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or a footnote.

See: Biblical Distance

Deuteronomy 3:11 (#5)

בְּאַמַּת־אִֽישׁ

“by the cubit of man”

Here the author is using the possessive form to describe the measurement of **the cubit** that a **man** would normally use. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression to describe a standard measurement. Alternate translation: [according to the cubit that most people use]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:12 (#1)

וְעָרָ֑יו

“and its cities”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **cities** that are located in the hill country of Gilead. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression for describing location. Alternate translation: [and the cities in that region]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:13 (#1)

וְיֶ֣תֶר הַגִּלְעָ֗ד וְכָל־הַבָּשָׁן֙ מַמְלֶ֣כֶת עֹ֔וג

“And the rest of Gilead and all Bashan, the kingdom of Og”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **kingdom** that **Og** rules over. The kingdom includes parts of **Gilead and all Bashan**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use

a comparable expression for describing a kingdom. Alternate translation: [And the rest of Gilead and all Bashan, which Og ruled,]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:13 (#2)

לַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה

“to half of the tribe of Manasseh”

Yahweh explains which areas belong to the part of the tribe of Manasseh that lives east of the Jordan in Joshua 13:29–31. Moses allotted part of the land west of the Jordan to part of the tribe of Manasseh in Deuteronomy 17:1–13. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, either in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [to the half of the tribe of Manasseh that lived east of the Jordan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:13–14 (#1)

כֹּל֙ חֶ֣בֶל הָאַרְגֹּ֔ב לְכָל־הַבָּשָׁ֑ן הַהוּא֙ יִקָּרֵ֣א אֶ֔רֶץ רְפָאִ֖ים: יָאִ֣יר בֶּן־מְנַשֶּׁ֗ה לָקַח֙ אֶת־כָּל־חֶ֣בֶל אַרְגֹּ֔ב עַד־גְּבֻ֖ול הַגְּשׁוּרִ֣י וְהַמַּעֲכָתִ֑י וַיִּקְרָא֩ אֹתָ֨ם עַל־שְׁמֹ֜ו אֶת־הַבָּשָׁ֗ן חַוֹּ֥ת יָאִ֛יר עַד־הַיֹּ֥ום הַזֶּֽה

“All the region of Argob, to all Bashan. The same is called the land of the Raphaites. Jair, son of Manasseh, took all the region of Argob as far as the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites. And he called it, Bashan, by his name, Havvoth Jair, to this day”

These verses provide background information about the land that the people of Israel captured. This information helps readers understand what happened in the story. These verses are not part of Moses’ speech to the Israelites. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 3:14 (#1)

בֶּן

“son of”

Here, **son** means “descendant.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a descendant of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 3:14 (#2)

עַד־גְּבֻ֖ול

“as far as the border of”

The implication is that **the border of** the Geshurites and the Maacathites is north of the region of Argob. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [northward to the border of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:14 (#3)

חַוֹּ֥ת יָאִ֛יר

“Havvoth Jair”

The term **Havvoth Jair** is the name of a region. The name means “tent villages of Jair” or “realm of Jair.”

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 3:14 (#4)

עַד־הַיֹּ֥ום הַזֶּֽה

“to this day”

The author is using the term **to this day** to refer to a specific time, the time when he was writing this book. The author is saying that at the time he wrote this book that people still called **Bashan** by the name **Havvoth Jair**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. Alternate translation: [and it is called that right up to this time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:15 (#1)

וּלְמָכִ֖יר

“And to Machir”

The word **Machir** is the name of a man, the son of Manasseh.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 3:15 (#2)

וּלְמָכִ֖יר

“And to Machir”

Machir had died before Moses gave this land. Here, his name refers to his descendants. Alternate translation: [And to the descendants of Machir]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:15 (#3)

נָתַתִּי

“I gave”

Here the pronoun **I** refers to Moses. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use his name here. Alternate translation: [I, Moses, gave]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:16 (#1)

מִן־הַגִּלְעָד וְעַד־נַחַל אַרְנֹן

“from Gilead and as far as the wadi of Arnon”

The implication is that **the wadi of Arnon** is the southern border of **Gilead**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:16 (#2)

גְּבוּל בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן

“the border of the sons of Ammon”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **the border** around the land that is occupied by the **sons of Ammon** of the Israelites. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression. Alternate translation: [the border of the land occupied by the sons of Ammon]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 3:16 (#3)

בְּנֵי

“the sons of”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 3:17 (#1)

מִכִּנֶּרֶת

“from Chinnereth”

The word **Chinnereth** is the name of a large freshwater lake that is also called “the Sea of Galilee.”

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 3:17 (#2)

תַּחַת אַשְׁדֹּת

“under the slopes of”

The phrase **under the slopes of** means “at the base of” when referring to a mountain. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the foot of] or [at the base of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#1)

וָאֲצַו אֶתְכֶם בָּעֵת הַהִוא לֵאמֹר

“And I commanded you at that time, saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [And I commanded you at that time] or [And at that time I commanded you]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#2)

אֶתְכֶם & אֱלֹהֵיכֶם & לָכֶם & אֲחֵיכֶם

“you & your God & to you & your brothers”

The pronouns **you** and **your** refer to the people of the tribe of Reuben, the tribe of Gad, and the half tribe of Manasseh. If this is not clear for your readers, you could clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [you three tribes ... your God ... to you tribesmen ... the other tribesmen]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#3)

נָתַן לָכֶם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת לְרִשְׁתָּהּ

“has given to you this land to possess it”

The expression **has given to you this land to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [has given you this land]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#4)

חֲלוּצִים

“The girded ones”

Here, **girded ones** means "fighting men." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The fighting men]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#5)

בְּנֵי־חָיִל

"sons of bravery"

Moses is using **sons of** as a common expression of his culture to indicate people who share a certain characteristic. In this case, the fighting men have the characteristic of being brave. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [brave men] or [men who are brave]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#6)

תַּעַבְרוּ

"will cross over"

The implication is that the fighting men of the three tribes will **cross over** the Jordan River. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [will cross the Jordan River]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#7)

לִפְנֵי

"to the faces of"

Here, **faces** represent being in front of or before the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#8)

אֲחֵיכֶם

"your brothers"

Here, **brothers** means "male relatives." The Israelites are all descendants of Jacob. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 3:18 (#9)

בְּנֵי

"the sons of"

Here, **sons** means "male descendants." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the men of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 3:20 (#1)

לַאֲחֵיכֶם׃

"your brothers"

Here, **brothers** means "relatives." The Israelites are all descendants of Jacob. You could include this information, as in the UST, if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 3:20 (#2)

יָנִיחַ & לַאֲחֵיכֶם׃ כָּכֶם׃

"causes your brothers, as you, to have rest"

The implication is that **to have rest** is the absence of war. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [causes your brothers, as you, to have rest from fighting]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:20 (#3)

וְשַׁבְתֶּם

"And you will return"

Moses is emphasizing that the other tribes must possess their land before Yahweh will permit these three tribes to possess their land. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [Only then are you to return.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:20 (#4)

אִישׁ

"every} man"

The word **man** represents every fighting man from the three tribes in general, not one particular man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a

more natural expression. Alternate translation: [every fighting man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 3:20 (#5)

לִירֻשָּׁתֹו

“to his inheritance”

The implication is that the **inheritance** is the land that Moses allotted to each family. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to his land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:21 (#1)

עֵינֶיךָ

“Your eyes”

Here, **eyes** represent the whole person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 3:21 (#2)

לִשְׁנֵי֙ הַמְּלָכִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“to these two kings”

Here the term **these two kings** refers to King Sihon and King Og, whom the Israelites defeated. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to these two kings, Sihon and Og]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:21 (#3)

שָׁמָּה

“there”

Here the word **there** refers to all of the land that Yahweh promised to give to the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the land that he will give you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:22 (#1)

לֹ֣א תִירָא֔וּם

“Do not fear them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people who live in the land that the Israelites are about to occupy. If this is not clear for your readers, you could clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Do not fear the people who live in the land]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:22 (#2)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 3:22 (#3)

הַה֥וּא הַנִּלְחָ֖ם

“he, he {is} the one fighting”

Moses is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the subject is already stated. He is doing that to emphasize that God is the one who will fight for his people. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [it is he who will fight] or [he himself will fight]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:23 (#1)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 3:24 (#1)

אֶת־עַבְדְּךָ֔

“your servant”

Here Moses is referring to himself as **your servant**, which is a polite way of speaking to someone with

greater authority. Alternate translation: [me, your servant,]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Deuteronomy 3:24 (#2)

אַתָּה֙ הַחִלּוֹתָ֔ךָ

“you, you have begun”

Moses is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you have begun** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Yahweh is the one who began their relationship. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [it is you who have begun] or [you yourself have begun]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:24 (#3)

יָדְךָ֣ הַחֲזָקָ֔ה

“your strong hand”

Here, **hand** represents Yahweh’s power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your great power]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:24 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר מִי־אֵל֙ בַּשָּׁמַ֣יִם וּבָאָ֔רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂ֖ה כְּמַעֲשֶׂ֣יךָ וְכִגְבוּרֹתֶֽךָ

“What god {is} in heaven or on earth that does works as your works and as your mighty deeds”

Moses uses a question to emphasize that Yahweh is the only God, and only he has the power to do the works he has done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [No god in heaven or in earth could do works as your works and as your mighty deeds.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 3:24 (#5)

בַּשָּׁמַ֣יִם וּבָאָ֔רֶץ

“is} in heaven or on earth”

Here Moses is referring to all places by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is there anywhere]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 3:24 (#6)

כְּמַעֲשֶׂ֣יךָ וְכִגְבוּרֹתֶֽךָ

“as your works and as your mighty deeds”

The terms **works** and **mighty deeds** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [as your very mighty works]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 3:25 (#1)

נָּ֣א

“please”

The word translated as **please** here is a term used in polite requests. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could use an equivalent expression for making a polite request.

See: Politeness

Deuteronomy 3:25 (#2)

בְּעֵ֣בֶר הַיַּרְדֵּ֔ן

“is} across the Jordan”

The implication is that the land **across the Jordan** is on the west side. When Moses spoke these words to Yahweh, he was east of the Jordan River in Moab. Alternate translation: [is west of the Jordan River.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:26 (#1)

וַיִּתְעַבֵּ֥ר יְהוָ֛ה בִּ֖י לְמַעַנְכֶ֑ם

“But Yahweh was angry with me because of you”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 20:1–13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:26 (#2)

וְלֹ֥א שָׁמַ֖ע אֵלָ֑י

“and he did not listen to me”

When Moses uses **did not listen** in reference to Yahweh, it means that Yahweh chose not to do what Moses had asked him in prayer, to allow him to enter

the land. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [and did not comply with my request to enter the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:27 (#1)

עֲלֵה ׀ רֹאשׁ

“Go up the head of”

Here, **head** represents the top of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Go up to the peak of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:27 (#2)

וְשָׂא עֵינֶיךָ

“and lift up your eyes”

Yahweh is using **lift up your eyes** as a common expression of the culture to mean “look.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use an expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and gaze]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 3:27 (#3)

וּרְאֵה בְעֵינֶיךָ

“And look with your eyes”

Yahweh uses the phrase **look with your eyes** to emphasize that Moses will only see but not enter the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And you may only look with your eyes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 3:28 (#1)

וְחַזְּקֵהוּ וְאַמְּצֵהוּ

“and encourage him and strengthen him”

The terms **encourage** and **strengthen** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and greatly strengthen him]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 3:28 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the faces of”

Here, **faces** represent the presence of the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 3:28 (#3)

הוּא יַעֲבֹר & וְהוּא יַנְחִיל אוֹתָם

“he, he will cross over & and he, he will cause them to inherit”

Yahweh states the pronoun **he** separately in these two places, even though the verbs translated as **he will cross over** and **he will cause them to inherit** already include this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Joshua is the one who will lead the people into the land, not Moses. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [it will be he who will cross over ... and it will be he who will cause them to inherit]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 3:29 (#1)

בֵּית פְּעוֹר

“Beth Peor”

The term **Beth Peor** is the name of a town in Moab near Mount Pisgah.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Moses encourages the Israelites to obey Yahweh (1–40)
2. Cities of refuge selected for the Reubenites, Gadites, and Manassites (41–43)
3. Moses’ introduction of the Law (44–49)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Moses' instructions
God will not allow Moses to enter into the land he had promised to Israel. Since the Israelites are getting ready to possess the land, Moses gives them some last instructions before his death. (See: Promised Land)

Cities of refuge
Verses 41–43 discuss cities of refuge, which are towns to which a manslayer could flee. In this case, a manslayer is anyone who accidentally kills another person. A close family member of the deceased would be obligated to take revenge for the killing of his family member by finding and killing the person who killed their family member. Yahweh provides protection for the manslayer so that they will not be punished too harshly. (See: refuge, refugee, shelter, sheltered; and avenge, avenger, revenge, vengeance)

Likeness
Verses 15–31 warn the Israelites against creating idols. The other people groups in the land worshiped entities in nature such as the sun, moon, stars, trees, and so on. They created idols that looked like (in the likeness of) these entities. Yahweh forbids the Israelites from making likenesses of anything for the purpose of worshiping it. (See: likeness; and god, false god, goddess, idol, idolater, idolatrous, idolatry)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Words for the law
- statutes
- ordinances
- judgments

Moses uses several words to refer to the law that Yahweh commanded the Israelites to obey. It is unclear what the differences are between these terms. If your language has different terms for the law, you could use them here to differentiate between the different Hebrew words. (See: Translate Unknowns)

"you" and "your" singular and plural
In verses 1–22 "you" and "your" are sometimes singular and sometimes plural; see notes for details. In verses 23–40 "you" and "your" are all singular.

Moses is speaking to the Israelites who are alive, but he refers to events that happened to their ancestors. The pronouns "you" or "your" are plural in these instances unless otherwise noted. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could explicitly state that these events happened to their ancestors. (See: Pronouns — When to Use Them; and Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 4:1 (#1)

שְׁמַ֣ע אֶל־הַחֻקִּ֔ים וְאֶל־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֑ים

"listen to the statutes and to the ordinances"

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of "obey." You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [listen and obey all]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:1 (#2)

אֶל־הַחֻקִּ֔ים וְאֶל־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֑ים

"to the statutes and to the ordinances"

The terms **statutes** and **ordinances** mean similar things. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could express the meaning with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to the important statutes]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:1 (#3)

לְמַ֣עַן

"so that"

Here, **so that** marks what comes after as the goal or purpose of what comes before. Moses wants the Israelites to live in the land. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:1 (#4)

אֲבֹתֵיכֶ֖ם

"your fathers"

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:2 (#1)

הַדָּבָ֣ר

"the word"

Moses is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly.

Alternate translation: [the statutes] or [the words of the law]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:2 (#2)

אֶת־מִצְוֹת֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“the commandments of Yahweh”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **commandments** that come from **Yahweh**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the commandments given by Yahweh]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 4:2 (#3)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֖ם

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 4:3 (#1)

עֵינֵיכֶ֗ם

“Your eyes”

Moses is using **eyes** to represent all of a person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You yourselves]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 4:3 (#2)

בְּבַ֣עַל פְּעֹ֑ור

“in Baal Peor”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 25:1–9.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:3 (#3)

הָלַ֣ךְ אַחֲרֵ֔י

“walked after”

Here, **walked after** means “worshiped.” Moses is speaking of worshiping idols as if people were physically walking behind idols to follow them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [worshiped]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:3 (#4)

הִשְׁמִידֹ֖ו

“has destroyed them”

The implication is that Yahweh **destroyed them** by killing them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [has killed them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:4 (#1)

הַדְּבֵקִ֖ים בַּיהוָ֑ה

“who clung to Yahweh”

Moses speaks as if obeying Yahweh were like physically holding on to him as one would hold on to another person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who carefully obeyed Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:5 (#1)

רְאֵ֣ה

“Look”

Moses is using the word **Look** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Be assured that]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:5 (#2)

חֻקִּים֙ וּמִשְׁפָּטִ֔ים

“statutes and ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes” and “ordinances” in 4:1. Alternate translation: [the important statutes]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:5 (#3)

אֱלֹהָ֖י

“my God”

Moses is not using the phrase **my God** to mean that he is the only one who worships Yahweh nor that he possesses or controls Yahweh, but rather to emphasize that Yahweh is the God that the Israelites worship, including himself. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the God whom we all worship,]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 4:5 (#4)

בָּאִים שָׁשָּׁמָּה לְרִשְׁתָּהּ

“are going into to possess it”

The expression **going into to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [are going into to possess]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#1)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם֙ וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֔ם

“And you shall keep and do {them”

The terms **keep** and **do** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And you shall carefully do them]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#2)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#3)

חָכְמַתְכֶם֙ וּבִ֣ינַתְכֶ֔ם

“is} your wisdom and your understanding”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas of **wisdom** and **understanding**, you can express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [is how you can act wisely and with understanding]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#4)

חָכְמַתְכֶם֙ וּבִ֣ינַתְכֶ֔ם & חָכָ֥ם וְנָבוֹ֖ן

“is} your wisdom and your understanding & wise and understanding”

The terms **wisdom** and **understanding** mean similar things and the terms **wise** and **understanding** mean similar things. Moses is using these terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [is your great wisdom ... very wise]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#5)

לְעֵינֵי

“in the eyes of”

Moses is using the common expression of his culture **in the eyes of** to mean “in the judgment of” or “in the opinion of.” See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “in the eyes of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of] or [in the perspective of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#6)

יִשְׁמְעוּן

“will hear”

Here the word **hear** means “learn about” through someone telling them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will learn about]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#7)

וְאָמְר֔וּ

“and may say”

Here the word **say** introduces direct speech. Consider natural ways of introducing direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 4:6 (#8)

עַם־חָכָם וְנָבוֹן הַגּוֹי הַגָּדוֹל הַזֶּה

“this great nation {is} a wise and understanding people”

Here, **nation** represents the people of that nation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of this great nation are wise and understanding]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:7 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:7–8 (#1)

כִּי מִי־גּוֹי גָּדוֹל אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ אֱלֹהִים קְרֹבִים אֵלָיו כַּיהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ בְּכָל־קָרְאֵנוּ אֵלָיו: וּמִי גּוֹי גָּדוֹל אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ חֻקִּים וּמִשְׁפָּטִים צַדִּיקִם כְּכֹל הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי נֹתֵן לִפְנֵיכֶם הַיּוֹם

“For which great nation {is there} that has a god near to it, as Yahweh our God {is} whenever we call on him? And, which great nation {is there} that has statutes and ordinances {as} righteous as all this law that I am giving to your faces today”

Moses is using the question form to emphasize how great Yahweh is compared to the lifeless idols that other nations follow. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate these questions as statements or exclamations. Alternate translation: [For there is no other great nation that has a god near to it as Yahweh our God is whenever we call on him. And, there is no other great nation that has statutes and ordinances as righteous as all this law that I am giving to your faces today.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 4:8 (#1)

חֻקִּים וּמִשְׁפָּטִים

“statutes and ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes” and “ordinances” in 4:1. Alternate translation: [ordinances] or [important rules]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:8 (#2)

לִפְנֵיכֶם

“to your faces”

Here, **faces** represents the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#1)

רַק

“Only”

Here Moses is using **Only** to emphasize his commands. Use a connector to introduce something important that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Be sure that you]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#2)

הִשָּׁמֶר לְךָ וּשְׁמֹר נַפְשְׁךָ & תִּשְׁכַּח & עֵינֶיךָ & מִלְּבָבְךָ & חַיֶּיךָ & וְהוֹדַעְתָּם לְבָנֶיךָ & בָּנֶיךָ

“guard yourself and guard your soul & you forget & your eyes & from your heart & your life. But make them known to your sons & your sons”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you**, **your**, and the command forms are singular in this verse and in verse 10. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#3)

הִשָּׁמֶר לְךָ וּשְׁמֹר נַפְשְׁךָ מְאֹד

“guard yourself and guard your soul strongly”

The terms **guard yourself** and **guard your soul strongly** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [carefully guard all of yourself]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#4)

פֶּן & וּפֶן

“lest & and lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case ... and in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#5)

אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים

“the things”

The implication is that the Israelites should not forget **the things** that Yahweh did for them, such as the miracles that Yahweh did to help the Israelites in the wilderness. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the miraculous things Yahweh did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#6)

עֵינֶיךָ

“your eyes”

Here, **eyes** represents all of a person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#7)

יָסוּרוּ מִלְּבָבְךָ

“they retreat from your heart”

Here Moses is speaking as if memories physically **retreat** from one’s **heart** when one forgets something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you forget them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#8)

כֹּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ

“all the days of your life”

Moses is using the term **days** to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the entire duration of your life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#9)

לִבָנֶיךָ וְלִבְנֵי בָנֶיךָ

“to your sons and to the sons of your sons”

Here, **sons** means “children.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to your children and to the children of your children]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:9 (#10)

וְלִבְנֵי בָנֶיךָ

“and to the sons of your sons”

Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [and to your grandsons]

See: Kinship

Deuteronomy 4:10 (#1)

יוֹם אֲשֶׁר עָמַדְתָּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּחֹרֵב

“The} day that you stood to the face of Yahweh your God at Horeb”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 19.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:10 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of” in 1:45. Alternate translation: [before] or [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:10 (#3)

בְּחֹרֵב

“at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also known as Mount Sinai. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 32.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 4:10 (#4)

הַקְהֶל־לִי֙ אֶת־הָעָ֔ם

“Assemble for me the people”

The implication is that Yahweh wants Moses to bring all the Israelite **people** to **Assemble** at Mount Sinai, where Yahweh will speak through a thunderstorm. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Tell the Israelite people to gather here]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:10 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר

“that”

The word translated as **that** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [so that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:11 (#1)

תַּ֣חַת

“under”

Here, **under** means “at the foot of.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at the foot of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:11 (#2)

לֵ֖ב

“the heart of”

Here the word **heart** means “middle.” Moses is speaking of the sky as if it had a heart in its middle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the middle of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:12 (#1)

וּתְמוּנָ֖ה אֵינְכֶ֣ם רֹאִ֑ים

“and you saw no form”

Here, **form** means the visible form of a living being. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you saw no visible form]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:13 (#1)

עֲשֶׂ֥רֶת הַדְּבָרִ֖ים

“the Ten Words”

Here the phrase **Ten Words** refers to the commandments that Yahweh gave by using words. The ULT capitalizes these words to show that they refer to these specific “words.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as modeled by the UST.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:14 (#1)

הַחֻקִּ֥ים וְאֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֖ים

“statutes and judgments”

The terms **statutes** and **judgments** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [important rules]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:14 (#2)

לַֽעֲשֹׂתְכֶ֗ם

“for your doing of”

Here, **for** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what comes before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:14 (#3)

בָּאָ֨רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֜ר אַתֶּ֣ם עֹבְרִ֗ים שָׁ֙מָּה֙ לְרִשְׁתָּ֔הּ

“in the land which you are going over to possess it”

The expression **the land which you are going over to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true

of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [in the land you will possess]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 4:15 (#1)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [this is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:15 (#2)

בְּיוֹם דִּבֶּר יְהוָה אֲלֵיכֶם בְּחֹרֵב מִתּוֹךְ הָאֵשׁ

“on {the} day Yahweh spoke to you at Horeb from the midst of the fire”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 19.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:15 (#3)

בְּחֹרֵב

“at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also known as Mount Sinai.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 4:16 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction (in the previous verse) to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:16 (#2)

תַּשְׁחִתֻ֗ן

“you act corruptly”

Here the term **act corruptly** means to sin or do wrong. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you sin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:16 (#3)

תַּבְנִ֣ית

“a likeness of”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **likeness**, you can express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [anything looking like a]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 4:16 (#4)

זָכָ֥ר אֹ֖ו נְקֵבָֽה

“male or female”

Here, **male or female** refers to human beings, not to animals. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [a male person or a female person]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:17 (#1)

תַּבְנִ֣ית & תַּבְנִיתֹ֔

“a likeness of & a likeness of”

See how you translated the word “likeness” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [anything looking like ... anything looking like]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 4:18 (#1)

תַּבְנִ֣ית & תַּבְנִ֔ית

“a likeness of & a likeness of”

See how you translated the word “likeness” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [anything looking like ... anything looking like]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 4:18 (#2)

רֹ֥מֶשׂ

“creeping thing”

A **creeping thing** means any creature that crawls on the ground. This could include reptiles and insects. You could include this information if that would be

helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [animal that crawls]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#1)

וּפֶן

“And lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction in 4:15 to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [And in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#2)

תִּשָּׂא עֵינֶיךָ & וְרָאִיתָ & וְנִדַּחְתָּ & וְהִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתָ & וַעֲבַדְתָּם & אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“you lift up your eyes & and see & and be seduced and bow down & and serve them & your God”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#3)

תִּשָּׂא עֵינֶיךָ

“you lift up your eyes”

Moses is using **you lift up your eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “you look.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you turn your eyes] or [you look]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#4)

כֹּל צְבָא הַשָּׁמָיִם

“all the multitude of the heavens”

Moses is using **all the multitude of the heavens** as a common expression of his culture to mean “all the heavenly bodies in the sky.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the heavenly bodies in the sky]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#5)

וְנִדַּחְתָּ

“and be seduced”

The expression **be seduced** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and let them seduce you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#6)

וְנִדַּחְתָּ

“and be seduced”

The implication is that the Israelites might **be seduced** to worship the sun, moon, or stars and commit the sin of idolatry. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [and be seduced to idolatry]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:19 (#7)

אֲשֶׁר חָלַק יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֹתָם לְכֹל הָעַמִּים תַּחַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמָיִם

“those which Yahweh your God has allotted for all the peoples under all the heavens”

Moses speaks of the heavenly bodies as if they were small objects that Yahweh **allotted** and gave out to the people groups. Moses means that all people groups are able to see the sun, moon, and the stars. Alternate translation: [those which Yahweh your God has allowed all the peoples under all the heavens to see]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:20 (#1)

מִכּוּר הַבַּרְזֶל מִמִּצְרָיִם

“out of the furnace of iron, from Egypt”

An **furnace of iron** is very hot; people use it to melt iron. Moses speaks as if the sufferings of the Israelites in Egypt were so severe that it was like being in a **furnace**; the Israelites were the iron inside the furnace. Alternate translation: [out of Egypt where the Egyptians severely oppressed you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:20 (#2)

לְעַ֣ם נַחֲלָ֔ה

“a people of his inheritance”

Moses speaks of all the people of Israel as if they were one object, Yahweh’s **inheritance**. Moses means that Yahweh chose to have a special relationship with Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his chosen people]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:20 (#3)

כַּיּ֖וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“as this day”

The implication is that the Israelites still have a special relationship with Yahweh at the time when Moses is giving this speech to them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as you are this day as I speak to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:21 (#1)

וַיהוָ֣ה הִתְאַנַּף־בִּ֣י עַל־דִּבְרֵיכֶ֗ם וַיִּשָּׁבַ֥ע לְבִלְתִּ֙י עָבְרִ֣י אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּ֔ן וּלְבִלְתִּ֖י־בֹּאִ֣א אֶל־הָאָ֣רֶץ הַטּוֹבָ֑ה

“And Yahweh was angry with me on account of your words. And he swore I would not cross the Jordan, and I would not go in to the good land”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 20:1–13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:21 (#2)

אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ & לְךָ֥

“your God & to you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 4:22 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“But”

Moses uses the word **But** here to indicate a strong contrast between the fact that he will not enter the land, while the Israelites will enter the land. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [As for me,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:22 (#2)

בָּאָ֣רֶץ הַזֹּ֔את אֵינֶ֥נִּי עֹבֵ֖ר אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּ֑ן

“in this land. I will not cross the Jordan”

The implication is that **this land** is the land of Moab, which is east of **the Jordan** River. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [here in Moab. I will not cross to the west side of the Jordan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:23 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:23 (#2)

אֶת־בְּרִ֣ית יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֗ם אֲשֶׁ֤ר כָּרַת֙

“the covenant of Yahweh your God, which he cut”

Moses is using **cut** and **covenant** as part of a common expression of his culture, “to cut a covenant,” which means “to make a covenant.” The phrase refers to ancient rituals around making covenants described in Genesis 15. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the covenant of Yahweh your God, which he made]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:23 (#3)

צִוְּךָ

“has commanded you”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [has commanded you not to do]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 4:23 (#4)

צִוְּךָ & אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“your God has commanded you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this whole passage, from verses 23–40. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 4:24 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:24 (#2)

אֵ֥שׁ אֹכְלָ֖ה

“is} a devouring fire”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh’s response, when he is jealous, as if it were **a devouring fire**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a destroyer of people who disobey him just as a fire burns its fuel to ashes]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:25 (#1)

כִּֽי

“If”

The word translated as **If** could mean: (1) that Moses is warning the people that they might do these things. (2) that Moses is predicting that the people will do these things. Alternate translation: [When]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 4:25 (#2)

בָּנִ֖ים וּבְנֵ֣י בָנִ֑ים

“sons, and sons of sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Moses is using the word here in a generic sense that includes both male and female descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [children, and children of children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 4:25 (#3)

וּבְנֵ֣י בָנִ֑ים

“and sons of sons”

See how you translated the phrase “sons of your sons” in 4:9. Alternate translation: [and they have sons] or [and they beget grandchildren for you]

See: Kinship

Deuteronomy 4:25 (#4)

וְהִשְׁחַתֶּ֔ם

“and you act corruptly”

Moses is introducing a possible condition in this verse, and he gives the consequence in the next verse in which Yahweh will become angry and punish the Israelites if the Israelites sin by making an idol. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and if you act corruptly]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 4:25 (#5)

בְּעֵינֵ֥י

“in the eyes of”

Moses is using **in the eyes of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in the judgment of” or “in the evaluation of.” See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “in the eyes of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could

state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the evaluation of] or [in the perspective of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#1)

הַעִידֹתִי֩ בָכֶ֨ם הַיּ֜וֹם אֶת־הַשָּׁמַ֣יִם וְאֶת־הָאָ֗רֶץ

“I will make the heavens and the earth witness against you today”

The implication is that **the heavens and the earth** will **witness** whether or not the Israelites will disobey Yahweh. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I will make the heavens and the earth witness whether you obey or disobey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#2)

הַעִידֹתִי֩ בָכֶ֨ם הַיּ֜וֹם אֶת־הַשָּׁמַ֣יִם וְאֶת־הָאָ֗רֶץ

“I will make the heavens and the earth witness against you today”

This verse introduces the consequence of the condition proposed in the previous verse. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the consequence of this possible condition. Alternate translation: [then I will make the heavens and the earth witness against you today]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#3)

אֶת־הַשָּׁמַ֣יִם וְאֶת־הָאָ֗רֶץ

“the heavens and the earth”

Here Moses is referring to everything that exists in the universe by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. Moses is referring to everything, living and non-living. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the whole universe]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#4)

אָבֹ֣ד תֹּאבֵדוּן֮ & הִשָּׁמֵד֒ תִּשָּׁמְדוּן

“perishing, you will perish & being destroyed, you will be destroyed”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **perish** and **destroy** in order to intensify the ideas that they express. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [you will certainly perish ... you will be utterly destroyed]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#5)

הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֨ר אַתֶּ֜ם עֹבְרִ֤ים אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּן֙ שָׁ֣מָּה לְרִשְׁתָּ֔הּ

“the land to which you are going over the Jordan to possess it”

The expression **the land to which you are going over the Jordan to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [the land to which you are going over the Jordan to possess]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#6)

לֹֽא־תַאֲרִיכֻ֥ן יָמִ֖ים

“You will not prolong {your} days”

Moses is using the phrase **prolong your days** to refer to living for a long period of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You will not be able to live for a long time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:26 (#7)

הִשָּׁמֵ֖ד תִּשָּׁמְדֽוּן

“being destroyed, you will be destroyed”

The expression **be destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will utterly destroy you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 4:27 (#1)

וְנִשְׁאַרְתֶּ֣ם מְתֵ֣י מִסְפָּ֔ר

“and you will be left men of {small} number”

The implication is that the population of Israelites in each nation would be very small. If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the

phrasing. Alternate translation: [and there will be few of you]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 4:27 (#2)

מְתֵ֣י

“men of”

Here the masculine term **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that would indicate this. Alternate translation: [people of]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 4:27 (#3)

יְנַהֲגֵ֣ יְהוָ֔ה אֶתְכֶ֖ם שָׁמָּ֑ה

“Yahweh will drive you there”

Here Moses is speaking of the Israelites as if they were livestock that **Yahweh** could **drive** from one place to another. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will make you go]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:28 (#1)

מַעֲשֵׂ֥ה יְדֵ֖י אָדָ֑ם

“the work of the hands of man”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **work**, as in an object, that is made by **the hands of man**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression to describe a man-made object. Alternate translation: [objects made by the hands of man]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 4:28 (#2)

יְדֵ֖י אָדָ֑ם

“the hands of man”

Moses is using **hands** to represent all of a person in the act of making an idol. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [mere men]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 4:29 (#1)

מִשָּׁ֖ם

“from there”

The word **there** refers to all the other nations where Yahweh will force the Israelites to live if they disobey him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from those nations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:29 (#2)

וּבִקַּשְׁתֶּ֣ם מִשָּׁ֔ם אֶת־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ וּמָצָ֕אתָ כִּֽי־תִדְרְשֶׁ֥נּוּ

“And from there you will search for Yahweh your God, and you will find {him} when you seek him”

Here Moses is speaking of praying to and knowing Yahweh as if one could physically **search for** and **seek** him and **find him** in a specific place. As God, Yahweh is everywhere and cannot be limited to a single space. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And from there you will pray to Yahweh your God, and he will answer when you appeal to him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:29 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ֖ וּבְכָל־נַפְשֶֽׁךָ

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

Moses is referring to all of a person by naming two major components, **heart** and **soul**. These terms are used together to mean “completely” or “wholeheartedly.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with all your being] or [wholeheartedly]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 4:30 (#1)

וּמְצָאֽוּךָ

“and you find”

Here Moses is speaking of experiencing trouble as if it were an object that one could **find**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you experience]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:30 (#2)

כֹּל֙ הַדְּבָרִ֣ים הָאֵ֔לֶּה

“all these things”

The phrase **all these things** refers to the hardship that the Israelites will experience when they live in the other nations. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [all these hardships]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:30 (#3)

בְּאַחֲרִית֣וֹת הַיָּמִ֔ים

“in the later days”

Moses is using the term **days** by association to refer to a specific time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [at a later time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:30 (#4)

וְשַׁבְתָּ֖ עַד־יְהוָ֣ה

“then you will return to Yahweh”

Here Moses is speaking of the Israelites choosing to worship **Yahweh** again as if **Yahweh** were a physical location to which they could **return**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then you will again worship Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:30 (#5)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֥ בְּקֹלֽוֹ

“and listen to”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See how you translated the same word in 4:1. Alternate translation: [and be obedient to] or [and act according to]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:30 (#6)

בְּקֹלֽוֹ

“his voice”

Here, **voice** represents the words that Yahweh spoke, which include his commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [what he says]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:31 (#1)

כִּֽי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:31 (#2)

וְלֹ֤א יַשְׁחִיתֲךָ֙

“and he will not destroy you”

The implication is that Yahweh **will not destroy** all the Israelites, because he will make sure that some Israelites survive. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he will not eliminate you completely]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:31 (#3)

וְלֹ֣א יִשְׁכַּ֔ח

“and he will not forget”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **forget**. Alternate translation: [and he will remember]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 4:31 (#4)

אֶת־בְּרִ֣ית אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ

“the covenant of your fathers”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe the **covenant** that Yahweh made with the **fathers** of the Israelites. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression to describe the covenant. Alternate translation: [the covenant between Yahweh and your fathers]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 4:32 (#1)

נָא

“please”

The word translated as **please** here is a term used in polite requests. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could use an equivalent expression for making a polite request.

See: Politeness

Deuteronomy 4:32 (#2)

לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your face”

Here Moses is using the expression **to your face** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before you were born]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:32 (#3)

אָדָם

“man”

In this verse, the word **man** is singular in form, but it refers to all human beings as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [human beings]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 4:32 (#4)

וּלְמִקְצֵה הַשָּׁמַיִם וְעַד־קְצֵה הַשָּׁמָיִם

“and from one end of the heavens and to the other end of the heavens”

Here Moses is referring to all of the world by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and on all the earth]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 4:32 (#5)

כַּדָּבָר הַגָּדוֹל הַזֶּה

“a great thing as this”

The term **a great thing** refers to the works that Yahweh did, which Moses mentions in the following verses. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as great a thing as what Yahweh did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:33 (#1)

הֲשָׁמַע עָם קוֹל אֱלֹהִים מְדַבֵּר מִתּוֹךְ־הָאֵשׁ כַּאֲשֶׁר־שָׁמַעְתָּ אַתָּה וַיֶּחִי

“Did a people hear the voice of God speaking from the midst of the fire, as you, you have heard, and live”

Here Moses is using the question form to emphasize how amazing it is that the Israelites heard Yahweh speak from the fire in Exodus 19–20. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement. Alternate translation: [No other people has heard the voice of God speaking from the midst of the fire, as you have heard, and lived.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 4:33 (#2)

קוֹל אֱלֹהִים

“the voice of God”

Here, **voice** represents Yahweh in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [God himself]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:33 (#3)

שָׁמַעְתָּ אַתָּה

“you, you have heard”

Moses is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you have heard** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that the people to whom he is speaking personally heard God’s voice. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [you indeed have heard] or [you yourselves have heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#1)

אוֹ ׀ הֲנִסָּה אֱלֹהִים לָבוֹא לָקַחַת לוֹ גוֹי מִקֶּרֶב גּוֹי

“Or has God attempted to go and take for himself a nation from the midst of {another} nation”

Moses is using the question form to emphasize how amazing it was that Yahweh chose Israel and saved them from Egypt. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Make sure to end the sentence with the appropriate punctuation. Alternate translation: [God has not attempted to go and take for himself any other nation from the midst of another nation.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#2)

בְּמַסֹּת

“by trials”

Here the word **trials** refers to the plagues in Exodus 7–11 that Yahweh sent so that the Egyptians would suffer. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by plagues]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#3)

בְּאֹתֹת וּבְמוֹפְתִים

“by signs and by wonders”

The words **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [by great signs]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#4)

וּבְמִלְחָמָה

“and by war”

The word **war** refers to Exodus 14, when the Egyptian army chased the Israelites as they left Egypt. Yahweh himself fought against the Egyptian army. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and by fighting for us against the Egyptian army]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#5)

וּבְיָד חֲזָקָה וּבִזְרֹעַ נְטוּיָה

“and by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm”

The terms **mighty hand** and **outstretched arm** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and by very great power]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#6)

וּבְיָד חֲזָקָה וּבִזְרֹעַ נְטוּיָה

“and by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm”

Here, **strong hand** and **outstretched arm** both represent the power of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and by his mighty power]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:34 (#7)

לְעֵינֶיךָ

“before your eyes”

See how you translated the phrase “before your eyes” in 1:30. Alternate translation: [in your sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:35 (#1)

אַתָּה הָרְאֵתָ

“You, you have been shown”

Moses is stating the pronoun **You** separately, even though the verb translated as **you have been shown** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Yahweh has shown these people more than any others. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [you indeed have been shown]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 4:35 (#2)

אַתָּה הָרְאֵתָ

“You, you have been shown”

The expression **have been shown** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [He showed all these things to you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 4:35 (#3)

אַתָּה֙ הָרְאֵ֣תָ לָדַ֔עַת

“You, you have been shown, to know”

Here the word **to** marks **know** as the goal or purpose of **you have been shown**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [You yourself have been shown so that you might know]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:36 (#1)

מִן־הַשָּׁמַ֖יִם הִשְׁמִיעֲךָ֣ אֶת־קֹל֑וֹ

“From the heavens he caused you to hear his voice”

The implication is that the **voice** of Yahweh came **from the heavens** and not from earth. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [He caused you to hear his voice that came from the heavens]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:36 (#2)

הִשְׁמִיעֲךָ֣ אֶת־קֹל֔וֹ לְיַסְּרֶ֑ךָּ

“he caused you to hear his voice, to instruct you”

Here the word **to** marks **instruct you** as the goal or purpose of **he caused you to hear his voice**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [he caused you to hear his voice so that he might instruct you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 4:36 (#3)

אֶת־אִשּׁ֣וֹ הַגְּדוֹלָ֔ה וּדְבָרָ֥יו שָׁמַ֖עְתָּ מִתּ֣וֹךְ הָאֵ֑שׁ

“his great fire, and you heard his words from the midst of the fire”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 19. Alternate translation: [his great fire on Mount Sinai, and you heard his words from the midst of the fire.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:36 (#4)

וּדְבָרָ֥יו שָׁמַ֖עְתָּ

“and you heard his words”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **words** that Yahweh spoke. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression to describe Yahweh’s speech. Alternate translation: [and you heard the words that Yahweh spoke]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 4:37 (#1)

אֶת־אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ

“your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:37 (#2)

בְּפָנָ֖יו

“with his face”

Moses is using **face**, meaning Yahweh’s presence, to represent Yahweh’s ability to save the Israelites. Moses is emphasizing that Yahweh brought the Israelites out of Egypt by the power of his presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:37 (#3)

בְּזַרְעֹ֥ו אַחֲרָ֑יו

“his seed after him”

In this verse, the pronouns **his** and **him** are singular in form, but they refer to all of the Israelites’ ancestors as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [their seed after them]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 4:38 (#1)

לְהוֹרִ֨ישׁ גּוֹיִ֜ם גְּדֹלִ֤ים וַעֲצֻמִים֙ מִמְּךָ֔ מִפָּנֶ֖יךָ

“to drive out from your faces nations greater and mightier than you”

This could refer to: (1) nations which the Israelites have already defeated and expelled from the land, as in Deuteronomy 2–3. Alternate translation: [when he drove out from before your faces nations greater and

mightier than you] or (2) nations which the Israelites will expel from the land in the future. Alternate translation: [so that he might drive out from before your faces nations greater and mightier than you]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Deuteronomy 4:38 (#2)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your faces”

Here the phrase **from your faces** could: (1) represent “from your presence,” Alternate translation: [from before you] or (2) be a common expression of the culture that means [on your account] or [on your behalf.] Alternate translation: [on your behalf]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:38 (#3)

לְהָבִיא אֹתְךָ

“to bring you in”

The implication is that Yahweh will use his power to **bring** the Israelites into the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to bring you into the land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:38 (#4)

כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה

“as this day”

The implication is that the land is the inheritance of the Israelites, even as Moses is speaking to them before they enter it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as it belongs to you now, even as I speak to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:39 (#1)

וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם וַהֲשֵׁבֹתָ אֶל־לְבָבֶךָ

“And you shall know today, and you shall return {it} to your heart”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [And you shall know today, indeed, you shall return it to your heart]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 4:39 (#2)

וַהֲשֵׁבֹתָ אֶל־לְבָבֶךָ

“and you shall return {it} to your heart”

Moses is using **return to your heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “think about.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you shall call it to mind] or [and think about it]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:39 (#3)

בַּשָּׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וְעַל־הָאָרֶץ מִתָּחַת

“in the heavens above and on the earth beneath”

Here Moses is referring to the whole universe by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everywhere]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 4:40 (#1)

אֶת־חֻקָּיו וְאֶת־מִצְוֹתָיו

“his statutes and his commandments”

The terms **statutes** and **commandments** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [his statutes] or [his commandments]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 4:40 (#2)

וּלְבָנֶיךָ

“and for your sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:40 (#3)

וּלְמַעַן תַּאֲרִיךְ יָמִים

“and so that you may prolong {your} days”

See how you translated the phrase “prolong your days” in 4:26. Alternate translation: [and you will live long]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:40 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

Moses is using **all of the days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “forever.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until the end of time] or [for all time]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:41 (#1)

אָז

“Then”

The author is using the word translated **Then** to introduce a new event in the story. Moses’s speech, which began in 1:6, has finished, and the writer continues his narration of events that ended in 1:5. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [After he finished his speech,]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 4:41 (#2)

מִזְרְחָה שָׁמֶשׁ

“toward the rising of {the} sun”

The author is using **the rising of the sun** as a common expression of his culture to mean “east.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [toward the east]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:42 (#1)

אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“his neighbor”

Here, **neighbor** means “fellow Israelite.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:42 (#2)

בִּבְלִי־דַעַת

“without knowing”

Here, **without knowing** means “unintentionally.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this explicitly. Alternate translation: [unintentionally]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:42 (#3)

וְהוּא לֹא־שֹׂנֵא לוֹ מִתְּמֹוֹל שִׁלְשֹׁום

“and he did not hate him previously before”

The implication is that the **manslayer** did not premeditate murder. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he did not hate him previously before and did not plan to kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:42 (#4)

מִתְּמֹוֹל שִׁלְשֹׁום

“previously before”

The expression **previously before** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [before]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:42 (#5)

וָחָי

“and he shall live”

The implication is that the family members of the dead person would try to kill the manslayer, so the people of those cities would protect the manslayer. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the avenger would not be able to kill him there]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:44 (#1)

שָׂשָׂם

“placed”

Here the word **placed** means “delivered.” Moses is speaking here as if the words of the law were physical objects that he **placed** before the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [told]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:44 (#2)

לִפְנֵי

“to the faces of”

Here, **faces** represents the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 4:44 (#3)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” Moses is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:45 (#1)

אֵאֶלֶּה הָעֵדֹת וְהַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּצֵאתָם מִמִּצְרָיִם

“These {are} the testimonies and the statutes and the judgments that Moses spoke to the sons of Israel when they came out from Egypt”

Moses is giving background information to help readers understand where the law comes from. Moses first told the Israelites the law in Exodus 20–24 on Mount Sinai, after the Israelites left Egypt. Moses is repeating that same law in his speech here. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 4:45 (#2)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the phrase “the sons of Israel” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:46 (#1)

בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן בַּגַּיְא מִמּוּל בֵּית פְּעוֹר בְּאֶרֶץ סִיחֹן מֶלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר יוֹשֵׁב בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן אֲשֶׁר הִכָּה מֹשֶׁה וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּצֵאתָם מִמִּצְרָיִם

“across the Jordan, in the valley opposite Beth Peor, in the land of Sihon, king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon, whom Moses and the sons of Israel had struck down when they came out from Egypt”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 21:21–35.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 4:46 (#2)

בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן

“across the Jordan”

As Moses is repeating the law to the Israelites, they are camping on the east side of the Jordan River. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [when the Israelites are camping east of the Jordan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:46 (#3)

וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the phrase “the sons of Israel” in 4:44. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:46 (#4)

בְּצֵאתָם מִמִּצְרָיִם

“when they came out from Egypt”

The events discussed in this verse occur after the Israelites **came out from Egypt** and after Moses told the Israelites the law the first time. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after they came out from Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 4:47 (#1)

אֶת־אַרְצוֹ

“his land”

The pronoun **his** refers to King Sihon. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the person’s name here. Alternate translation: [King Sihon’s land]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 4:47 (#2)

מִזְרַח שָׁמֶשׁ

“toward} the rising of {the} sun”

See how you translated the phrase “toward the rising of the sun” in 4:41. Alternate translation: [toward the east]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 4:48 (#1)

שְׂפַת

“the lip of”

See how you translated the phrase “the lip of” in 2:36.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 4:48 (#2)

שִׂיאֹן & חֶרְמוֹן

“Sion & is} Hermon”

The words **Sion** and **Hermon** are different names for the same mountain. The word **Sion** is another spelling of “Sirion” (3:9). You could keep the same spelling for both occurrences if it would be clearer for your readers. For **Hermon**, see how you translated that name in 3:8.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 4:49 (#1)

תַּחַת אַשְׁדֹּת

“under the slopes of”

The phrase **under the slopes of** means “at the base of” when referring to a mountain. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. See how you translated this in 3:17.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins Moses’ second speech to the Israelites and includes the Ten Commandments (6–21).

Some translations set Yahweh’s introductory words in 5:6 and each of the commandments in the list of Ten Commandments in 5:7–21 farther to the right on the page than the rest of the text. The ULT uses a separate paragraph for each commandment.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Ten Commandments

This chapter repeats the words from Exodus 20, which are known as the Ten Commandments. It is important for the Israelites to obey these words as part of their covenant with Yahweh. Yahweh gave the Israelites the Ten Commandments on Mount Sinai after the Israelites left Egypt. The Ten Commandments were written on two stone tablets that were placed in the ark of the covenant. (See: Ten Commandments; and ark of the covenant, ark of Yahweh, box, Box of the Testimony, Box of the Covenant of Yahweh)

The Sabbath

Yahweh commands the Israelites to rest on the seventh day, known as the Sabbath. The rest reminds the Israelites that Yahweh rested on the seventh day of creation. The Sabbath also reminds the Israelites that they have rest because Yahweh rescued them from being slaves in Egypt, where they had no rest. (See: Sabbath)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“you” singular and plural

Throughout this chapter, when Moses is speaking to the Israelites, he uses the plural forms of “you.” However, in verses 6–21, Yahweh is speaking to Moses and uses singular pronouns.

Deuteronomy 5:1 (#1)

וַיִּקְרָ֣א מֹשֶׁה֮ אֶל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל֒

“Then Moses called to all Israel”

Here the word **called** means “summoned.” The writer is speaking as if calling someone is the same as summoning them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then Moses commanded all Israel to come to him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:1 (#2)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“and said”

Here the phrase **and said** introduces direct speech. Moses is beginning his second speech to the Israelites. Consider natural ways of doing that in your own language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 5:1 (#3)

אֶת־הַחֻקִּ֖ים וְאֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֑ים

“the statutes and the ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes” and “ordinances” in 4:1. Alternate translation: [the important statutes]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 5:1 (#4)

בְּאָזְנֵיכֶ֔ם

“in your ears”

Moses is using **ears** to represent all of a person in the act of hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to you yourselves]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 5:2 (#1)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֔ינוּ כָּרַ֥ת עִמָּ֖נוּ בְּרִ֣ית בְּחֹרֵֽב

“Yahweh our God cut a covenant with us at Horeb”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 19–24.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:2 (#2)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵ֔ינוּ

“Yahweh our God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh our God” in 1:6.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 5:2 (#3)

כָּרַ֥ת עִמָּ֖נוּ בְּרִ֣ית

“cut a covenant with us”

Moses is using **cut a covenant** as a common expression of his culture which means “to make a covenant.” The phrase refers to ancient rituals around making covenants described in Genesis 15. See how you translated this concept in 4:23. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the covenant of Yahweh your God, which he made]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 5:2 (#4)

בְּחֹרֵֽב

“at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also known as Mount Sinai. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 32.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 5:3 (#1)

לֹ֣א אֶת־אֲבֹתֵ֔ינוּ כָּרַ֥ת יְהוָ֖ה אֶת־הַבְּרִ֣ית הַזֹּ֑את

“Yahweh did not cut this covenant with our fathers”

Moses means that the covenant was not only for the ancestors of the Israelites, but for the current generation also. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh cut this covenant not only with our fathers]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 5:3 (#2)

אֶת־אֲבֹתֵ֔ינוּ

“with our fathers”

Here, **fathers** could mean: (1) the ancestors of the Israelites such as Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, who made a covenant with Yahweh. Alternate translation: [with our predecessors] or (2) the parents of the living Israelites, who made a covenant with Yahweh at Mount Sinai. Alternate translation: [with our parents]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:3 (#3)

כִּ֛י

“but”

The word translated as **but** marks a strong contrast with the previous clause. Use a natural way in your

language for introducing a strong contrast. Alternate translation: [but, in fact,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:3 (#4)

אֲנַחְנוּ אֵלֶּה פֹּה הַיּוֹם כֻּלָּנוּ חַיִּים

“those of us here today, all who are living”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [those of us here today, indeed, all who are living]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 5:4 (#1)

פָּנִים ׀ בְּפָנִים

“face to face”

Here, **face** represents being in someone’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:4 (#2)

פָּנִים ׀ בְּפָנִים

“face to face”

Deuteronomy 4:15 states that the Israelites only heard Yahweh’s voice but did not see him. Moses means that the Israelites physically and personally heard the voice of Yahweh’s voice. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [personally]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 5:5 (#1)

בֵּין & וּבֵינֵיכֶם

“between & and between you”

Here the text repeats the word “between” to describe how Moses spoke to Yahweh on behalf of the Israelites while they stood far away. If it is unnatural in your language to repeat a preposition, you could use a form that identifies physical distance between people. Alternate translation: [between ... and you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 5:5 (#2)

לְהַגִּיד

“to reveal”

Here the word **to** marks “reveal to you the word of Yahweh” as the goal or purpose of Moses standing between Yahweh and the Israelites. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose as is modeled in the UST.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:5 (#3)

אֶת־דְּבַר יְהוָה

“the word of Yahweh”

Here, **word** represents everything that Yahweh said. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh told me to tell you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:5 (#4)

כִּי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:5 (#5)

מִפְּנֵי

“of the face of”

Here, **face** represents the presence of something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:5 (#6)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation of Yahweh that is introduced in the previous verse. Consider natural ways of doing that in your own language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 5:6 (#1)

אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ & הוֹצֵאתִ֖יךָ

“your God & brought you”

Yahweh is speaking directly to Moses, so the pronouns **you** and **your** are singular in this verse and in the rest of Yahweh’s speech (verses 6–21).

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 5:6 (#2)

מִבֵּ֣ית עֲבָדִ֑ים

“from the house of slaves”

Yahweh speaks of Egypt as if it were a **house** where people keep **slaves**. See how you translated “from the house of slavery” in Exodus 13:3. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the place where you were slaves]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:7 (#1)

לֹא־יִהְיֶ֥ה לְךָ֛ אֱלֹהִ֥ים אֲחֵרִ֖ים עַל־פָּנָֽי

“There shall not be for you other gods above my face”

Alternate translation: [You must not worship any other gods besides me]

Deuteronomy 5:7 (#2)

עַל־פָּנָֽי

“above my face”

Here, **face** represents Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [besides me]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 5:8 (#1)

כָּל־תְּמוּנָ֔ה

“any likeness”

See how you translated the word “likeness” in 4:16. Alternate translation: [anything looking like something]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 5:8 (#2)

בַּשָּׁמַ֣יִם מִמַּ֑עַל וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר בָּאָ֖רֶץ מִתָּ֑חַת וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר בַּמַּ֖יִם מִתַּ֥חַת לָאָֽרֶץ

“is} in heaven above or that {is} in the earth beneath or that {is} in the water under the earth”

This list refers to anything in the universe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [is in the universe]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 5:9 (#1)

לָהֶ֖ם

“to them”

Here the pronoun **them** refers to carved figures or idols. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 5:9 (#2)

פֹּקֵ֤ד עֲוֹן־אָבוֹת֙ עַל־בָּנִ֔ים

“visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the sons”

The implication is that Yahweh will **visit**, or extend, the punishment for the **iniquity** of one generation for a few more generations. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [putting the punishment for the iniquity of the fathers also on the sons]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:9 (#3)

אָבוֹת֙ עַל־בָּנִ֔ים

“the fathers on the sons”

Although the terms **fathers** and **sons** are masculine, Yahweh is using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [parents on the children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 5:9 (#4)

עַל־בָּנִ֔ים וְעַל־שִׁלֵּשִׁ֖ים וְעַל־רִבֵּעִֽים

“on the sons, and on the third and on the fourth”

Yahweh is leaving out a word that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. Here the word **sons** implies that the words **third** and **fourth** refer to the third and fourth generations, that is, the grandchildren and great-grandchildren. You could supply any of these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [on the sons down to the third and fourth generations]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 5:9 (#5)

וְעַל־שִׁלֵּשִׁים וְעַל־רִבֵּעִים

“and on the third and on the fourth”

If your language would not represent numbers in a form such as **on the third and on the fourth**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use such as in the UST.

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 5:10 (#1)

וְעֹשֶׂה חֶסֶד לָאֲלָפִים לְאֹהֲבַי וּלְשֹׁמְרֵי מצותו

“But I show covenant faithfulness to thousands, to lovers of me and to keepers of my commandments”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you can express the same idea with the words “faithfully” or “faithful.” Alternate translation: [But I faithfully love the thousands who are lovers of me and keepers of my commandments.]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 5:10 (#2)

לָאֲלָפִים

“to thousands”

Here, **thousands** could refer to: (1) thousands of generations with “generations” being implied as in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [to a thousand generations] or (2) to thousands of people. Alternate translation: [to thousands of people]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 5:10 (#3)

לָאֲלָפִים

“to thousands”

Here, **thousands** as referring to generations, is a way of representing the concept of forever. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to all of my people always]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 5:11 (#1)

לֹא תִשָּׂא & אֵת אֲשֶׁר־יִשָּׂא

“Do not lift up & he who lifts up”

Here, **lift up** means “use” or “say.” This includes invoking Yahweh’s name, making a claim to him, attempting to manipulate him, or misrepresenting him. A broad word should be used in translation of this term. Alternate translation: [Do not use ... he who uses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:11 (#2)

לַשָּׁוְא & לַשָּׁוְא

“with emptiness & with emptiness”

Here, **with emptiness** means “carelessly” or “without proper respect.” Yahweh is speaking of his name as if it were a physical object that could be emptied of substance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [carelessly]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:11 (#3)

כִּֽי לֹא יְנַקֶּהוּ יְהוָה

“for Yahweh will not leave unpunished”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this double negative that consists of the negative particle **not** and the negative **leave unpunished**. Alternate translation: [for Yahweh will certainly treat as guilty]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 5:14 (#1)

וְיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“But the seventh day”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the seventh day**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [But day seven] or [But day 7]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 5:14 (#2)

בַּשַּׁעֲרֶיךָ

“is} within your gates”

Here, **gates** represents the entire community who lives inside the gates. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [is within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:15 (#1)

בְּיָ֣ד חֲזָקָ֔ה וּבִזְרֹ֥עַ נְטוּיָ֖ה

“by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm”

See how you translated the phrase “by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [by his great power]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 5:15 (#2)

עַל־כֵּ֗ן

“Therefore”

The words translated as **Therefore** indicate that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [As a result,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:16 (#1)

כַּבֵּ֖ד אֶת־אָבִ֑יךָ וְאֶת־אִמֶּ֗ךָ כַּאֲשֶׁ֤ר צִוְּךָ֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ לְמַ֨עַן ׀ יַאֲרִיכֻ֣ן יָמֶ֗יךָ וּלְמַ֙עַן֙ יִ֣יטַב לָ֔ךְ

“Honor your father and your mother, as Yahweh your God has commanded you, so that your days may lengthen and so that it may go well with you”

Here, **so that** marks **you may prolong your days** and **it may go well with you** as the goal or purpose of **Honor your father and your mother**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that these things are the purposes of honoring father and mother.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:16 (#2)

יַאֲרִיכֻ֣ן יָמֶ֗יךָ

“your days may lengthen”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “prolong your days” in 4:26. Alternate translation: [your life may be long]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:17 (#1)

לֹ֥א תִרְצָֽח

“Do not murder”

Here, **murder** does not mean all kinds of killing, which would imply that killing in war, accidental killing, and legal execution are sinful acts. Alternate translation: [Do not commit an unlawful, premeditated killing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:18 (#1)

וְלֹ֥א תִנְאָֽף

“And do not commit adultery”

Alternate translation: [And do not have sexual relations with anyone other than your spouse]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:20 (#1)

וְלֹא־תַעֲנֶ֥ה בְרֵעֲךָ֖ עֵ֥ד שָֽׁוְא

“And do not testify against your neighbor false testimony”

The implication is that the **testimony** would be given in court or before a judge. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And do not lie as you testify]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:20 (#2)

בְּרֵעֲךָ

“against your neighbor”

Here, **neighbor** means “fellow Israelite.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against your fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:21 (#1)

רֵעֶ֑ךָ & רֵעֲךָ֙ & לְרֵעֶֽךָ

“your neighbor & your neighbor & is} of your neighbor”

See how you translated the phrase “your neighbor” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelite ... your fellow Israelite ... is of your fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:21 (#2)

וְכֹל֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר לְרֵעֶ֔ךָ

“and anything that {is} of your neighbor”

Here Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe **anything** that is a material possession that belongs to **your neighbor**. If it would be helpful for your readers, use an expression for the possessions that someone else owns. Alternate translation: [and any possession that belongs to your neighbor]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 5:22 (#1)

קֹ֣ול גָּדֹ֗ול

“in} a great voice”

The implication is that the voice of Yahweh was very loud. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [loudly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:22 (#2)

קְהַלְכֶ֑ם

“your assembly”

The pronoun **your** refers to all the Israelites who were present at Mount Sinai when Yahweh gave the law to Moses. If this is not clear for your readers, you could clarify who **your** refers to. Alternate translation: [the assembly of Israelites]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 5:23 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

Moses is using the word translated **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [And then] or [At that time]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 5:23 (#2)

אֶת־הַקֹּ֖ולֹ

“the voice”

Here, **voice** represents the sound of someone speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sound of Yahweh speaking]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:23 (#3)

רָאשֵׁ֣י

“the heads of”

Here, **heads** means “leaders.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:24 (#1)

הֵ֣ן

“Behold”

The Israelite leaders are using the term **behold** to focus Moses’ attention on what they are about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention to what we have to say]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:24 (#2)

קֹלֹ֔ו

“his voice”

Here, **voice** represents the sound of someone speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sound of Yahweh speaking]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:24 (#3)

אֶת־הָאָדָ֖ם

“to man”

Although the term **man** is masculine, the Israelite leaders are using the word in a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [humankind]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 5:25 (#1)

וְעַתָּה֙ לָ֣מָּה נָמ֔וּת

“And now, why should we die”

The Israelite leaders are using the question form to express their fears that they would die if Yahweh spoke to them. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And we do not want to die.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 5:25 (#2)

כִּֽי־תֹאכְלֵ֣נוּ הָאֵ֤שׁ הַגְּדֹלָה֙ הַזֹּ֣את אִם־יֹסְפִ֔ים ׀ אֲנַ֖חְנוּ לִשְׁמֹ֑עַ אֶת־קֹ֥ול יְהוָ֛ה אֱלֹהֵ֖ינוּ עֹ֥וד וָמָֽתְנוּ

“For this great fire will consume us if we continue anymore to hear the voice of Yahweh our God, and we will die”

The Israelite leaders are describing a possible condition in which they will only **die if** they **continue to hear the voice of Yahweh**. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. It may be helpful to reorder this sentence so that the conditional statement is first. Alternate translation: [If we continue anymore to hear the voice of Yahweh our God, then this great fire will consume us and we will die]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 5:26 (#1)

כִּ֣י מִֽי־כָל־בָּשָׂ֗ר אֲשֶׁ֤ר שָׁמַע֙ קֹ֣ול אֱלֹהִ֔ים חַיִּ֖ים מְדַבֵּ֣ר מִתֹּ֣וךְ־הָאֵ֑שׁ כָּמֹ֙נוּ֙ וַיֶּ֔חִי

“For who {is there of} all flesh that has heard the voice of the living God speak from the midst of the fire like us and has lived”

The Israelite leaders are using the question form to explain why they are very afraid. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [No flesh has heard the voice of the living God speak from the midst of the fire like us and has lived.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 5:26 (#2)

כִּ֣י מִֽי־כָל־בָּשָׂ֗ר אֲשֶׁ֤ר שָׁמַע֙ קֹ֣ול אֱלֹהִ֔ים חַיִּ֖ים מְדַבֵּ֣ר מִתֹּ֣וךְ־הָאֵ֑שׁ כָּמֹ֙נוּ֙ וַיֶּ֔חִי

“For who {is there of} all flesh that has heard the voice of the living God speak from the midst of the fire like us and has lived”

The Israelite leaders mean that, while they have heard God speak and have lived, it is a rare occurrence, one which they do not believe will happen again. This verse does not contradict verse 24. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, as modeled by the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:26 (#3)

בָּשָׂ֗ר

“flesh”

The Israelite leaders are using **flesh** to represent humans. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [humankind]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:26 (#4)

קֹ֣ול

“the voice of”

Here, **voice** represents the sound of someone speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sound of the words of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 5:26 (#5)

אֱלֹהִ֔ים חַיִּ֖ים

“the living God”

The implication is that only Yahweh is a **living God**, in contrast with idols who are not living. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the only living God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:27 (#1)

תְּדַבֵּ֤ר אֵלֵ֙ינוּ֙

“speak to us”

The implication is that the Israelite leaders want Moses to go up Mount Sinai to speak with Yahweh on their behalf, then come back down to their camp

to tell the Israelites what Yahweh said. This way, the Israelites do not have to listen to Yahweh speak. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [come back down the mountain to tell us]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:28 (#1)

אֶת־קֹ֣ל דִּבְרֵיכֶ֗ם בְּדַבֶּרְכֶם֙ אֵלָ֔י & אֶת־קֹ֣ל דִּבְרֵ֔י הָעָ֥ם הַזֶּ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר דִּבְּר֑וּ אֵלֶ֣יךָ

“the sound of your words when you spoke to me & the sound of the words of this people that they spoke to you”

The expression **the sound of your words when you spoke to me** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [what you said to me ... what this people spoke to you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 5:29 (#1)

מִֽי־יִתֵּ֨ן

“Who will give and have”

Yahweh is using the question form of **Who will give** to express a strong desire for something. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation, ending the sentence with a period: [Oh that they would have]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 5:29 (#2)

לְבָבָ֜ם

“heart”

Here the **heart** represents where a person’s motives, intentions, and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [desire]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:29 (#3)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֔ים

“all the days”

See how you translated the similar phrase “all of the days” in 4:40. Alternate translation: [forever]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 5:29 (#4)

וְלִבְנֵיהֶ֖ם

“and for their sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:30 (#1)

לֵ֣ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לָהֶ֔ם שׁ֖וּבוּ לָכֶ֥ם לְאָהֳלֵיכֶֽם

“Go say to them, “Return yourselves to your tents”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting Yahweh (level 2) telling Moses what to say to the people (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation as is modeled in the UST.

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 5:30 (#2)

לֵ֣ךְ אֱמֹ֣ר לָהֶ֔ם שׁ֖וּבוּ לָכֶ֥ם לְאָהֳלֵיכֶֽם

“Go say to them, “Return yourselves to your tents”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as in the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 5:30 (#3)

שׁ֖וּבוּ לָכֶ֥ם

“Return yourselves”

The expression **Return yourselves** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [Return]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 5:31 (#1)

וְאַתָּ֗ה

“But you”

Yahweh uses the words **But you** here to indicate a strong contrast between what Moses and the rest of the Israelites will do. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [As for you]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:31 (#2)

עִמָּדִי׳

“by me”

This does not mean that Yahweh had a physical body, which was present at Mount Sinai. Yahweh means that Moses should stand near the fire and clouds where Yahweh’s voice came from. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [by the fire where my voice comes from]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 5:31 (#3)

הַמִּצְוָה וְהַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים

“the commandment and the statutes and the ordinances”

The terms **commandment** and **statutes** and **ordinances** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the very important commandments]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 5:31 (#4)

הַמִּצְוָה

“the commandment”

In this verse, the word **commandment** is singular in form, but it refers to all Yahweh’s commandments as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [the commandments]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 5:31 (#5)

אֲשֶׁר תְּלַמְּדֵם

“that you will teach them”

Yahweh is using a future statement to give an instruction or command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words using a command or instruction form. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could start a new sentence here. Alternate translation: [that you must teach them]

See: Statements — Other Uses

Deuteronomy 5:31 (#6)

בָּאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי נֹתֵן לָהֶם לְרִשְׁתָּהּ

“in the land that I am giving to them to possess it”

The expression **the land that I am giving to them to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [in the land that I am giving to them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 5:32 (#1)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם לַעֲשׂוֹת כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם אֶתְכֶם לֹא תָסֻרוּ יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאל

“And you shall keep {them}, doing as Yahweh your God has commanded you. Do not turn aside, right or left”

Moses has finished quoting what Yahweh said. This verse continues Moses’ speech to the Israelites. Consider natural ways of reintroducing a speaker of direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 5:32 (#2)

לֹא תָסֻרוּ יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאל

“Do not turn aside, right or left”

Moses is speaking as if the Israelites had literally been walking behind God but then could **turn aside** to walk in a different direction from him. He means that they should not stop living in the manner in which God wants people to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not get off track] or [Do not disobey Yahweh’s commands]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:33 (#1)

בְּכָל־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם אֶתְכֶם תֵּלֵכוּ

“In all the ways that Yahweh your God has commanded you, you shall walk”

Here Moses is speaking of the commandments of Yahweh as if they were **ways** or a path that the person should **walk** on. He means that obeying those commandments is like walking on that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [All the commandments that Yahweh your God has commanded you, you shall obey]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 5:33 (#2)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks the benefits of living a good, long life as the goal or purpose of obeying Yahweh. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in such a way that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 5:33 (#3)

וְהַאֲרִכְתֶּן יָמִים

“and you might prolong {your} days”

See how you translated the phrase “so that you may prolong your days” in 4:40. Alternate translation: [and you be able to live a long time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. The greatest commandment (1–9)
2. A warning against disobeying Yahweh (10–19)
3. Teaching children about Yahweh’s commands (20–25)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Yahweh’s blessings

Yahweh’s continued blessing of the people of Israel is dependent upon the people’s obedience to the law of Moses. When the Israelites agreed to the covenant with Yahweh, they acknowledged that worshiping and obeying Yahweh would lead to blessings, while disobeying him and worshiping other gods would lead to curses. (See: bless, blessed, blessing; and law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God)

The Shema

Verses 6–9 are known as “the Shema” in Judaism. They are an important foundation of Judaism. In Mark 12:28–29, Jesus identifies the Shema as the greatest commandment.

Writing Yahweh’s words on one’s arms, forehead, and doorposts

Verses 8–9 command the Israelites always to remember Yahweh’s words. There are different understandings of these commands. Some Jewish traditions interpret these verses as meaning the Israelites should physically write copies of the law. Others believe that the command is to memorize and cherish the law. Translators should be careful to translate the passage as it is, without favoring one interpretation or the other in their translation.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Words for the law

- statutes
- ordinances
- judgments

Moses uses three different words to refer to the law that Yahweh commanded the Israelites to obey. It is unclear what distinguishes each of these terms from the others. If your language has several terms for the law, you could use them here to differentiate between the various Hebrew words. (See: Translate Unknowns)

“you” and “your” singular and plural

The pronouns “you” and “your” are plural in this chapter unless otherwise noted. Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he sometimes addresses them as “you” singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 6:1 (#1)

הַמִּצְוָה הַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים

“are} the commandments, the statutes, and the ordinances”

See how you translated these terms for the law in 5:31.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 6:1 (#2)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 6:1 (#3)

צִוָּ֣ה

“has commanded”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The fact that Yahweh commanded Moses is implied by the events which Moses described in the previous chapter. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [has commanded me]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:1 (#4)

בָּאָ֨רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֜ר אַתֶּ֣ם עֹבְרִ֗ים שָׁ֙מָּה֙ לְרִשְׁתָּ֔הּ

“in the land which you are going over to possess it”

The expression **the land which you are going over to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [in the land you are going over to possess]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 6:1 (#5)

עֹבְרִ֗ים שָׁ֙מָּה֙

“are going over”

The implication is that the Israelites must cross the Jordan River in order to go to the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [are crossing over the Jordan River]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:2 (#1)

לְמַ֣עַן & וּלְמַ֣עַן

“so that & and so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows the two uses of **so that** are the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:2 (#2)

תִּירָ֞א & אֱלֹהֶ֣יךָ & מְצַוְּךָ֗ אַתָּה֙ וּבִנְךָ֣ וּבֶן־בִּנְךָ֔ & חַיֶּ֖יךָ & יָמֶ֑יךָ

“you will fear & your God & am commanding you and your son and the son of your son & your life & your days”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 13. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 6:2 (#3)

אַתָּה֙ וּבִנְךָ֣ וּבֶן־בִּנְךָ֔ כָּל־יְמֵ֥י חַיֶּ֖יךָ

“you and your son and the son of your son, all the days of your life”

In this verse, the words **son** and **life** are singular in form, but refer to all Israelites and their descendants as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [all of you and sons and your grandsons, all the days of your lives] or [all of you and your descendants, all the days of your lives]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 6:2 (#4)

יַאֲרִכֻ֖ן יָמֶֽיךָ

“your days will be prolonged”

The expression **be prolonged** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will prolong your days]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 6:2 (#5)

יַאֲרִכֻ֖ן יָמֶֽיךָ

“your days will be prolonged”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “so that you may prolong your days” in 4:40. Alternate translation: [you will be able to live a long life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#1)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֣ & וְשָׁמַרְתָּ֔ לַעֲשׂ֑וֹת

“And you shall listen & and carefully do”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And you shall listen to them ... and carefully do them]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#2)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֣

“And you shall listen”

See how you translated the term “listen” in 4:30.

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר֩ & וַאֲשֶׁ֨ר

“that & and that”

Here each occurrence of **that** marks what comes after as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#4)

תִּרְבֶּ֗ון מְאֹ֔ד

“you will greatly multiply”

The implication is that the number of Israelites will **multiply** by births. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your population will greatly increase]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#5)

אֲבֹתֶ֖יךָ

“your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#6)

דִּבֶּ֥ר

“spoke”

The implication is that Yahweh will ensure that what he **spoke** will happen. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [told you he would do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:3 (#7)

אֶ֣רֶץ זָבַ֥ת חָלָ֛ב וּדְבָ֖שׁ

“in} a land flowing with milk and honey”

Moses is speaking as if the land that God promised to give to the Israelites were physically **flowing with milk and honey**. Moses means that the land is “a very fertile land.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in a rich and fertile land] or [in a very productive land]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:4 (#1)

יְהוָ֥ה ׀ אֶחָֽד

“Yahweh {is} one”

It is difficult to know exactly what **Yahweh is one** means. In order to allow for the following possibilities, it would be good to use a word such as **one**, if possible. This could mean: (1) Yahweh is the only God that Israel worships. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is our only God] or (2) Yahweh is the only God that exists. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is the one and only God] or (3) Yahweh is unique. Alternate translation: [Yahweh is unique]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:5 (#1)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ֖ וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁךָ֑ וּבְכָל־מְאֹדֶֽךָ

“with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your strength”

Moses is referring to all of a person by naming three major components, **heart**, **soul** and **strength**. These terms are used together to mean “completely” or “with full devotion.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [wholeheartedly] or [with complete devotion]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 6:6 (#1)

וְהָי֗וּ הַדְּבָרִ֛ים הָאֵ֥לֶּה אֲשֶׁ֖ר אָנֹכִ֣י מְצַוְּךָ֑ הַיּ֖וֹם עַל־לְבָבֶֽךָ׃

“And these words that I am commanding you today will be on your heart”

Moses is using **on your heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “you will remember.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And bear in mind these words that I am commanding you today] or [And never forget these words that I am commanding you today]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 6:7 (#1)

לְבָנֶ֔יךָ

“to your sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to your descendants]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:7 (#2)

בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ֥ בְּבֵיתֶ֖ךָ וּבְלֶכְתְּךָ֣ בַדָּ֑רֶךְ

“when you sit in your house and when you walk on the road”

Here Moses is referring to every place an Israelite would go in daily life by referring to two major categories of locations. The term **in your house** refers to the indoors, and **on the road** refers to the outdoors. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wherever you are]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 6:7 (#3)

וּבְשָׁכְבְּךָ֖ וּבְקוּמֶֽךָ׃

“and when you lie down and when you get up”

Here Moses is referring to all activities of daily life by referring to two major categories of activities. The phrase **lie down** refers to resting, and the phrase **get up** refers to any other activity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and whatever you are doing]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 6:8 (#1)

לְטֹטָפֹ֣ת

“as frontlets”

A **frontlet** is a type of decorative accessory, often used as a symbol of commitment, worn around the head. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of headwear, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [as a symbolic marker]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 6:8–9 (#1)

וּקְשַׁרְתָּ֣ם לְא֔וֹת עַל־יָדֶ֑ךָ וְהָי֥וּ לְטֹטָפֹ֖ת בֵּ֥ין עֵינֶֽיךָ׃ וּכְתַבְתָּ֣ם עַל־מְזוּזֹ֣ת בֵּיתֶ֔ךָ וּבִשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ׃

“And you shall tie them as a sign on your hand. And they will be as frontlets between your eyes. And you shall write them on the doorposts of your house and on your gates”

The law was so important to remember that Moses wanted the Israelites to remember the law as though the law were written on their **hand**, between their **eyes**, on their **doorposts**, and on their **gates**. Alternate translation: [And you shall know the law so well that it was as if you tied them as a sign on your hand. And it will be as if they are frontlets between your eyes, and as if they were written on the doorposts of your house and on your gates]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:9 (#1)

וּבִשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ׃

“and on your gates”

Here the word **gates** refers to city gates. In those days, homes did not have gates, so we know that Moses is referring to city gates. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and on the entryways to towns]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:10 (#1)

וְהָיָ֗ה כִּֽי־יְבִיאֲךָ֤ ׀ יְהוָה֙ אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ אֶל־הָאָ֕רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֥ר נִשְׁבַּ֖ע לַאֲבֹתֶ֑יךָ לְאַבְרָהָ֣ם לְיִצְחָ֔ק וְלִיעֲקֹ֖ב לָתֶ֣ת לָ֔ךְ עָרִ֥ים גְּדֹלֹ֖ת וְטֹבֹ֑ת אֲשֶׁ֖ר לֹא־בָנִֽיתָ׃

“And it will happen that Yahweh your God will bring you into the land that he swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give to you, {with} large and good cities that you did not build”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of the clauses in this verse. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, that he would give to you the land. And it will happen that he will bring you into the land: This land has large and good cities that you did not build]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 6:10 (#2)

וְהָיָ֗ה

“And it will happen”

Moses is using the word translated **And it will happen** to introduce a new topic in his speech. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new topic. Alternate translation: [Now, note]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 6:10 (#3)

יְבִיאֲךָ֣

“will bring you”

In a context such as this, your language might say “take” instead of **bring**. Alternate translation: [will take you]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 6:10–11 (#1)

עָרִ֣ים גְּדֹלֹ֣ת וְטֹבֹ֔ת אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־בָנִ֖יתָ: וּבָתִּ֣ים מְלֵאִ֑ים כָּל־טוּב֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־מִלֵּאתָ֔ וּבֹרֹ֥ת חֲצוּבִ֖ים אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹא־חָצַ֑בְתָּ כְּרָמִ֥ים וְזֵיתִ֖ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־נָטָ֑עְתָּ

“with} large and good cities that you did not build, and houses full of every good thing that you did not gather, and hewn cisterns that you did not dig, vineyards and olive trees that you did not plant”

The people groups who live on the land built cities and cultivated the land. When the Israelites conquer that land, they will take over all those good things. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [with large and good cities that you did not build, and houses full of every good thing that you did not gather, and hewn cisterns that you did not dig, vineyards and olive trees that you did not plant. You will take all of these from the people groups that you will drive out from the land.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:12 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:12 (#2)

מִבֵּ֖ית עֲבָדִֽים

“from the house of slaves”

See how you translated the phrase “from the house of slaves” in 5:6. Alternate translation: [from the place where you were slaves]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:13 (#1)

אֶת־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ תִּירָ֑א וְאֹת֖וֹ תַּעֲבֹ֑ד וּבִשְׁמ֖וֹ תִּשָּׁבֵֽעַ

“Yahweh your God you shall fear and him you shall serve and by his name you shall swear”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the phrasing to emphasize in your language what Moses is emphasizing here, that the Israelites should worship only Yahweh. Alternate translation: [It is Yahweh your God and no one else whom you shall fear; it is he alone whom you shall worship, and it is by his name and only his name that you shall swear]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 6:13 (#2)

וּבִשְׁמ֖וֹ תִּשָּׁבֵֽעַ

“and by his name you shall swear”

The implication is that when the Israelites swear by Yahweh, that means they are asking Yahweh to take note of their promise and punish them if they do not fulfill their promise. Moses wants the Israelites to only invoke Yahweh’s name when making promises. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you shall make strong promises using only his name]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:13 (#3)

וּבִשְׁמֹו תִּשָּׁבֵֽעַ

“and by his name you shall swear”

Here, **name** represents all of Yahweh: his power, presence, knowledge, and so on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and swear by Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:14 (#1)

לֹ֣א תֵלְכ֔וּן אַחֲרֵ֖י

“Do not go after”

Here Moses is speaking of idols as if they were moving beings that one could physically **go after** and follow. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not serve]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:14 (#2)

אֱלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֗ים מֵאֱלֹהֵי֙

“other gods, the gods of”

The expression **other gods, the gods of** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [other gods that are worshiped by]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 6:14 (#3)

מֵאֱלֹהֵי֙ הָעַמִּ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר סְבִיבֹותֵיכֶֽם

“the gods of the peoples who surround you”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **gods** that the other **peoples** of the land worship. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an expression that describes the same relationship. Alternate translation: [the gods which the peoples who surround you worship]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 6:14 (#4)

הָעַמִּ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֖ר סְבִיבֹותֵיכֶֽם

“the peoples who surround you”

Here the phrase **the peoples who surround you** refers to the people groups that live near the land that Yahweh is about to give to the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the neighboring peoples]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:15 (#1)

אֱלֹהֶ֣יךָ בְּקִרְבֶּ֗ךָ & אֱלֹהֶ֣יךָ בָּ֔ךְ וְהִשְׁמִידְךָ֖

“your God in your midst & your God & against you, and he destroy you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 6:15 (#2)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [and this is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:15 (#3)

בְּקִרְבֶּ֗ךָ

“in your midst”

This does not mean that Yahweh has a physical body that lives with the Israelites. Moses means that Yahweh has a special relationship with the Israelites. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [who is present with you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:15 (#4)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction (in the previous verse) to follow so that this will not happen. Use a

connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:15 (#5)

וְחָרָה אַף־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בָּךְ

“the nose of Yahweh your God burn against you”

Moses is using the terms **the nose … burn** as a common expression of his culture to mean “become angry.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God become angry with you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 6:15 (#6)

מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה

“from the face of the earth”

Moses is using **the face of the earth** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the surface of the earth and everything that exists on it.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from existing on the earth]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 6:16 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר נִסִּיתֶם בַּמַּסָּה

“as you tested {him} at Massah”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 17:1–7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:16 (#2)

בַּמַּסָּה

“at Massah”

The word **Massah** is the name of a place. It means “testing.”

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 6:17 (#1)

שָׁמֹר תִּשְׁמְרוּן

“Keeping, you shall keep”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **keep** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis.

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 6:17 (#2)

אֶת־מִצְוֹת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם וְעֵדֹתָיו וְחֻקָּיו אֲשֶׁר צִוָּךְ

“the commandments of Yahweh your God and his testimonies and his statutes that he has commanded you”

The expression **the commandments of Yahweh your God that he has commanded you** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [the commandments of Yahweh your God and his testimonies and his statutes]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#1)

וְעָשִׂיתָ הַיָּשָׁר וְהַטּוֹב בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“And you shall do the right and the good in the eyes of Yahweh”

Alternate translation: [And you shall do what Yahweh thinks is right and good]

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#2)

וְעָשִׂיתָ & לְךָ וּבָאתָ וְיָרַשְׁתָּ & לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

“And you shall do & for you, and you may go in and possess & to your fathers”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 21. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#3)

הַיָּשָׁר וְהַטּוֹב

“the right and the good”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the ideas of **right** and **good**, you could express the same

idea using adjectives or in another way. Alternate translation: [what is righteous and pleasing]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#4)

הַיָּשָׁר וְהַטּוֹב

“the right and the good”

The terms **right** and **good** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [what is righteous] or [what is pleasing]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#5)

בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the phrase “in the eyes of Yahweh” in 4:25. Alternate translation: [according to the judgment of Yahweh]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#6)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what comes after the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:18 (#7)

אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּע יְהוָה לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

“that Yahweh swore to your fathers”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The fact that Yahweh will give the land to the living Israelites is implied by what Moses said earlier in this speech. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh swore to your fathers that he would enable you to possess] or [that Yahweh swore that he would give to your fathers]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:19 (#1)

לַהֲדֹף

“to thrust away”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. It is implied that Yahweh is the subject from the previous clause. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that he would thrust away]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:19 (#2)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your faces”

Here the phrase **from your faces** could: (1) represent “from your presence,” Alternate translation: [from before you] or (2) be a common expression of the culture that means [on your account] or [on your behalf.] Alternate translation: [on your behalf]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:20 (#1)

כִּי־יִשְׁאָלְךָ בִנְךָ מָחָר לֵאמֹר מָה הָעֵדֹת וְהַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֶתְכֶם

“When your son asks you tomorrow, saying, ‘What the testimonies and the statutes and the ordinances that Yahweh our God commanded you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [When your son asks you tomorrow about the testimonies and the statues and the ordinances that Yahweh our God commanded you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 6:20 (#2)

בִּנְךָ

“your son”

Although the term **son** is masculine, Moses is using the word in a generic sense that includes both sons and daughters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a phrase that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [your child]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 6:20 (#3)

מָחָר

“tomorrow”

Here, **tomorrow** means “in the future.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [someday]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:20 (#4)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 6:20 (#5)

מָ֣ה הָעֵדֹ֗ת וְהַחֻקִּים֙ וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֔ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוָּ֛ה יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵ֖ינוּ אֶתְכֶֽם

“What the testimonies and the statutes and the ordinances that Yahweh our God commanded you”

The author is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would need in many languages to be complete. If your readers might misunderstand this, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [What is the meaning of the testimonies and the statutes and the ordinances that Yahweh our God commanded you] or [What do the testimonies and the statutes and the ordinances that Yahweh our God commanded you mean]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:21 (#1)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ לְבִנְךָ֔ עֲבָדִ֥ים הָיִ֖ינוּ לְפַרְעֹ֣ה בְּמִצְרָ֑יִם וַיּוֹצִיאֵ֨נוּ יְהוָ֤ה מִמִּצְרַ֙יִם֙ בְּיָ֣ד חֲזָקָֽה

“Then you shall say to your son, ‘We were slaves of Pharaoh in Egypt. And Yahweh brought us out from Egypt with a mighty hand”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you shall say to your son that you were slaves of Pharoah in Egypt, and that Yahweh brought you out from Egypt with a mighty hand]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 6:21 (#2)

לְבִנְךָ֔

“to your son”

Although the term **son** is masculine, Moses is using the word in a generic sense that includes both sons and daughters. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [to your child]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 6:21 (#3)

וַיּוֹצִיאֵ֨נוּ יְהוָ֤ה

“And Yahweh brought us out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh took us out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 6:21 (#4)

בְּיָ֣ד חֲזָקָֽה

“with a mighty hand”

Here the word **hand** represents God’s power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated “a mighty hand” in 4:34.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:22 (#1)

וַיִּתֵּ֣ן יְהוָ֔ה

“And Yahweh gave”

Here, **gave** means “did” or “performed.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh performed]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:22 (#2)

אוֹתֹ֥ת וּמֹפְתִ֖ים

“signs and wonders”

The words **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [amazing signs]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 6:22 (#3)

גְּדֹלִים וְרָעִים

“great and terrible”

The implication is that Yahweh did **great and terrible** things to the people of Egypt through the 10 plagues in Exodus 7–11. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [great and terrible plagues]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 6:22 (#4)

בְּמִצְרַיִם

“on Egypt”

Here, **Egypt** represents the people of Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on the Egyptians]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:22 (#5)

בֵּיתוֹ

“his house”

Here, **house** represents Pharaoh’s family and the officials in his court. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his royal court]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:22 (#6)

לְעֵינֵינוּ

“before our eyes”

Here, **eyes** represents the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and we witnessed it]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 6:23 (#1)

וְאוֹתָנוּ הוֹצִיא & הָבִיא אֹתָנוּ

“And he brought us out & bring us in”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [And he took us out ... take us in]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 6:23 (#2)

לְמַעַן

“in order to”

Here, **in order to** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 6:23 (#3)

הָבִיא אֹתָנוּ

“bring us in”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The fact that Yahweh is bringing the Israelites into the land is implied by the next phrase. You could supply these words from later in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [bring us into the land]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:23 (#4)

נִשְׁבַּע לַאֲבֹתֵינוּ

“he swore to our fathers”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The fact that Yahweh will give the land to the living Israelites is implied by what Moses said earlier in this speech. You could supply these words from earlier in the passage if it would be clearer in your language. See how you translated the similar phrase “swore to your fathers” in verse 18. Alternate translation: [he swore to our fathers that he would give to us]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 6:23 (#5)

לַאֲבֹתֵינוּ

“to our fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the word “fathers” in 1:8. Alternate translation: [to our predecessors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 6:24 (#1)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

See how you translated the expression “all of the days” in 4:40. Alternate translation: [until the end of time] or [forever]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 6:24 (#2)

לְטוֹב לָנוּ

“for good to us”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **good**, you can express the same idea in another way, as modeled by the UST. Alternate translation: [so that we might prosper]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 6:25 (#1)

וּצְדָקָה תִּהְיֶה־לָּנוּ כִּי־נִשְׁמֹר לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת־כָּל־הַמִּצְוָה הַזֹּאת לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּנוּ

“And it will be righteousness to us, if we keep doing all these commandments to the face of Yahweh our God, as he has commanded us”

Moses is suggesting that this is a possible condition, that Yahweh will only consider the Israelites to be righteous if they obey Yahweh’s commandments. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation that could happen. It may be helpful to reorder this sentence so that the conditional statement is clear. Alternate translation: [If we keep doing all these commandments to the face of Yahweh our God as he has commanded us, then it will be righteousness to us]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 6:25 (#2)

וּצְדָקָה תִּהְיֶה־לָּנוּ

“And it will be righteousness to us”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will consider us as righteous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 6:25 (#3)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of” in 1:42. Alternate translation: [before] or [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Moses tells the Israelites what they are to do to the seven nations occupying the land that Yahweh had promised them and to those nations’ objects of worship (1–11)
2. Blessings for obedience (12–24)
3. Commands regarding what the Israelites are to do with the idols of the false gods of the nations they dispossess (25–26)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

“You must completely destroy them”

The people of Canaan worshiped idols and did other things that were abominations to Yahweh. Since the Israelites had a special relationship with Yahweh, Yahweh used Israel to punish these nations for their idolatry by destroying them completely. Yahweh wanted the Israelites to live differently than those nations. (See: sin, sinful, sinner, sinning; and mercy, merciful)

Abrahamic Covenant

This chapter references parts of the covenant Yahweh made with Abraham. Yahweh promised Abraham that he would have very many descendants. The Israelites are the descendants of Abraham, so Yahweh repeats his promise to them in Deuteronomy, telling them that they will prosper and increase their population if they obey him. (See: covenant; and faithful, faithfulness, trustworthy)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“you” and “your” singular and plural

The pronouns “you” and “your” are plural in this chapter unless otherwise noted. Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he sometimes addresses them as “you” singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you

could use the plural forms in your translation. (See Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 7:1 (#1)

יְבִיאֲךָ & אֱלֹהֶיךָ & אַתָּה & מִפָּנֶיךָ & מִמֶּךָּ

“your God brings you & you & from your face & than you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 4. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 7:1 (#2)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 7:1 (#3)

יְבִיאֲךָ

“brings you”

In a context such as this, your language might say “takes” instead of **brings**. Alternate translation: [takes you]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 7:1 (#4)

הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה בָא־שָׁמָּה לְרִשְׁתָּהּ

“the land which you are going to there to possess it”

The expression **the land which you are going to there to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [the land which you are going to possess]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 7:1 (#5)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your face”

See how you translated the similar phrase “from their faces” in 2:12. Alternate translation: [on your behalf] or [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:2 (#1)

וּנְתָנָם יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְפָנֶיךָ

“and Yahweh your God will give them to your face”

Moses is using **give them to your face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “give you victory over them” or “deliver them into your power.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will give you victory over them] or [and Yahweh will hand them over to you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:2 (#2)

וְהִכִּיתָם

“and you shall strike them down”

Here the term **strikes** means attacking with the intent to kill. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and you shall attack and kill them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:2 (#3)

הַחֲרֵם תַּחֲרִימֵם

“devoting, you shall devote”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **devote** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. See how you translated “devoted” at 2:34. Alternate translation: [utterly devoting] or [utterly destroying]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 7:2 (#4)

לֹא־תִכְרֹת לָהֶם בְּרִית

“Do not cut with them a covenant”

See how you translated the similar phrase “cut a covenant with us” in 5:2. Alternate translation: [Do not make a covenant with them]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:2 (#5)

בְּרִית

“a covenant”

The implication is that the Israelites should not make a peace treaty with the nations named in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a peace treaty]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:3 (#1)

וְלֹא תִתְחַתֵּן בָּהֶם בִּתְּךָ לֹא־תִתֵּן לִבְנוֹ וּבִתּוֹ לֹא־תִקַּח לִבְנֶךָ

“And do not arrange marriages with them. Do not give your daughter to his son, and you shall not take his daughter for your son”

In that culture, at the time of this speech, parents would **arrange marriages** for their children. Their understanding of marriage was that a father would **give** his daughter in marriage, and the other family would **take** the daughter for their son. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could describe marriage in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Do not arrange marriages for your children with their children. Prevent your sons and daughters from becoming their spouses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:3 (#2)

בִּתְּךָ & לִבְנוֹ וּבִתּוֹ & לִבְנֶךָ

“your daughter to his son, and & his daughter for your son”

In this verse, the words **son** and **daughter** are singular in form, but they refer to all children of marrying age from the Israelites and the other people groups. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [any of your daughters to any of their sons, and ... any of their daughters for any of your sons]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 7:4 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:4 (#2)

יָסִיר אֶת־בִּנְךָ מֵאַחֲרַי

“they will turn away your son from after me”

Moses is speaking of disobeying Yahweh as if one could **turn away** from walking on a path that follows Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they will cause your son to disobey me]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:4 (#3)

אֶת־בִּנְךָ

“your son”

In this verse, the word **son** is singular in form, but it refers to all the children of the Israelites, both their sons and their daughters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [your offspring]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 7:4 (#4)

וְחָרָה אַף־יְהוָה בָּכֶם

“And the nose of Yahweh will burn against you”

See how you translated “nose” and “burn” in the similar phrase in 6:15. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will be very angry with you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:5 (#1)

וּמַצֵּבֹתָם תְּשַׁבֵּרוּ

“and smash their pillars”

The people groups in the land built stone **pillars** as symbols of their god Baal. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and smash their sacred stone pillars]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:5 (#2)

וַאֲשֵׁירֵהֶם֙ תְּגַדֵּעֽוּן

“and cut their Asherah poles to pieces”

The people groups in the land made wooden **poles** to worship their goddess, **Asherah**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and cut their wooden poles symbolizing the goddess Asherah to pieces]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:6 (#1)

אַתָּ֔ה & אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ בָּֽךְ & אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“you & your God & your God & you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 7:6 (#2)

כִּ֣י

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:6 (#3)

עַל־פְּנֵ֥י הָאֲדָמָֽה

“are on the face of the earth”

See how you translated the phrase “the face of the earth” in the similar phrase in 6:15. Alternate translation: [are existing on the earth] or [are on the earth]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:7 (#1)

לֹ֣א & כִ֤י

“not & for”

Moses uses the words **not** and **for** here to indicate a strong contrast. Yahweh could have chosen a numerous people group, but he did not do that. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [not for the reason ... but rather,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:7 (#2)

אַתֶּ֖ם הַמְעַ֣ט מִכָּל־הָעַמִּֽים

“you {were} the fewest of all the peoples”

Moses says **fewest of all the peoples** here as an extreme statement for emphasis. The Israelites were most likely not the smallest people group. Moses means that they were insignificant compared to other people groups. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [you were insignificant compared to the other peoples]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 7:8 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“but”

The word translated as **but** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before, specifically the reason why Yahweh “chose” the Israelites (see the preceding verse for the use of the word “chose”). Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:8 (#2)

לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶ֑ם

“to your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:8 (#3)

בְּיָ֣ד חֲזָקָ֔ה & מִיַּ֖ד

“with a mighty hand & from the hand of”

Here the word **hand** represents power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with mighty strength ... from the control of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:8 (#4)

מִבֵּ֖ית עֲבָדִ֑ים

“from the house of slaves”

See how you translated the phrase “from the house of slaves” in 5:6. Alternate translation: [from the place where you were slaves]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:9 (#1)

וְיָדַעְתָּ֣ & אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“And you shall know & your God”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 7:9 (#2)

וְהַחֶ֖סֶד

“and faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and loves steadfastly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 7:9 (#3)

לְאֶ֥לֶף דֹּֽור

“for a thousand generations”

Here, **a thousand generations** represents the concept of forever. See how you translated the similar concept with “thousands” in 5:10. Alternate translation: [for all of his people always]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 7:10 (#1)

וּמְשַׁלֵּ֥ם לְשֹׂנְאָ֖יו אֶל־פָּנָ֑יו לְהַאֲבִידֹ֔ו לֹ֥א יְאַחֵ֖ר לְשֹׂנְאֹ֑ו אֵ֥ל־פָּנָ֖יו יְשַׁלֶּם־לֹֽו

“and he repays those who hate him to his face, to destroy him. He will not delay with him who hates him; he will repay him to his face”

These two sentences mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the sentences with a word that shows that the second sentence is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [and he repays those who hate him to his face, to destroy him. Indeed, he will not delay with him who hates him; he will repay him to his face]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 7:10 (#2)

אֶל־פָּנָ֑יו & אֶל־פָּנָ֖יו

“to his face & to his face”

Moses is using **face** to represent all of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [personally ... personally]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 7:10 (#3)

לֹ֥א יְאַחֵ֖ר

“He will not delay”

Moses is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [He will act swiftly] or [He will deal swiftly]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 7:11 (#1)

וְשָׁמַרְתָּ֣ & מְצֻוָּ֔ךָ

“And you shall keep & command you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 24. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 7:12 (#1)

עֵ֖קֶב

“on account of”

Here, **on account of** introduces the first part of a condition. Yahweh will only bless the Israelites if they obey his commandments. Use a natural form in

your language for introducing a situation that could happen.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 7:12 (#2)

וּשְׁמַרְתָּתָם וַעֲשִׂיתֶתָם

“and keeping and doing”

The two words **keeping** and **doing** express a single idea. The word **keeping** describes how the act of **doing** takes place. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [and faithfully doing]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 7:12 (#3)

וְאֶת־הַחֶסֶד

“and the faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **faithfulness**, you can express the same idea with “faithfully” or “faithful” or in some other way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [with loyalty]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 7:13 (#1)

וְהִרְבֶּךָּ

“and multiply you”

The implication is that the number of Israelites will **multiply** by births. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and increase your population]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:13 (#2)

וּבֵרַךְ פְּרִי־בִטְנְךָ

“And he will bless the fruit of your womb”

Moses is using **fruit of your womb** as a common expression of his culture to mean “your ability to have many children.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will cause your women to be fertile]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:13 (#3)

וּפְרִי־אַדְמָתֶךָ

“and the fruit of your ground”

Moses is using **fruit of your ground** as a common expression of his culture to mean “your crops.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your crops]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:13 (#4)

דְּגָנְךָ וְתִירֹשְׁךָ וְיִצְהָרֶךָ

“your grain and your new wine and your oil”

In this verse, the words **grain**, **wine**, and **oil** are singular in form, but they refer to all crops and produce as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [all your crops of grain and all of your new wine and all of your oil]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 7:13 (#5)

וְתִירֹשְׁךָ וְיִצְהָרֶךָ

“and your new wine and your oil”

The implication is that Yahweh will cause the grapevines and olive plants of the Israelites to produce abundant crops of grapes and olives. **Wine** is made from grapes and **oil** is made from olives. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and your grapes for wine and your olive trees for oil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:13 (#6)

אֲלָפֶיךָ

“your cattle”

Here the word **cattle** refers to livestock such as bulls and cows. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your bulls and cows]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:14 (#1)

בָּרוּךְ תִּהְיֶה

“You will be blessed”

The expression **be blessed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will bless you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 7:14 (#2)

לֹא־יִהְיֶ֥ה בְךָ֛ עָקָ֖ר וַעֲקָרָ֑ה וּבִבְהֶמְתֶּֽךָ

“There will not be a barren male or a barren female among you or among your cattle”

Moses is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [All your males and females will be fertile among you and among your cattle]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 7:15 (#1)

יָדַ֣עְתָּ

“you have known”

Here, **you have known** means “you have known about” or “you have heard of.” This does not mean “experienced,” which would imply that the Israelites also experienced all of the diseases that the Egyptians experienced. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [you have heard of]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 7:16 (#1)

וְאָכַלְתָּ֞

“And you shall consume”

Here, **consume** means “completely destroy.” Moses is speaking of conquering a people group as if it were like eating food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you shall exterminate]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:16 (#2)

נֹתֵ֤ן

“will give to you”

Here, **give** means “allow to conquer.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will cause you to defeat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:16 (#3)

לֹא־תָחֹ֥ס עֵינְךָ֖ עֲלֵיהֶ֑ם

“your eye shall not pity them”

Moses is using **your eye shall not pity them** as a common expression of his culture to mean “do not feel sorry for them.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not let your heart soften towards them] or [do not have compassion on them]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:16 (#4)

כִּ֥י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:16 (#5)

מוֹקֵ֥שׁ הוּא֙ לָ֔ךְ

“it will be a snare for you”

Moses is speaking of the person who worships idols as if they were an animal caught in a hunter’s **snare**. Moses is saying that idolatry leads to certain destruction, just like a trapped animal faces destruction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly or express the meaning with a simile. Alternate translation: [it will be like a snare for you because you will keep on serving their gods]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:17 (#1)

כִּֽי־תֹאמַ֖ר

“If you say”

Moses is using the word **If** to introduce a condition that might happen but that is not a good condition. In the next verse, he tells the Israelites what to do in this case, to counteract this condition and to encourage them. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this. Alternate translation: [Even though you might say]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 7:17 (#2)

תֹּאמַר֙ בִּלְבָבְךָ֔

“you say in your heart”

Moses is using **say in your heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “think” or “say to yourself.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you say to yourself] or [if you think]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:17 (#3)

אֵיכָ֥ה אוּכַ֖ל לְהוֹרִישָׁ֑ם

“how can I dispossess them”

Moses is using the question form to illustrate how the Israelites might be afraid of the other nations. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I will not be able to dispossess them.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 7:18 (#1)

זָכֹ֣ר תִּזְכֹּ֔ר

“Remembering, you shall remember”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **remember** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [You must certainly remember] or [Keep in mind]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 7:18 (#2)

מִצְרָֽיִם

“Egypt”

Here, **Egypt** represents the people of Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Egyptians]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:19 (#1)

הַמַּסֹּ֣ת הַגְּדֹלֹ֔ת

“the great trials”

Here the word **trials** refers to the plagues in Exodus 7–11 that Yahweh sent so that the Egyptians would see his power. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. See how you translated the similar phrase “by trials” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [the great plagues that Yahweh sent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:19 (#2)

עֵינֶ֑יךָ

“your eyes”

Moses is using **eyes** to represent the whole person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 7:19 (#3)

וְהָאֹתֹ֥ת וְהַמֹּפְתִ֖ים

“and the signs and the wonders”

See how you translated the similar phase “by signs and by wonders” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [and the amazing signs]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 7:19 (#4)

וְהַיָּ֣ד הַחֲזָקָ֔ה וְהַזְּרֹ֥עַ הַנְּטוּיָ֖ה

“and the mighty hand and the outstretched arm”

See how you translated the similar phase “by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [and the very great power]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 7:19 (#5)

הוֹצִאֲךָ

“brought you out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [took you out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 7:19 (#6)

אַתָּה יָרֵא מִפְּנֵיהֶם

“you are afraid of their faces”

Moses is using the phrase **their faces** to represent the people themselves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are afraid]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 7:20 (#1)

אֶת־הַצִּרְעָה

“the hornet”

A **hornet** is a stinging insect. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of insect, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [stinging insects]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 7:20 (#2)

אֶת־הַצִּרְעָה יְשַׁלַּח & בָּהֶם

“will send the hornet against them”

Here Moses could be using the term **hornet** to refer to: (1) terror. The phrase **Yahweh your God will send the hornet against them** would then mean that Yahweh would cause the people to become terrified and want to run away. Alternate translation: [will cause them to feel terror] or (2) actual hornets. The phrase **Yahweh your God will send the hornet against them** would then mean that Yahweh would send flying insects that sting people and cause pain.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:20 (#3)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your face”

See how you translated the similar phrase “from their faces” in 2:12. Alternate translation: [because of you] or [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:21 (#1)

מִפְּנֵיהֶם

“from their faces”

See how you translated the phrase “from their faces” in 2:12. Alternate translation: [because of them] or [by their presence]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:22 (#1)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your face”

Here the phrase **from your face** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on your account” or “on your behalf,” Alternate translation: [on your behalf] or (2) represent [from your presence.] Alternate translation: [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:22 (#2)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that **Yahweh** does not want to happen, but that could happen if the Israelites drove out the nations quickly rather than **little by little**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of Yahweh not allowing the Israelites to drive out the nations occupying the land too quickly.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:22 (#3)

תִּרְבֶּה עָלֶיךָ חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה

“the animals of the field multiply against you”

The implication is that the wild animals will increase in population and take over the land before the Israelites are able to cultivate all of the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the animals of the field multiply before you can control their population]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:22 (#4)

חַיַּ֥ת הַשָּׂדֶ֖ה

“the animals of the field”

Moses is using **animals of the field** as a common expression of his culture to mean “wild animals” or “non-domestic animals.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:23 (#1)

וּנְתָנָ֣ם יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“And Yahweh your God will give them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the other nations mentioned in the previous verse. If this is not clear to your readers, you could use state it in your translation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh your God will give those other nations]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 7:23 (#2)

לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“to your faces”

Here, **faces** represents being in their presence which implies being under their control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:23 (#3)

וְהָמָם֙ מְהוּמָ֣ה גְדֹלָ֔ה

“And he will confuse them {with} great confusion”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **confuse** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [And he will confuse them very greatly]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 7:23 (#4)

הִשָּׁמְדֵֽם

“they are destroyed”

The expression **are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you are able to completely destroyed them]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#1)

וְנָתַ֣ן

“And he will give”

Here, **give** means “enable victory over.” Moses speaks of victory in battle as if it were a physical object one person could **give** to another. Alternate translation: [And he will give victory over]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#2)

בְּיָדֶ֑ךָ

“into your hand”

Here the word **hand** represents power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into your control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#3)

אֶת־שְׁמָ֖ם

“their name”

Here, **name** represents the people, their bloodline, and knowledge of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [knowledge of them] or [memory of them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#4)

מִתַּ֣חַת הַשָּׁמָ֔יִם

“from under the heavens”

Moses is using **under the heavens** as a common expression of his culture to mean “on earth.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could

state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the earth]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#5)

לֹא־יִתְיַצַּב אִישׁ

“No man will stand”

Here, **stand** means “resist” or “stop.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [No man will survive the battle]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#6)

אִישׁ

“man”

By **man**, Moses means anyone from the enemy people groups. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [fighting man from these peoples]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:24 (#7)

בְּפָנֶיךָ

“against your face”

Here, **face** represents the presence of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#1)

לֹא־תַחְמֹד & וְלָקַחְתָּ לָּךְ & תִּוָּקֵשׁ & אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“do not covet & and take {it} for yourself & you become trapped & your God”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you**, **your**, and the command **covet** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#2)

תִּשְׂרְפוּן בָּאֵשׁ

“You shall burn & in fire”

The expression **burn … in fire** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression, as modeled by the UST.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#3)

כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב

“silver and gold”

Idols were often decorated with **silver and gold** and other precious materials. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the silver and gold overlays]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#4)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#5)

תִּוָּקֵשׁ בּוֹ

“you become trapped by it”

Moses is speaking of these **silver** and **gold** decorated **idols** as if they were a **trap** that a hunter would use to catch animals. Moses is saying that idolatry leads to certain destruction, just like a trapped animal faces destruction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly or express the meaning with a simile. See how you translated the similar phrase “it will be a snare for you” in 7:16. Alternate translation: [it will be like a trap for you because you will keep on serving their gods]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#6)

תִּוָּקֵשׁ בּוֹ

“you become trapped by it”

The expression **become trapped** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [it entraps you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 7:25 (#7)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#1)

וְלֹא־תָבִ֤יא & בֵּיתֶךָ֙ & תִּשַׁקֵּצֶ֔נּוּ & וְהָיִ֥יתָ & תְּתַעֲבֶ֖נּוּ

“And do not bring & your house and you become & you shall detest it & you shall abhor it”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you**, **your**, and the command form of **bring** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#2)

תּוֹעֵבָ֣ה

“an abomination”

Here the specific type of **abomination** that Moses is referring to is an idol. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [any abomination of an idol]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#3)

וְהָיִ֥יתָ חֵ֖רֶם

“and you become a devoted thing”

Moses is saying that if the people bring an idol into their house, whoever does that will become a devoted thing, which means cursed by God and to be destroyed. This is an outcome that he does not want to happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is an outcome that they must avoid. See the discussion of the term **devoted** in the note at 2:34. Alternate translation: [so that you do not also become a devoted thing] or [or you will become a cursed thing]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#4)

שַׁקֵּ֥ץ ׀ תְּשַׁקְּצֶ֛נּוּ וְתַעֵ֥ב ׀ תְּתַעֲבֶ֖נּוּ

“Detesting, you shall detest it, and abhorring, you shall abhor it”

The terms **detest** and **abhor** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [You shall completely and utterly detest it]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#5)

שַׁקֵּ֥ץ ׀ תְּשַׁקְּצֶ֛נּוּ וְתַעֵ֥ב ׀ תְּתַעֲבֶ֖נּוּ

“Detesting, you shall detest it, and abhorring, you shall abhor it”

Moses is repeating forms of the verbs **detest** and **abhor** in order to intensify the idea that they express. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis.

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#6)

כִּ֥י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 7:26 (#7)

חֵ֖רֶם הִ֑וא

“it {is} a devoted thing”

See how you translated “devoted” at 2:34. Alternate translation: [it is to be completely destroyed]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy - Chapter 8 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses' second speech, which began in chapter five. Moses commands the Israelites not to forget Yahweh their God and tells them what will happen if they do (1–20).

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Forgetting

Moses reminds the living Israelites about all the miracles that Yahweh did for them to bring them out of Egypt and survive in the wilderness. In the wilderness, the Israelites complained and grumbled. It was easy for them to forget what Yahweh did for them and disobey Yahweh. As a result, Yahweh punished that generation by causing them to die in the wilderness without entering the land. The living Israelites are the children of that generation. Moses is warning them not to make the same mistakes as their parents did. (See: Israel, Israelites)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular and plural

When Moses is addressing the Israelites, he uses both the singular and plural forms of "you."

- In verses 1–19 see the notes.
- In verse 20 "you" and "your" are plural.

Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he sometimes addresses them as "you" singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Pronouns — When to Use Them; and Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 8:1 (#1)

מְצַוְּךָ

"am commanding you"

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** is singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 8:1 (#2)

לְמַעַן

"so that"

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what comes before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 8:1 (#3)

תִּחְיוּן וּרְבִיתֶם

"you may live and multiply"

The implication is that the Israelites will continue to **live** in the land and **multiply** their population with many births if they obey Yahweh. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you may dwell in the land for a long time and multiply your population]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:1 (#4)

נִשְׁבַּע יְהוָה לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם

"Yahweh swore to your fathers"

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The fact that Yahweh will give the land to the living Israelites is implied by what Moses said earlier in this speech. You could supply these words from earlier in the passage if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh swore to your fathers that he would give to you]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 8:1 (#5)

לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם

"to your fathers"

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase "your fathers" in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 8:2 (#1)

וְזָכַרְתָּ֣ & הֹלִיכְךָ֣ & אֱלֹהֶ֣יךָ & עִנֹּתְךָ֣ לְנַסֹּתְךָ֣ & בְּלְבָבְךָ֣

"And you shall remember & your God has led you & he might humble you, to test you & was} in your heart"

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 19. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not

be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 8:2 (#2)

אֶת־כָּל־הַדֶּ֣רֶךְ

“all the way”

Here, **all the way** represents everything that the Israelites saw, heard, and experienced during the time they were in the wilderness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everything that happened on the journey]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 8:2 (#3)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 8:2 (#4)

לְמַ֣עַן & לְנַסֹּתְךָ֖ לָדַ֣עַת

“so that & to test you to know”

Here the words **so that** and **to** mark what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 8:2 (#5)

אֶת־אֲשֶׁ֥ר בְּלְבָבְךָ֑

“what {was} in your heart”

Here, **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and intentions exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what you truly wanted]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 8:3 (#1)

וַיַּאֲכִלְךָ֣ אֶת הַמָּ֔ן

“and fed you manna”

This does not mean that Yahweh personally fed the Israelites like a mother would feed her infant. What Moses means is that Yahweh provided manna from heaven for the Israelites to eat, as Exodus 16 describes. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [and gave you manna to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:3 (#2)

לֹא־יָדַ֣עְתָּ וְלֹ֤א יָדְעוּן֙ אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ

“you had not known and your fathers had not known”

The expression **you had not known and your fathers had not known** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [you and your fathers had not known]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 8:3 (#3)

הָאָדָ֔ם & הָאָדָ֖ם

“man & the man”

In this verse, the word **man** is singular in form, but it refers to all human beings as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [humankind … humankind]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 8:3 (#4)

הַלֶּ֑חֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** represents all food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [eating meals]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 8:3 (#5)

כָּל־מוֹצָ֥א פִי־יְהוָ֖ה

“everything coming out of the mouth of Yahweh”

Here, **mouth** represents the act of speaking, and **everything coming out** represents the words or commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your

language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh declares]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 8:4 (#1)

שִׂמְלָתְךָ֙ לֹֽא־בָלְתָ֣ה מֵעָלֶ֔יךָ וְרַגְלְךָ֖ לֹ֣א בָצֵ֑קָה זֶ֖ה אַרְבָּעִ֥ים שָׁנָֽה

“Your clothing did not wear out from upon you, and your feet did not swell up these 40 years”

The implication is that Yahweh protected and provided for the Israelites. As a result, their **clothing did not wear out** and their **feet did not swell up** even though they walked for **40 years** in the wilderness. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh protected you so that your provisions did not run out and you remained healthy for those 40 years in the wilderness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:4 (#2)

שִׂמְלָתְךָ֙ לֹֽא־בָלְתָ֣ה מֵעָלֶ֔יךָ

“Your clothing did not wear out from upon you”

The expression **Your clothing did not wear out from upon you** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [Your clothing did not wear out]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 8:5 (#1)

וְיָדַעְתָּ֖ עִם־לְבָבֶ֑ךָ

“And you shall know with your heart”

Here the expression **know with your heart** means “think about” or “reflect on.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you shall consider]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 8:5 (#2)

יְיַסֵּ֥ר אִישׁ֙ אֶת־בְּנ֔וֹ

“a man instructs his son”

In this verse, the words **man** and **son** are singular in form, but refer to all parents and children as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [a parent instructs a child]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 8:6 (#1)

לָלֶ֖כֶת בִּדְרָכָ֑יו

“to walk in his ways”

Here Moses is speaking of the **commandments** of Yahweh as if they were **ways** or a path that the people should **walk** on. He means that obeying those commandments is like walking on that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to obey him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 8:7 (#1)

מְבִיאֲךָ֙

“is bringing you”

In a context such as this, your language might say “taking” instead of **bringing**. Alternate translation: [is taking you]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 8:7 (#2)

אֶ֣רֶץ

“a land of”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **land** that has the features that follow. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable way of expressing landmarks. Alternate translation: [a land that features]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 8:7 (#3)

נַחֲלֵ֤י מָ֙יִם֙ עֲיָנֹ֣ת וּתְהֹמֹ֔ת יֹצְאִ֖ים בַּבִּקְעָ֣ה וּבָהָֽר

“brooks of water, fountains, and springs coming out in valleys and in hills”

The implication is that water comes up from under the ground even in the mountains. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [plentiful water in both the valleys and the hills] or [flowing out in both the valleys and the hills]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:7 (#4)

נַחֲלֵ֤י מָ֙יִם֙ עֲיָנֹ֣ת וּתְהֹמֹ֔ת

“brooks of water, fountains, and springs”

Here, **brooks of water, fountains, and springs** are all types of flowing bodies of water. Moses is using the these terms together for emphasis. If your language does not have these, or all of these distinctions between bodies of water, you could use a more general description or use fewer terms. Alternate translation: [types of flowing bodies of water]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 8:8 (#1)

אֶֽרֶץ & אֶֽרֶץ

“a land of & a land of”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **land** that produces certain types of crops. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable way of describing the land. Alternate translation: [a land that can produce ... a land that can produce]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֨ר לֹֽא בְמִסְכֵּנֻ֤ת תֹּֽאכַל־בָּ֙הּ֙ לֶ֔חֶם

“where you will eat bread in it not with poverty”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the phrasing of this clause. Alternate translation: [where you will eat bread without scarcity]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#2)

לֶ֔חֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** represents all food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#3)

לֹֽא בְמִסְכֵּנֻ֤ת

“not with poverty”

Moses is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **no**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the author’s intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [in abundance]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#4)

בְמִסְכֵּנֻ֤ת

“with poverty”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **poverty**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [feeling hungry]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#5)

לֹֽא־תֶחְסַ֥ר כֹּ֖ל בָּֽהּ

“you will not lack anything in it”

Moses is using a figure of speech here that expresses a strongly positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with an expression that is the opposite of the author’s intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the positive meaning. Alternate translation: [where everything in it will be sufficient for you]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#6)

אֲבָנֶ֣יהָ בַרְזֶ֑ל וּמֵֽהָרָרֶ֖יהָ תַּחְצֹ֥ב נְחֹֽשֶׁת

“its stones {are} iron, and from the hills you may dig copper”

The implication is that one can **dig** (as in, mine) for **iron** and **copper** ore in the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [there is iron ore and there is copper ore that you can mine]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:9 (#7)

נְחֹֽשֶׁת

“copper”

Here the word **copper** refers to a soft metal used for making tools and other utensils. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of metal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [soft metal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 8:11 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 8:11 (#2)

מִצְוֹתָיו֙ וּמִשְׁפָּטָ֣יו וְחֻקֹּתָ֔יו

“his commandments and his ordinances and his statutes”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “the commandment and the statutes and the ordinances” in 5:31.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 8:12 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction (in the previous verse) to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 8:14 (#1)

וְרָ֥ם לְבָבֶ֖ךָ

“and your heart is lifted up”

In this verse, Moses gives the negative consequences that could happen as a result of the previous verses. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [so that your heart is lifted up]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 8:14 (#2)

וְרָ֥ם לְבָבֶ֖ךָ

“and your heart is lifted up”

Moses is using **your heart is lifted up** as a common expression of his culture to mean “you become proud.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you become prideful] or [and you become conceited]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 8:14 (#3)

מִבֵּ֣ית עֲבָדִ֑ים

“from the house of slaves”

See how you translated the phrase “from the house of slaves” in 5:6. Alternate translation: [from the place where you were slaves]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#1)

הַגָּדֹ֤ל וְהַנּוֹרָא֙

“great and terrible”

See how you translated the phrase “great and terrible wilderness” in 1:19. Alternate translation: [the great and unsafe]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#2)

נָחָ֨שׁ ׀ שָׂרָ֜ף וְעַקְרָ֗ב

“fiery serpent and scorpion”

In this verse, the words **serpent** and **scorpion** are singular in form, but they refer to all serpents and scorpions in the wilderness as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [fiery serpents and scorpions]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#3)

נָחָ֨שׁ ׀ שָׂרָ֜ף

“fiery serpent”

This phrase begins a list of the “great and terrible” things that the Israelites encountered in the wilderness. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previ-

ous one. Alternate translation: [which had the fiery serpent]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#4)

נָחָשׁ ׀ שָׂרָף

“fiery serpent”

Here, **fiery serpent** probably means that the venom from the bite of the serpent causes burning or **fiery** pain. Alternate translation: [poisonous serpent]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#5)

וְעַקְרָב

“and scorpion”

A **scorpion** is a poisonous creature that crawls on the ground, similar to a spider. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of poisonous creature, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and small stinging and poisonous creature]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#6)

וְצִמְאוֹן

“and thirsty ground”

The implication is that the **ground** was **thirsty** because the region was dry, with very little rain there. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and waterless land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#7)

הַמּוֹצִיא לְךָ מַיִם מִצּוּר הַחַלָּמִישׁ

“he brought out water for you from the rock of flint”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 20:2–13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#8)

מִצּוּר הַחַלָּמִישׁ

“from the rock of flint”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **rock** that has the qualities of **flint**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression to describe hard rock. Alternate translation: [from the flinty rock]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 8:15 (#9)

מִצּוּר הַחַלָּמִישׁ

“from the rock of flint”

Here the word **flint** refers to a hard, solid type of rock that can be used to ignite fires. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of rock, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [from the rock that was very hard]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 8:16 (#1)

הַמַּאֲכִלְךָ מָן בַּמִּדְבָּר

“He fed you manna in the wilderness”

This does not mean that Yahweh personally **fed** the Israelites like a mother would feed her infant. What Moses means is that Yahweh sent manna from heaven for the Israelites to eat. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [and provided you with manna to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:16 (#2)

לְמַעַן & וּלְמַעַן

“so that & and so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that ... and in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 8:16 (#3)

בְּאַחֲרִיתֶךָ

“in your end”

The implication is that Yahweh would “do good” to the Israelites at the **end** of all the testing and trials they experienced. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the end of all the testing]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:17 (#1)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ בִּלְבָבֶ֗ךָ כֹּחִי֙ וְעֹ֣צֶם יָדִ֔י עָשָׂ֥ה לִ֖י אֶת־הַחַ֥יִל הַזֶּֽה

“And you will say in your heart, ‘My power and the might of my hand made for me this wealth”

As modeled by the UST, if it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And you will say in your heart that your power and the might of your hand made for you this wealth]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 8:17 (#2)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ בִּלְבָבֶ֗ךָ

“And you will say in your heart”

See how you translated “say in your heart” in 7:17. Alternate translation: [And you will say to yourselves]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 8:17 (#3)

וְעֹ֣צֶם יָדִ֔י

“and the might of my hand”

Here, **hand** represents the ability of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and with my own might]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 8:17 (#4)

אֶת־הַחַ֥יִל הַזֶּֽה

“this wealth”

Here, **this wealth** refers to all the good things that Moses listed in 8:7–10 and 8:12–13. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [this prosperity and all these possessions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:18 (#1)

לְמַ֣עַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 8:18 (#2)

הָקִ֞ים אֶת־בְּרִיתֹ֗ו

“he may establish his covenant”

Alternate translation: [he may fulfill his covenant]

Deuteronomy 8:18 (#3)

כַּיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“as this day”

The implication is that at the same time that Moses is speaking to the Israelites, Yahweh is fulfilling the covenant. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as he is doing now]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:19 (#1)

שָׁכֹ֨חַ תִּשְׁכַּ֜חְ & אָבֹ֣ד תֹּאבֵדֻ֗ון

“forgetting, you forget & perishing, you will perish”

Moses is repeating forms of the verbs **forget** and **perish** in order to intensify the idea that they express. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [you indeed forget … you will indeed perish]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 8:19 (#2)

וְהָלַכְתָּ֣ אַחֲרֵ֔י

“and walk after”

Here, **walk after** means “worship.” Moses is speaking of worshiping idols as if they were walking behind them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and serve]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 8:19 (#3)

הַעִדֹ֤תִי בָכֶם֙

“I testify against you”

The phrase **I testify against you** is an oath formula used as a strong warning. Use a natural way in your

language to express a strong warning. Alternate translation: [I promise you]

See: Oath Formulas

Deuteronomy 8:20 (#1)

מִפְּנֵיכֶֽם

“from your faces”

See how you translated the similar phrase “from their faces” in 2:12. Alternate translation: [because of you] or [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 8:20 (#2)

לֹ֣א תִשְׁמְעֻ֔ון בְּקֹ֖ול

“you would not listen to the voice of”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, means to listen and “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [you would not obey the voice of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 8:20 (#3)

בְּקֹ֖ול

“to the voice of”

Here, **voice** represents the words that Yahweh spoke, which include his commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the words of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 9 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Moses tells the Israelites that when they enter the land that Yahweh had promised to them that Yahweh will be with them and fight for them (1–3)
2. Moses reminds the Israelites that Yahweh is not allowing them to dispossess the people groups in the land that Yahweh had promised them because of the Israelites righteousness but rather because of the wickedness of the people who live in that land (4–6)
3. Moses recounts the Israelites’ consistent pattern of sinning against Yahweh and his intercession on their behalf (7–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Yahweh’s victory

This chapter assures the Israelites that it is Yahweh who will empower them to conquer the land that Yahweh had promised them. The Israelites will not be strong enough on their own to conquer these other nations. This victory will be Yahweh’s. The people did not earn this victory, but it is Yahweh’s punishment of these sinful nations. (See: Promised Land; and sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

Israel’s sin

Yahweh is about to punish the Canaanites for their sin. He also reminds Israel of their sin. This serves as a warning to the people of Israel. If they sin again, Yahweh will punish them too.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“you” and “your” singular and plural

When Moses is addressing the Israelites, he uses both the singular and plural forms of “you.”

- In verses 1–6: “you” and “your” are singular.
- In verse 7 see the note.
- In verses 8–9 “you” and “your” are plural.
- In verses 16–25 “you” and “your” are plural.

Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he sometimes addresses them as “you” singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Pronouns — When to Use Them; and Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 9:1 (#1)

שְׁמַ֣ע & אַתָּ֗ה & מִמֶּךָּ֔

“Hear & You & than you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, commands and the words **you** and **your** are singular from here to verse 6. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 9:1 (#2)

וּבְצֻרֹ֖ת בַּשָּׁמָֽיִם

“and fortified to the heavens”

Moses says **fortified to the heavens** here as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. See how you translated this phrase in 1:28. Alternate translation: [and extremely well-fortified]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 9:2 (#1)

בְּנֵי

“the sons of”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:2 (#2)

אַתָּה יָדַעְתָּ֣ אַתָּ֔ה וְאַתָּ֖ה שָׁמַ֥עְתָּ

“you, you know, and you, you have heard”

Moses is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verbs translated as **know** and **heard** already include this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that these people know about the Anakites very well. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [you know very well, and you indeed have heard] or [you yourselves know, and you indeed have heard]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 9:2 (#3)

וְאַתָּ֖ה שָׁמַ֥עְתָּ

“and you, you have heard”

Here the word **heard** means “heard rumors of.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and of whom you have heard it said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:2 (#4)

מִמִּ֥י יִתְיַצַּ֖ב לִפְנֵ֣י בְנֵי־עֲנָ֑ק

“Who can stand to the faces of the sons of Anak”

Moses is using the question form to emphasize that people were afraid of the Anakites. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There is no one who can stand to the faces of the sons of Anak.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 9:2 (#5)

יִתְיַצַּ֖ב

“can stand”

Here, **stand** means “resist” or “oppose in battle.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [can endure in battle]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:2 (#6)

לִפְנֵ֣י

“to the faces of”

Here, **faces** represents the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:3 (#1)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶ֛יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 9:3 (#2)

אֵ֣שׁ אֹכְלָ֔ה

“a devouring fire”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh’s response, when he is jealous, as if it were **a devouring fire**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is a destroyer of people who disobey him, just as a fire burns its fuel to ashes]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:3 (#3)

הֽוּא־יַשְׁמִידֵ֣ם וְהֽוּא־יַכְנִיעֵ֣ם לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“he, he will destroy them, and he, he will subdue them to your face”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [he will destroy them, indeed, he will subdue them to your face]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 9:3 (#4)

הוּא יַשְׁמִידֵם וְהוּא יַכְנִיעֵם

“he, he will destroy them, and he, he will subdue them”

Moses is stating the pronoun **he** separately, even though the verbs translated as **he will destroy** and **he will subdue** already include this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Yahweh alone will do these things. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [it is he who will destroy them, and it is he alone will subdue them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 9:3 (#5)

לְפָנֶיךָ & לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your face & to your face”

Here, **face** represents the presence of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your presence ... before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#1)

אַל־תֹּאמַר בִּלְבָבְךָ

“You shall not say in your heart”

See how you translated “say in your heart” in 7:17. Alternate translation: [You shall not think]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#2)

בַּהֲדַף יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֹתָם

“when Yahweh your God has thrust them out”

Here, **when** means “after.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after Yahweh your God has thrust them out]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#3)

בַּהֲדַף יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֹתָם

“when Yahweh your God has thrust them out”

Yahweh will **thrust out** the people of the other nations by driving them off of the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh your God has driven them out]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#4)

מִלְּפָנֶיךָ

“from to your face”

Here, **face** represents what is in front of the Israelites or in their presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from your presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#5)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#6)

בְּצִדְקָתִי & וּבְרִשְׁעַת

“In my righteousness & but in the wickedness of”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **righteousness** and **wickedness**, you could express these ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [Since I am righteous ... but for the wicked deeds of]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#7)

בְּצִדְקָתִי & וּבְרִשְׁעַת

“In my righteousness & but in the wickedness of”

Here, **In** means “because of.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Due to my righteousness ... but due to the wickedness of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#8)

הֱבִיאַנִי

“has brought me in”

In a context such as this, your language might say “taken” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [has taken me in]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#9)

וּבְרִשְׁעַת

“but in the wickedness of”

Moses uses the word **but** here to indicate a strong contrast between what the Israelites might think and the real reason why Yahweh is giving them the land. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [nevertheless, in the wickedness of]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:4 (#10)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your face”

Here the phrase **from your face** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on your account” or “on your behalf,” Alternate translation: [on your behalf] or (2) represent [from in front of] the Israelites. Alternate translation: [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#1)

לֹא בְצִדְקָתְךָ וּבְיֹשֶׁר לְבָבְךָ אַתָּה בָּא לָרֶשֶׁת אֶת־אַרְצָם כִּי בְּרִשְׁעַת ׀ הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מוֹרִישָׁם מִפָּנֶיךָ

“Not in your righteousness or in the uprightness of your heart are you going in to possess their land, but in the wickedness of these nations, Yahweh your God is driving them out from your face”

This sentence means basically the same thing as the previous verse. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the sentences in a way that would make this clear. Alternate translation: [I reiterate, not in your righteousness or in the uprightness of your heart are you going in to possess their land, but in the wickedness of these nations, Yahweh your God is driving them out from before your face]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#2)

בְּצִדְקָתְךָ וּבְיֹשֶׁר לְבָבְךָ

“in your righteousness or in the uprightness of your heart”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **righteousness** and **uprightness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [in your righteous acts or your upright heart]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#3)

בְּצִדְקָתְךָ וּבְיֹשֶׁר

“in your righteousness or in the uprightness”

Here, **in** means “because of.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because of your righteousness or because of the uprightness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#4)

לְבָבְךָ

“of your heart”

Here the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of your desires]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#5)

אַתָּה בָּא

“are you going in”

In a context such as this, your language might say “coming” instead of **going**. Alternate translation: [are you coming in]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#6)

כִּֽי

“but”

Moses uses the word **but** here to indicate a strong contrast between what the Israelites might think and the real reason why Yahweh is giving them the land. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but, rather,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#7)

מִפָּנֶ֔יךָ

“from your face”

Here the phrase **from your face** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on your account” or “on your behalf,” Alternate translation: [on your behalf] or (2) represent [from in front of] the Israelites. Alternate translation: [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#8)

וּלְמַ֣עַן

“and so that”

Here, **so that** marks **Yahweh may establish the word** as the goal or purpose of **Yahweh your God is driving them out**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#9)

הָקִ֗ים

“may establish”

Here, **establish** means “fulfill.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated “may establish” in 8:18. Alternate translation: [may fulfill]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#10)

אֶת־הַדָּבָ֛ר

“the word”

Here, **word** represents what someone said, which, in this case, is the promise that Yahweh spoke. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the promise]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:5 (#11)

לַאֲבֹתֶ֖יךָ

“to your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:6 (#1)

בְּצִדְקָתְךָ֣

“in your righteousness”

Here, **in** means “because of.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because of your righteousness]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:6 (#2)

בְּצִדְקָתְךָ֣

“in your righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in your good deeds]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 9:6 (#3)

עַם־קְשֵׁה־עֹ֖רֶף

“are} a people stiff of neck”

Moses is using **stiff of neck** as a common expression of his culture to mean “stubborn” and “rebellious.” The image comes from an animal that does not want to go the way his master is trying to direct him. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are a hard-hearted people] or [are a rebellious people]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:7 (#1)

זְכֹר֣ אַל־תִּשְׁכַּ֗ח & הִקְצַפְתָּ֤ & אֱלֹהֶ֙יךָ֙ & יָצָֽאתָ

“Remember, you shall not forget & you provoked & your God to anger & you went out”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, the command **Remember**, and the pronouns **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 9:7 (#2)

זְכֹר֙ אַל־תִּשְׁכַּ֔ח

“Remember, you shall not forget”

The words **remember** and **you shall not forget** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Remember, indeed, you shall not forget]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 9:7 (#3)

הַמָּקֹ֣ום הַזֶּ֔ה

“this place”

Here, **this place** refers to the Jordan River valley, where the Israelites are camping. This is where Moses is speaking to the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [this valley]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:8 (#1)

וּבְחֹרֵ֖ב

“And at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of the mountain which is also known as Mount Sinai. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 32.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 9:9 (#1)

לוּחֹ֣ת הַבְּרִ֔ית

“the tablets of the covenant”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **the tablets** on which Yahweh wrote **the covenant**, specifically, the words of the Ten Commandments. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression to describe a tablet with writing on it. Alternate translation: [the tablets that had the words of the covenant on them]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 9:9 (#2)

הַבְּרִ֔ית אֲשֶׁר־כָּרַ֥ת יְהוָ֖ה

“the covenant that Yahweh cut”

See how you translated the similar phrase “cut a covenant with us” in 5:2. Alternate translation: [the covenant that Yahweh made]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:9 (#3)

לֶ֣חֶם לֹ֤א אָכַ֙לְתִּי֙ וּמַ֣יִם לֹ֣א שָׁתִ֔יתִי

“bread I did not eat and water I did not drink”

The implication is that Moses chose to go without food or water while he was on the mountain. Be sure that this distinction is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [bread I chose not to eat and water I chose not to drink]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:9 (#4)

לֶ֣חֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** represents all food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 9:10 (#1)

כְּתֻבִ֖ים בְּאֶצְבַּ֣ע אֱלֹהִ֑ים

“written with the finger of God”

The term **written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [on which the finger of God wrote]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 9:10 (#2)

כְּתֻבִ֖ים בְּאֶצְבַּ֣ע אֱלֹהִ֑ים

“written with the finger of God”

The implication is that it was God who wrote on the stone, not Moses. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [written by the finger of God himself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:10 (#3)

כְּכָל־הַדְּבָרִ֗ים אֲשֶׁ֨ר דִּבֶּ֤רְ יְהוָה֙ עִמָּכֶ֔ם בָּהָ֖ר מִתּ֣וֹךְ הָאֵ֑שׁ בְּי֖וֹם הַקָּהָֽל

“was} according to all the words that Yahweh spoke with you on the mountain from the midst of the fire on the day of the assembly”

This refers to the events of Exodus 19, when the Israelites gathered at the base of Mount Sinai while Moses went to the top. THere Yahweh told Moses all the commandments from a fire at the top of Mount Sinai. Alternate translation: [was according to all the words that Yahweh spoke to you from the fire on the top of the mountain while you were gathered at the base of the mountain]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:11 (#1)

וַיְהִ֗י

“And it happened”

Moses is using the word translated as **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event. Alternate translation: [Then]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 9:11 (#2)

לֻחֹ֥ת הַבְּרִ֖ית

“the tablets of the covenant”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **the tablets** on which Yahweh wrote **the covenant**, specifically, the words of the Ten Commandments. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression to describe a tablet with writing on it. Alternate translation: [the tablets that had the words of the covenant on them]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 9:12 (#1)

וַיֹּ֨אמֶר יְהוָ֜ה אֵלַ֗י קוּם֙ רֵ֣ד מַהֵ֔רָ מִזֶּ֔ה כִּֽי־שִׁחֵ֥ת עַמְּךָ֖ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הוֹצֵ֑אתָ מִמִּצְרַ֗יִם סָ֚רוּ מַהֵ֣ר מִן־הַדֶּ֔רֶךְ אֲשֶׁ֥ר צִוִּיתִ֖ם עָשׂ֣וּ לָהֶ֑ם מַסֵּכָֽה

“And Yahweh said to me, ‘Get up, go down quickly from here, for your people, whom you brought out from Egypt, have become corrupted. They have quickly turned aside from the path that I commanded them. They have made for themselves a cast figure”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh commanded me to leave the mountain quickly because you had turned aside from his path that he had commanded you and made a cast figure for yourselves]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 9:12 (#2)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:12 (#3)

עַמְּךָ֖

“your people”

Here Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe the **people** that Moses leads. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression to describe leadership. Alternate translation: [the people whom you oversee]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 9:12 (#4)

שִׁחֵ֥ת

“have become corrupted”

Here the phrase **have become corrupted** means the Israelites had sinned and done wrong. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [sinned greatly]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:12 (#5)

סָ֣רוּ מַהֵ֗ר מִן־הַדֶּ֙רֶךְ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוִּיתִ֔ם

“They have quickly turned aside from the path that I commanded them”

Here Yahweh is speaking of commandments as if they were a **path** and saying that disobeying commandments is like turning aside from that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They have quickly disobeyed my commands] or [They have quickly disobeyed what I commanded them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:13 (#1)

וַיֹּ֤אמֶר יְהוָה֙ אֵלַ֣י לֵאמֹ֔ר רָאִ֥יתִי אֶת־הָעָ֖ם הַזֶּ֑ה וְהִנֵּ֥ה עַם־קְשֵׁה־עֹ֖רֶף הֽוּא

“And Yahweh said to me, saying, ‘I have seen this people, and behold, it {is} a people stiff of neck”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh told me that he saw you, and that you are a people stiff of neck]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 9:13 (#2)

רָאִ֥יתִי אֶת־הָעָ֖ם הַזֶּ֑ה

“I have seen this people”

The implication is that Yahweh has **seen** and knows everything that the Israelites do. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I know the actions of this people]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:13 (#3)

וְהִנֵּ֥ה

“and behold”

Yahweh is using the term **behold** to focus Moses’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and indeed]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:13 (#4)

עַם & הֽוּא

“it {is} a people”

The pronoun **it** refers to the **people** of Israel. If it would be more natural in your language, you could use a plural pronoun here. Alternate translation: [these people are]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 9:13 (#5)

עַם־קְשֵׁה־עֹ֖רֶף

“is} a people stiff of neck”

See how you translated “stiff of neck” in 9:6. Alternate translation: [is a hard-hearted people] or [is a rebellious people]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:14 (#1)

הֶ֣רֶף מִמֶּ֔נִּי

“Release from me”

Yahweh is using **Release from me** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to not interfere.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Leave me be] or [Do not interfere with me]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:14 (#2)

וְאַשְׁמִידֵ֑ם וְאֶמְחֶ֥ה אֶת־שְׁמָ֖ם מִתַּ֣חַת הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“and I will destroy them and wipe out their name from under the heavens”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [and I will destroy them; indeed, I will wipe out their name from under the heavens]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 9:14 (#3)

וְאֶמְחֶ֥ה אֶת־שְׁמָ֖ם מִתַּ֣חַת הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“and wipe out their name from under the heavens”

Yahweh speaks of destroying the Israelites as if he were erasing a word written on paper. Yahweh means that he will **wipe out** the memory of their **name**, and by extension, everything about them. See how you translated the very similar phrase, "cause their name to perish from under the heavens," in 7:24. Alternate translation: [and no one will know they ever existed]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:14 (#4)

וְאֶעֱשֶׂה אוֹתְךָ לְגוֹי

"and I will make you a nation"

The implication is that Yahweh will cause Moses to have so many descendants that those descendants will become **a nation** to replace the Israelites. This **nation** would be **mightier and greater** than the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and I will make a nation from you and your descendants, one that is]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:15 (#1)

וָאֵפֶן

"And I turned"

Here the word **turned** describes the beginning of Moses' action. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And I got up]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:15 (#2)

וָאֵרֵד

"and came down"

In a context such as this, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [and went down]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 9:15 (#3)

וְהָהָר בֹּעֵר בָּאֵשׁ

"and the mountain was burning with the fire"

The expression **burning with the fire** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [and there was fire on the mountain]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 9:15 (#4)

לֻחֹת הַבְּרִית

"tablets of the covenant"

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **the tablets** on which Yahweh wrote **the covenant**, specifically, the words of the Ten Commandments. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression to describe a tablet with writing on it. Alternate translation: [tablets that had the words of the covenant on them]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 9:15 (#5)

שְׁתֵּי יָדָי

"my two hands"

The expression **two hands** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [my hands]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 9:16 (#1)

סַרְתֶּם מַהֵר מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶתְכֶם

"You had quickly turned aside from the path that Yahweh had commanded you"

See how you translated this phrase, "turned aside from the path," in 9:12. Alternate translation: [You had rapidly disobeyed the commandments of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:17 (#1)

וָאַשְׁלִכֵם מֵעַל שְׁתֵּי יָדָי

"and threw them out of my two hands"

The expression **threw them out of my two hands** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [and threw them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 9:17 (#2)

לְעֵינֵיכֶם

“before your eyes”

See how you translated the same phrase, “before your eyes,” in 1:30. Alternate translation: [in your sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:18 (#1)

וָאֶתְנַפַּל֙ לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה

“And I prostrated myself to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **prostrated** refers to the act of bowing on the ground and lying prone. Here it is a symbolic action done in order to worship Yahweh and show submission. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And I bowed before Yahweh in submission and lay prone on the ground]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 9:18 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י

“to the face of”

Here, **face** represents being in front of or in the presence of someone. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of” in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [in front of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:18 (#3)

לֶ֚חֶם לֹ֣א אָכַ֔לְתִּי וּמַ֖יִם לֹ֣א שָׁתִֽיתִי

“Bread I did not eat and water I did not drink”

See how you translated this in 9:9.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:18 (#4)

לֶ֚חֶם

“Bread”

Here, **bread** represents all food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Food]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 9:18 (#5)

בְּעֵינֵ֖י

“in the eyes of”

See how you translated the phrase “in the eyes of” in 4:25. Alternate translation: [in the evaluation of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:18 (#6)

לְהַכְעִיסֽוֹ

“to provoke him to anger”

This does not mean that the Israelites provoked Yahweh to anger on purpose, but rather, that their actions provoked Yahweh to anger. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [which provoked him to anger]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#1)

כִּֽי־

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for Moses prostrating himself in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#2)

מִפְּנֵ֣י

“from the face of”

Moses is using **from the face of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of] or [on account of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#3)

הָאַ֛ף וְהַחֵמָ֖ה

“the nose and the heat”

The terms **nose** and **heat** come from the common expression about “the burning of his nose” which means that Yahweh is angry. See how you translated this ex-

pression “nose of Yahweh your God burn against you” in 6:15. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the hot anger] or [the great anger]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#4)

הָאַף וְהַחֵמָה

“the nose and the heat”

The terms **nose** and **heat** both mean “anger” so are saying similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the extreme anger]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#5)

הָאַף

“the nose”

Here, **nose** represents anger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a body part from your language that is associated with anger or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the anger]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#6)

וְהַחֵמָה

“and the heat”

Here, **heat** refers to extreme anger, which causes the angry person’s body to become hot. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the rage]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#7)

קָצַף יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם לְהַשְׁמִיד אֶתְכֶם

“Yahweh was angry against you to destroy you”

The implication is that Yahweh was so **angry** with the Israelites that he wanted **to destroy** them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh raged against you enough to eliminate you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#8)

וַיִּשְׁמַע יְהוָה אֵלַי

“And Yahweh listened to me”

The implication is that Moses asked Yahweh not to destroy the Israelites and that **Yahweh listened to** him and answered his prayer. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [And I asked Yahweh to have mercy on you and he heard my prayer and did not destroy you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:19 (#9)

גַּם בַּפַּעַם הַהִוא

“also that time”

This refers back to 5:23–28, when Moses asked Yahweh if the Israelites could remain at the base of the mountain because they were afraid that they would die in the presence of Yahweh. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as he also listened to me when you asked me to speak to Yahweh on your behalf]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:20 (#1)

וָאֶתְפַּלֵּל גַּם־בְּעַד אַהֲרֹן בָּעֵת הַהִוא

“And I interceded also for the sake of Aaron at that time”

The implication is that Yahweh also listened to Moses’ prayer on behalf of Aaron. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And I interceded on behalf of Aaron, and Yahweh did not kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:21 (#1)

חַטַּאתְכֶם

“your sin”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **sin** that the Israelites had committed by making the cast-image calf. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression to describe an idol. Alternate translation: [your wicked creation]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 9:22 (#1)

וּבְתַבְעֵרָהוְ וּבְמַסָּהוְ וּבְקִבְרֹ֥ת הַתַּאֲוָֽה

“And at Taberah and at Massah and at Kibroth Hattaavah”

Taberah, **Massah**, and **Kibroth Hattaavah** are names of places that the Israelites traveled through in the wilderness.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 9:22 (#2)

וּבְתַבְעֵרָהוְ

“And at Taberah”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 11:1–3.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:22 (#3)

וּבְמַסָּֽה

“and at Massah”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 17:1–7.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:22 (#4)

וּבְקִבְרֹ֥ת הַתַּאֲוָֽה

“and at Kibroth Hattaavah”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 11:1–34.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#1)

וּבִשְׁלֹ֨חַ יְהוָ֜ה אֶתְכֶ֗ם מִקָּדֵשׁ֙ בַּרְנֵ֔עַ לֵאמֹ֖ר עֲל֣וּ וּרְשׁ֔וּ אֶת־הָאָ֕רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֥ר נָתַ֖תִּי לָכֶ֑ם

“and when Yahweh sent you from Kadesh Barnea, saying, ‘Go up and take possession of the land that I have given to you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh sent you from Kadesh Barnea and commanded you to go up and take possession of the land that he has given to you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֖ר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces direct speech. Consider natural ways of doing that in your own language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#3)

עֲל֣וּ

“Go up”

See how you translated “go up” in 1:21. Alternate translation: [Go attack]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#4)

אֶת־פִּ֣י

“the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** refers to Yahweh’s commands and what he says to do. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the command of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#5)

וְלֹ֣א הֶאֱמַנְתֶּ֣ם לוֹ֮

“and you did not believe him”

The Israelites disobeyed Yahweh because they did not believe that Yahweh would fulfill his promise to give them the land. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because you did not believe him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#6)

וְלֹ֣א שְׁמַעְתֶּ֔ם בְּקֹלֽוֹ

“and you did not listen to his voice”

Here the word **listen** means to listen and obey. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [and you did not obey his voice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:23 (#7)

בְּקֹלוֹ

“to his voice”

Here, **voice** represents the words Yahweh spoke, including his commandments. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to his commandments]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:25 (#1)

וָאֶתְנַפַּל לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֵאֵת אַרְבָּעִים הַיּוֹם וְאֵת־אַרְבָּעִים הַלַּיְלָה אֲשֶׁר הִתְנַפָּלְתִּי כִּי־אָמַר יְהוָה לְהַשְׁמִיד אֶתְכֶם

“And I prostrated myself to the face of Yahweh 40 days and 40 nights, and I prostrated myself because Yahweh had said to destroy you”

In this verse, Moses repeats what he said in verse 18 and continues his speech. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [And again, I tell you that I prostrated myself to the face of Yahweh 40 days and 40 nights, and I prostrated myself because Yahweh had said to destroy you]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 9:25 (#2)

וָאֶתְנַפַּל & הִתְנַפָּלְתִּי

“And I prostrated myself & I prostrated myself”

See how you translated this phrase, “prostrated myself,” in 9:18. Alternate translation: [And I bowed down … I bowed down]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 9:25 (#3)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated this same phrase in verse 18.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:25 (#4)

כִּי־אָמַר יְהוָה לְהַשְׁמִיד אֶתְכֶם

“because Yahweh had said to destroy you”

The implication is that Yahweh said that he intended to eliminate all of the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [because Yahweh intended to eliminate all of you] or [because Yahweh had said that he wanted to kill you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:26 (#1)

עַמְּךָ וְנַחֲלָתְךָ

“your people and your inheritance”

The terms **your people** and **your inheritance** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [your own people]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 9:26 (#2)

בִּגְדֻלָּתֶךָ

“through your greatness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **greatness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [through your great miracles]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 9:26 (#3)

בְּיָד חֲזָקָה

“with a mighty hand”

See how you translated the phrase “by a mighty hand” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [with might]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:27 (#1)

זְכֹר לַעֲבָדֶיךָ לְאַבְרָהָם לְיִצְחָק וּלְיַעֲקֹב

“Remember your servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob”

The implication is that Moses wants Yahweh to remember the promises he made to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Remember the promises you made to your servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:27 (#2)

אַל־תֵּ֣פֶן אֶל

“Do not turn to”

Here, **turn** means “think about” or “regard.” Moses is speaking of turning to something as if it was the same as focusing on it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not dwell on]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:27 (#3)

קְשִׁי֙

“the stiffness of”

Here, **hardness** means “stubbornness.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the stubborn acts of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 9:27 (#4)

רִשְׁעוֹ֙

“their wickedness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [their evil acts]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 9:28 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen, to convince Yahweh not to destroy the Israelites. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of Moses’ request in the previous two verses. Alternate translation: [otherwise] or [or else]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 9:28 (#2)

יֹאמְר֣וּ הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֤ר הוֹצֵאתָ֙נוּ מִשָּׁ֔ם מִבְּלִי֙ יְכֹלֶ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה לַהֲבִיאָ֖ם אֶל־הָאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּ֣ר לָהֶ֑ם וּמִשִּׂנְאָתוֹ֙ אוֹתָ֔ם הוֹצִיאָ֖ם לַהֲמִתָ֥ם בַּמִּדְבָּֽר

“the land where you brought us out from should say, “From Yahweh not being able to bring them into the land that he spoke to them, or from his hatred of them he has brought them out to kill them in the wilderness”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting his own prayer to Yahweh (level 2) and quoting what the people of Egypt might say (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations as modeled in the UST.

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 9:28 (#3)

יֹאמְר֣וּ הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֤ר הוֹצֵאתָ֙נוּ מִשָּׁ֔ם מִבְּלִי֙ יְכֹלֶ֣ת יְהוָ֔ה לַהֲבִיאָ֖ם אֶל־הָאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּ֣ר לָהֶ֑ם וּמִשִּׂנְאָתוֹ֙ אוֹתָ֔ם הוֹצִיאָ֖ם לַהֲמִתָ֥ם בַּמִּדְבָּֽר

“the land where you brought us out from should say, “From Yahweh not being able to bring them into the land that he spoke to them, or from his hatred of them he has brought them out to kill them in the wilderness”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation as modeled by the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 9:28 (#4)

הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֤ר הוֹצֵאתָ֙נוּ מִשָּׁ֔ם

“the land where you brought us out from”

Here, **the land where you brought us out from** represents the people of Egypt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the Egyptians]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 9:28 (#5)

הוֹצֵאתָ֙נוּ & לַהֲבִיאָ֖ם & הוֹצִיאָ֖ם

“you brought us out & to bring them & he has brought them out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [you took us out ... to take them ... he has taken them out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 9:28 (#6)

דִּבֶּ֣ר

“he spoke”

Here, **spoke** means “promised.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [he promised]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 9:29 (#1)

עַמְּךָ וְנַחֲלָתֶךָ

“are} your people and your inheritance”

See how you translated the phrase “your people and your inheritance” in 9:26. Alternate translation: [are your own people]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 9:29 (#2)

הוֹצֵאתָ

“you brought out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [you took out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 9:29 (#3)

בְּכֹחֲךָ הַגָּדֹל וּבִזְרֹעֲךָ הַנְּטוּיָה

“by your great power and by your outstretched arm”

The terms **great power** and **outstretched arm** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [by your amazing acts]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 9:29 (#4)

וּבִזְרֹעֲךָ הַנְּטוּיָה

“and by your outstretched arm”

Here, **arm** refers to Yahweh’s power. Moses speaks of God stretching out his **arm** as if it were a demonstration of supernatural power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your awesome deeds]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 10 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Yahweh writes the commandments on stone tablets again (1–5)
2. Aaron dies, the priesthood continues, and the special role of the Levites (6–9)
3. Yahweh listens to Moses and does not destroy the Israelites (10–11)
4. Moses encourages the Israelites to obey Yahweh (12–22)

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is a continuation of the previous chapter.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“you” and “your” singular and plural

When Moses is addressing the Israelites, he uses both the singular and plural forms of “you.”

- In verse 10 “you” is singular.
- In verses 12–14 “you” and “your” are singular.
- In verse 15 see the note.
- In verses 17–19 “you” and “your” are plural.
- In verses 20–22 “you” and “your” are singular.

Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he sometimes addresses them as “you” singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Pronouns — When to Use Them; and Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 10:1 (#1)

כָּרִאשֹׁנִים

“like the first”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like the first tablets of stone]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 10:1 (#2)

כָּרִאשֹׁנִים

“like the first”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first**, you could represent this in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [like the earlier]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 10:1 (#3)

הָהָרָה

“on the mountain”

This refers to Mount Sinai. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [on Mount Sinai]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:2 (#1)

עַל־הַלֻּחֹת הָרִאשֹׁנִים

“on the first tablets”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first**, you could represent this in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [on the previous ones]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 10:3 (#1)

כָּרִאשֹׁנִים

“like the first”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [like the first tablets of stone]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 10:3 (#2)

כָּרִאשֹׁנִים

“like the first”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first**, you could represent this in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [like the previous ones]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 10:3 (#3)

הָהָרָה

“the mountain”

Here, **mountain** refers to Mount Sinai. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [Mount Sinai]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:3 (#4)

וּשְׁנֵי הַלֻּחֹת בְּיָדִי

“and the two tablets {were} in my hand”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could describe how Moses carried the tablets with an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [and I was carrying the two tablets] or [and the two tablets were in my hands]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 10:4 (#1)

וַיִּכְתֹּב עַל־הַלֻּחֹת כַּמִּכְתָּב הָרִאשׁוֹן אֵת עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר
דִּבֶּר יְהוָה אֲלֵיכֶם בָּהָר מִתּוֹךְ הָאֵשׁ בְּיוֹם הַקָּהָל

“And he wrote on the tablets, like the first writing, the Ten Words which Yahweh had spoken to you on the mountain from the midst of the fire on the day of the assembly”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases. Alternate translation: [And on the mountain from the midst of the fire on the day of the assembly, Yahweh wrote the Ten Words on the tablets, just as he had done before]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 10:4 (#2)

כַּמִּכְתָּב הָרִאשׁוֹן

“like the first writing”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first**, you could represent this in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [like the previous writing]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 10:4 (#3)

אֵת עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדְּבָרִים

“the Ten Words”

See how you translated the phrase “the Ten Words” in 4:13.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:5 (#1)

וָאֵפֶן

“And I turned”

Here the word **turned** describes the beginning of action. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [And I got up]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:5 (#2)

וַיִּֽהְיוּ שָׁ֑ם

“And there they are”

The implication is that the tablets are still in the box at the time when Moses is giving this speech to the Israelites. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [And they have been there ever since]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:6 (#1)

מִבְּאֵרֹ֣ת בְּנֵי־יַעֲקָ֗ן מוֹסֵרָה֮

“from Beeroth Bene Jaakan to Moserah”

The terms **Beeroth Bene Jaakan** and **Moserah** are names of places where the people of Israel traveled. **Beeroth Bene Jaakan** means “the wells that belonged to the sons of Jaakan.” You could translate the names or include this information in a footnote if it would be helpful for your readers.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 10:6 (#2)

וַיִּקָּבֵ֥ר שָׁ֖ם

“and there he was buried”

The expression **was buried** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the people of Israel made a grave for him at that place]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 10:6–9 (#1)

וּבְנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵל֮ נָסְעוּ֒ מִבְּאֵרֹ֣ת בְּנֵי־יַעֲקָ֗ן מוֹסֵרָה֮ שָׁ֣ם מֵ֣ת אַהֲרֹן֒ וַיִּקָּבֵ֥ר שָׁ֖ם וַיְכַהֵ֣ן אֶלְעָזָ֣ר בְּנ֑וֹ תַּחְתָּֽיו׃ מִשָּׁ֣ם נָסְעוּ֮ הַגִּדְגֹּדָה֒ וּמִן־הַגִּדְגֹּדָה֮ יָטְבָ֣תָה אֶ֣רֶץ נַחֲלֵי־מָֽיִם׃ בָּעֵ֣ת הַהִ֣וא הִבְדִּ֣יל יְהוָ֔ה אֶת־שֵׁ֥בֶט הַלֵּוִ֖י לָשֵׂ֣את אֶת־אֲרֹ֣ון בְּרִית־יְהוָ֑ה לַעֲמֹ֤ד׀ לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָה֮ לְשָׁרְתוֹ֒ וּלְבָרֵ֣ךְ בִּשְׁמ֔וֹ עַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה׃ עַל־כֵּ֗ן לֹא־הָיָ֨ה לְלֵוִ֜י חֵ֤לֶק

וְנַחֲלָ֔ה עִם־אֶחָ֖יו יְהוָ֣ה הֽוּא נַחֲלָתֹ֑ו כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבֶּ֛ר יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ לֹֽו׃

“And the sons of Israel journeyed from Beeroth Bene Jaakan to Moserah. There Aaron died, and there he was buried. And Eleazar, his son, was priest in his place. From there they journeyed to Gudgodah, and from Gudgodah to Jotbathah, a land of streams of water. At that time Yahweh separated the tribe of Levi to carry the box of the covenant of Yahweh, to stand to the face of Yahweh to serve him, and to bless in his name, until this day. Therefore, Levi has no portion nor inheritance with his brothers. Yahweh, he is his inheritance, as Yahweh your God spoke to him”

In order to help readers understand what happens next in the story, these verses provide background information about the places where the Israelites traveled. In your translation, present this information in a way that makes it clear that this is background information.

See: Background Information

Deuteronomy 10:7 (#1)

אֶ֣רֶץ נַחֲלֵי־מָֽיִם

“a land of streams of water”

Here the writer is using the possessive form to describe a **land** that contains many **streams of water**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression as in the UST.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#1)

הִבְדִּ֣יל יְהוָ֔ה

“Yahweh separated”

Here, **separated** means “chose for a special role.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh selected]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#2)

אֶת־אֲרֹ֣ון בְּרִית־יְהוָ֑ה

“the box of the covenant of Yahweh”

Here the author is using the possessive form to describe the **box** that contains **the covenant of Yahweh**. If your language would not use the possessive form

for this, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [the box that held the covenant of Yahweh]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#3)

בְּרִית־יְהוָה

“the covenant of Yahweh”

Here, **the covenant of Yahweh** represents the two stone tablets on which Yahweh wrote the Ten Commandments. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the tablets of the covenant]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#4)

לַעֲמֹד֨ לִפְנֵ֤י יְהוָה֙ לְשָׁרְת֔וֹ

“to stand to the face of Yahweh to serve him”

Here, **to the face of Yahweh** represents his presence. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of Yahweh” in 1:45. Alternate translation: [to stand before Yahweh to serve him]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#5)

וּלְבָרֵ֥ךְ

“and to bless”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and to bless human beings]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#6)

בִּשְׁמ֑וֹ

“in his name”

Here, **name** represents all of Yahweh: his power, person, authority, and so on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as his representative]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:8 (#7)

עַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“until this day”

See how you translated the phrase “until this day” in 2:22. Alternate translation: [as they continue doing today]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#1)

לֹא־הָיָ֨ה לְלֵוִ֜י חֵ֤לֶק וְנַחֲלָה֙

“Levi has no portion nor inheritance”

The implication is that the Levites will not receive any **portion** or **inheritance** of land. See Numbers 18:20 for more information. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [Levi will not own any land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#2)

לֹא־הָיָ֨ה לְלֵוִ֜י

“Levi has no”

Here, **Levi** refers to the descendants of Levi. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Levi have no]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#3)

אֶחָ֑יו

“his brothers”

Here, **brothers** refers to the people of the other Israelite tribes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the other Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#4)

יְהוָ֣ה ה֔וּא נַחֲלָתֹ֕ו

“Yahweh, he is his inheritance”

Yahweh speaks of the special priesthood that Aaron and his descendants have as if Yahweh were something that they inherit. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [As his gift to them, Yahweh will

allow them to serve him, and he will provide for them through that service]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#5)

יְהוָה֙ הֽוּא

“Yahweh, he”

The pronoun **he** adds emphasis that **Yahweh** alone is Levi’s inheritance. If your language uses explicit pronouns for emphasis, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of bringing out this emphasis. Alternate translation: [It is Yahweh who] or [Yahweh himself]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#6)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#7)

אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“your God”

Even though the author is referring to all of the Israelites, the pronoun **your** is singular here. If the singular form of this pronoun would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural form in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#8)

דִּבֶּ֥ר

“spoke”

Alternate translation: [promised]

Deuteronomy 10:9 (#9)

לֽוֹ

“to him”

Alternate translation: [to the tribe of Levi] or [regarding the tribe of Levi]

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#1)

וְאָנֹכִ֗י עָמַ֙דְתִּי֙ בָּהָ֔ר כַּיָּמִ֥ים הָרִאשֹׁנִ֖ים אַרְבָּעִ֣ים י֑וֹם וְאַרְבָּעִ֣ים לֵיָלָ֔ה וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע יְהוָ֛ה אֵלַ֥י גַּ֖ם בַּפַּ֣עַם הַהִ֑וא לֹא־אָבָ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה הַשְׁחִיתֶֽךָ׃

“And I, I stood on the mountain as the first days, 40 days and 40 nights. And Yahweh listened to me that time also. Yahweh was not willing to destroy you”

This verse continues Moses’ speech to the Israelites from verse 5. Consider natural ways of continuing direct quotations in your language, as modeled by the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#2)

וְאָנֹכִ֗י עָמַ֙דְתִּי֙

“And I, I stood”

Moses is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I stood** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he is the one who stood on the mountain. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And indeed I stood] or [And I myself stood]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#3)

וְאָנֹכִ֗י עָמַ֙דְתִּי֙

“And I, I stood”

Alternate translation: [And I remained]

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#4)

כַּיָּמִ֥ים הָרִאשֹׁנִ֖ים

“as the first days”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first**, you could represent this in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [as the previous time]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#5)

כַּיָּמִ֥ים הָרִאשֹׁנִ֖ים

“as the first days”

Here the word **days** refers to a specific period of time. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the first period of time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#6)

וַיִּשְׁמַע יְהוָה אֵלַי גַּם בַּפַּעַם הַהִוא

“And Yahweh listened to me that time also”

The implication is that Yahweh **listened** to Moses’ request to not destroy the Israelites, just like Yahweh he did in 9:19. See how you translated the similar phrase, “Yahweh listened to me also that time,” in that verse. Alternate translation: [And I interceded on your behalf, and Yahweh listened to me at that time also]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:10 (#7)

הַשְׁחִיתֶךָ

“to destroy you”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** is singular here. If the singular form of these pronoun would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural form in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 10:11 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the faces of”

Here, **to the faces of** represents being in front of the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the similar phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated “to your faces” in 1:8. Alternate translation: [in front of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:11 (#2)

לַאֲבֹתָם

“their fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the word “fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:12 (#1)

אֱלֹהֶיךָ & מֵעִמָּךְ & אֱלֹהֶיךָ & אֱלֹהֶיךָ & לְבָבְךָ & נַפְשֶׁךָ

“your God & from you & your God & your God & your heart & your soul”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 14. Moses is speaking to the Israelites as if they were all one person. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 10:12 (#2)

לָלֶכֶת בְּכָל־דְּרָכָיו

“to walk in all his paths”

Here Moses is speaking of the commandments of Yahweh as if they were **paths** that the people should **walk** on. He means that obeying those commandments is like walking on that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to obey all his commandments]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:12 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל־נַפְשֶׁךָ

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

See how you translated the phrase “with all your heart and with all your soul” in 4:29.

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 10:12–13 (#1)

מָה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ שֹׁאֵל מֵעִמָּךְ כִּי אִם־לְיִרְאָה אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לָלֶכֶת בְּכָל־דְּרָכָיו וּלְאַהֲבָה אֹתוֹ וְלַעֲבֹד אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל־נַפְשֶׁךָ: לִשְׁמֹר אֶת־מִצְוֹת יְהוָה וְאֶת־חֻקֹּתָיו אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ הַיּוֹם לְטוֹב לָךְ

“what does Yahweh your God ask from you except to fear Yahweh your God, to walk in all his paths and to love him and to worship Yahweh your God with all your heart and with all your soul, to keep the commandments of Yahweh and his statutes, which I am commanding you today for your good”

Moses is using the question form to teach the people of Israel what Yahweh wants them to do. If you would not use the question form for this purpose in your language, you could translate this as a statement or an exclamation, as modeled by the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 10:14 (#1)

הֵ֣ן

“Behold”

Moses is using the term **behold** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Know that]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:14 (#2)

הַשָּׁמַ֥יִם וּשְׁמֵֽי הַשָּׁמָ֖יִם

“belong the heavens and the heaven of heavens”

The possessive form is being used here to include all parts of the heavens, even the highest part. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use another form to indicate this height. Alternate translation: [all of the heavens, even to the highest part of heaven]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 10:15 (#1)

רַ֚ק

“Only”

Alternate translation: [Yet]

Deuteronomy 10:15 (#2)

בַּאֲבֹתֶ֣יךָ

“in your fathers”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, the Israelites, **your** is singular here. If the singular form of this pronoun would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural form in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 10:15 (#3)

כַּיּ֖וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“as this day”

Moses means that, at the time of this speech to the Israelites, they are still Yahweh’s chosen people. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [and you are still his chosen people today]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:16 (#1)

וּמַלְתֶּ֥ם אֵ֖ת עָרְלַ֣ת לְבַבְכֶ֑ם

“And you shall circumcise the foreskin of your hearts”

Moses is speaking of the act of circumcision (in relation to their hearts) as if it were committing to covenant obedience. In Genesis 17:9–14 God gave Abraham the covenant of circumcision and the Israelites then expressed their obedience to Yahweh’s covenant by circumcising the foreskin of their son’s genitals. If it would help your readers, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you must commit your wills to fulfilling the obligations of my covenant with you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:16 (#2)

וְעָ֥רְפְּכֶ֖ם לֹ֥א תַקְשׁ֖וּ

“and do not stiffen your necks”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “stiff of neck,” in 9:6. Alternate translation: [and do not be hard-hearted] or [and do not be rebellious]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 10:17 (#1)

כִּ֣י

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [Do these things because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 10:17 (#2)

אֱלֹהֵ֤י הָֽאֱלֹהִים֙ וַאֲדֹנֵ֣י הָֽאֲדֹנִ֔ים

“the God of gods and the Lord of lords”

The possessive form is used here to indicate a comparison with other **gods** people might worship and other **lords** (the term **lords** refers to human rulers or kings) to show that **Yahweh** is the greatest. (This does not mean that other gods that people worship are actually true gods.) If it would be helpful in your language, you could use another form to indicate this comparison. Alternate translation: [the one true and powerful God and is the greatest of all rulers] or [the one true God and the greatest ruler]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 10:17 (#3)

הָאֵל הַגָּדֹל הַגִּבֹּרֹ

“the great God, the mighty one”

The terms **great** and **mighty** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the very mighty God]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 10:17 (#4)

לֹא־יִשָּׂא פָנִים

“does not lift up a face”

Moses is using **lift up a face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “be partial to someone.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does not show favoritism] or [judges everyone fairly]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 10:18 (#1)

עֹשֶׂה מִשְׁפַּט יָתוֹם וְאַלְמָנָה וְאֹהֵב גֵּר

“He makes a judgment {for} the fatherless and widow, and he loves a foreigner”

This means that Yahweh makes sure that everyone is treated fairly. The **fatherless** (orphans) and **widow** and **foreigner** are more likely to be treated unfairly by people, especially if they do not have someone advocating for their rights. You could include in your translation what the phrase **make a judgment** means if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [He makes a fair judgment for the fatherless and widow, and he cares for a foreigner]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:18 (#2)

יָתוֹם וְאַלְמָנָה וְאֹהֵב גֵּר לָתֶת לוֹ

“the fatherless and widow, and he loves a foreigner, giving to him”

The words **fatherless, widow**, and **foreigner** represent everyone in those groups in general, not one particular fatherless person, widow, or foreigner. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [for anyone who is fatherless or a widow, and he loves all foreigners, giving to them]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 10:18 (#3)

לֶחֶם

“bread”

Here, **bread** represents all food. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [food]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 10:19 (#1)

אֶת־הַגֵּר

“the foreigner”

The word **foreigner** represents all foreigners in general, not one particular foreigner. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any foreigner]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 10:19 (#2)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 10:20 (#1)

אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ תִּירָא אֹתוֹ תַעֲבֹד וּבוֹ תִדְבָּק וּבִשְׁמֹו תִּשָּׁבֵעַ

“Yahweh your God you shall fear, him you shall serve, and to him you shall cling, and by his name you shall swear”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the phrasing to emphasize that the Israelites should worship only Yahweh. See how you translated a similar verse in 6:13. Alternate translation: [It is Yahweh your God and no one else whom you shall fear; it is he alone whom you shall worship, and it is to him whom you shall cling, and it is by his name only that you shall swear]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 10:20 (#2)

אֱלֹהֶיךָ תִּירָא & תַּעֲבֹד & תִּדְבָּק & תִּשָּׁבַע

“your God you shall fear & you shall serve & you shall cling & you shall swear”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular from this verse to verse 22. Moses is speaking to the Israelites as if they were all one person. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 10:20 (#3)

וּבוֹ תִדְבָּק

“and to him you shall cling”

Here Moses is speaking of having a good relationship with Yahweh as if that meant physically clinging **to him**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and with him you shall maintain a good relationship]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:20 (#4)

וּבִשְׁמֹו תִּשָּׁבַע

“and by his name you shall swear”

See how you translated the phrase “by his name you shall swear” in 6:13. Alternate translation: [and you shall make strong promises using his name]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:21 (#1)

הוּא תְהִלָּתְךָ

“He {is} your praise”

The phrase **He is your praise** could mean: (1) that Yahweh is the one whom the Israelites should praise or do praise. Alternate translation: [He is the one you must praise] or (2) that the great things that Yahweh had done for the Israelites are the reason that people from other nations praise the Israelites. Alternate translation: [He is the reason that people from other nations praise you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:21 (#2)

עֵינֶיךָ

“your eyes”

Moses is using **eyes** to represent the whole person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you yourself]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 10:22 (#1)

בְּשִׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ יָרְדוּ אֲבֹתֶיךָ מִצְרַיְמָה

“Your fathers went down into Egypt as 70 souls”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Genesis 46.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 10:22 (#2)

אֲבֹתֶיךָ

“Your fathers”

See how you translated the word “fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 10:22 (#3)

יָרְדוּ

“went down”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase **went down**. Alternate translation: [went] or [entered]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 10:22 (#4)

נֶפֶשׁ

“souls”

Here, **souls** represents human lives. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 10:22 (#5)

וְעַתָּה

“And now”

Moses uses the word **now** here to indicate a strong contrast between how many Israelites there were when the Israelites first went to Egypt and how many Israelites there are at the time of this speech. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language.

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 10:22 (#6)

כְּכוֹכְבֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם לָרֹב

“like the stars of the heavens in number”

Here Moses compares the number of Israelites to the **number** of **the stars of the heavens**. He uses this to emphasize that Yahweh had blessed the Israelites so that they had many children and increased in population. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make it clear that Moses is referring to many people and many stars. Alternate translation: [as many as the many stars of heaven]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy - Chapter 11 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Moses wants the Israelites to obey Yahweh because of his miracles (1–7)
2. Blessings for obedience (8–15)
3. Warnings for disobedience (16–17)
4. The importance of Yahweh’s words (18–25)
5. Instructions on the blessings and curses (26–32)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Placing Yahweh’s words on one’s arms, forehead, and doorposts

Verses 18–20 command the Israelites to always remember Yahweh’s words. There are different understandings of these commands. Some Jewish traditions interpret these verses as meaning that the Israelites should physically write copies of the law. Others believe that the command is to memorize and cherish the law. Translators should be careful to translate the passage as it is, without implying one interpretation or the other in their translation.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“you” and “your” singular and plural

When Moses is addressing the Israelites, he uses both the singular and plural forms of “you.”

- In verse 1 “you” and “your” are singular.
- In verses 2–9 “you” and “your” are plural.
- In verse 10 see the note.
- In verses 11–13 “you” and “your” are plural.
- In verses 14–15 “you” and “your” are singular.
- In verses 16–18 “you” and “your” are plural.
- In verses 19–20 see the notes.
- In verses 21–28 “you” and “your” are plural.
- In verse 29 “you” and “your” are singular.
- In verses 31–32 “you” and “your” are plural.

Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, he sometimes addresses them as “you” singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Pronouns — When to Use Them; and Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 11:1 (#1)

וְאָהַבְתָּ֖ & אֶת־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ וְשָׁמַרְתָּ֞

“And you shall love & your God and keep”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 11:1 (#2)

אֵ֚ת יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 11:1 (#3)

מִשְׁמַרְתּ֔וֹ וְחֻקֹּתָ֥יו וּמִשְׁפָּטָ֖יו וּמִצְוֹתָֽיו

“his charge and his statutes and his ordinances and his commandments”

If your language does not have four terms for these things you could use one or two terms. See how you translated the similar phrase, “the commandment and the statutes and the ordinances” in 5:31. Alternate translation: [his charge and his commandments] or [everything he has commanded you]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 11:1 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

See how you translated the same expression in 4:40. Alternate translation: [always] or [forever]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 11:2 (#1)

אֶת־בְּנֵיכֶם

“it was & your sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with your descendants]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:2 (#2)

אֶת־יָדוֹ֙ הַחֲזָקָ֔ה וּזְרֹעֲוֹ֖ הַנְּטוּיָֽה

“his mighty hand, and his outstretched arm”

See how you translated the phrase “by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [and his very great power]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 11:3 (#1)

וְאֶת־אֹתֹתָיו֙ וְאֶת־מַעֲשָׂ֣יו

“and his signs and his deeds”

The terms **signs** and **deeds** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and his great deeds]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 11:3 (#2)

וְאֶת־אֹתֹתָיו֙ וְאֶת־מַעֲשָׂ֣יו אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֔ה בְּתֹ֖וךְ מִצְרַ֑יִם לְפַרְעֹ֥ה
מֶֽלֶךְ־מִצְרַ֖יִם וּלְכָל־אַרְצֽוֹ

“and his signs and his deeds that he did in the midst of Egypt to Pharaoh, king of Egypt, and to all his land”

This refers to the miracles and plagues that Yahweh did in Egypt while the Israelites were slaves there. Yahweh used these deeds to show his power over Pharaoh so that he would let the Israelites leave Egypt. See Exodus 6–14. Alternate translation: [and the plagues he put on Pharaoh, king of Egypt, and on all of Egypt] or [and the plagues he sent on Pharaoh, king of Egypt, and on all of Egypt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:4 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֗ה לְחֵ֙יל֙ מִצְרַ֔יִם לְסוּסָ֖יו וּלְרִכְבּ֑וֹ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֵצִ֗יף
אֶת־מֵ֤י יַם־סוּף֙ עַל־פְּנֵיהֶ֔ם בְּרָדְפָ֖ם אַחֲרֵיכֶ֑ם

“and what he did to the army of Egypt, to its horses and to its chariots, how he caused the water of the Sea of Reeds to flow over their faces in their pursuit after you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of the phrases in this verse. Alternate translation: [and how he caused the water of the Sea of Reeds to flow over the faces of the army of Egypt, to its horses and to its chariots in their pursuit after you] or [and how he caused the water of the Sea of Reeds to flow over the Egyptian soldiers, and their horses and chariots when they pursued after you]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 11:4 (#2)

פְּנֵיהֶ֔ם

“their faces”

Moses is using one part of the men in the Egyptian army, their **faces**, to mean their entire bodies in the act of drowning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [them]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 11:4 (#3)

וַיְאַבְּדֵ֖ם יְהוָ֑ה עַ֖ד הַיּ֥וֹם הַזֶּֽה

“and Yahweh has destroyed them to this day”

The implication is that after Yahweh destroyed the Egyptians, the Egyptians and their army remained weak until the time of this speech. See how you translated the similar phrase, “until this day,” in 2:22.

Alternate translation: [and Yahweh has caused their destruction to remain until this time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:5 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לָכֶם בַּמִּדְבָּר

“and what he did for you in the wilderness”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 13–25.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:5 (#2)

עַד־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה

“to this place”

The term **this place** refers to the plain of the Jordan River Valley where Moses is speaking to them before they cross over into Canaan. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [to this valley]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְדָתָן וְלַאֲבִירָם בְּנֵי אֱלִיאָבׇ בֶּן־רְאוּבֵן אֲשֶׁר פָּצְתָה הָאֲדָמָה אֶת־פִּיהָ וַתִּבְלַע אֹתָם וְאֶת־בָּתֵּיהֶם וְאֶת־אָהֳלֵיהֶם וְאֵת כָּל־הַיְקוּם אֲשֶׁר בְּרַגְלֵיהֶם בְּקֶרֶב כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and what he had done to Dathan and to Abiram, the sons of Eliab, son of Reuben, how the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up and their houses and their tents and every living thing that {was} in their steps, in the midst of all Israel”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#2)

וַאֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְדָתָן וְלַאֲבִירָם בְּנֵי אֱלִיאָבׇ בֶּן־רְאוּבֵן אֲשֶׁר פָּצְתָה הָאֲדָמָה אֶת־פִּיהָ וַתִּבְלַע אֹתָם וְאֶת־בָּתֵּיהֶם וְאֶת־אָהֳלֵיהֶם וְאֵת כָּל־הַיְקוּם אֲשֶׁר בְּרַגְלֵיהֶם בְּקֶרֶב כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and what he had done to Dathan and to Abiram, the sons of Eliab, son of Reuben, how the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up and their houses and their tents and every living thing that {was} in their steps, in the midst of all Israel”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses. You could also start a new sentence here, as modeled by the UST.

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#3)

בֶּן

“son of”

Here, **son** means “descendant.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [descendant of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#4)

פָּצְתָה הָאֲדָמָה אֶת־פִּיהָ וַתִּבְלַע אֹתָם

“the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up”

Here Moses is speaking of **the earth** as if it were a person who had a mouth that can open and swallow. Yahweh caused the earth to open and close. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh made a crack in the earth underneath them and caused the earth to cover them]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#5)

בָּתֵּיהֶם

“their houses”

Here, **houses** represents the families of Dathan and Abiram. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their households]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#6)

כָּל־הַיְקוּם

“every living thing”

The term **living thing** includes people and animals. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [every person and animal]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#7)

בְּרַגְלֵיהֶם

“was} in their steps”

Moses is using **in their steps** as a common expression of his culture to mean "belongs to them." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [belonged to them]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#8)

בְּקֶרֶב כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"in the midst of all Israel"

Here, **midst** represents a person's presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and all Israel witnessed it]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:6 (#9)

יִשְׂרָאֵל

"Israel"

Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:7 (#1)

כִּֽי

"but"

Moses uses the word **but** here to indicate a strong contrast between what the Israelites have experienced and what their descendants have experienced. Moses means that the Israelites, and not their descendants, have personally experienced Yahweh's **great work**. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whereas]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 11:7 (#2)

עֵינֵיכֶם

"your eyes"

Here, **eyes** represents the whole person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you yourselves]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 11:7 (#3)

אֶת־כָּל־מַעֲשֵׂה יְהוָה הַגָּדֹל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה

"all the great work of Yahweh that he did"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the phrasing so that the subject and verb are more clear. Alternate translation: [all the great work that Yahweh did]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 11:7 (#4)

מַעֲשֵׂה יְהוָה הַגָּדֹל

"the great work of Yahweh"

The term **great work** refers to all the miracles and other deeds that Yahweh did using his great power. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the wonders of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:8 (#1)

לְמַעַן

"so that"

Here, **so that** marks what comes after it as the goal or purpose of what comes before it. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 11:8 (#2)

תֶּחֶזְקוּ וּבָאתֶם

"you may be strong and go in"

The two words **be strong** and **go in** express a single idea. The word **be strong** tells how they will be able to go in and conquer the land. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [you may be prepared to go in]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 11:8 (#3)

וּבָאתֶם

"and go in"

In a context such as this, your language might say "come" instead of **go**. Alternate translation: [and come in]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 11:8 (#4)

עֹבְרִים

"are going over"

Moses is using the term **going over** because the Israelites must cross the Jordan River to enter into Canaan. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [are crossing the Jordan]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:9 (#1)

וּלְמַעַן

"and so that"

Here, **so that** marks what comes after it as the goal or purpose of obeying Yahweh. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 11:9 (#2)

תַּאֲרִיכוּ יָמִים

"you may prolong days"

See how you translated the similar phrase "so that you may prolong your days" in 4:40. Alternate translation: [you will be able to live a long time] or [you may dwell continuously]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:9 (#3)

לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם

"to your fathers"

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase "to your fathers" in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:9 (#4)

וּלְזַרְעָם

"and to their seed"

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites' offspring were **seed**. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this use of the term "seed." Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to their offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:9 (#5)

אֶרֶץ זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבָשׁ

"a land flowing with milk and honey"

See how you translated the phrase "a land flowing with milk and honey" in 6:3.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:10 (#1)

אַתָּה & תִּזְרַע אֶת־זַרְעֲךָ וְהִשְׁקִיתָ בְרַגְלְךָ

"you & you sowed your seed and watered with your foot"

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 11:10 (#2)

וְהִשְׁקִיתָ בְרַגְלְךָ

"and watered with your foot"

The word **foot** refers to hard work. In Egypt, workers would use their feet to turn a water wheel that would water the fields. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and labored just to water the fields]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:10 (#3)

כְּגַן הַיָּרָק

"as {for} a garden of herbs"

Here, **garden of herbs** refers to a vegetable garden. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as for a vegetable garden]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:11 (#1)

לִמְטַעַר הַשָּׁמַיִם תִּשְׁתֶּה־מָּיִם

“drinks water of the rain of the heavens”

Here Moses speaks of the land as if it were a person who could **drink water**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [watered by rainfall]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 11:12 (#1)

תָּמִ֣יד עֵינֵ֔י יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ בָּ֔הּ

“The eyes of Yahweh your God {are} always upon it”

Here, **eyes** represents attention and care. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God always cares for it]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:13 (#1)

וְהָיָ֗ה אִם

“And it will happen, if”

Moses is describing a possible condition in which the blessings of verses 14–15 will take place only if they do what this verse describes. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The following things will happen if]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 11:13 (#2)

שָׁמֹ֣עַ תִּשְׁמְעוּ֮

“listening, you will listen”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **listen** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you carefully listen] or [you make sure to listen]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 11:13 (#3)

תִּשְׁמְעוּ֮ אֶל־מִצְוֹתַ֣י

“you will listen to my commandments”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [you will obey all that Yahweh has said]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:13 (#4)

מִצְוֹתַ֣י

“my commandments”

Moses is relaying Yahweh’s commandments to the Israelites. He does not mean that the commandments originate from him. You could include this information if that would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh’s commandments]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:13 (#5)

בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶ֖ם וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁכֶֽם

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

See how you translated the phrase “with all your heart and with all your soul” in 4:29.

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 11:14 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּ֤י מְטַר־אַרְצְכֶם֙

“then, ‘I will give the rain of your land”

Yahweh is speaking the words in this verse and the next. Use a convention that would be natural in your language to indicate that Yahweh is speaking these verses and not Moses. The ULT indicates this by using single quotation marks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state clearly who is speaking. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh promises you, ‘I will give the rain of your land]

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 11:14 (#2)

וְנָתַתִּ֤י

“then, ‘I will give”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh will give]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 11:14 (#3)

מְטַר־אַרְצְכֶם בְּעִתּוֹ יוֹרֶה וּמַלְקוֹשׁ

“the rain of your land in its season, the former rain and the latter rain”

The implication is that if the people obey his commands, Yahweh will cause **the rain** to fall on the **land** at the proper times for growing crops. The **former rain** is the spring rains and the **latter rain** is the autumn rains. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the rain on your land in the proper seasons, spring and fall]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:14 (#4)

מְטַר & דְּגָנְךָ֖ וְתִֽירֹשְׁךָ֥ וְיִצְהָרֶֽךָ

“the rain of & your grain and your new wine and your oil”

In this verse, the words **rain**, **grain**, **wine**, and **oil** are singular in form, but they refer to all rainfall, crops, and produce as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly, as modeled by the UST.

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 11:14 (#5)

וְתִֽירֹשְׁךָ֥ וְיִצְהָרֶֽךָ

“and your new wine and your oil”

The implication is that Yahweh will bless the crops of grapes and olives. Wine is made from grapes and oil is made from olives. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [grapes for your new wine and olive trees for your oil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:15 (#1)

וְנָתַתִּ֥י

“And I will give”

This verse continues the consequence of the possible condition proposed in verse 13. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the consequence of this possible condition. Alternate translation: [And then I will give]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 11:15 (#2)

בְּשָׂדְךָ֖ לִבְהֶמְתֶּ֑ךָ וְאָכַלְתָּ֖ וְשָׂבָֽעְתָּ

“in your fields for your cattle, and you will eat and be satisfied”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 11:15 (#3)

וְאָכַלְתָּ֖ וְשָׂבָֽעְתָּ

“and you will eat and be satisfied”

Moses means that the Israelites will always have enough food to eat. This does not mean that, after eating, the Israelites will be satisfied and never have to eat again. You could include this information if that would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [and you will always have enough food to eat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:16 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 11:16 (#2)

יִפְתֶּ֥ה לְבַבְכֶ֖ם

“your heart be deceived”

Here, **heart** represents a person’s desire and will. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are deceived by your desires]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:16 (#3)

יִפְתֶּ֥ה לְבַבְכֶ֖ם

“your heart be deceived”

In this verse, the word **heart** is singular in form, but it refers to all the hearts of the Israelites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [your hearts are deceived]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 11:16 (#4)

יִפְתֶּתָה לְבַבְכֶם

“your heart be deceived”

The expression **be deceived** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [your heart causes you to disobey]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 11:16 (#5)

וְסַרְתֶּם

“and you turn aside”

Moses is speaking as if the Israelites were literally walking behind God but then could **turn aside** to walk in a different direction from him. He means that they should not stop living in the manner in which God wants people to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you disobey]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:17 (#1)

וְחָרָה אַף־יְהוָה בָּכֶם

“And the nose of Yahweh will burn against you”

See how you translated the sentence “And the nose of Yahweh will burn against you” in 7:4. Alternate translation: [And the anger of Yahweh your God will burn against you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 11:17 (#2)

וְעָצַר אֶת־הַשָּׁמַיִם וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה מָטָר וְהָאֲדָמָה לֹא תִתֵּן אֶת־יְבוּלָהּ וַאֲבַדְתֶּם מְהֵרָה מֵעַל הָאָרֶץ הַטֹּבָה

“And he will restrain the heavens and there will be no rain, and the land will not give its fruit, and you will perish quickly from off the good land”

Moses is describing a chain of events that will happen as the result of disobedience. If there is no rain, then the crops will not grow. If the crops do not grow, then the people will die from starvation. If the connection between these statements is unclear, you may want to use connecting words to show the cause-and-effect relationships. Alternate translation: [And he will restrain the heavens so there will be no rain, and then the land will not give its fruit, and then you will perish quickly from off the good land]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 11:18 (#1)

וְשַׂמְתֶּם אֶת־דְּבָרַי אֵלֶּה עַל־לְבַבְכֶם וְעַל־נַפְשְׁכֶם

“And you shall place these words of mine on your heart and on your soul”

Moses is speaking as if **words** were objects and a person’s **heart** and **soul** were a container into which one could place words. Moses means that he wants the Israelites to remember and cherish Yahweh’s commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you shall cherish my words]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:18 (#2)

אֶת־דְּבָרַי אֵלֶּה

“these words of mine”

Here, **words** represents Yahweh’s commands, which Moses is repeating to the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [these laws from Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:18 (#3)

עַל־לְבַבְכֶם וְעַל־נַפְשְׁכֶם

“on your heart and on your soul”

See how you translated the similar expression “with all your heart and with all your soul” in 4:29.

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 11:18 (#4)

לְטוֹטָפֹת

“as frontlets”

A **frontlet** is a type of decorative accessory, often used as a symbol of commitment, worn around the head. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of headwear, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [as a symbolic headband]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 11:18 (#5)

בֵּ֣ין עֵינֵיכֶֽם

“between your eyes”

Moses is using **between your eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “forehead.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [above your brow]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 11:18 (#6)

וּקְשַׁרְתֶּ֣ם אֹתָ֗ם לְאוֹת֙ עַל־יֶדְכֶ֔ם וְהָי֥וּ לְטוֹטָפֹ֖ת בֵּ֣ין עֵינֵיכֶֽם

“and you shall bind them as a sign on your hand, and they will be as frontlets between your eyes”

Moses is saying that the Israelites should remember the law so well that it would be as if the law were written on their **hand** and between their **eyes**. See how you translated this image in 6:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:19 (#1)

אֶת־בְּנֵיכֶ֑ם

“to your sons”

Although the term **sons** is masculine, Moses is using the word in a generic sense that includes both sons and daughters. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to your offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:19 (#2)

בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ֣ בְּבֵיתֶ֔ךָ וּבְלֶכְתְּךָ֖ & וּבְשָׁכְבְּךָ֑ וּבְקוּמֶֽךָ

“when you sit in your house and when you walk & and when you lie down and when you get up”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 11:19 (#3)

בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ֣ בְּבֵיתֶ֔ךָ וּבְלֶכְתְּךָ֖ בַּדָּ֑רֶךְ

“when you sit in your house and when you walk on the road”

Here Moses is referring to every place an Israelite would go in daily life by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wherever you are]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 11:19 (#4)

וּבְשָׁכְבְּךָ֖ וּבְקוּמֶֽךָ

“and when you lie down and when you get up”

Here Moses is referring to all activities of daily life by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and whatever you are doing]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 11:20 (#1)

וּכְתַבְתָּ֖ם עַל־מְזוּזֹ֣ות בֵּיתֶ֑ךָ וּבִשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ

“And you shall write them on the doorposts of your house and on your gates”

Moses continues the image from verse 18 by saying that they should remember the law so well that it would be as if the law were written on their **doorposts** and on their **gates**. See how you translated this in 6:9.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:20 (#2)

וּבִשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ

“and on your gates”

Here the word **gates** refers to city gates. In those days, homes did not have gates, so we know that Moses is referring to city gates. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and on the entrance to your city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:20 (#3)

בֵּיתֶךָ וּבִשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“your house and on your gates”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 11:21 (#1)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of verses 18–20. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. [in order that]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 11:21 (#2)

יִרְבּוּ יְמֵיכֶם וִימֵי בְנֵיכֶם

“your days and the days of your sons will be multiplied”

The expression **be multiplied** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [you and your children may have longevity]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 11:21 (#3)

בְנֵיכֶם

“your sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:21 (#4)

כִּימֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ

“as the days of the heavens over the earth”

Moses is saying that the Israelites and their descendants would live on the land for so long that that time would be equal to the length of time that the **heavens** exist **over the earth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [forever]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 11:22 (#1)

שָׁמֹר תִּשְׁמְרוּן

“keeping, you will keep”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **keep** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you are careful to keep]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 11:22 (#2)

אָנֹכִי מְצַוֶּה אֶתְכֶם לַעֲשֹׂתָהּ

“I am commanding you to do them”

The expression **I am commanding you to do them** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression, as modeled by the UST.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 11:22 (#3)

לָלֶכֶת בְּכָל־דְּרָכָיו

“to walk in all his ways”

Here Moses is speaking of the **commandments** of Yahweh as if they were **ways** or a path that the people should **walk** on. He means that obeying those commandments is like walking on that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to obey him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:22 (#4)

וּלְדָבְקָה־בּוֹ

“and to cling to him”

See how you translated the similar expression, “to him you shall cling,” in 10:20. Alternate translation: [and with him to maintain a good relationship]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:23 (#1)

אֶת־כָּל־הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵאֶלֶּה & גּוֹיִם

“all these nations & nations”

Here, **nations** represents the people living in those nations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of the people of these nations ... people from nations]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:23 (#2)

מִלְּפְנֵיכֶם

“from to your faces”

Here, **faces** represents the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from your presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:24 (#1)

כָּל־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר תִּדְרֹךְ כַּף־רַגְלְכֶם בּוֹ

“Every place where the sole of your foot will tread upon”

This is an emphatic way of saying “everywhere.” Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [Every single place you go]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:24 (#2)

הַנָּהָר נְהַר־פְּרָת

“the river, the Euphrates River”

The expression **the river, the Euphrates River** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression, as modeled by the UST.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#1)

לֹא־יִתְיַצַּב אִישׁ

“No man will be able to stand”

Here, **stand** means “resist” or “stop.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning explicitly as in the UST. Alternate translation: [No man will be able to resist]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#2)

אִישׁ

“man”

By **man**, Moses means anyone from the enemy people groups. If it would be helpful for your readers, you could include this information in your translation. Alternate translation: [army of these peoples]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#3)

בִּפְנֵיכֶם

“from your faces”

Here, **faces** represents the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before you] or [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#4)

פַּחְדְּכֶם וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם יִתֵּתֵּן ׀ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“Yahweh your God will give the fear of you and the terror of you”

Here Moses speaks of emotions as if they were objects one could physically put on the land. He means that God will cause their enemies to feel **fear** and **terror**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God will cause your enemies to feel the fear of you and the terror of you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#5)

פַּחְדְּכֶם וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם יִתֵּתֵּן ׀ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ

“Yahweh your God will give the fear of you and the terror of you upon the face of all the land”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **fear** and **terror**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God will cause you to frighten and terrify all the land]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#6)

פַּחְדְּכֶם וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם

“the fear of you and the terror of you”

The terms **fear** and **terror** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the extremely great fear of you]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#7)

פַּחְדְּכֶם וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם

“the fear of you and the terror of you”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe how the Israelites will cause **fear** and **terror**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression that describes cause and effect. Alternate translation: [the fear caused by you and the terror caused by you]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 11:25 (#8)

פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ

“the face of all the land”

Here, **the face of all the land** represents all the people who live on the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the people living in the place]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:26 (#1)

רְאֵה

“Look”

Moses is using the term **Look** to focus the Israelites’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:26 (#2)

לִפְנֵיכֶם

“to your faces”

Here, **faces** represents the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in your presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:26 (#3)

בְּרָכָה וּקְלָלָה

“a blessing and a curse”

The implication is that the Israelites have a choice between obedience and disobedience. If the Israelites obey Yahweh, then they will receive a **blessing**, and if they disobey, they will receive the **curse** of Yahweh’s punishment. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the choice to receive a blessing or a curse from Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:27 (#1)

תִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶל־מִצְוֹת

“you listen to the commandments of”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “you will listen to my commandments,” in 11:13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:28 (#1)

וְסַרְתֶּם מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ

“and turn aside from the way”

See how you translated the phrase “turn aside” in 5:32 where it is used with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [and disobey the commands]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:28 (#2)

לִלְכָּא תִּשְׁמְעוּ אֶל־מִצְוֹת

“you do not listen to the commandments of”

See how you translated the similar phrase “you will listen to my commandments,” in the previous verse 11:27.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:29 (#1)

יְבִיאֲךָ & אֱלֹהֶיךָ & אַתָּה & וְנָתַתָּה

“your God brings you & you & that you will set”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** are singular in this verse. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 11:29 (#2)

וְנָתַתָּ֞ה אֶת־הַבְּרָכָה֙ עַל־הַ֣ר גְּרִזִ֔ים וְאֶת־הַקְּלָלָ֖ה עַל־הַ֥ר עֵיבָֽל

“that you will set the blessing on Mount Gerizim and the curse on Mount Ebal”

The **blessing** and the **curse** are spoken of as if they were objects that one could **set** on a mountain. Moses means that the Israelites will remind themselves of the consequences of obedience or disobedience while some of them are on each mountain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly, as modeled by the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 11:30 (#1)

הֲלֹא־הֵ֜מָּה בְּעֵ֣בֶר הַיַּרְדֵּ֗ן אַחֲרֵי֙ דֶּ֣רֶךְ מְבֹ֣א הַשֶּׁ֔מֶשׁ בְּאֶ֖רֶץ
הַֽכְּנַעֲנִ֑י הַיֹּשֵׁ֣ב בָּֽעֲרָבָ֗ה מ֚וּל הַגִּלְגָּ֔ל אֵצֶ֖ל אֵל֣וֹנֵי מֹרֶֽה

“Are} they not across the Jordan, following the road of the sun setting, in the land of the Canaanites who live in the Arabah, opposite Gilgal, beside the oaks of Moreh”

The Israelites are on the eastern side of the Jordan River. Moses uses a question to remind the people where these mountains are located. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement, as modeled by the UST.

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 11:30 (#2)

דֶּ֣רֶךְ מְבֹ֣א הַשֶּׁ֔מֶשׁ

“the road of the sun setting”

Moses is using **the sun setting** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the west.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the road along the west side of the river]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 11:30 (#3)

מ֚וּל

“opposite”

Here, **opposite** means “near.” You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [close to]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 11:30 (#4)

אֵל֣וֹנֵי מֹרֶֽה

“the oaks of Moreh”

The term **the oaks of Moreh** probably refers to a place near Gilgal where there were sacred trees.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 11:31 (#1)

כִּֽי־אַתֶּ֞ם עֹבְרִ֣ים אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּ֗ן לָבֹא֙ לָרֶ֣שֶׁת אֶת־הָאָ֔רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־יְהוָ֥ה
אֱלֹהֵיכֶ֖ם נֹתֵ֣ן לָכֶ֑ם וִֽירִשְׁתֶּ֣ם אֹתָ֔הּ וִֽישַׁבְתֶּ֖ם בָּֽהּ

“For you are crossing over the Jordan to go in to possess the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you, and you will possess it and live in it”

If less repetition of phrases would be more natural in your language, you could simplify these phrases. Alternate translation: [For you are crossing over the Jordan to posses the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you, and you will live in it]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 11:32 (#1)

לִפְנֵיכֶֽם

“to your faces”

Here, **faces** represents being in front of or in the presence of people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 11:32 (#2)

הַחֻקִּ֖ים וְאֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִֽים

“the statutes and the ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes” and “ordinances” in 4:1. Alternate translation: [the important statutes]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 11:32 (#3)

אָנֹכִי נֹתֵתֵן לִפְנֵיכֶם

“I set to your faces”

Moses is speaking of Yahweh’s **statutes** and **ordinances** as if they were objects that could be **set** on the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am telling you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 12 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. The statutes and the ordinances that Yahweh commands the Israelites to keep in the land that Yahweh had promised them (1–31)
2. Yahweh commands the Israelites not to add or take away from the commands he has given them (32)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Covenant with Moses

This chapter is a continuation of the covenant Yahweh made with Moses. The reasons for these food restrictions are not always known. (See: covenant; and Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information)

Israel and Yahweh

In the ancient Near East, when nations conquered other nations, they often added the gods of the conquered nation into the collection of gods they worshiped. It was rare to worship only one God. Israel was to be known for worshiping Yahweh and Yahweh alone. (See: god, false god, goddess, idol, idolater, idolatrous, idolatry)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Words for the law

- statutes
- ordinances
- judgments

Moses uses several words to refer to the law that Yahweh commanded the Israelites to obey. It is unclear what the differences are between these terms. If your language has different terms for the law, you could use them here to differentiate between the different Hebrew words. (See: Translate Unknowns)

“you” and “your” singular and plural

The pronouns “you” and “your” are plural in this chapter unless otherwise noted. Although Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, from verses 13–32 he addresses them as “you” singular. Moses wants each individual to obey the law for themselves. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

“the place that Yahweh your God will choose”

Moses uses phrases such as this to refer to the future place where the temple will be built. These phrases emphasize that Yahweh will be the one who decides where the Israelites will build his temple as well as how they will worship him. (See: temple, house, house of God)

“the place Yahweh your God will choose ... to put his name,” “the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay,” “the place that Yahweh your God chooses to put his name”

In 12:5, 12:11 and 12:21 the author uses God’s name to represent his reputation and presence. These phrases indicate that God would choose a place and make his presence and reputation stay there. That place would be the future temple. (See: Metonymy)

Deuteronomy 12:1 (#1)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר־אַתֶּם חַיִּים עַל־הָאֲדָמָה

“all the days that you live on the earth”

Moses is using **all the days that you live on the earth** as a common expression of his culture to mean “for as long as you live.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as long as you live]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:1 (#2)

הַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים׃

“are} the statutes and the ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes” and “ordinances” in 4:1.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 12:2 (#1)

אַבֵּד תְּאַבְּדוּן

“Destroying, you shall destroy”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **destroy** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You shall surely destroy]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 12:2 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר עָבְדוּ־שָׁם הַגּוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם יֹרְשִׁים אֹתָם אֶת־אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

“that the nations that you shall dispossess them served their gods there”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the phrasing so that it is clear what the **places** were used for. Alternate translation: [where the enemies who you will dispossess served their gods]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 12:2 (#3)

הַגּוֹיִם

“the nations”

Here, **nations** represents the people groups that live in the land that the Israelites will conquer. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your enemies]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:3 (#1)

אֶת־מַצֵּבֹתָם

“their stone pillars”

The people groups in the land built **stone pillars** as symbols of their god Baal. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [their sacred stone pillars]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:3 (#2)

אֶת־שְׁמָם

“their name”

Here, **name** represents the idols and knowledge about them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [any trace of those idols]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:3 (#3)

הַמָּקֹם הַהוּא

“that place”

Here, **that place** refers to all the places where the people living in the land worshiped idols, as described in the previous verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [those places of idol worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:4 (#1)

לֹא־תַעֲשׂוּן כֵּן לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“You shall not do thus to Yahweh your God”

The implication is that the Israelites should not worship Yahweh the way the other nations worship their idols. The other nations worship their gods wherever they want, but the Israelites must only worship Yahweh in the place that Yahweh decides. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [You shall not worship Yahweh your God as those nations worship their idols]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:4 (#2)

לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“to Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the similar phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10. Alternate translation: [to Yahweh, the God we worship]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 12:5 (#1)

כִּי אִם

“But”

Moses uses the word **But** here to indicate a strong contrast between how the Israelites will worship and how the other people groups worship. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Rather,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:5 (#2)

מִכֹּל־שִׁבְטֵיכֶם לָשׂוּם אֶת־שְׁמוֹ

“out of all your tribes to put his name”

The implication is that Yahweh will choose a place for the Israelites to worship him from the land belonging to one of the Israelite tribes. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from the land of one of the tribes to put his name]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:5 (#3)

לָשׂוּם אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to put his name there”

Here Yahweh’s **name** represents his presence and his reputation which would be proclaimed by the future temple of Yahweh. See the discussion of this entire phrase in the introduction to this chapter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. See the discussion of this phrase in the Introduction to Deuteronomy. Alternate translation: [for you to worship him] or [for you to come into his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:5 (#4)

לָשׂוּם אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to put his name there”

This phrase contains extra information that may be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [to put his name]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 12:5 (#5)

וּבָאתָ שָּׁמָּה

“and there you shall go”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, the pronoun **you** is singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 12:6 (#1)

תְּרוּמַת יֶדְכֶם

“the contribution of your hand”

Here, **hand** represents the whole person in the act of giving an offering. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the contribution that you personally give]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 12:6 (#2)

וְנִדְרֵיכֶם

“and your offerings for vows”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **offerings** that were given to fulfill **vows** one made. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [and offerings to fulfill your vows]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 12:7 (#1)

וַאֲכַלְתֶּם־שָׁם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“And there you shall eat to the face of Yahweh your God”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Leviticus 1–16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:7 (#2)

שָׁם

“there”

Here the word **there** refers to the place that Yahweh will choose for the Israelites to worship him that is mentioned in 12:5. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the chosen place of worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:7 (#3)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how

you translated “to the face of” in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:7 (#4)

מִשְׁלַח יֶדְכֶם

“the sending out of your hand”

Moses is using **the sending out of your hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the results of your hard work.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the fruit of your labor] or [the results of your hard work]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:7 (#5)

אֲשֶׁר בֵּרַכְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“where Yahweh your God has blessed you”

The implication is that Yahweh is the one who enables the Israelites to be successful in all their work. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which you have because of the favor of Yahweh your God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:8 (#1)

לֹא תַעֲשׂוּן כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר אֲנַחְנוּ עֹשִׂים פֹּה הַיּוֹם אִישׁ כָּל־הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינָיו

“You shall not do as everything that we are doing here today, {every} man {doing} whatever {is} right in his eyes”

The implication is that at the time of this speech, the Israelites are worshiping Yahweh in whichever manner they want to. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Right now, every man does whatever worship is right in his eyes, but you shall not do any of that in the future]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:8 (#2)

אֲנַחְנוּ

“we”

Moses is using the pronoun **we** to refer to himself and all the Israelites, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction. If the change in pronoun from “you” to **we** would be confusing for your readers, you could use the second-person pronoun here. Alternate translation: [you]

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Deuteronomy 12:8 (#3)

אִישׁ

“every} man {doing”

The word **man** represents all people in general, not one particular man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression and change the following pronouns to fit. Alternate translation: [each person doing]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 12:8 (#4)

בְּעֵינָיו

“in his eyes”

Moses is using **in his eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in his own judgment” or “in his own evaluation.” See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “in the eyes of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to his own evaluation]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:9 (#1)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:9 (#2)

אֶל־הַמְּנוּחָה וְאֶל־הַנַּחֲלָה

“to the rest and to the inheritance”

The two words **rest** and **inheritance** express a single idea. The word **rest** tells what their lives will be like when the Israelites live in the land that is their **inheritance**. If it would be more natural in your language,

you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [to the land of your inheritance where you will rest]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 12:9 (#3)

הַמְּנוּחָהוְ

“the rest”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rest**, you can express the same idea with a comparable phrase. Alternate translation: [the land where you will live without having to fight]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 12:9 (#4)

אֱלֹהֶיךָ & לָךְ

“your God & to you”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, **your** and **you** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 12:10 (#1)

וְהֵנִיחַ לָכֶם מִכָּל־אֹיְבֵיכֶם מִסָּבִיב

“and he will cause you to rest from all your surrounding enemies”

The implication is that the Israelites will not have to defend their land from the attacks of nearby people groups. Yahweh will protect them and cause the other nations to fear the Israelites. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he will prevent nearby foes from attacking you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:11 (#1)

וְהָיָה

“And it will be that”

Moses is using **And it will be** to introduce commands for the future. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [Then, it will be]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 12:11 (#2)

וְהָיָה הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם & לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם שָׁמָּה תָּבִיאוּ אֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוֶּה אֶתְכֶם

“And it will be that the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay there, there you will bring all that I command you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could rearrange these phrases so that the subject and verb are clear. Alternate translation: [You will bring all that I command you to the place which Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay there]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 12:11 (#3)

לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to make his name stay there”

See the discussion of the phrase “the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated the expression “to make his name stay there” in 12:11. Alternate translation: [to have his temple]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:11 (#4)

לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to make his name stay there”

This phrase contains extra information that may be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [to put his name]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 12:11 (#5)

וּתְרֻמַת יֶדְכֶם

“and the contribution of your hand”

Here, **hand** represents the whole person in the act of giving an offering. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the contribution that you personally give]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 12:11 (#6)

מִבְחַרֵ֣י נִדְרֵיכֶ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר

“your choice offerings for vows that”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **offerings** that were given to fulfill **vows** one made. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [and the offerings you choose to give to fulfill your vows]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 12:12 (#1)

לִפְנֵי֙

“to the face of”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated this phrase in verse 7.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:12 (#2)

בְּשַׁעֲרֵיכֶ֑ם

“are} within your gate”

See how you translated the similar phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [are within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:12 (#3)

כִּֽי־אֵ֥ין לֹ֛ו חֵ֥לֶק וְנַחֲלָ֖ה אִתְּכֶֽם

“because he has no portion nor inheritance among you”

As explained in Numbers 18:21–25, the Levites received tithes from the rest of the Israelites. Since the tithe is their **inheritance**, Yahweh did not allot any land to them. See how you translated the phrase “has no portion nor inheritance” in 10:9. Alternate translation: [because Yahweh gave the tithe to them and they have no portion or allotment of land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:12 (#4)

לֹ֛ו

“he has”

The word **he** represents any Levite in general, not one particular Levite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [a Levite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 12:13 (#1)

הִשָּׁמֶ֣ר לְךָ֔ & תַּעֲלֶ֖ה עֹלֹתֶ֑יךָ & תִּרְאֶֽה

“Watch yourself & you offer your burnt offerings & you see”

From this verse to the end of the chapter, **you**, **your**, and the command forms are singular although Moses is still speaking to all of the Israelites. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. See the introduction to this chapter for more information.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 12:13 (#2)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:13 (#3)

תִּרְאֶֽה

“you see”

Alternate translation: [you desire]

Deuteronomy 12:14 (#1)

כִּֽי־אִ֣ם

“except”

Moses uses the word **except** here to indicate a strong contrast between where the Israelites might want to offer sacrifices and the one place that Yahweh commands them to offer sacrifices. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [rather]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:14 (#2)

בְּאַחַד שְׁבָטֶיךָ

“in one of your tribes”

The implication is that Yahweh will choose a place for the Israelites to worship him from the land belonging to one of the tribes. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [within the borders of one of your tribe’s land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#1)

תִּזְבַּח ׀ וְאָכַלְתָּ֣ בָשָׂ֔ר

“you may kill and eat animals”

The implication is that the Israelites could **kill and eat animals** for food anywhere they wanted, as much as they wanted. The command from the previous verse only applies to animals killed for sacrifices. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you may kill and eat animals for food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#2)

שְׁעָרֶ֑יךָ

“your gates”

Here the word **gates** refers to the entire city or town. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your cities]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#3)

בְּכָל־אַוַּ֣ת נַפְשְׁךָ֗

“in all the desire of your soul”

Here, **soul** represents a person’s inner being, will, and desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as much as what you desire]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#4)

הַטָּמֵא֙ וְהַטָּה֣וֹר

“the unclean and the clean”

A **clean** person is anyone who has is ceremonially clean according to Yahweh’s law. An **unclean** person is anyone who has touched something unclean according to the law. If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this explicitly. Alternate translation: [everyone, whether or not they are ceremonially unclean]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#5)

הַטָּמֵא֙ וְהַטָּה֣וֹר

“the unclean and the clean”

Moses is using the adjectives **unclean** and **clean** as nouns to refer to people and their ceremonial purity. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who are unclean and people who are clean]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#6)

כַּצְּבִ֖י

“such as the gazelle”

The implication is that the Israelites could eat domesticated animals (which were designated for certain sacrifices) for food, just as they would eat wild animals (which were not used in sacrifices). You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as you are permitted to eat wild animals like the gazelle]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:15 (#7)

כַּצְּבִ֖י

“such as the gazelle”

A **gazelle** is a small type of antelope, that looks and moves like a deer and is similar in size. It is a hoofed animal with long, thin legs that can run quickly. The males grow horns, called antlers, from their heads. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of a similar animal in your area, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [such as the antelope] or [such as the hoofed wild animal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 12:16 (#1)

רַ֣ק

“Only”

Moses uses the word **Only** here to indicate a strong contrast between which parts of the animals that the Israelites could and could not eat. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Except]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:16 (#2)

רַ֣ק הַדָּ֔ם לֹ֥א תֹאכֵ֖לוּ עַל־הָאָ֑רֶץ תִּשְׁפְּכֶ֥נּוּ כַמָּֽיִם

“Only you shall not eat the blood; you shall pour it on the earth like water”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Leviticus 17:10–14.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:17 (#1)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֑יךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the similar phrase “within all your gates” in 12:15. Alternate translation: [within your cities] or [in your cities]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 12:17 (#2)

וְכָל־נְדָרֶ֙יךָ֙

“and any of your vows”

Here, **vows** represent any offering that belongs to Yahweh because a person vowed to give it to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and anything you promised to give in your vows]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:17 (#3)

וּתְרוּמַ֥ת יָדֶֽךָ

“and the contribution of your hand”

Here, **hand** represents how a person could carry or bring something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that you bring]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:18 (#1)

כִּ֤י אִם

“But”

Moses uses the word **But** here to indicate a strong contrast between where the Israelites should not eat the things dedicated to Yahweh and where they should eat them. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Rather]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:18 (#2)

לִפְנֵי֙ & לִפְנֵ֣י

“to the face of & to the face of”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “to the face of.” See how you translated this phrase in verse 7. Alternate translation: [before … before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:18 (#3)

וְהַלֵּוִ֔י

“and the Levite”

The word **Levite** represents all Levites in general, not one particular Levite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [and any Levite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 12:18 (#4)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֑יךָ

“is} within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [is within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:18 (#5)

מִשְׁלַ֖ח יָדֶֽךָ

“the sending out of your hand”

See how you translated “the sending out of your hand” in 12:7.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:19 (#1)

פֶּן

“lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:19 (#2)

אֶת־הַלֵּוִי

“the Levite”

The word **Levite** represents all Levites in general, not one particular Levite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any Levite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 12:19 (#3)

כָּל־יָמֶיךָ

“all your days”

Moses is using **all your days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “as long as you live.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as long as you live] or [throughout your life]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:20 (#1)

כִּי־יַרְחִיבֽ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֶת־גְּבוּלְךָ

“When Yahweh your God broadens your borders”

The implication is that Yahweh will broaden the **borders** of the Israelites’ land by allowing them to conquer more land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [When Yahweh your God causes you to conquer more land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:20 (#2)

דִּבֶּר

“he has spoken”

Here, **spoken** means “promised.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [he has sworn]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:20 (#3)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ אֹכְלָ֔ה בָּשָׂ֖ר כִּֽי־תְאַוֶּ֣ה נַפְשְׁךָ֔ לֶֽאֱכֹ֖ל בָּשָׂ֑ר

“and you say, ‘I will eat meat,’ due to the desire of your soul to eat meat”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as in the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 12:20 (#4)

תְּאַוֶּ֣ה נַפְשְׁךָ֔ & בְּכָל־אַוַּ֥ת נַפְשְׁךָ֖

“the desire of your soul & in all the desire of your soul”

Here, **soul** represents a person’s inner being, will, and desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your desire … according to your desire]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:21 (#1)

הַמָּקוֹם֩ אֲשֶׁ֨ר יִבְחַ֜ר יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ לָשׂ֤וּם שְׁמ֙וֹ֙ שָׁ֔ם

“the place that Yahweh your God chooses to put his name there”

The expression **the place that Yahweh your God chooses to put his name there** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. See how you translated the similar expression, “the place that Yahweh your God will choose … to put his name there” in 12:5. Alternate translation: [the place that Yahweh your God chooses to put his name]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 12:21 (#2)

לָשׂ֤וּם שְׁמ֙וֹ֙ שָׁ֔ם

“to put his name there”

See the discussion of the similar phrase “the place Yahweh your God will choose ... to put his name,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated this similar expression, “to put his name there,” in 12:5.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:21 (#3)

בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 12:15. Alternate translation: [within your cities] or [in your cities]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 12:21 (#4)

בְּכֹל אַוַּת נַפְשֶׁךָ

“in all the desire of your soul”

See how you translated this phrase, “in all the desire of your soul,” in 12:15.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:22 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יֵאָכֵל אֶת־הַצְּבִי וְאֶת־הָאַיָּל

“as the gazelle and the deer are eaten”

The expression **are eaten** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [as one eats the gazelle and the deer]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 12:22 (#2)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יֵאָכֵל אֶת־הַצְּבִי וְאֶת־הָאַיָּל

“as the gazelle and the deer are eaten”

The implication is that the Israelites who lived far away from Yahweh’s chosen place could eat these sacrifices where they lived. This would be just as they would eat wild animals **as the gazelle and the deer** (which were not used in sacrifices). You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as you are permitted to eat wild animals like the gazelle and the deer]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:22 (#3)

אֶת־הַצְּבִי וְאֶת־הָאַיָּל

“the gazelle and the deer”

See how you translated the same phrase, “the gazelle and the deer,” in 12:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 12:22 (#4)

הַטָּמֵא וְהַטָּהוֹר

“the unclean and the clean”

See how you translated these terms, “the unclean” and “the clean,” in 12:15.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:22 (#5)

הַטָּמֵא וְהַטָּהוֹר יַחְדָּו

“the unclean and the clean alike”

Moses is using the adjectives **unclean** and **clean** as nouns to refer to people and their ceremonial purity. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who are unclean and people who are clean] or. Alternate translation: [everyone, whether or not they are ceremonially clean]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 12:23 (#1)

רַק

“Only”

Moses uses the word **Only** here to indicate a strong contrast between what is and is not permissible for the Israelites to eat. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yet]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:23 (#2)

הַדָּם הוּא הַנָּפֶשׁ

“the blood is the life”

Blood sustains the life of living beings. Moses is speaking as if **blood** were **life** itself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [blood sustains life in living beings]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 12:23 (#3)

הַנֶּפֶשׁ

“the life”

The word **life** here represents the blood that sustains life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the blood that maintains life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:24 (#1)

לֹא תֹאכְלֶנּוּ עַל־הָאָרֶץ תִּשְׁפְּכֶנּוּ כַּמָּיִם

“Do not eat it; you shall pour it out on the earth like water”

In Leviticus 17:10–14 Yahweh forbids the Israelites from eating blood. He explains that the life of animals is in their blood, and the blood is reserved for sacrifices. Yahweh commands the Israelites to drain the blood of the animal onto the ground and bury the blood before cooking and consuming the animal. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [Only do not eat the blood, because the blood is the life of the animal, you shall pour it out on the earth like water]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:25 (#1)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

The word translated as **so that** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [so that as a result]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:25 (#2)

וּלְבָנֶיךָ

“and for your sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 12:25 (#3)

אַחֲרֶיךָ

“after you”

Here, **after** means “later.” The implication is that the descendants of the Israelites will continue living on the land after the parents die. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who will live in the land following you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:25 (#4)

הַיָּשָׁר

“right”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **right**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [justly] or [what is righteous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 12:25 (#5)

בְּעֵינֵי

“in the eyes of”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase “in the eyes of.” See how you translated that phrase in 4:25. Alternate translation: [in the judgment of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:26 (#1)

רַק

“But”

Moses uses the word **But** here to indicate a strong contrast between where it is permissible to offer sacrifices that one would personally eat and where it is permissible to offer other sacrifices. This command applies to those who live far away from the place that Yahweh will choose, as specified in verse 15. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [As for]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:26 (#2)

וּנְדָרֶיךָ

“and your vow offerings”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “your offerings for vows,” in 12:6.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 12:27 (#1)

עֹלֹתֶיךָ & וְדַם־זְבָחֶיךָ יִשָּׁפֵךְ עַל־מִזְבַּח יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ וְהַבָּשָׂר תֹּאכֵל

“your burnt offerings & and the blood of your sacrifices shall be poured out on the altar of Yahweh your God, and you shall eat the meat”

Here the term **burnt offerings** and the term **sacrifices** refer to two different types of offerings. Leviticus 1 describes the commands for **burnt offerings**, which are wholly burned by the fire of the altar. By saying **sacrifices**, Moses is referring to Leviticus 3 and Leviticus 7:11–36, which describe the commands for fellowship offerings. Some parts of the animal for these offerings were burned on the altar, some parts were for the priest to eat, and the rest was for the person who offered the sacrifice to eat. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [your burnt offerings ... as for the fellowship offering, the blood of your sacrifices shall be poured out on the altar of Yahweh your God, and you shall eat some of the meat]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:27 (#2)

וְדַם־זְבָחֶיךָ יִשָּׁפֵךְ

“and the blood of your sacrifices shall be poured out”

The expression **be poured out** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the priest will pour out the blood of your sacrifices]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#1)

שְׁמֹר וְשָׁמַעְתָּ

“Keep and listen to”

This phrase expresses a single idea by using two words connected with **and**. The word **Keep** tells how Moses wants the Israelites to **listen** to the commandments. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning with an equivalent phrase that does not use “and.” Alternate translation: [Carefully attend to]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#2)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ אֵת כָּל

“and listen to all”

See how you translated “listen” in 11:13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#3)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#4)

וּלְבָנֶיךָ

“and for your sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#5)

אַחֲרֶיךָ

“after you”

Here, **after** means “later.” The implication is that the descendants of the Israelites will continue living on the land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who will live in the land following you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#6)

הַטּוֹב וְהַיָּשָׁר

“the good and the right”

The terms **good** and **right** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [whatever is correct]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#7)

הַטּוֹב וְהַיָּשָׁר

“the good and the right”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **good** and **right**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [rightly and justly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 12:28 (#8)

בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“in the eyes of”

See how you translated the phrase “in the eyes of” in 4:25. Alternate translation: [in the evaluation of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:29 (#1)

יַכְרִ֨ית

“cuts off”

Here, **cuts off** means “completely destroys” so that a people group will not have descendants. Moses is speaking of eliminating a people group as if it were like cutting off a branch from a tree so that the branch could no longer grow new leaves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [completely eliminates]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 12:29 (#2)

כִּֽי־יַכְרִית֩ יְהוָ֨ה אֱלֹהֶ֜יךָ אֶת־הַגּוֹיִ֗ם אֲשֶׁ֤ר אַתָּה֙ בָּא־שָׁ֣מָּה לָרֶ֔שֶׁת
אוֹתָ֖ם מִפָּנֶ֑יךָ וְיָרַ֣שְׁתָּ֔ אוֹתָ֖ם וְיָשַׁ֥בְתָּ֖ בְּאַרְצָֽם

“When Yahweh your God cuts off the nations from your face, when you go in there to dispossess them, and you dispossess them and live in their land”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could arrange these clauses in chronological order, as the Israelites must enter the land before Yahweh can enable their victory over the other nations. Alternate translation: [As you go in there to dispossess the nations, Yahweh your God will cut them off from your face. Then, you will take their place and live on their land]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 12:29 (#3)

אֶת־הַגּוֹיִ֗ם

“the nations”

Here the word **nations** represents all the people groups who live in the land that Yahweh is giving to the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the peoples]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 12:29 (#4)

מִפָּנֶ֑יךָ

“from your face”

Here the phrase **from your face** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on your account” or “on your behalf,” Alternate translation: [on your behalf] or (2) represent [from your presence.] Alternate translation: [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#1)

פֶּן & וּפֶן

“lest & and lest”

Moses is using the word **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites the instruction, **watch yourself**, so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in case ... and in case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#2)

תִּנָּקֵ֖שׁ אַחֲרֵיהֶ֑ם

“you become trapped after them”

Moses compares idolatry to becoming **trapped**. This is because, just like the result of an animal becoming trapped is disastrous, so is the result of worshiping false gods. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you be caused to turn from Yahweh and follow their false religion]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#3)

תִּנָּקֵ֖שׁ אַחֲרֵיהֶ֑ם

“you become trapped after them”

The expression **become trapped** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you

could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [their religion traps you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#4)

אַחֲרֵיהֶם

“after them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people of the nations from the previous verse and their religious customs. If this is not clear for your readers, you could include clarifying information. Alternate translation: [after the idolatry of the nations]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#5)

הִשָּׁמְדָם מִפָּנֶיךָ

“they are destroyed from your face”

The expression **are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh destroys them from your face]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#6)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your face”

Here the phrase **from your face** could: (1) be a common expression of the culture that means “on your account” or “on your behalf,” Alternate translation: [on your behalf] or (2) represent [from your presence.] Alternate translation: [from before you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#7)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 12:30 (#8)

לֵאמֹר אֵיכָכָה יַעַבְדוּ הַגּוֹיִם הָאֵלֶּה אֶת־אֱלֹהֵיהֶם וְאֶעֱשֶׂה־כֵּן גַּם־אָנִי

“saying, ‘How do these nations serve their gods? And thus I also will do”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as in the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 12:31 (#1)

כֵּן

“thus”

Here the word **thus** refers to the ways the other nations worship their gods. Moses is forbidding the Israelites from worshiping Yahweh in those ways. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as the other nations do]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 12:31 (#2)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because] or [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 12:31 (#3)

כָּל־תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר שָׂנֵא עָשׂוּ לֵאלֹהֵיהֶם

“every abomination {to} Yahweh, which he hates, they have done for their gods”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reword these phrases so that the subject and verb are clear. Alternate translation: [they have done for their gods every abomination which Yahweh hates]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy - Chapter 13 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Instructions regarding Israelite prophets and dreamers of dreams who try to entice fellow Israelites to worship false gods (1–5)
2. Instructions regarding Israelite family members who try to entice an Israelite family member to worship false gods (6–11)
3. Instructions regarding the worship of false gods in Israelite cities (12–18)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

False prophecy
Verses 1–11 discuss false prophets and people who practice divination. These are people would encourage people to worship idols instead of Yahweh and therefore Yahweh commanded that they must be put to death. (See: false prophet; and divination, diviner, soothsaying, soothsayer)

Abominations
Anything that is sinful or ceremonially impure according to the law is called an "abomination" in this chapter. The sinful things include people who worship idols, items used for idol worship, and anything associated with idolatry. (See: abomination, abominable)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Hypothetical conditions
Moses is addressing situations that could occur in the future and giving instructions for the Israelites to follow if those situations occur. In your translation, be sure to use phrases that show that Moses is talking about hypothetical situations, not promising that something will happen in the future. (See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions)

Deuteronomy 13:1 (#1)

כִּי

"If"

Moses is using the word **If** to introduce a possible condition that he describes in this verse and the next. It is a warning against idolatry. The instruction for what they should do if this condition happens comes in verse 3. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this. Alternate translation: [Should it happen that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:1 (#2)

חֹלֵם חֲלוֹם

"a dreamer of dreams"

Here, **dreamer of dreams** means someone who interprets the meaning of dreams. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a word in your language that describes someone who interprets dreams. Alternate translation: [a person who foretells the future by dreams]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 13:1 (#3)

יָקוּם

"arises"

Here, **arises** means "appears." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [appears]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:1 (#4)

וְנָתַן אֵלֶיךָ אוֹת אוֹ מוֹפֵת

"and he gives to you a sign or a wonder"

This could mean that the prophet or dreamer of dreams will (1) perform a sign or wonder. Alternate translation: [and he performs a sign or a wonder] or (2) announce that a sign or wonder will occur. Alternate translation: [and he predicts a sign or a wonder]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:1 (#5)

אוֹת אוֹ מוֹפֵת

"a sign or a wonder"

The terms **sign** and **wonder** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [any supernatural act]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 13:2 (#1)

וּבָא הָאוֹת וְהַמּוֹפֵת

"and the sign or the wonder comes about"

Alternate translation: [and the sign or the wonder occurs]

Deuteronomy 13:2 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר אֵלֶיךָ לֵאמֹר נֵלְכָה אַחֲרֵי אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים אֲשֶׁשָׁר לֹא־יְדַעְתָּם וְנָעָבְדֵם

“which he spoke to you, saying, ‘Let us go after other gods’ (which you have not known) ‘and let us worship them”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [which he told you about in order to lead you to other gods, which you have not known, so that you could worship them]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 13:2 (#3)

נֵלְכָה אַחֲרֵי

“Let us go after”

Here, **go after** means “worship.” Moses is speaking of worshiping idols as if people were physically walking behind idols to follow them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let us serve]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:3 (#1)

לֹא תִשְׁמַע

“do not listen”

The instruction starts here for what to do if the condition expressed in verses 1–2 happen. Use a connector that makes it clear that this is what to do if that condition happens. Alternate translation: [then do not listen]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:3 (#2)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 13:3 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶם וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁכֶם

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

See how you translated the phrase “with all your heart and with all your soul” in 4:29.

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 13:4 (#1)

אַחֲרֵי & תֵּלֵכוּ

“You shall walk after”

Here, **walk after** means “worship.” Moses is speaking of worshiping Yahweh as if people were physically walking behind him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall worship]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:4 (#2)

וְאֶת־מִצְוֹתָיו תִּשְׁמֹרוּ וּבְקֹלוֹ תִשְׁמָעוּ

“and keep his commandments and listen to his voice”

The phrases **keep his commandments** and **listen to his voice** mean similar things. Moses is using the two together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and obey all that he tells you to do]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 13:4 (#3)

וּבְקֹלוֹ תִשְׁמָעוּ

“and listen to his voice”

Here, **voice** represents the words that Yahweh spoke, which include his commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and listen to his instructions]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 13:4 (#4)

תִשְׁמָעוּ

“listen to”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “did not listen to his voice,” in 9:23. Alternate translation: [obey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:4 (#5)

וּבוֹ תִדְבָּקוּן

“and cling to him”

See how you translated “cling” in 10:20. Alternate translation: [and maintain a good relationship with him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#1)

וְהַנָּבִיא הַהוּא אוֹ חוֹלֵם הַחֲלוֹם הַהוּא יוּמָת כִּי דִבֶּר־סָרָה עַל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הַמּוֹצִיא אֶתְכֶם ׀ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם וְהַפֹּדְךָ מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים לְהַדִּיחֲךָ מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר צִוְּךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לָלֶכֶת בָּהּ

“And that prophet or that dreamer of dreams shall be put to death because he has spoken rebellion against Yahweh your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt, and who redeemed you from the house of slaves, to drive you out from the way in which Yahweh your God commanded you to walk”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases so it is clear which phrases refer to Yahweh and which refer to the prophet or dreamer of dreams. Alternate translation: [And that prophet or dreamer of dreams shall be put to death because he has spoken rebellion against Yahweh your God in order to drive you out from the way in which Yahweh your God commanded you to walk. Remember that Yahweh your God is the one who brought you out from the land of Egypt, and who redeemed you from the house of slaves]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#2)

וְהַנָּבִיא הַהוּא אוֹ חוֹלֵם הַחֲלוֹם הַהוּא יוּמָת

“And that prophet or that dreamer of dreams shall be put to death”

The expression **be put to death** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And you must put to death that prophet or that dreamer of dreams]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#3)

דִּבֶּר־סָרָה

“he has spoken rebellion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea behind the word **rebellion**, you can express the same idea with a verbal form. Alternate translation: [he wants you to rebel]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#4)

הַמּוֹצִיא אֶתְכֶם

“who brought you out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [who took you out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#5)

מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים

“from the house of slaves”

See how you translated the phrase “from the house of slaves” in 5:6. Alternate translation: [from the place where you were slaves]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#6)

לְהַדִּיחֲךָ מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר צִוְּךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לָלֶכֶת בָּהּ

“to drive you out from the way in which Yahweh your God commanded you to walk”

Here Moses is speaking of obedience to Yahweh as if it were a **way** or path on which a person could **walk**. He speaks of disobedience as going away from that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to cause you to reject the commands of Yahweh your God] or [to cause you to disobey the commands of Yahweh your God]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:5 (#7)

וּבָעַרְתָּ הָרָע מִקִּרְבֶּךָ

“And you shall remove the evil from among you”

Moses is using the adjective **evil** as a noun to mean an evil act. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [And you will stop any of your people from doing this evil act]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 13:6 (#1)

כִּי

“If”

Moses is using the word **If** to introduce a possible condition that he describes in this verse and the next. It is a warning against idolatry. The instruction for what they should do if this condition happens comes in verse 8. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this. Alternate translation: [Should it happen that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:6 (#2)

אֵֽשֶׁת חֵיקֶ֔ךָ

“the wife of your bosom”

Here, **bosom** represents relational intimacy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your dear wife]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 13:6 (#3)

רֵעֲךָ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר כְּנַפְשְׁךָ֔

“your friend who {is} like your life”

Here Moses means a **friend** who is so important to someone that they are as important as **life**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state that explicitly. Alternate translation: [your dearest friend]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 13:6 (#4)

יְסִיתְךָ֥ & בַּסֵּ֛תֶר לֵאמֹ֖ר נֵֽלְכָ֣ה וְנַעַבְדָ֑ה אֱלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֗ים

“secretly entices you, saying, ‘Let us go and serve other gods”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as modeled by the UST. Alternate translation: [secretly entices you to go and serve other gods]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 13:6 (#5)

לֵאמֹ֖ר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces direct speech. Consider natural ways of doing that in your own language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 13:6 (#6)

וְאָבִ֑יךָ

“nor your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:7 (#1)

מֵאֱלֹהֵ֣י הָעַמִּ֔ים

“from the gods of the peoples”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **gods** whom the nearby **peoples** worship. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [from the gods worshiped by the peoples]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 13:7 (#2)

הָעַמִּ֔ים אֲשֶׁר֙ סְבִיבֹתֵיכֶ֔ם

“the peoples that surround you”

Alternate translation: [the bordering nations]

Deuteronomy 13:7 (#3)

הַקְּרֹבִ֤ים אֵלֶ֙יךָ֙ אוֹ֙ הָרְחֹקִ֔ים מִמְּךָ֖ מִקְצֵ֣ה הָאָ֑רֶץ וְעַד־קְצֵ֖ה הָאָֽרֶץ

“near to you or far from you, from {one} end of the earth and to the {other} end of the earth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [near to you or far from you, indeed, from one end of the earth and to the other end of the earth]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 13:7 (#4)

הַקְּרֹבִ֤ים אֵלֶ֙יךָ֙ אוֹ֙ הָרְחֹקִ֔ים מִמֶּ֖ךָּ

“near to you or far from you”

Here Moses is referring to all of the earth by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wherever they are]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 13:7 (#5)

מִקְצֵה הָאָרֶץ וְעַד־קְצֵה הָאָרֶץ

“from {one} end of the earth and to the {other} end of the earth”

Here Moses is referring to all of the earth by naming the parts that are at the extreme ends of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [anywhere on earth]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 13:8 (#1)

לֹא־תֹאבֶה

“do not yield”

The instruction starts here for what to do if the condition expressed in verses 6–7 happen. Use a connector that makes it clear that this is what to do if a condition happens. Alternate translation: [then do not yield]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:8 (#2)

וְלֹא־תָחוֹס עֵינְךָ עָלָיו

“and your eye shall not pity him”

Moses is using **your eye shall not pity him** as a common expression of his culture to mean “do not feel sorry for him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [do not let your heart soften towards him] or [and do not have compassion on him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 13:8 (#3)

וְלֹא־תְכַסֶּה עָלָיו

“nor hide him”

Here Moses means that people should not **hide** or keep secret the fact that someone is urging others to worship idols. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [nor hide his guilt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:9 (#1)

כִּי

“Instead”

Moses uses the word **Instead** here to indicate a strong contrast between what someone should and should not do when someone is urging others to worship false gods. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Rather]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 13:9 (#2)

הָרֹג תַּהַרְגֶנּוּ

“killing, you shall kill him”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **kill** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you shall surely kill him]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 13:9 (#3)

הָרֹג תַּהַרְגֶנּוּ

“killing, you shall kill him”

The implication is that the Israelites will **kill** those people by throwing stones at them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you shall surely stone him to death]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:9 (#4)

יָדְךָ & וְיַד כָּל־הָעָם בָּאַחֲרֹנָה

“Your hand & and afterwards, the hand of all the people”

Here Moses is using **hand** to represent the whole person in the act of executing someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You yourself ... and afterwards, all the other people]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 13:10 (#1)

וּסְקַלְתּוֹ בָאֲבָנִים וָמֵת

“And you shall stone him to death with stones”

The expression **stone him to death with stones** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [And you shall stone him to death]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 13:10 (#2)

לְהַדִּיחֲךָ מֵעַל יְהוָה

“to drive you away from Yahweh”

Here Moses is speaking of obedience to Yahweh as if obedience to him were a path that one walks on. He speaks of disobedience as someone driving one away from that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to cause you to reject the commands of Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:10 (#3)

הַמּוֹצִיאֲךָ

“who brought you out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “took” instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [who took you out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 13:10 (#4)

מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים

“from the house of slaves”

See how you translated the phrase “from the house of slaves” in 5:6. Alternate translation: [from the place where you were slaves]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:11 (#1)

יִשְׁמְעוּ

“will hear”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the chapter if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will hear about the execution]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 13:11 (#2)

כַּדְּבָר

“as the things of”

Here, **things** refers to the actions of the false prophets and dreamers of dreams. These include urging others to disobey Yahweh and worship idols. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as the idolatrous deeds of]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:11 (#3)

הָרָע

“wickedness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [sinful behavior]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 13:12 (#1)

כִּי

“If”

Moses is using the word **If** to introduce a possible condition that he describes in this verse through verse 14. It is a warning against idolatry. The instruction for what they should do if this condition happens comes in verse 15. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this. Alternate translation: [Should it happen that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:12 (#2)

תִּשְׁמַע

“you hear”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these implied words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [you hear someone speak]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 13:12 (#3)

עָרֶ֙יךָ֙ אֲשֶׁר֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ נֹתֵ֥ן לְךָ֖ לָשֶׁ֥בֶת שָׁ֖ם

“your cities that Yahweh your God gives to you to live there”

The expression **your cities that Yahweh your God gives to you to live there** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [your cities that Yahweh your God gives to you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 13:12 (#4)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces direct speech. Consider natural ways of doing that in your own language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 13:12–13 (#1)

כִּֽי־תִשְׁמַ֗ע בְּאַחַ֤ת עָרֶ֙יךָ֙ אֲשֶׁר֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ נֹתֵ֥ן לְךָ֖ לָשֶׁ֥בֶת
שָׁ֖ם לֵאמֹֽר׃ יָצְא֨וּ אֲנָשִׁ֜ים בְּנֵי־בְלִיַּ֣עַל ׀ מִקִּרְבֶּ֗ךָ וַיַּדִּ֤יחוּ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי
עִירָם֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר נֵלְכָ֥ה וְנַעַבְדָ֖ה אֱלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יְדַעְתֶּֽם

“If you hear in one of your cities that Yahweh your God gives to you to live there, saying, ‘Men, sons of wickedness, have gone out from among you and have driven out the inhabitants of their city saying, “Let us go and serve other gods that you have not known”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting what people might hear in the cities (level 2) that quotes what wicked men might say (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there are not quotations within quotations as is modeled in the UST.

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 13:12–13 (#2)

כִּֽי־תִשְׁמַ֗ע בְּאַחַ֤ת עָרֶ֙יךָ֙ אֲשֶׁר֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ נֹתֵ֥ן לְךָ֖ לָשֶׁ֥בֶת
שָׁ֖ם לֵאמֹֽר׃ יָצְא֨וּ אֲנָשִׁ֜ים בְּנֵי־בְלִיַּ֣עַל ׀ מִקִּרְבֶּ֗ךָ וַיַּדִּ֤יחוּ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי
עִירָם֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר נֵלְכָ֥ה וְנַעַבְדָ֖ה אֱלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֑ים אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יְדַעְתֶּֽם

“If you hear in one of your cities that Yahweh your God gives to you to live there, saying, ‘Men, sons of wickedness, have gone out from among you and have driven out the inhabitants of their city saying, “Let us go and serve other gods that you have not known”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [If you hear that some sons of wickedness have gone out from one of your cities that Yahweh your God gives to you to live there and have driven out the inhabitants in order to convince them to serve other gods that they have not known]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 13:13 (#1)

בְּנֵי־בְלִיַּ֣עַל ׀

“sons of wickedness”

Moses is using **sons of** as a common expression of his culture to indicate people who share a certain characteristic. In this case, these people share the characteristic of **wickedness**. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wicked men]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 13:13 (#2)

מִקִּרְבֶּ֗ךָ

“from among you”

The implication is that the “sons of wickedness” came from Israelite communities. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from your communities]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:13 (#3)

וַיַּדִּ֤יחוּ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי֙ עִירָ֔ם

“and have driven out the inhabitants of their city”

Here Moses is speaking of obedience to Yahweh as if it were a path that one walks on. He speaks of disobedience as someone driving one out from that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and have caused the inhabitants of their city to disobey Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:14 (#1)

וְדָרַשְׁתָּ֣ וְחָקַרְתָּ֔ וְשָׁאַלְתָּ֖ הֵיטֵ֑ב

“and you shall investigate and search out and ask thoroughly”

The terms **investigate**, **search out**, and **ask thoroughly** mean similar things. Moses is using the terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and you shall carefully investigate what happened] or [and you shall carefully inquire about what happened]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 13:14 (#2)

וְהִנֵּ֤ה

“and behold”

Moses is using the term **behold** to focus attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and indeed]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:14 (#3)

אֱמֶת֙ נָכ֣וֹן הַדָּבָ֔ר

“the matter {is} an established truth”

This verse continues to describe a possible condition that Moses began describing in verse 12. The instruction for what they should do if these conditions happen comes in verse 15. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this. Alternate translation: [if you discover that it is true that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:14 (#4)

הַדָּבָ֔ר

“the matter”

Here, **the matter** refers to the act of idol worship. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [this idol worship]

Deuteronomy 13:14 (#5)

נֶעֶשְׂתָ֥ה הַתּוֹעֵבָ֖ה הַזֹּ֣את בְּקִרְבֶּֽךָ׃

“this abomination has been done in your midst”

The expression **has been done** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the people of the city have done this terrible thing]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 13:15 (#1)

הַכֵּ֣ה

“striking”

The instruction starts here for what to do if the condition expressed in verses 12–14 happen. Use a connector that makes it clear that this is what to do if a condition happens. Alternate translation: [then striking]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 13:15 (#2)

הַכֵּ֣ה תַכֶּ֔ה

“striking, you shall strike”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **strike** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you shall certainly strike] or [you shall surely strike]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 13:15 (#3)

הַכֵּ֣ה תַכֶּ֔ה אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵ֖י הָעִ֣יר ההוא

“striking, you shall strike the dwellers of that city”

Here, **striking** represents killing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you shall certainly kill the dwellers of that city]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 13:15 (#4)

לְפִי־חָ֑רֶב & לְפִי־חָ֑רֶב

“to the mouth of the sword & to the mouth of the sword”

Here Moses is using the expression **to the mouth of the swords** in connection with the term **devoting**. These were common expressions of his culture that could refer to destroying something completely. See how you translated the related phrase “devoted” in 2:34. If these phrases do not have that meaning in

your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that do have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by destroying it completely ... by destroying them completely]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 13:15 (#5)

הַחֲרֵ֤ם אֹתָהּ֙ וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־בָּ֔הּ וְאֶת־בְּהֶמְתָּ֖הּ לְפִי־חָֽרֶב

“devoting it and all who {are} in it and its livestock to the mouth of the sword”

The implication is that the Israelites were supposed kill everyone in this type of city so that no person or livestock were left living there. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [completely destroying it and all who are in it and its livestock so that there is nothing living there]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:15 (#6)

אֹתָהּ & בָּ֔הּ & בְּהֶמְתָּ֖הּ

“it & are} in it & its livestock”

The pronouns **it** and **its** refers to the “city.” If this is not clear for your readers, you could repeat the word. Alternate translation: [that city ... are in that city ... that city’s livestock]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 13:16 (#1)

וְשָׂרַפְתָּ֥ בָאֵ֛שׁ אֶת־הָעִ֖יר

“and burn the city in fire”

The expression **burn the city in fire** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [and burn the city]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 13:16 (#2)

וְשָׂרַפְתָּ֥ בָאֵ֛שׁ אֶת־הָעִ֖יר וְאֶת־כָּל־שְׁלָלָ֑הּ כָּלִ֥יל

“and burn the city in fire, and all its spoil completely”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these clauses so that the objects of the verb **burn** are clear. Alternate translation: [and completely burn the city and all its spoil in fire]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 13:16 (#3)

לַיהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“for Yahweh your God”

The implication is that burning the spoil would be like burning an offering for Yahweh. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as an offering for Yahweh your God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:16 (#4)

תֵּ֥ל

“a heap”

The implication is that the city will become a **heap** of ruins. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a heap of ruins]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:16 (#5)

לֹ֥א תִבָּנֶ֖ה עֽוֹד

“it shall not be built again”

The expression **be built** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [no one should ever build that city again]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#1)

וְלֹא־יִדְבַּ֥ק בְּיָדְךָ֖ מְאוּמָ֑ה מִן־הַחֵ֣רֶם

“And in your hand you shall not cling to anything from the devoted thing”

Here Moses is speaking of taking forbidden spoil as if the objects were clinging to one’s hands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And do not take as spoil anything from the devoted things] or [And do not take anything from the devoted things]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#2)

מִן־הַחֵרֶם

“from the devoted thing”

See how you translated the term “devoted” in 2:34. Alternate translation: [from the things set apart for destruction]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#3)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#4)

יָשׁוּב יְהוָה מֵחֲרוֹן אַפּוֹ

“Yahweh will turn from the burning of his nose”

Moses is speaking as if the Yahweh will be going one way and then **will turn** away from his burning nose. He means that Yahweh will stop being angry with them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will no longer be angry with you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#5)

מֵחֲרוֹן אַפּוֹ

“from the burning of his nose”

See how you translated the similar expression “lest the nose of Yahweh your God burn against you” in 6:15.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#6)

וְנָתַן־לְךָ רַחֲמִים וְרִחַמְךָ

“and give to you compassion and have compassion on you”

The terms **give compassion** and **have compassion** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and he will give you much compassion]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 13:17 (#7)

וְהִרְבֶּךָ

“and make you increase”

The implication is that Yahweh will **make** the population of Israelites **increase** in number by births. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and increase your population]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 13:18 (#1)

כִּֽי

“when”

The word translated as **when** indicates that what follows is the condition for the blessings from Yahweh in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [if you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 13:18 (#2)

בְּקוֹל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“to the voice of Yahweh your God”

Here, **voice** represents the words that Yahweh spoke. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to what Yahweh your God says]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 13:18 (#3)

הַיָּשָׁר

“right”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **right**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is righteous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 13:18 (#4)

בְּעֵינָֽיו

“in the eyes of”

See how you translated the phrase “in the eyes of” in 4:25. Alternate translation: [according to the judgment of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy - Chapter 14 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses' second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Commands for mourning practices (1–2)
2. Commands regarding the eating of animals (3–21)
3. Commands regarding tithing (22–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Law of Moses

This chapter is part of the law of Moses, which is part of the covenant Yahweh made with Moses. Yahweh will enable the Israelites to live on the land if they obey his commands. (See: law, law of Moses, law of Yahweh, law of God)

Clean animals

There are animals which the law considered to be clean and unclean. The people were not allowed to eat the unclean animals. Scholars are not certain about the reasons that some animals are to be considered clean and others unclean. The result of these food restrictions was a nation that was different from the nations surrounding it.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular and plural

Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, so all forms of the second person pronouns "you" and "your" are plural in this chapter unless otherwise specified. Use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction. (See: Forms of 'You' — Singular; and Pronouns — When to Use Them) (See Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Types of living creatures

This chapter discusses which living creatures are permissible for the Israelites to eat. It is unclear which specific creatures some of the Hebrew terms refer to, but the general categories of these creatures are explained in the notes. Additionally, your readers may not be familiar with many of these creatures. In your translation, you could use broad categories of animals, such as fish, birds of prey, and cattle. Or, you could use the names of creatures in your area that are similar to the ones mentioned in this chapter. (See: Translate Unknowns)

"the place that Yahweh your God will choose"

Moses uses phrases such as this to refer to the future place where the temple will be built. These phrases emphasize that Yahweh will be the one who decides where the Israelites will build his temple as well as how they will worship him. (See: temple, house, house of God)

"the place that he will choose to make his name stay," "the place that Yahweh your God will choose to put his name"

In 14:23 and 14:24 the author uses God's name to represent his reputation and presence. These phrases indicate that God would choose a place and make his presence and reputation stay there. That place would be the future temple. (See: Metonymy)

Deuteronomy 14:1 (#1)

בָּנִים

"are} the sons of"

Here, **sons** means chosen and beloved people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are beloved people belonging to]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:1 (#2)

לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

"Yahweh your God"

See how you translated the phrase "Yahweh your God" in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 14:1 (#3)

לֹא תִתְגֹּדְדוּ

"Do not cut yourselves"

The other people groups living in the land would cut themselves with sharp objects when they mourned the dead. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Do not cut your skin with sharp objects in mourning]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 14:1 (#4)

וְלֹא־תָשִׂימוּ קָרְחָה בֵּין עֵינֵיכֶם

"and do not make a baldness between your eyes"

The other people groups living in the land would shave the hair at the front of their heads when they mourned the dead. If this would not be clear to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the

text or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and do not cut off the hair on your forehead in mourning]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 14:1 (#5)

בֵּבֵין עֵינֵיכֶם

“between your eyes”

Moses is using **between your eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “your forehead.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [above your eyebrows]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 14:2 (#1)

כִּי עַם קָדוֹשׁ אַתָּה לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ וּבְךָ בָּחַר יְהוָה לִהְיוֹת לוֹ לְעַם סְגֻלָּה

“for you {are} a nation set apart for Yahweh your God, and Yahweh has chosen you to be a people for his possession”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second clause emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the clauses with a word other than **and** that shows that the second clause is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [for you are a nation set apart for Yahweh your God, indeed, he has chosen you to be a people for his possession]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 14:2 (#2)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is the reason the Israelites were not to show their mourning as the other people groups around them did. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 14:2 (#3)

אַתָּה & אֱלֹהֶיךָ וּבְךָ

“you & your God, and & you”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, **you** and **your** are singular here. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 14:2 (#4)

עַל־פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה

“are on the face of the earth”

See how you translated the phrase “the face of the earth” in 6:15. Alternate translation: [are existing on the earth]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 14:5 (#1)

אַיָּל וּצְבִי וְיַחְמוּר וְאַקּוֹ וְדִישׁוֹן וּתְאוֹ וָזֶמֶר

“the deer and the gazelle and the roebuck and the wild goat and ibex and the antelope and the mountain sheep”

These are all hoofed animals with long, thin legs that can run quickly. Their males grow horns from their head. If your readers would not be familiar with these types of animals, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [hoofed animals with long, thin legs that can run quickly]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:5 (#2)

וּצְבִי

“and the gazelle”

See how you translated the term “gazelle” in 12:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:6 (#1)

מַפְרֶסֶת פַּרְסָה

“parting the hoof”

Moses is referring to a **hoof** that is split into two parts instead of being one whole. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [whose hooves are two separate parts]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:6 (#2)

וְשֹׁסַעַת שֶׁשַׁסְעַ֥ת שְׁתֵּ֖י פְּרָסֹ֑ות

“or {with} a cleft splitting {into} two hooves”

Moses is referring to **hooves** that are split into two at the front, but the back of the hoof is connected. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [or with divided hooves]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:6 (#3)

מַעֲלַ֥ת גֵּרָ֖ה

“chewing the cud”

An animal that chews **the cud** has multiple stomachs. The animal brings its food up from its stomach and chews it again. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [which rechew their food]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:7 (#1)

אַ֚ךְ אֶת־זֶ֔ה

“Despite this”

Moses uses the phrase **Despite this** here to indicate a strong contrast between animals that are and are not permissible for the Israelites to eat. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yet]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 14:7 (#2)

מִמַּעֲלֵ֣י הַגֵּרָ֔ה וּמִמַּפְרִיסֵ֖י הַפַּרְסָ֑ה הַשְּׁסוּעָ֗ה

“from chewers of the cud and from splitters of the hoof, the cloven-footed”

See how you translated the similar phrases, “chewing the cud” and “parting the hoof,” in the previous verse.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:7 (#3)

הָאַרְנֶ֖בֶת

“the rabbit”

A **rabbit** is a small, furry animal that eats plants and lives in holes in the ground. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [small, furry animals]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:7 (#4)

הַשָּׁפָ֑ן

“the rock badger”

A **rock badger** is a medium-sized, furry animal that eats plants and lives in holes in the ground. It is also known as a rock hyrax or rock rabbit. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [larger furry animals]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:7 (#5)

טְמֵאִ֖ים

“are} unclean”

An **unclean** animal is anything that is not ceremonially clean according to Yahweh’s law (also called the Law of Moses). If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [are impure]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:8 (#1)

מַפְרִ֣יס פַּרְסָ֔ה הוּא֙ וְלֹ֣א גֵרָ֔ה

“he parts the hoof and {chews} not the cud”

See how you translated the similar phrases, “chewing the cud” and “parting the hoof,” in 14:6.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:8 (#2)

טָמֵ֥א

“is} unclean”

See how you translated the term “unclean” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [is impure]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:9 (#1)

מִכֹּ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר בַּמָּ֑יִם

“from all that is in the water”

Moses is referring to any creature that lives **in the water**. You could include this information if that would

be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from aquatic creatures]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:9 (#2)

סְנַפִּ֥יר

“fins”

Here the word **fins** refers to the thin, flat part which the fish uses to move through the water. If your readers would not be familiar with this part, you could use the name of something similar or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [flippers]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:9 (#3)

וְקַשְׂקֶ֖שֶׂת

“and scales”

The word **scales** refers to the small plates that cover the body of the fish, similar to those that cover a snake. If your readers would not be familiar with this part, you could use the name of something similar or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and flakes covering its skin]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:10 (#1)

טָמֵ֥א

“is} unclean”

See how you translated the term “unclean” in 14:7. Alternate translation: [is impure]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:11 (#1)

טְהֹרָ֖ה

“clean”

Something that is **clean** is anything that is permissible for an Israelite to eat while remaining ceremonially clean according to Yahweh’s law (also called the Law of Moses). If it would be helpful in your language, consider stating this plainly. Alternate translation: [pure]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:12 (#1)

מֵהֶ֥ם

“from them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the word “birds” from the previous verse. If this is not clear for your readers, you could repeat the word here. Alternate translation: [from the birds]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 14:12 (#2)

הַנֶּ֖שֶׁר וְהַפֶּ֣רֶס וְהָעָזְנִיָּֽה

“the eagle, and the large vulture, and the black vulture”

These birds all eat dead animals. If your readers would not be familiar with these birds, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [large birds that eat dead animals]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:12 (#3)

וְהָעָזְנִיָּֽה

“and the black vulture”

The word the ULT translates as **the black vulture** could refer to: (1) the black vulture, which is a type of vulture, or (2) the bearded vulture, which is a type of vulture. Alternate translation: [the bearded vulture] or (3) an osprey. An osprey is a type of hawk that eats primarily fish. Alternate translation: [and the osprey]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:13 (#1)

וְהָרְאָהֹ֖ וְאֶת־הָאַיָּ֑ה וְהַדַּיָּ֖ה לְמִינָֽהּ

“the red kite, and the falcon, and the kite according to its kind”

The term **kite** refers to a type of large bird that hunts animals. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the falcon, the large birds that hunt animals]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:14 (#1)

עֹרֵֽב

“raven”

A **raven** is a medium-sized, all-black bird that eats dead animals. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of

something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [black scavenging bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:15 (#1)

בַּבַּת הַיַּעֲנָה

“the ostrich”

Ostriches are large birds that do not fly. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the large, flightless bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:15 (#2)

הַתַּחְמָס

“the owl”

An **owl** is a medium-sized bird that hunts animals during the night. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the medium-sized nocturnal bird of prey]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:15 (#3)

הַשָּׁשַׁחַף

“the gull”

A **gull** is a bird that lives near bodies of water that soars in the sky or scavenges on the ground. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the scavenging seabird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:15 (#4)

הַנֵּץ

“the hawk”

A **hawk** is a medium-sized bird that eats animals. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the medium-size bird that eat animals]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:16 (#1)

אֶת־הַכּוֹס וְאֶת־הַיַּנְשׁוּף וְהַתִּנְשֶׁמֶת

“the little owl, and the great owl, and the white owl”

An **owl** is a bird that is active at night and hunts animals during the night. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Also, if you do not have three different terms for these types of birds you could combine them into one phrase. Alternate translation: [birds that hunt animals at night]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:17 (#1)

וְהַקָּאָת

“and the pelican”

A **pelican** is a large bird that wades in bodies of water and eats fish. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the wading bird that hunts fish]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:17 (#2)

הָרָחָמָה

“the carrion vulture”

A **carrion vulture** is a type of vulture that eats the flesh of dead animals (the word “carrion” refers to the decaying flesh of dead animals and a vulture is a type of bird). If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the large black bird that eats the flesh of dead animals]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:17 (#3)

הַשָּׁלָךְ

“the cormorant”

A **cormorant** is a bird that lives in the water and eats fish. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general

term. Alternate translation: [the aquatic bird that hunts fish]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:18 (#1)

וְהַחֲסִידָה

“and the stork”

A **stork** is a large bird with a long beak that wades in the water. They eat small creatures. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the large wading bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:18 (#2)

וְהָאֲנָפָה

“and the heron”

A **heron** is a medium-sized bird with long legs and a long neck. It lives near bodies of water. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the long-legged bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:18 (#3)

וְהַדּוּכִיפַת

“and the hoopoe”

A **hoopoe** is a small, colorful bird with a crown of feathers on the top of its head. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of bird, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the small, crowned bird]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:18 (#4)

וְהָעֲטַלֵּף

“and the bat”

A **bat** is a flying animal with wings and a furry body. It hunts insects and rodents at night. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of flying animal, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and the nocturnal flying animal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 14:19 (#1)

שֶׁשֶׂרֶץ הָעוֹף

“winged, swarming things”

The phrase **winged, swarming things** refers to flying insects that move in large groups. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [flying insects traveling in groups]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:19 (#2)

טָמֵא

“unclean”

See how you translated the term “unclean” in 14:7. Alternate translation: [impure]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:19 (#3)

לֹא יֵאָכֵלוּ

“they must not be eaten”

The expression **be eaten** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [do not eat them]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 14:20 (#1)

טָהוֹר

“clean”

See how you translated the term “clean” in 14:11. Alternate translation: [pure]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 14:21 (#1)

נְבֵלָה

“dying {of itself”

Moses is using **dying of itself** as a common expression of his culture to mean “died of natural causes.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state

the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that has died of natural causes]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 14:21 (#2)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֙יךָ֙ תִּתְּנֶ֣נָּה & אַתָּ֔ה & אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ לֹא־תְבַשֵּׁ֥ל

“you may give it & is} within your gates & you & your God. You must not boil”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, **you**, **your**, and the command forms that are noted here are singular. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 14:21 (#3)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֙יךָ֙

“is} within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [is within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:21 (#4)

מָכַ֣רְ

“sell”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [sell it]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 14:21 (#5)

כִּ֣י

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 14:22 (#1)

עַשֵּׂ֥ר תְּעַשֵּׂ֖ר

“Tithing, you shall tithe”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **tithe** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You shall surely tithe]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 14:22 (#2)

תְּעַשֵּׂ֥ר & זֶ֖רַע

“you shall tithe & your seed”

Even though Moses is speaking to all the Israelites, **you** and **your** and the command forms are singular in this whole passage, from this verse to verse 29. If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 14:22 (#3)

אֵ֚ת כָּל־תְּבוּאַ֣ת זַרְעֶ֔ךָ

“all the produce of your seed”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe all of the **produce** that comes from each planted **seed**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use an equivalent expression. Alternate translation: [from all the harvest]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 14:22 (#4)

זַרְעֶ֔ךָ

“your seed”

Here, **seed** is literal and refers to seeds used in farming. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [your farming]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:22 (#5)

שָׁנָ֖ה שָׁנָ֑ה

“year {after} year”

Moses is using **year after year** as a common expression of his culture to mean “every year.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language,

you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [yearly] or [every year]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of” in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#2)

לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to make his name stay there”

See the discussion of the similar phrase “the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated the expression “to make his name stay there” in 12:11. Alternate translation: [for you to come into his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־יִבְחַר לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“that he will choose to make his name stay there”

The expression **that he will choose to make his name stay there**. contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [that he will choose to make his name stay] or [where his name will stay]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#4)

דְּגָנְךָ תִּירֹשְׁךָ וְיִצְהָרֶךָ וּבְכֹרֹת

“your grain, your new wine, and your oil and the firstborn of”

In this verse, the words **grain**, **wine**, **oil**, and **firstborn** are singular in form, but they refer to anything an Israelite might tithe. If it would be helpful in your language, you could say this plainly. Alternate translation: [all your crops of grain, all of your new wine, and all of your oil, and all the firstborn males of]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#5)

תִּירֹשְׁךָ וְיִצְהָרֶךָ

“your new wine, and your oil”

The implication is that the Israelites will grow crops of grapes and olives in the land. Since **wine** is made from grapes and **oil** is made from olives, you could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and your grapes for wine and your olive trees for oil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#6)

וּבְכֹרֹת

“and the firstborn of”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to Yahweh’s command described in Exodus 13:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#7)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 14:23 (#8)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all the days”

Moses is using **all the days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “forever.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [forever]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 14:23–24 (#1)

שְׂאֵתוֹ

“to carry it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the tithe of crops and livestock. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to carry the tithe from all your produce and livestock]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 14:24 (#1)

וְכִי־יִרְבֶּה מִמְּךָ הַדֶּרֶךְ כִּי לֹא תוּכַל שְׂאֵתוֹ כִּי־יִרְחַק מִמְּךָ הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לָשׂוּם שְׁמוֹ שָׁם כִּי יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“And if the journey is too long for you, that you are not able to carry it (because the place that Yahweh your God will choose to put his name there is too far from you), when Yahweh your God blesses you”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could change the order of these phrases so that it is clear that Yahweh must bless the Israelites before the Israelites can sell their tithe. Alternate translation: [When Yahweh your God blesses you, and you are not able to carry it to the place that Yahweh your God will put his name because it is too far]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 14:24 (#2)

לָשׂוּם שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to put his name there”

See the discussion of the similar phrase “the place Yahweh your God will choose … to put his name,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated this same expression, “to put his name there,” in 12:5. Alternate translation: [for you to worship him] or [for you to come into his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:24 (#3)

כִּי יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“when Yahweh your God blesses you”

The implication is that Yahweh will bless the Israelites by allowing their crops and cattle to grow well. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [when Yahweh your God blesses your fields and flocks]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:25 (#1)

וְנָתַתָּה

“then you may give it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the tithe. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [then you may give the tithe]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 14:25 (#2)

וְנָתַתָּה בַּכָּסֶף

“then you may give it in silver”

The implication is that the Israelite who lives too far from the temple should sell the tithe where he lives. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [then you will sell your offering for money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:25 (#3)

וְצַרְתָּ הַכֶּסֶף בְּיָדֶךָ

“and bind the silver in your hand”

The implication is that the Israelite should take the money from selling the tithe and bring the money with him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and bring the money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:25 (#4)

הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בּוֹ

“the place that Yahweh your God will choose it”

The expression **the place that Yahweh your God will choose it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [the place which Yahweh your God will choose]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 14:26 (#1)

וְנָתַתָּה הַכֶּסֶף בְּכֹל

“And give the money for anything”

The implication is that the Israelite will use the money to buy things where the temple is. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And purchase anything]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:26 (#2)

בְּכֹלאֲשֶׁר־תְּאַוֶּה נַפְשְׁךָ & וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר תִּשְׁאָלְךָ נַפְשֶׁךָ

“for anything that your soul desires & or for anything that your soul desires”

Here, **soul** represents a person’s inner being, will, and desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for anything that you desire ... or for anything else that you desire]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:26 (#3)

וּבַשֵּׁכָר

“or for strong drink”

Moses is using **strong drink** as a common expression of his culture to mean “hard liquor.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or for liquor]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 14:26 (#4)

שָׁשָׁם

“there”

The word **there** refers to the place where Yahweh will choose for the Israelites to worship him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the temple]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:26 (#5)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of “to the face of.” See how you translated this same phrase in verse 23.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:26 (#6)

וְשָׂמַחְתָּ אַתָּה וּבֵיתֶךָ

“and you shall rejoice, you and your household”

The implication is that the Israelite and their household would **rejoice** at the temple because Yahweh blessed them with flocks and crops. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you shall rejoice because Yahweh is good to you, you and your household]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:27 (#1)

וְהַלֵּוִי & לֹא תַעַזְבֶנּוּ & לוֹ

“And the Levite & do not forsake him & he has”

The word **Levite**, and the corresponding pronouns **him** and **he** represent all Levites in general, not one particular Levite. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions, as modeled by the UST.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 14:27 (#2)

בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“is} within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [is within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:27 (#3)

לֹא תַעַזְבֶנּוּ

“do not forsake him”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **forsake**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [remember him]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 14:27 (#4)

לֹא תַעַזְבֶנּוּ

“do not forsake him”

The Levites relied on tithes to live, as commanded by Yahweh in Numbers 18:21–25. Yahweh chose the Levites to serve him, so they did not have any land on which to grow food for themselves. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [do not forsake the Levite by withholding the tithe from him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:27 (#5)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 14:27 (#6)

אֵ֣ין לֹ֔ו חֵ֥לֶק וְנַחֲלָ֖ה עִמָּֽךְ

“he has no portion nor inheritance with you”

The implication is that the Levites will not receive any portion or inheritance of land. See how you translated the phrase “has no portion nor inheritance” in 10:9. Alternate translation: [the Levite does not own any land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:28 (#1)

תּוֹצִיא

“you shall bring out”

In a context such as this, your language might say “take” instead of **bring**. Alternate translation: [you shall take out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 14:28 (#2)

תּוֹצִיא֙ אֶת־כָּל־מַעְשַׂ֣ר תְּבוּאָתְךָ֔ בַּשָּׁנָ֖ה הַהִ֑וא וְהִנַּחְתָּ֖ בִּשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ

“you shall bring out all the tithe of your produce in that year, and you shall deposit {it} within your gates”

The implication is that this produce would be stored somewhere in the town to give to anyone in the community who needed food. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you shall bring the tithe of your produce for that year and put it in a community store-house for the needy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:28 (#3)

בִּשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 12:15. Alternate translation: [in your cities]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 14:29 (#1)

אֵ֣ין־לֹ֔ו חֵ֥לֶק וְנַחֲלָ֖ה עִמָּֽךְ

“he has no portion nor inheritance with you”

The implication is that the Levites will not receive any **portion** or **inheritance** of land on which to grow food for themselves. See how you translated the phrase “has no portion nor inheritance” in 10:9. Alternate translation: [the Levite does not own any land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 14:29 (#2)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֑יךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 14:29 (#3)

לְמַ֣עַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 14:29 (#4)

מַעֲשֵׂ֥ה יָדְךָ֖

“the work of your hand”

Moses is using one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of him in the act of working. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of your own work]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 15 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Rules for canceling debts (1–11)

2. Rules for fellow Israelite slaves (12–18)
3. Rules for firstborn male animals (19–23)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Israelite slaves
This chapter contains rules for owning slaves that were fellow Israelites. An Israelite might work as another Israelite's slave to pay off a debt. Instead of receiving pay, their wages would go toward their debt. The debtor would be their creditor's property, and they could not work elsewhere. If the word "slave" would not accurately describe this practice in your culture, you could use a comparable term, such as "indentured servant" or "bondservant." (See: servant, serve, maid-servant, young man, young women)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular
Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 15:1 (#1)

מִקֵּ֖ץ שֶׁ֣בַע־שָׁנִ֑ים

"At the end of seven years"

The implication is that the Israelites must do this every seven years. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Every seventh year]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:1 (#2)

תַּעֲשֶׂ֥ה שְׁמִטָּֽה

"you shall make a remission"

The implication is that the **remission** is a cancelation of debts. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you shall declare that loans do not need to be paid back] or [you shall declare that debts no longer need to be paid back]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#1)

דְּבַ֣ר

"is} the word of"

Here Moses is using the term **word** to represent what Yahweh had commanded using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the procedure for]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#2)

הַשְּׁמִטָּ֔ה & קָרָ֖א שְׁמִטָּ֥ה לַיהוָֽה

"the remission & the remission of Yahweh has been proclaimed"

See how you translated the term "remission" in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [how you should cancel debts ... Yahweh has proclaimed the commandment about cancelation of debt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#3)

שָׁמ֣וֹט כָּל־בַּ֠עַל מַשֵּׁ֨ה יָדֹ֜ו אֲשֶׁ֣ר יַשֶּׁ֗ה בְּרֵעֵ֛הוּ

"Every owner of debt shall release his hand that he has loaned to his neighbor"

Moses is using **release his hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean "forgive the debts owed to him." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Every owner of debt shall forgive what his neighbor owes to him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#4)

בַּ֠עַל מַשֵּׁ֨ה

"owner of debt"

The implication is that the **owner of debt** loaned money to someone else. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [creditor] or [person who is owed money]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#5)

בְּרֵעֵ֛הוּ & אֶת־רֵעֵ֥הוּ

"to his neighbor & his neighbor"

Here Moses is speaking as if any fellow Israelite living in the same community as oneself were one's next door **neighbor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#6)

אֶת־רֵעֵ֥הוּ וְאֶת־אָחִ֖יו

“his neighbor and his brother”

Here the terms **neighbor** and **brother** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [his fellow Israelite]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#7)

אָחִ֖יו

“his brother”

Moses is using the term **brother** to describe people who are descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:2 (#8)

כִּי־קָרָ֥א שְׁמִטָּ֖ה לַיהוָֽה

“because the remission of Yahweh has been proclaimed”

The expression **has been proclaimed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [because Yahweh has commanded you to void debts]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 15:3 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר יִהְיֶ֛ה לְךָ֖ אֶת־אָחִ֥יךָ

“and what is yours {with} your brother”

By **what is yours with your brother** Moses means “what your brother owes you.” You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and what your brother owes you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:3 (#2)

תַּשְׁמֵ֣ט יָדֶ֑ךָ

“your hand shall release”

Moses is using **your hand shall release** as a common expression of his culture to mean “forgive the debts owed to you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must forgive whatever he owes]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:4 (#1)

אֶ֗פֶס כִּֽי־לֹ֤א יִהְיֶה־בְּךָ֙ אֶבְי֔וֹן

“However, there should be no poor among you”

Moses is describing a possible condition in which Yahweh will bless them and there will be no more poor among them only if they listen and keep his commandments. The condition is stated in the next verse. It may be helpful to combine these verses and reorder the clauses so that the conditional statement is clear as is modeled in the UST.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 15:4 (#2)

אֶבְי֔וֹן

“poor”

Moses is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean poor people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [destitute ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 15:4 (#3)

בָּרֵ֣ךְ יְבָרֶכְךָ֔ יְהוָ֖ה

“blessing, Yahweh will bless you”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **bless** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will surely bless you]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:4 (#4)

בָּאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁר֩ יְהוָ֨ה אֱלֹהֶ֜יךָ נֹתֵ֧ן־לְךָ֛ נַחֲלָ֖ה לְרִשְׁתָּֽהּ

“in the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you {as} an inheritance, to possess it”

The expression **in the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you as an inheritance, to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [in the land that he is giving to you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 15:4 (#5)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 15:5 (#1)

שָׁמוֹעַ תִּשְׁמַע

“listening, you listen”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **listen** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [you indeed listen]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:5 (#2)

תִּשְׁמַע

“you listen”

See how you translated “listen” in 11:13.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:5 (#3)

בְּקוֹל

“to the voice of”

Here, **voice** represents the words that Yahweh spoke, which include his commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the commands of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:5 (#4)

אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ

“I am commanding you”

Although Moses says **I am commanding**, he is telling the Israelites the commands from Yahweh. Yahweh is the original source of the commands. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I am commanding you on his behalf]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:6 (#1)

דִּבֶּר

“he spoke”

Here, **spoke** means “promised.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:6 (#2)

וְהַעֲבַטְתָּ֣ & וְאַתָּה֮ לֹ֣א תַעֲבֹֽט

“you will lend to & and you, you will not borrow”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The fact that Moses is talking about money is implied from the context. Alternate translation: [you will lend money to … and you yourself will not borrow money]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 15:6 (#3)

וְאַתָּה֮ לֹ֣א תַעֲבֹֽט

“and you, you will not borrow”

Moses is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you will not borrow** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that others will borrow, but not God’s people. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [and you indeed will not borrow] or [and you yourselves will not borrow]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 15:6 (#4)

גּוֹיִם & בְּגוֹיִם רַבִּים

“nations & over many nations”

Here the word **nations** represents the people living in those nations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [peoples ... over many peoples]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#1)

כִּי

“If”

Here Moses is describing a possible condition in which the Israelites should not harden their hearts if there are poor people among them. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [In the case that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#2)

כִּי־יִהְיֶה֨ בְךָ֜ אֶבְי֗וֹן

“If there is poor among you”

Moses is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean a poor person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [If there is any needy person among you] or [If there is among you a poor person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#3)

אַחֶ֙יךָ֙ & מֵאָחִ֣יךָ הָאֶבְיוֹן

“your brothers & from your poor brother”

Moses is speaking as if the poor man were an actual **brother** of the Israelites he’s addressing. He is using the term to mean a descendant of the same ancestor. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your fellow countrymen ... from your poor fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#4)

שְׁעָרֶ֔יךָ

“your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [your communities]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#5)

לֹ֥א תְאַמֵּ֖ץ אֶת־לְבָבְךָ֑

“do not harden your heart”

Moses is using **harden your heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “be cruel.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must not be hard-hearted] or [you must not be cruel]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#6)

וְלֹ֣א תִקְפֹּ֔ץ אֶת־יָדְךָ֖ מֵאָחִ֥יךָ הָאֶבְיֽוֹן

“and do not shut your hand from your poor brother”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **shut**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [and you must open your hand to your poor brother]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 15:7 (#7)

וְלֹ֣א תִקְפֹּ֔ץ אֶת־יָדְךָ֖

“and do not shut your hand”

Moses is using **shut your hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean “be stingy.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you must not be stingy] or [and do not hold back assistance]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:8 (#1)

כִּי

“but”

Moses uses the word **but** here to indicate a strong contrast between what an Israelite should and should not do to a poor fellow Israelite. In your translation,

indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [rather]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 15:8 (#2)

פָּתֹחְתַּ֤ח תִּפְתַּ֙ח

“opening, you shall open”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **open** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [you must surely open]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:8 (#3)

תִּפְתַּ֙ח אֶת־יָדְךָ֔

“you shall open your hand”

Moses is using **open your hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean “give generously.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must give freely]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:8 (#4)

וְהַעֲבֵט֙ תַּעֲבִיטֶ֔נּוּ

“and lending, you shall lend him”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **lend** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [and you shall surely lend him] or [and you must surely lend him]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:8 (#5)

מַחְסֹרוֹ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יֶחְסַ֔ר לֽוֹ

“for} his need that he has need”

The expression **his need that he has need** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [for whatever he needs]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#1)

פֶּן־יִהְיֶ֣ה

“lest there be”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [so that you will not have]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#2)

פֶּן־יִהְיֶ֣ה דָבָר֮ עִם־לְבָבְךָ֣ בְלִיַּ֣עַל

“lest there be a wicked matter in your heart”

Here the **heart** represents a person’s thoughts. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [lest you think of a wicked matter]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#3)

יִהְיֶ֣ה דָבָר֮ עִם־לְבָבְךָ֣ בְלִיַּ֣עַל לֵאמֹ֒ר קָרְבָ֤ה שְׁנַת־הַשֶּׁ֙בַע֙ שְׁנַ֣ת הַשְּׁמִטָּ֔ה

“there be a wicked matter in your heart, saying, ‘The seventh year, the year of remission, {is} near”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [you remember that the seventh year, the year of remission, is near and you think of a wicked matter]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#4)

לֵאמֹ֒ר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces someone’s thoughts. Consider natural ways of doing that in your own language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#5)

קָרְבָה שְׁנַת־הַשֶּׁבַע שְׁנַת הַשְּׁמִטָּה

“The seventh year, the year of remission, {is} near”

It is implied that someone would be reluctant to lend money because they might have to cancel the debt at the year of remission before the debtor pays it back. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The seventh year, the year of remission, is near, and I might have to cancel debts owed to me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#6)

שְׁנַת־הַשֶּׁבַע

“The seventh year”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **The seventh year**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [Year seven]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#7)

הַשְּׁמִטָּה

“remission”

The implication is that the **remission** is a cancelation of debts. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [loan cancelation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#8)

וְרָעָעָה עֵינְךָ

“and you do wrong in your eyes”

Moses is using **do wrong in your eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “act in a hostile way.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you act with hostility]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#9)

בְּאָחִיךָ הָאֶבְיוֹן

“against your poor brother”

Moses is speaking as if the poor man were an actual **brother** of the Israelites he’s addressing. He is using the term to mean a descendant of the same ancestor. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against your poor fellow countryman]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#10)

וְקָרָא עָלֶיךָ אֶל־יְהוָה

“and he calls out to Yahweh about you”

The implication is that the poor Israelite will complain to Yahweh about the Israelite’s lack of generosity. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he complains to Yahweh that you did not help him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:9 (#11)

וְהָיָה בְךָ חֵטְא

“and it would be sin for you”

The implication is that Yahweh would condemn the Israelite for his lack of generosity. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will condemn your actions as sin]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:10 (#1)

נָתֹתָן תִּתֵּן

“Giving, you shall give”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **give** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must surely give]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:10 (#2)

וְלֹא־יֵרַע לְבָבְךָ

“and your heart shall not do evil”

Here the **heart** represents where a person’s desires exist. You may have a comparable expression in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly.

Alternate translation: [and you shall not desire to do evil] or [and you shall not give reluctantly]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:10 (#3)

וּבְכֹל֙ מִשְׁלַ֣ח יָדֶ֔ךָ

“and in all the sending out of your hand”

Moses is using **the sending out of your hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the results of your hard work.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and in all the fruits of your labor] or [and in all the results of your hard work]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#1)

לֹא־יֶחְדַּ֥ל אֶבְיוֹן֙ מִקֶּ֣רֶב הָאָ֔רֶץ

“the poor will not cease to be among the land”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative verb **cease**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [the poor will live among you continually]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#2)

אֶבְיוֹן֙

“the poor”

Moses is using the adjective **poor** as a noun to mean poor people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [needy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#3)

אָנֹכִ֞י מְצַוְּךָ֣ לֵאמֹ֗ר פָּתֹ֤חַ תִּפְתַּח֙ אֶת־יָדְךָ֔ לְאָחִ֥יךָ לַעֲנִיֶּ֖ךָ וּלְאֶבְיֹנְךָ֑ בְּאַרְצֶֽךָ

“I command you, saying, ‘Opening, you shall open your hand to your brother, to your needy, and to your poor in your land”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [I command you to open your hand to your brother, to your needy, and to your poor in your land]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#4)

לֵאמֹ֑ר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#5)

פָּתֹ֤חַ תִּפְתַּח֙

“Opening, you shall open”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **open** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must surely open]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#6)

פָּתֹ֤חַ תִּפְתַּח֙ אֶת־יָדְךָ֔

“Opening, you shall open your hand”

Here, **open your hand** means “give generously.” Moses is speaking of opening one’s hand as if one were allowing other people to take whatever they wanted from oneself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Eagerly offer help]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#7)

לְאָחִ֥יךָ

“to your brother”

Moses is speaking as if the poor man were an actual **brother** of the Israelites he is addressing. He is using the term to mean a descendant of the same ancestor. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to your poor fellow countryman]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#8)

לְאָחִיךָ֙ לַעֲנִיֶּ֔ךָ וּלְאֶבְיֹנְךָ֖

“to your brother, to your needy, and to your poor”

Moses is not distinguishing between **your brother**, **your needy**, and **your poor** as separate groups of people. Moses is referring to Israelites who are poor or needy. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [to your brother who is needy and poor]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#9)

לַעֲנִיֶּ֔ךָ וּלְאֶבְיֹנְךָ֖

“to your needy, and to your poor”

The terms **needy** and **poor** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to the ones who are in need]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 15:11 (#10)

לַעֲנִיֶּ֔ךָ וּלְאֶבְיֹנְךָ֖

“to your needy, and to your poor”

Moses is using the adjectives **needy** and **poor** as nouns to mean needy people and poor people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [to your people who are needy, and to your people who are poor]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 15:12 (#1)

כִּֽי־יִמָּכֵ֨ר לְךָ֜ אָחִ֣יךָ הָעִבְרִ֗י אֹ֚ו הָעִבְרִיָּ֔ה וַעֲבָדְךָ֖ שֵׁ֣שׁ שָׁנִ֑ים וּבַשָּׁנָ֣ה הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔ת תְּשַׁלְּחֶ֥נּוּ

“If your brother, a Hebrew man or a Hebrew woman, is sold to you and serves you six years, then in the seventh year you must send him out”

Moses is describing a possible condition in which an Israelite must free a Hebrew man or woman who was sold to him. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Suppose your brother, a Hebrew man or Hebrew woman, is sold to you and serves you six years, then in the seventh year you must send him out]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 15:12 (#2)

יִמָּכֵ֨ר לְךָ֜ אָחִ֣יךָ הָעִבְרִ֗י אֹ֚ו הָעִבְרִיָּ֔ה

“your brother, a Hebrew man or a Hebrew woman, is sold to you”

The expression **is sold** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [your brother, a Hebrew man or a Hebrew woman, becomes your slave]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 15:12 (#3)

אָחִ֣יךָ

“your brother”

Moses is speaking as if the one being sold were an actual **brother** of the Israelites he is addressing. He is using the term to mean a descendant of the same ancestor. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your fellow countryman]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:12 (#4)

יִמָּכֵ֨ר לְךָ֜

“is sold to you”

When someone could not pay their debts, he or she would sell himself or herself to work for their creditor to pay back their debt. See the introduction to this chapter for more information on Israelite slaves. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [is sold to you to pay his debt]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:12 (#5)

וּבַשָּׁנָ֣ה הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔ת

“then in the seventh year”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the seventh year**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [then in year seven]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 15:13 (#1)

לֹ֥א תְשַׁלְּחֶ֖נּוּ רֵיקָֽם

“you must not send him emptily”

Moses is speaking of a person who has no possessions as if he were an empty container. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must not let him leave without provisions]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:13 (#2)

לֹ֥א תְשַׁלְּחֶ֖נּוּ רֵיקָֽם

“you must not send him emptily”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative adverb **emptily**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [you must send him with provisions]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 15:14 (#1)

הַעֲנֵ֤יק תַּעֲנִיק֙

“Providing, you shall liberally provide”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **provide** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [You must very liberally provide]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 15:14 (#2)

וּמִגָּרְנְךָ֔

“and from your threshing floor”

Here, **threshing floor** represents grain for food since grain was separated from the plant on the threshing floor in order to prepare it to be eaten. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and from your grain]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:14 (#3)

וּמִיִּקְבֶ֑ךָ

“and from your winepress”

Here, **winepress** represents wine made from pressing the juice out of grapes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and from your wine]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:14 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר בֵּרַכְךָ֖ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“As Yahweh your God has blessed you”

The implication is that Yahweh is the one who enabled the Israelites to have sheep, grain, and wine, so they should do with them as Yahweh commands here. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has enabled you to have these possessions, so in proportion to what you have] or [Yahweh has enabled you to have these possessions, so to the degree that he has blessed you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:16 (#1)

יֹאמַ֣ר אֵלֶ֔יךָ לֹ֥א אֵצֵ֖א מֵעִמָּֽךְ

“he says to you, ‘I will not go from you”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [he does not want to go from you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 15:16 (#2)

בֵּיתֶ֑ךָ

“your house”

Here, **house** represents the other people living in the owner’s house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your family]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:16 (#3)

טָ֥וֹב לוֹ֙ עִמָּ֔ךְ

“it is} good for him {to be} with you”

The implication is that it is **good** for the slave to be with the owner because the owner allows him to have a good life. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his life has been good while he has lived with you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:17 (#1)

וְלָקַחְתָּ֤ אֶת־הַמַּרְצֵ֙עַ֙ וְנָתַתָּ֣ה בְאָזְנוֹ֔ וּבַדֶּ֖לֶת

“then you shall take an awl and put {it} through his ear and to the door”

Piercing a slave’s ear against the door of their master’s house was a symbolic action by which the master showed that the person whose ear they were piercing would be their slave for life. (The **ear** was significant because it symbolized obedience since it was with their ears that a slave would hear their master’s commands. The **door** was significant because it represented the master’s household to which the slave now belonged for life. The hole in the servant’s ear would be a life long visible symbol that the servant belonged to their master.) If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in a footnote.

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 15:17 (#2)

אֶת־הַמַּרְצֵ֑עַ

“an awl”

An **awl** is a sharp, pointed tool, usually made out of metal for making holes. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of tool, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a sharp tool]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 15:17 (#3)

עוֹלָ֔ם

“forever”

Here Moses is speaking of someone’s lifespan as if it were **forever**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until he dies]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:17 (#4)

וְאַ֥ף לַאֲמָתְךָ֖ תַּעֲשֶׂה־כֵּֽן

“And also you shall do thus to your female slave”

The implication is that the owner must **also** pierce a female servant’s ear if she wants to stay with him and his family. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And if any of your female servants wants to stay with you, you shall also pierce her ear and let her be your slave for the rest of her life]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:18 (#1)

לֹא־יִקְשֶׁ֥ה בְעֵינֶ֖ךָ

“It must not seem difficult in your eyes”

Moses is using **in your eyes** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in your judgment” or “in your opinion.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the related phrase “in the eyes of.” Alternate translation: [Do not think of it as a hardship] or [Do not consider it troublesome]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:18 (#2)

בְּשַׁלֵּחֲךָ֥ אֹתְוֹ֛ חָפְשִׁ֖י מֵעִמָּ֑ךְ

“when you send him out free from you”

Alternate translation: [for you to liberate him]

Deuteronomy 15:18 (#3)

כִּ֚י מִשְׁנֶ֣ה׀ שְׂכַ֣ר שָׂכִ֗יר עָבָ֙דְךָ֙ שֵׁ֣שׁ שָׁנִ֔ים

“for double the wage of a hired man he has served you six years”

The implication is that a slave would work approximately twice the amount of time as **a hired man** since **a hired man** would only work the agreed upon hours in a day but a slave would be available any time their master needed them, thus making their work worth **double the wage of a hired man**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for during the six years he has served you, his work has been worth twice the value of a hired man] or [because his six years of service to you were worth twice the wages of a hired man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:18 (#4)

וּבֵרַכְךָ֣ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“And Yahweh your God will bless you”

Moses is saying that if the Israelites obey the commands about freeing slaves without complaining, then Yahweh will bless them as a result. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a connecting word to show how this statement relates to what came before it. Use a natural form in your language for connecting this statement to the previous one. Alternate translation: [If you do that, Yahweh your God will bless you]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 15:19 (#1)

כָּל־הַבְּכֹר֩ אֲשֶׁר֙ יִוָּלֵ֣ד בִּבְקָרְךָ֔ וּבְצֹאנְךָ֖ הַזָּכָ֑ר תַּקְדִּ֣ישׁ לַיהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“All the firstborn that are born in your herd and your flock, you shall sanctify the males to Yahweh your God”

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to Yahweh’s command described in Exodus 13:2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:19 (#2)

לֹ֥א תַעֲבֹ֖ד בִּבְכֹ֣ר שׁוֹרֶ֑ךָ

“You shall not work with the firstborn of your herd”

The implication is that the Israelites could not use the firstborn male animals to pull plows in their fields. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Do not use the firstborn male animals from your herd to plow your fields]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:20 (#1)

שָׁנָ֣ה בְשָׁנָ֔ה

“year by year”

Moses is using **year by year** as a common expression of his culture to mean “every year.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [every year]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 15:20 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:20 (#3)

וּבֵיתֶֽךָ

“and your house”

Here, **house** represents all of the people living in the house. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your household]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 15:21 (#1)

וְכִֽי־יִהְיֶ֥ה בֹ֛ו מ֖וּם פִּסֵּ֣חַ אֹ֑ו עִוֵּ֣ר כֹּ֔ל מ֥וּם רָ֖ע לֹ֣א תִזְבָּחֶ֑נּוּ

“And if it has on it a blemish (lame or blind, any severe blemish), you must not sacrifice it”

Moses is giving instructions for what the Israelites should do in the possible situation of an animal having a blemish should occur. Use a connector that makes it clear that this is what to do if a condition happens. Alternate translation: [And if it has on it a blemish (lame or blind, any severe blemish), then you must not sacrifice it] or [Suppose it has on it a blemish (lame or blind, any severe blemish). In that case, you must not sacrifice it]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 15:21 (#2)

יִהְיֶ֥ה בֹּ֛ו

“it has on it”

The pronoun **it** refers to a firstborn male domesticated animal. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the firstborn male animal has]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 15:21 (#3)

יִהְיֶ֥ה בֹּ֛ו מ֖וּם

“it has on it a blemish”

The expression **it has on it a blemish** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you

could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [it has a blemish]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 15:22 (#1)

תֹּאכְלֶֽנּוּ

“You shall eat it”

The pronoun **it** refers to a firstborn male domesticated animal that has a physical defect. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [You shall eat the animal that has a blemish]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 15:22 (#2)

בִּשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 12:15.

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 15:22 (#3)

הַטָּמֵא וְהַטָּהוֹר יַחְדָּו

“the unclean and the clean alike”

See how you translated the phrase “the unclean and the clean alike” in 12:22. Alternate translation: [everyone, whether or not they are ceremonially clean]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 15:22 (#4)

הַטָּמֵא וְהַטָּהוֹר

“the unclean and the clean”

Moses is using the adjectives **unclean** and **clean** as nouns to refer to people and their ceremonial purity. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who are ceremonially unclean and people who are ceremonially clean]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 15:22 (#5)

כַּצְּבִי

“as a gazelle”

The implication is that the Israelites could eat a firstborn male that has a blemish, just as they would eat wild animals (which are not used in sacrifices). You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [as you are allowed to eat a wild animal like a gazelle]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 15:22 (#6)

כַּצְּבִי

“as a gazelle”

See how you translated “gazelle” and “deer” in 12:15.

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 15:23 (#1)

רַק

“Only”

Moses uses the word **Only** here to indicate a strong contrast between which parts of the animals that the Israelites could and could not eat. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Except]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 15:23 (#2)

אֶת־דָּמוֹ לֹא תֹאכֵל עַל־הָאָרֶץ תִּשְׁפְּכֶנּוּ כַּמָּֽיִם

“you shall not eat its blood; you shall pour it on the ground like water”

See how you translated the similar sentence in 12:16.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy - Chapter 16 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Instructions for the Festival of the Passover (1–8)
2. Instructions for the Festival of the Harvest (9–12)
3. Instructions for the Feast of Huts (13–17)
4. Administration of justice (18–20)
5. Asherah poles and pillars forbidden (21–22)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Feasts

This chapter gives instructions for the feasts that Yahweh commanded the Israelites to celebrate. The Passover feast represents the time when the Israelites

escaped from Egypt. There are several other important festivals described in this chapter. (See: Passover)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular and plural
Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you" and "your." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

"the place that Yahweh will choose"
Moses uses phrases such as this to refer to the future place where the temple will be built. These phrases emphasize that Yahweh will be the one who decides where the Israelites will build his temple as well as how they will worship him. (See: temple, house, house of God)

"the place that Yahweh will choose to make his name stay"
In 16:2, 16:6 and 16:11 the author uses God's name to represent his reputation and presence. The phrase "the place that Yahweh will choose to make his name stay" indicates that God would choose a place and make his presence and reputation stay there. That place would be the future temple. (See: Metonymy)

Deuteronomy 16:1 (#1)

שָׁמוֹר

"Keeping"

The implication is that the Israelites must **keep** "the month of Aviv" by celebrating the Festival of the Passover during that month. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Celebrate]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:1 (#2)

אֶת־הַחֹדֶשׁ הָאָבִיב

"the month of Aviv"

Aviv is the first month of the Hebrew calendar and includes parts of March and April on western calendars. You could convert the Hebrew day and month into an approximate date on the calendar that your culture uses. However, the Jews used a lunar calendar, so if you use a solar calendar, the date will be different every year and the translation will not be entirely accurate. So you may just want to give the name of the month on the Hebrew calendar, and say approximately what time of year that is on your calendar in a footnote.

See: Hebrew Months

Deuteronomy 16:1 (#3)

וְעָשִׂיתָ

"and you shall make"

Here, **make** means "celebrate" or "observe." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you shall celebrate]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 16:1 (#4)

לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ & יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

"to Yahweh your God & Yahweh your God"

See how you translated the similar phrase "Yahweh your God" in 1:10. Alternate translation: [to Yahweh, the God we worship, ... Yahweh our God]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 16:1 (#5)

כִּי בְחֹדֶשׁ הָאָבִיב הוֹצִיאֲךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מִמִּצְרַיִם לָיְלָה

"for in the month of Aviv, Yahweh your God brought you out from Egypt {by} night"

You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 12.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:1 (#6)

הוֹצִיאֲךָ

"brought you out"

In a context such as this, your language might say "took" instead of **brought**. Alternate translation: [took you out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 16:2 (#1)

פֶּסַח

"the Passover"

Here, **the Passover** represents the animal that the Israelites sacrificed for the Festival of the Passover. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the

meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the animal for the Passover]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:2 (#2)

לַיהוָֽה

“to Yahweh”

The implication is that the Passover sacrifice was for honoring **Yahweh**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [for the honor of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:2 (#3)

צֹ֚אן וּבָקָ֔ר

“the flock and the herd”

Here, **the flock and the herd** represent the animals sacrificed for the Festival of the Passover. Yahweh commanded each Israelite family to sacrifice a male lamb or goat without blemish during the sacrifice in Numbers 9 and Exodus 12. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [one male from the flock or the herd from each of your families]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:2 (#4)

בַּמָּקוֹם֙ אֲשֶׁר־יִבְחַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה לְשַׁכֵּ֥ן שְׁמ֖וֹ שָֽׁם

“in the place that Yahweh will choose to make his name stay there”

This phrase contains extra information that may be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [in the place that Yahweh will choose to make his name stay]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 16:2 (#5)

לְשַׁכֵּ֥ן שְׁמ֖וֹ שָֽׁם

“to make his name stay there”

See the discussion of the similar phrase “the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated the expression “to make his name stay there” in 12:11. Alternate translation: [for his presence to be] or [for you to come into his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:3 (#1)

עָלָ֖יו

“with it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the animal for the Passover sacrifice. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [with the sacrifice]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 16:3 (#2)

עָלָ֑יו

“on it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the Feast of Unleavened Bread, which is the part of the Festival of the Passover that follows the Passover sacrifice. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [during the Feast of Unleavened Bread]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 16:3 (#3)

עָלָ֖יו מַצּ֥וֹת לֶ֛חֶם עֹ֖נִי

“unleavened bread on it, the bread of affliction”

Here, **bread of affliction** refers to **unleavened bread**. It does not refer to another type of bread that the Israelites should eat. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [unleavened bread, which is the bread of affliction]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 16:3 (#4)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [this is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 16:3 (#5)

יָצָ֣אתָ

“you came out”

In a context such as this, your language might say "went" instead of **came**. Alternate translation: [you went out]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 16:3 (#6)

בְּחִפָּזוֹן יָצָאתָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם

"you came out from the land of Egypt in haste"

The implication is that the Israelites had to leave Egypt so quickly that they did not have enough time to make bread with yeast in it, because bread with yeast takes time to rise. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you could not wait for bread with yeast to rise because you had to escape Egypt so fast]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:4 (#1)

וְלֹא־יֵרָאֶה לְךָ שְׂאֹר

"And no yeast shall be seen among you"

The expression **be seen** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And remove any yeast that you have]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 16:4 (#2)

יֵרָאֶה

"shall be seen"

Here Moses is using the expression **be seen** to mean "be present." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [shall be present]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:4 (#3)

וְלֹא־יָלִין מִן־הַבָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר תִּזְבַּח בָּעֶרֶב בַּיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן לַבֹּקֶר

"and nothing from the meat that you sacrifice in the evening on the first day shall remain until the morning"

The implication is that the Israelites must eat all the meat from the Passover sacrifice in the same evening that they sacrifice it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you must eat all of the meat that you sacrifice in the evening on that day]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:4 (#4)

בַּיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן

"on the first day"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the first day**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [of day one]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 16:5 (#1)

אֶת־הַפֶּסַח

"the Passover"

Here, **Passover** represents the animal that the Israelites sacrificed for the Festival of the Passover. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the animal for the Passover]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:5 (#2)

בְּאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ

"within any of your gates"

Here, **gates** represents the borders of the towns in the land of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [within any of your towns]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 16:5 (#3)

בְּאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ

"within any of your gates"

Moses is not saying that they cannot sacrifice in any town but rather that they should not sacrifice in any town other than the one that Yahweh will choose as he explains in the next verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [within just any of your towns]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:6 (#1)

הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay there”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 16:2. For more information, see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to this chapter.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 16:6 (#2)

לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to make his name stay there”

See the discussion of the similar phrase “the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated the expression “to make his name stay there” in 12:11. Alternate translation: [for his presence to be] or [for you to come into his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:6 (#3)

אֶת־הַפֶּסַח

“the Passover”

Here, **Passover** represents the animal that the Israelites sacrifice for the Festival of the Passover. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the animal for the Passover]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:7 (#1)

וּבִשַּׁלְתָּ֖ וְאָכַלְתָּ֑

“And you shall cook and eat”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the previous verse if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And you shall cook the meat and eat it]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 16:7 (#2)

בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בּוֹ

“in the place which Yahweh your God will choose it”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 16:2. For more information, see the discussion of this phrase in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [in the place which Yahweh your God will choose]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 16:8 (#1)

וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי

“and on the seventh day”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the seventh year**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [and on day seven]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 16:9 (#1)

חֶרְמֵשׁ בַּקָּמָה

“the sickle on the grain”

Moses is using **the sickle on the grain** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the time of harvest.” A **sickle** is a sharp tool used for cutting grain. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [harvesting time]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 16:10 (#1)

נִדְבַת יָדְךָ אֲשֶׁר תִּתֵּן

“a freewill offering of your hand that you shall give”

Here, **hand** represents how a person could carry or bring something. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that you bring] Alternate translation: [a freewill offering that you personally bring to give]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 16:10 (#2)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“as Yahweh your God has blessed you”

The implication is that Yahweh blesses the Israelites by causing their grain to grow. Thus, the Israelites must offer a portion of grain that reflects how much grain Yahweh blessed them with. See how you translated the identical phrase in 15:14. Alternate transla-

tion: [according to the amount of grain that Yahweh your God blessed you with by causing it to grow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:11 (#1)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:11 (#2)

וּבִנְךָ֣ וּבִתֶּ֔ךָ וְעַבְדְּךָ֥ וַאֲמָתֶ֖ךָ וְהַלֵּוִ֑י & וְהַגֵּ֣ר וְהַיָּת֔וֹם וְהָאַלְמָנָ֖ה

“and your son and your daughter and your male servant and your female servant and the Levite & and the foreigner and the fatherless and the widow”

These terms do not refer to a specific person. These terms represent these categories of people in general. Alternate translation: [and any of your sons, daughters, male servants, females servants, or any Levite ... and any foreigners, fatherless, or widows]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 16:11 (#3)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֑יךָ

“is} within your gates”

Here, **gates** represents the entire community who lives inside the gates. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [is within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:11 (#4)

בַּמָּקוֹם֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יִבְחַר֒ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ לְשַׁכֵּ֥ן שְׁמ֖וֹ שָׁ֑ם

“in the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay there”

See how you translated the similar phrase in 16:2.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 16:11 (#5)

לְשַׁכֵּ֥ן שְׁמ֖וֹ שָׁ֑ם

“to make his name stay there”

See the discussion of the similar phrase “the place that Yahweh your God will choose to make his name stay,” in the introduction to this chapter. See how you translated the expression “to make his name stay there” in 12:11. Alternate translation: [for his presence to be] or [for you to come into his presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:13 (#1)

מִגָּרְנְךָ֖ וּמִיִּקְבֶֽךָ

“from your threshing floor and from your winepress”

See how you translated “from your threshing floor and from your winepress” in 15:14 where the terms **threshing floor** and **winepress** are used with the same meanings.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:14 (#1)

וּבִנְךָ֣ וּבִתֶּ֔ךָ וְעַבְדְּךָ֥ וַאֲמָתֶ֖ךָ וְהַלֵּוִ֑י וְהַגֵּ֣ר וְהַיָּת֔וֹם וְהָאַלְמָנָ֖ה

“and your son and your daughter and your male servant and your female servant and the Levite and the foreigner and the fatherless and the widow”

These terms do not refer to a specific person. These terms represent these categories of people in general. Alternate translation: [and any of your sons, daughters, male servants, female servants, Levites, foreigners, fatherless, or widows]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 16:14 (#2)

בִּשְׁעָרֶֽיךָ

“are} within your gates”

Here, **gates** represents the entire community who lives inside the gates. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are in your communities]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:15 (#1)

וּבְכֹל֙ מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה יָדֶ֔ךָ

“and in all the work of your hands”

Moses is using one part of a person, the **hands**, to represent all of a person in the act of working. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and in all of your own work]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 16:16 (#1)

כָּל־זְכוּרְךָ

“all your males”

Here, **males** refer to any adult man, 20 years and older. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [all your adult men]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:16 (#2)

אֶת־פְּנֵי & אֶת־פְּנֵי

“to the face of & to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of ... in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:16 (#3)

וְלֹא יֵרָאֶה אֶת־פְּנֵי יְהוָה רֵיקָם

“And he shall not appear to the face of Yahweh emptily”

This is a double negative, consisting of the negative particle **not** and the negative word **emptily**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a positive expression to translate this. Alternate translation: [And they must bring an offering to the face of Yahweh]

See: Double Negatives

Deuteronomy 16:17 (#1)

אִישׁ

“every} man”

The word **man** represents all adult Israelite men in general, not one particular man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [each man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 16:17 (#2)

כְּמַתְּנַת יָדוֹ

“according to the giving of his hand”

Moses is using one part of a person, the **hand**, to represent all of a person in the act of giving an offering. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what he himself gives]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 16:17 (#3)

כְּבִרְכַּת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן־לָךְ

“according to the blessing of Yahweh your God that he has given to you”

The implication is that Yahweh blesses the Israelites by causing their crops and flocks to be healthy and produce. Thus, the Israelites must offer a portion of their produce that reflects how much Yahweh blessed them with. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [according to the amount of produce that Yahweh your God blessed you with by causing it to grow]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:18 (#1)

תִּתֶּן־לְךָ

“You shall set for yourself”

Here, **set** means “appoint.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall designate for yourself] or [You shall select for yourself]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:18 (#2)

בְּכָל־שְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within all your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [within each of your communities]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 16:18 (#3)

לִשְׁבָטֶיךָ

“from your tribes”

The implication is that each of the 12 tribes of Israel will have judges and officers. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from each of your tribes]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:18 (#4)

מִשְׁפַּט־צֶדֶק

“with} righteous judgment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [justly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#1)

לֹא־תַטֶּה מִשְׁפָּט

“You shall not twist a judgment”

Here Moses is speaking of **a judgment** as if it were a physical object that one could **twist**. He means that people should not change evidence in order to favor a certain outcome. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall not act unjustly when you make a decision]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#2)

מִשְׁפָּט

“a judgment”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the decision of a legal case]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#3)

לֹא תַכִּיר פָּנִים

“you shall not recognize a face”

Moses is using **recognize a face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “show partiality.” See how you translated the same phrase in 1:17. Alternate translation: [you shall not play favorites] or [you shall not show partiality]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#4)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#5)

יְעַוֵּר עֵינֵי חֲכָמִים

“blinds the eyes of the wise”

Here Moses is speaking of a **wise** person making an unjust **judgment** as if the **bribe blinds** his **eyes** to the injustice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causes a wise person to overlook what is right]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#6)

וְיסַלֵּף דִּבְרֵי צַדִּיקִם

“and perverts the words of the righteous”

The phrase **perverts the words of the righteous** could mean (1) that a bribe causes a judge to pervert the words of righteous people and wrongly misrepresent what they said or did and therefore make an unfair and unjust decision. Alternate translation: [and causes a judge to wrongly misrepresent the words of the righteous]. Or it could mean (2) that a bribe causes a judge to make an unjust decision regarding the cause of righteous people (in this interpretation the original language word that the ULT translates as **the words** would be translated as “the matters” or “the cause”). Alternate translation: [and causes a judge to make an unjust decision regarding the cause of the righteous]. Or it could mean (3) that a bribe causes an otherwise righteous judge to make an unrighteous and unjust decision. Alternate translation: [and causes the righteous to make wrong decisions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:19 (#7)

חֲכָמִים & צַדִּיקִם

“the wise & the righteous”

Moses is using the adjectives **wise** and **righteous** as nouns to mean wise people and righteous people.

Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [wise people ... righteous people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 16:20 (#1)

צֶ֣דֶק צֶ֔דֶק

“Righteousness, righteousness”

Moses is repeating the noun **righteousness** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Righteousness, only righteousness]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 16:20 (#2)

צֶ֣דֶק צֶ֔דֶק תִּרְדֹּ֑ף

“Righteousness, righteousness you shall pursue”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [You shall only judge righteously]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 16:20 (#3)

צֶ֣דֶק צֶ֔דֶק תִּרְדֹּ֑ף

“Righteousness, righteousness you shall pursue”

Here Moses is speaking of **righteousness** as if it were something a person could run after or **pursue**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall only make fair decisions]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 16:22 (#1)

מַצֵּבָ֑ה

“a pillar”

The people groups in the land built stone pillars as symbols of their god Baal. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a sacred stone pillar]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 16:22 (#2)

מַצֵּבָ֑ה

“a pillar”

The word **pillar** represents pillars for idols in general, not one particular pillar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [any pillars]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 16:22 (#3)

מַצֵּבָ֑ה אֲשֶׁ֥ר שָׂנֵ֖א יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ׃

“a pillar, which Yahweh your God hates”

Moses is not distinguishing this **pillar, which Yahweh your God hates** from other pillars used for idol worship that Yahweh does not hate. He is stating that Yahweh hates all idol worship. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [a pillar because Yahweh your God hates those]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy - Chapter 17 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. More instructions for animals for sacrifice (1)
2. Punishments for Israelites who worship idols (2–7)
3. Instructions for difficult legal cases (8–13)
4. Instructions for kings (14–20)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Witnesses

In the ancient Near East, it was common for a person to be punished by the testimony of a single person, especially if this was an important person. The rules in this chapter give protection to people, especially the poor by requiring multiple witnesses. This allowed justice to be done. (See: testimony, testify, witness, eyewitness, evidence; and just, justice, unjust, injustice, justify, justification)

King

Israel was not to have a king because Yahweh was their king. Knowing the sinfulness of the people, Yahweh anticipated that one day Israel would have a king. Therefore, this passage gives commands about their king prophetically. They were not allowed to collect chariots because they were a sign of earthly power and the king was to trust in Yahweh. (See:

prophet, prophecy, prophesy, seer, prophetess; sign, proof, reminder; and trust, trusted, trustworthy, trustworthiness)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular and plural
Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Generic nouns used in hypothetical conditions
Verses 2–13 give examples of sins that an Israelite might commit when they are living in the land and instructions for deciding what should happen. In these hypothetical conditions, singular nouns like "man," "woman," and "judge" represent those people in general, not a specific man or woman whom Moses is predicting will commit a sin. If it would be helpful in your language, you could clarify that these terms refer to any person who fulfills the hypothetical situation. (See: Generic Noun Phrases; and Connect — Hypothetical Conditions)

Deuteronomy 17:1 (#1)

לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ & יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

"to Yahweh your God & to Yahweh your God"

See how you translated the phrase "Yahweh your God" in 1:10. Alternate translation: [to the Yahweh, the God we worship, ... to Yahweh our God]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 17:1 (#2)

שׁוֹר וָשֶׂה

"an ox or a sheep"

Here, **ox** and **sheep** represent those animals in general, not one specific ox or sheep. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use more natural expressions. Alternate translation: [any ox or any sheep]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 17:1 (#3)

כִּי

"for"

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 17:1 (#4)

הִוא

"it"

The pronoun **it** refers to a sacrifice that has a blemish. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [a blemished sacrifice]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 17:2 (#1)

כִּי

"if"

Moses is describing a possible condition in which the people are to follow the instructions that begin in verse 5 only if the events described in verses 2–4 occur first. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [In the case that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 17:2 (#2)

יִמָּצֵא

"there} is found"

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [there is anyone]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 17:2 (#3)

בְּאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ

"in any of your gates"

See how you translated the similar phrase "within your gates" in 5:14. Alternate translation: [in any of your communities]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 17:2 (#4)

בְּעֵינֵי

"in the eyes of"

See how you translated the phrase “in the eyes of” in 4:25. Alternate translation: [according to the judgment of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 17:3 (#1)

וַיֵּ֣לֶךְ

“and he followed”

Moses is speaking of idol worship as if it were a path that one **followed**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he worshiped]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:3 (#2)

צְבָ֣א הַשָּׁמַ֗יִם

“the multitude of the heavens”

Moses is using **the multitude of the heavens** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the stars in the sky.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the celestial bodies in the sky]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 17:3 (#3)

לֹא־צִוִּיתִי

“I have not commanded”

The implication is that Yahweh has **commanded** the Israelites **not** to worship any of the things listed in this verse. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I have forbidden]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:4 (#1)

וְהֻגַּד־לְךָ֖

“and {it} is told to you”

The expression **is told** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and someone tells you about this]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 17:4 (#2)

וְשָׁמָ֥עְתָּ

“and you listen”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and you listen to the account]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 17:4 (#3)

וְהִנֵּ֔ה

“and behold”

Moses is using the term **behold** to focus attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you could use in your translation. Alternate translation: [and indeed]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:4 (#4)

אֱמֶ֤ת נָכוֹן֙ הַדָּבָ֔ר

“the matter {is} an established truth”

This verse introduces the conclusion of the possible condition that Moses began describing in verse 2. The instruction for what they should do if these conditions happen comes in verse 5. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this. Alternate translation: [if you discover that it is true that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 17:4 (#5)

הַדָּבָ֔ר

“the matter”

Here, **the matter** refers to the act of an Israelite worshipping an idol. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [this idol worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:4 (#6)

נֶעֱשְׂתָ֥ה

“has been done”

The expression **been done** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that

is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that someone has done]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#1)

וְהוֹצֵאתָ

“then you shall bring”

This verse gives instructions for what the Israelites should do if the possible situation introduced in verses 2–4 occurs. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the instructions for what to do when a possible situation happens. Alternate translation: [then, if those things happened, you must bring]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#2)

וְהוֹצֵאתָ

“then you shall bring”

In a context such as this, your language might say “take” instead of **bring**. Alternate translation: [then you shall take]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#3)

אֶת־הָאִישׁ הַהוּא אוֹ֙ אֶת־הָאִשָּׁ֔ה הַהִוא֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשׂ֔וּ אֶת־הַדָּבָ֥ר הָרָ֖ע הַזֶּ֑ה אֶל־שְׁעָרֶ֙יךָ֙ אֶת־הָאִ֣ישׁ אוֹ֔ אֶת־הָאִשָּׁ֖ה

“that man or that woman who has done this evil thing to your gates, the man or the woman”

The expression **that man or that woman who has done this evil thing to your gates, the man or the woman** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [that man or that woman who has done this evil thing to your gates]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#4)

אֶת־הַדָּבָ֥ר הָרָ֖ע הַזֶּ֑ה

“this evil thing”

Here, **this evil thing** refers to the act of an Israelite worshipping an idol. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [this evil of idol worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#5)

אֶל־שְׁעָרֶ֙יךָ֙

“to your gates”

Moses assumes that the Israelites will know that **to your gates** means “outside the gates of your city.” (Legal matters were conducted in front of the city gate, in an open square, and if a person was found guilty of an act deserving of stoning, they were stoned outside the city gates.) You could state explicitly that this phrase refers to the guilty person being taken outside of the city gates, if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [outside your city gates] or [outside the gates of your city]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#6)

וּסְקַלְתָּ֥ם בָּאֲבָנִ֖ים

“and you shall stone them with stones”

The expression **stone them with stones** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [and you shall stone them]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 17:5 (#7)

וָמֵֽתוּ

“and they shall die”

The implication is that the Israelites should **stone** the guilty person until that person is dead. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [until they die]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:6 (#1)

עַל־פִּ֣י & עַל־פִּ֔י

“At the mouth of & at the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** represents the words that someone says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [According to the testimony of ... on account of the testimony of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 17:6 (#2)

הַמֻּמָת

“he who is to die”

Here, **he who is to die** refers to the man or woman accused of worshipping an idol. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the accused person] or [the defendant in the case]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:7 (#1)

יַד הָעֵדִים & וְיַד כָּל־הָעָם בָּאַחֲרֹנָה

“The hand of the witnesses & and afterward the hand of all the people”

Moses is using one part of a person, the **hand**, to represent all of a person in the act of stoning someone. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The witnesses … and afterward all the people] or [The witnesses … and afterward all the other people shall stone him]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 17:7 (#2)

תִּהְיֶה־בּוֹ בָרִאשֹׁנָה

“shall be the first on him”

The implication is that the witnesses will be the first to throw stones **on him**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [shall be the first to stone him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:7 (#3)

וְיַד כָּל־הָעָם בָּאַחֲרֹנָה

“and afterward the hand of all the people”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and afterward the hand of all the people shall be second to stone him] or [and afterward the hand of all the other people shall stone him]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 17:7 (#4)

כָּל־הָעָם

“all the people”

Here, **all the people** refers to the rest of the people in the town that the legal case happened in, besides those who brought the charges. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [all the other people in the town]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:7 (#5)

וּבָעַרְתָּ הָרָע מִקִּרְבֶּךָ

“and you shall remove the evil from among you”

See how you translated this same phrase in 13:5.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#1)

בֵּין־דָּם ׀ לְדָם

“between blood and blood”

The implication is that **blood** means “bloodshed,” specifically accidental or purposeful manslaughter. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [between accidental and planned manslaughter]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#2)

בֵּין־דִּין לְדִין

“between a lawsuit and a lawsuit”

The implication is that the judge must decide the outcome of various types of lawsuits. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [between who is right and who is wrong in all types of lawsuits]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#3)

וּבֵין נֶגַע לָנָגַע

“and between an assault and an assault”

Here, **assault** could refer to a case where: (1) one person physically harmed another. Alternate translation: [and who is at fault when someone physically harms another] or (2) one person damages the property of another. Alternate translation: [and who is at fault when someone damages the property of another]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#4)

דִּבְרֵי רִיבֹת

“cases of dispute”

The implication is that there is **dispute** in these **cases** as to what actually happened and who is at fault. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [undecided cases]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#5)

בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“in your gates”

Here, **gates** represents the border of a town or city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in your cities]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#6)

וְקַמְתָּ

“then you shall arise”

Moses is using the common expression of his culture **arise** as a common expression of his culture to tell the people to “take action.” He is not telling them to get out of bed or stand up from a seated position. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then you shall leave your city]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#7)

וְעָלִיתָ

“and go up”

See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase **go up**. Alternate translation: [and go]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 17:8 (#8)

הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בּוֹ

“the place which Yahweh your God will choose it”

The expression **the place which Yahweh your God will choose it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [the place which Yahweh your God will choose]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 17:9 (#1)

אֶל־הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם

“to the priests, the Levites”

Moses is not distinguishing between **priests** who are **Levites** and priests who are not Levites. All priests are Levites but not all Levites are priests. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [to the Levites who are priests]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 17:9 (#2)

וְאֶל־הַשֹּׁפֵט אֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם

“and to the judge who will be {there} at that time”

The implication is that there will be a **judge** at the place of worship who will make decisions for all of Israel. The judge serves for a limited period of time, then another judge replaces him. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and to the judge in office] or [and to the judge in office at that time]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:9 (#3)

וְדָרַשְׁתָּ

“and you shall inquire”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and you shall inquire about your case]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 17:9 (#4)

אֵת דְּבַר הַמִּשְׁפָּט

“the word of the judgment”

Moses is using **the word of the judgment** as a common expression of his culture to mean “the verdict.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your

language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the verdict]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 17:10 (#1)

עַל־פִּי הַדָּבָר֮ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יַגִּ֣ידוּ לְךָ֒

“according to the mouth of the word that they tell you”

Moses is using **according to the mouth of the word** as a common expression of his culture to mean “according to the decision” or “according to the judgment.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [according to what they say should be done] or [according to their judgment]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 17:11 (#1)

עַל־פִּ֣י הַתּוֹרָ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֤ר יוֹרוּךָ֙ וְעַל־הַמִּשְׁפָּ֔ט אֲשֶׁר־יֹאמְר֥וּ לְךָ֖ תַּעֲשֶׂ֑ה

“According to the mouth of the law that they teach you, and according to the judgment that they say to you, you shall do”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [According to the mouth of the law that they teach you, indeed, according to the judgment that they say to you, you shall do]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 17:11 (#2)

עַל־פִּ֣י הַתּוֹרָ֗ה

“According to the mouth of the law”

Here, **mouth** represents the words that someone says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [According to the words of the law]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 17:11 (#3)

לֹ֣א תָס֔וּר מִן־הַדָּבָ֖ר אֲשֶׁר־יַגִּ֣ידוּ לְךָ֑ יָמִ֥ין וּשְׂמֹֽאל

“Do not turn aside from the word that they tell you, right or left”

Here, **turn aside** means to disobey or stop following. Moses is speaking of the **word** of the judge as if it were a path that one could walk on and disobedience as turning aside, **right or left**, from that path. See how you translated the expression “Do not turn aside, right or left” in 5:32. Alternate translation: [Do not disobey their verdict]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:12 (#1)

וּבִעַרְתָּ֥ הָרָ֖ע מִיִּשְׂרָאֵֽל

“and you shall remove the evil from Israel”

See how you translated the similar phrase “you shall remove the evil from among you” in 13:5.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 17:14 (#1)

תָּבֹ֔א

“you have come”

In a context such as this, your language might say “gone” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [you have gone]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 17:14 (#2)

וְאָמַרְתָּ֣ אָשִׂ֤ימָה עָלַי֙ מֶ֔לֶךְ כְּכָל־הַגּוֹיִ֖ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר סְבִיבֹתָֽי

“and you say, ‘I shall set a king over myself, like all the nations that surround me”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and you decide that you want to set a king over yourself, like all the nations that surround you]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 17:14 (#3)

הַגּוֹיִ֖ם

“the nations”

Here, **nations** represent the people who live in those nations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your

language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of the nations]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 17:15 (#1)

שׂוֹשִׂם תְּשִׂשִׂים

“setting, you shall set”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **set** in order to intensify the idea that it expresses. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [you shall surely set]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 17:15 (#2)

אַחֶיךָ & אָחִיךָ

“your brothers & your brother”

Here, **brothers** and **brother** refer to those who are descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelites … your fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:16 (#1)

רַק

“Only”

Moses uses the word **Only** here to indicate a strong contrast between what is allowed and not allowed for Israel’s king. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 17:16 (#2)

לְמַעַן הַרְבּוֹת סוּס

“so that he may multiply horses”

This could mean that the king must not (1) send people to Egypt to buy horses for him as is modeled in the UST, or (2) sell Israelites to the Egyptians in exchange for horses. Alternate translation: [in exchange for horses for him]

Deuteronomy 17:16 (#3)

וַיהוָה אָמַר לָכֶם לֹא תֹסִפוּן לָשׁוּב בַּדֶּרֶךְ הַזֶּה עוֹד

“for Yahweh said to you, ‘You will no longer return that way again”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as modeled by the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 17:16 (#4)

לֹא תֹסִפוּן לָשׁוּב בַּדֶּרֶךְ הַזֶּה עוֹד

“You will no longer return that way again”

The expression **no longer return that way again** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [You will not return that way]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 17:17 (#1)

וְלֹא יָסוּר לְבָבוֹ

“and his heart will not turn aside”

Here the **heart** represents where a person’s thoughts and desires exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will not desire to turn aside]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:17 (#2)

וְלֹא יָסוּר לְבָבוֹ

“and his heart will not turn aside”

See how you translated the phrase “turn aside” in 11:16, where it is used with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [so that his heart will not disobey Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#1)

וְהָיָה

“And it will be”

Here the word translated as **And it will be** introduces a new section for laws about kings. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new topic. Alternate translation: [Then]

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#2)

כְּשִׁבְתּוֹ עַל כִּסֵּא

“when he sits on the throne of”

Here, **sits on the throne** represents the act of ruling a kingdom. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when he rules]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#3)

מַמְלַכְתּוֹ

“his kingdom”

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **kingdom** that a king rules. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a different way to explain the relationship between a king and his kingdom. Alternate translation: [the kingdom that he rules over]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#4)

וְכָתַב לוֹ אֶת־מִשְׁנֵה הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת עַל־סֵפֶר

“then he shall write for himself in a scroll a copy of this law”

This could mean that (1) the king himself must write a copy of the law. Alternate translation: [then he himself shall write in a scroll a copy of this law for himself] or (2) the king must appoint someone to write a copy of the law for him. Alternate translation: [he shall appoint someone to write in a scroll a copy of this law for him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#5)

אֶת־מִשְׁנֵה הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת עַל־סֵפֶר מִלִּפְנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים

“in a scroll a copy of this law from to the faces of the priests”

Here, **this law from to the faces of the priests** could mean: (1) the king must copy the original copy of the laws that the priests keep in the place of worship. Alternate translation: [in a scroll a copy of the original law that is kept by the priests] or (2) the priests would read out the law for someone to copy it. Alternate translation: [in a scroll a copy of this law as the priests read it to you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#6)

מִלִּפְנֵי

“from to the faces of”

Here, **to the faces** represents being in the presence of the priests. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the one that is in the presence of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 17:18 (#7)

הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם

“the priests, the Levites”

Moses is not distinguishing between **priests** who are **Levites** and priests who are not Levites. All priests are Levites but not all Levites are priests. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [the priests who are also Levites]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 17:19 (#1)

וְהָיְתָה

“and it shall be”

The pronoun **it** refers to the copy of the law from the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the copy of the law shall be]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 17:19 (#2)

לְמַעַן

“so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 17:19 (#3)

אֶת־כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת וְאֶת־הַחֻקִּים הָאֵלֶּה

“all the words of this law and these statutes”

The terms **this law** and **these statutes** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [all the important words of this law]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 17:19 (#4)

לַעֲשֹׂתָם

“to do them”

It might seem that the expression **to do them** contains extra information that is already contained in **to keep** and would not be natural to express in your language. If your translation already has that information, you may not need to repeat it here.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 17:20 (#1)

לְבִלְתִּי֩ רוּם־לְבָבוֹ֙ & וּלְבִלְתִּ֤י סוּר & לְמַעַן֙

“so that his heart is not lifted up & and so that he does not turn aside & so that”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of the commands from the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose.

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 17:20 (#2)

לְבִלְתִּי֩ רוּם־לְבָבוֹ֙ מֵאֲחָיו

“so that his heart is not lifted up above his brothers”

Moses is using **heart is ... lifted up** as a common expression of his culture to mean “is proud” or “is arrogant.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that he does not look down his nose at his brothers] or [so that he does not act like he is better than his brothers]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 17:20 (#3)

מֵאֲחָיו

“above his brothers”

Here, **brothers** means “fellow Israelites.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [above his fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:20 (#4)

וּלְבִלְתִּי֩ סוּר֩ מִן־הַמִּצְוָ֜ה יָמִ֣ין וּשְׂמֹ֗אול

“and so that he does not turn aside from the commandments, right or left”

See how you translated the similar expression in 5:32. Alternate translation: [and so that he does not disobey the commandments]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 17:20 (#5)

יַאֲרִ֤יךְ יָמִים֙ עַל־מַמְלַכְתּ֔וֹ

“he will prolong days in his kingdom”

Moses is speaking of time as if it were something over which man could exercise control, to prolong it. If the king obeys Yahweh, then he will **prolong** the **days** that he rules over **his kingdom**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will reign in his kingdom for a long time]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 18 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Yahweh’s provision for the priests and all Levites (1–8)
2. Warnings against pagan religious practices (9–14)
3. Yahweh promises to send a prophet like Moses (15–22)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Levites

As Yahweh’s chosen priests, the Levites were to trust in Yahweh to provide for them. They did not inherit any land, but Yahweh was their inheritance, in the sense that they received the privilege of being his priests. Yahweh provided for their needs through the rest of the Israelites, because the Levites were allowed to eat portions of the sacrifices that the Israelites sacrificed to Yahweh. (See: chosen, choose, chosen people, Cho-

sen One, elect; priest, priesthood; and trust, trusted, trustworthy, trustworthiness; and inherit, inheritance, heir)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular and plural
Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Generic nouns in hypothetical situations
Verses 6–10 and 20–22 give instructions and warnings for the Israelites. In these hypothetical conditions, singular nouns like "Levite," "maker," and "prophet" represent those groups of people in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could clarify that these terms refer to any person who fulfills the hypothetical situation. (See: Generic Noun Phrases; and Connect — Hypothetical Conditions)

Deuteronomy 18:1 (#1)

לֹא־יִֽהְיֶה לַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם כָּל־שֵׁבֶט לֵוִי חֵלֶק וְנַחֲלָה עִם־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"The priests, the Levites, all the tribe of Levi, shall have no portion nor inheritance with Israel"

The implication is that the Levites will not receive any **portion** or **inheritance** of land so that they cannot grow or raise their own food. See how you translated the similar phrase "Levi has no portion nor inheritance with his brothers" in 10:9. Alternate translation: [All the tribe of Levi will not own a portion of land] or [The Levites will not be given a portion of land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:1 (#2)

לַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם כָּל־שֵׁבֶט לֵוִי

"The priests, the Levites, all the tribe of Levi"

Moses is not distinguishing between **priests** who are **Levites** and priests who are not Levites. All **priests** came from **the tribe of Levi** and were therefore **Levites**. However, not all people of the tribe of Levi were priests. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [People from the tribe of Levi who serve as priests and all the rest of the Levites]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 18:1 (#3)

אִשֵּׁי יְהוָה

"the gifts of Yahweh"

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe **gifts** that the Israelites would offer to **Yahweh**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable expression for describing an offering. Alternate translation: [the food that the other Israelites give as an offering to Yahweh]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 18:1–2 (#1)

וְנַחֲלָתָ֣ו & יִֽהְיֶה־לּ֑וֹ & אֶחָ֖יו & נַחֲלָתֹ֥ו & לֹֽו

"as his inheritance & he shall have & his brothers & his inheritance & to him"

In these verses, the pronouns **his**, **he**, and **him** are singular in form, but they refer to all of the Levites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use plural forms of these pronouns.

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 18:2 (#1)

אֶחָ֖יו

"his brothers"

Here Moses is speaking as if people from the other 11 tribes of Israel were actually the Levites' **brothers**. He is using the term to mean descendants of the same ancestor. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:2 (#2)

יְהוָה֙ הִ֣וא נַחֲלָתֹ֔ו

"Yahweh is his inheritance"

Moses speaks of the honor of serving **Yahweh** as if the priests were receiving **Yahweh** himself as an **inheritance**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [instead, their inheritance is the privilege of serving Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:2 (#3)

דִּבֶּ֥ר

"he spoke"

Here, **spoke** means "promised." If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:3 (#1)

מִשְׁפַּט הַכֹּהֲנִים

"the ordinance of the priests"

Here Moses is using the possessive form to describe an **ordinance** that benefits **the priests**. If your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could use a comparable way to describe rules for priests. Alternate translation: [the provision for the priests]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 18:3 (#2)

מֵאֵאת הָעָם מֵאֵאת זֹבְחֵי הַזֶּבַח

"from the people, from those who offer a sacrifice"

Moses is not distinguishing between **the people** who **offer a sacrifice** from people who do not offer a sacrifice. Here, **the people** and **those who offer a sacrifice** are the same group of people. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [from the sacrifices that the people offer]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 18:3 (#3)

הַזֶּבַח אִם־שׁוֹר אִם־שֶׂה וְנָתַן לַכֹּהֵן הַזְּרֹעַ וְהַלְּחָיַיִם וְהַקֵּבָה

"a sacrifice, whether an oxen or a sheep, and they shall give the shoulder and the two cheeks and the stomach to the priest"

Leviticus 1–16 describes the different types of offerings and which parts the Israelites must give to the Levites and which they can eat. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. Alternate translation: [a sacrifice that Yahweh commanded you to eat, whether an oxen or sheep, and they shall give the shoulder and the two cheeks and the internal organs to the priest and eat the rest]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:4 (#1)

גֵּז

"the fleece of"

A **fleece** is the hair from a sheep. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of hair, you could use the name of something similar in your area or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [the hair of]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 18:4 (#2)

לוֹ

"to him"

The pronoun **him** refers to the Levite priests referred to in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to the priests]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:5 (#1)

כִּי

"For"

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 18:5 (#2)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

"Yahweh your God"

See how you translated the phrase "Yahweh your God" in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 18:5 (#3)

בּוֹ

"him"

The pronoun **him** refers to the tribe of Levi. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers as in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:5 (#4)

בְּשֵׁם־יְהוָה

"in the name of Yahweh"

Here, **name** represents all of Yahweh: his power, presence, knowledge, and so on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh himself]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:5 (#5)

וּבָנָיו

“and his sons”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his descendants]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:5 (#6)

כָּל־הַיָּמִים

“all of the days”

Moses is using **all of the days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “forever.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [forever]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 18:6 (#1)

וְכִי

“And if”

Moses is introducing a possible condition in this verse, and he gives the consequence in the next verse in which a Levite can serve at the temple if he greatly desires to move there. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [In the case that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 18:6 (#2)

הַלֵּוִי

“the Levite”

Moses is not referring to a specific **Levite**. He means Levites in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a Levite]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 18:6 (#3)

מֵאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ

“from one of your gates”

See how you translated the similar phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [from one of your communities]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:6 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר־הוּא גָּר שָׁם

“where he is living there”

The expression **where he is living there** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [where he is living]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 18:6 (#5)

בְּכָל־אַוַּת נַפְשׁוֹ

“desires with all his soul”

Here, **soul** represents a whole person, including their inner being, will, and desires. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he strongly desires]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:7 (#1)

בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה אֱלֹהָיו

“in the name of Yahweh his God”

Here, **name** represents all of Yahweh: his power, presence, knowledge, and so on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh his God]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:7 (#2)

אֶחָיו

“his brothers”

Moses is speaking as if the Levites were actually all **brothers**. Here, he is using the term to mean their fellow tribesmen. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his fellow tribesmen]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:7 (#3)

שָׁ֑שָׁם

“there”

Here, **there** refers to the place of worship that Yahweh will choose. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [at the place of worship]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:7 (#4)

לִפְנֵ֥י

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:8 (#1)

חֵ֚לֶק כְּחֵלֶ֔ק יֹאכֵ֖לוּ

“They shall eat portions alike portions”

Moses is using **portions alike portions** as a common expression of his culture to mean “equal portions.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They shall share and share alike] or [They shall all eat equal portions]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 18:8 (#2)

לְבַ֣ד מִמְכָּרָ֔יו עַל־הָאָבֽוֹת

“besides from the sale of his fathers”

Here, **the sale of his fathers** refers to the money from selling family inheritance. The Levite was allowed to keep this money and use it as he wished. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [besides any family inheritance] or [even if he has received money from his family]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:8 (#3)

הָאָבֽוֹת

“his fathers”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [his father’s possessions] or [inherited possessions]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 18:9 (#1)

בָּבָ֗א

“have come”

In a context such as this, your language might say “gone” instead of **come**. Alternate translation: [have gone]

See: Go and Come

Deuteronomy 18:9 (#2)

הַגּוֹיִ֔ם

“nations”

Here, **nations** represents the people groups living in those nations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [peoples]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:10 (#1)

לֹא־יִמָּצֵ֥א בְךָ֖

“There shall not be found among you”

The expression **be found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [There must not be among you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 18:10 (#2)

מַעֲבִ֣יר בְּנ֔וֹ־וּבִתּ֖וֹ בָּאֵ֑שׁ

“one who causes his son or his daughter to pass through the fire”

The people groups in the land would sacrifice to idols by burning their children in **fire**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [anyone who worships idols by burning his children to death]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:10–11 (#1)

מַעֲבִ֥יר בְּנֹו־וּבִתֹּ֖ו בָּאֵ֑שׁ קֹסֵ֣ם קְסָמִ֗ים מְעוֹנֵ֤ן וּמְנַחֵשׁ֙ וּמְכַשֵּׁ֔ף
וְחֹבֵ֖ר חָ֑בֶר וְשֹׁאֵ֥ל אוֹב֙ וְיִדְּעֹנִ֔י וְדֹרֵ֖שׁ אֶל־הַמֵּתִֽים

“one who causes his son or his daughter to pass through the fire, a user of divination, a soothsayer or a diviner or a sorcerer or a maker of charms or a questioner of mediums or a conjurer of spirits or a seeker of the dead”

These terms represent anyone who practices these abominations in general, not one particular person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [anyone who causes his son or his daughter to pass through the fire, any user of divination, any soothsayer or any diviner or any sorcerer or any maker of charms or any questioner of mediums or any conjurer of spirits or any seeker of the dead]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 18:10–11 (#2)

קֹסֵ֣ם קְסָמִ֗ים מְעוֹנֵ֤ן וּמְנַחֵשׁ֙ וּמְכַשֵּׁ֔ף: וְחֹבֵ֖ר חָ֑בֶר וְשֹׁאֵ֥ל אוֹב֙
וְיִדְּעֹנִ֔י וְדֹרֵ֖שׁ אֶל־הַמֵּתִֽים

“a user of divination, a soothsayer or a diviner or a sorcerer or a maker of charms or a questioner of mediums or a conjurer of spirits or a seeker of the dead”

These are different ways of practicing magic, including using magic to predict the future or speak to the dead. It is unclear the exact difference between all of these terms. If your language does not have separate terms for these types of magic, you can use more general terms. Alternate translation: [anyone who engages in any type of witchcraft, tries to predict the future, or speaks to the dead]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:11 (#1)

אוֹב֙

“mediums”

A **medium** is someone who contacts the spirits of the dead by practicing witchcraft. If your readers would not be familiar with this type of witchcraft, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [those who speak with the spirits of the dead]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 18:11 (#2)

הַמֵּתִֽים

“the dead”

Moses is using the adjective **dead** as a noun to mean people who are dead. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the dead ones]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 18:12 (#1)

כִּ֤י

“For”

The word translated as **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 18:12 (#2)

אֵ֖לֶּה

“these”

Here the word **these** refers to any of the abominable practices listed in verses 10–11. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [these pagan practices]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:12 (#3)

מוֹרִ֥ישׁ אוֹתָ֖ם

“is driving them out”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people groups who had been living in the land. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [is driving out those people groups who live in the land]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:12 (#4)

מִפָּנֶ֔יךָ

“from your face”

Here, **from your face** is a common expression of the culture that means “on account of you” or “on your behalf.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression

from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [on your behalf]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:14 (#1)

הַגּוֹיִם

“nations”

Here, **nations** represents the people groups that live in those nations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:14 (#2)

וְאַתָּה

“but you”

Moses is stating the pronoun **you** here even though he states **you** again in its normal place at the end of the sentence. He is doing that because he is making a strong contrast between what the other people groups do and what the Israelites must do. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing that meaning here. Alternate translation: [but concerning you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:15 (#1)

יָקִים

“will raise up”

Moses is speaking as if Yahweh would literally **raise up** a prophet, that is, as if Yahweh had lifted the prophet up to a high place. Here it means that he will appoint a prophet for them. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will appoint]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:15 (#2)

מֵאַחֶיךָ

“from your brothers”

Here, **brothers** means “fellow Israelites.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from your fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:16 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 18:16 (#2)

בְּחֹרֵב

“at Horeb”

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also known as Mount Sinai. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 32.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 18:16 (#3)

לֵאמֹר לֹא אֹסֵף לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶת־קוֹל יְהוָה אֱלֹהָי וְאֶת־הָאֵשׁ הַגְּדֹלָה הַזֹּאת לֹא־אֶרְאֶה עוֹד וְלֹא אָמוּת

“saying, ‘We will not continue to hear the voice of Yahweh our God, and we will not see this great fire anymore, or we will die”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation, as modeled by the UST.

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 18:17 (#1)

דִּבְּרוּ

“they have said”

The pronoun **they** refers to the Israelites who asked Moses to speak to Yahweh on their behalf. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Israelites have requested]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:18 (#1)

אָקִים

“I shall raise up”

See how you translated the phrase “raise up” in 18:15 where it is used with the same meaning. Alternate translation: [I shall appoint]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:18 (#2)

אֲחֵיהֶם

“their brothers”

Here, **brothers** means “fellow Israelites.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:18 (#3)

וְנָתַתִּי דְבָרַי בְּפִיו

“And I shall set my words on his lips”

Here Yahweh is speaking of **words** as if they were physical objects that one could put on someone’s **lips**. Yahweh means that he will tell the prophet what to say. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will tell him all the words to speak]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 18:19 (#1)

הָאִישׁ & מֵעִמּוֹ

“the man & from him”

The words **man** and **him** represent people in general, not one particular man. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a more natural expression. Alternate translation: [anyone ... from that person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 18:19 (#2)

יְדַבֵּר

“he speaks”

The pronoun **he** refers to the prophet from the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the prophet speaks]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:19 (#3)

בִּשְׁמִי

“in my name”

Here Yahweh’s **name** represents Yahweh’s authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by my authority]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:19 (#4)

אָנֹכִי אֶדְרֹשׁ מֵעִמּוֹ

“I, I will require {it} from him”

The implication is that Yahweh will **require** anyone who disobeys his prophet to give an account for their disobedience. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I will require accountability for disobedience from him] or [I will hold him responsible]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:19 (#5)

אָנֹכִי אֶדְרֹשׁ

“I, I will require {it”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will require** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that he will personally punish the person who disobeys his prophet. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I will indeed require it] or [I personally will require it]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:20 (#1)

אַךְ

“But”

Yahweh uses the word **But** here to indicate a strong contrast between a prophet that he himself sends and a false prophet. In your translation, indicate this strong contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [However,]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 18:20 (#2)

דָּבָר

“a word”

Here, **word** represents a message. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:20 (#3)

בִּשְׁמִי

“in my name”

Here Yahweh’s **name** represents Yahweh’s authority, as it did in the previous verse. See how you translated it there. Alternate translation: [by my authority]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:20 (#4)

וַאֲשֶׁר יְדַבֵּר בְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“or who speaks in the name of other gods”

Here the **name** of false **gods**, represents the false gods themselves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [or who claims to speak on behalf of other gods]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:20 (#5)

וּמֵת הַנָּבִיא הַהוּא

“then that prophet shall die”

The implication is that the Israelites must execute that prophet. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [then you must kill that prophet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:21 (#1)

תֹּאמַר בִּלְבָבֶךָ אֵיכָה֣ נֵדַ֔ע אֶת־הַדָּבָ֕ר אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־דִבְּרָ֖וֹ יְהוָ֑ה

“you must say in your heart, ‘How will we recognize a word that Yahweh has not spoken”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [you must ask yourselves how you will recognize a word that Yahweh has not spoken]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 18:21 (#2)

תֹּאמַר בִּלְבָבֶךָ

“you must say in your heart”

Moses is using **say in your heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “think” or “say to yourself.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you must say to yourself] or [you must think]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 18:21 (#3)

נֵדַע

“will we recognize”

The pronoun **we** refers to the Israelites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [will we Israelites recognize]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#1)

בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה

“in the name of Yahweh”

Here, **name** represents Yahweh’s power and authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by Yahweh’s authority]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#2)

הַדָּבָר

“the thing”

Here, **the thing** refers to what the prophet predicts will happen. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the prophecy]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#3)

וְלֹא־יִהְיֶ֣ה הַדָּבָ֔ר וְלֹ֥א יָבֹ֖וא

“and the thing does not happen and does not come to pass”

These two phrases **does not happen** and **does not come to pass** mean basically the same thing. The

second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and the thing does not actually happen]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#4)

הַדָּבָר

"is} a word"

Here, **word** represents a message or prophecy. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is a message]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#5)

דִּבְּרָנּוּ

"has spoken it"

The pronoun **it** refers to the false prophecy. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [has spoken the message]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#6)

בְּזָדוֹן דִּבְּרָנּוּ

"has spoken it in presumption"

The implication is that the false prophet spoke because of pride, not because Yahweh told him to speak. He spoke **in presumption** by presuming to know Yahweh's thinking and plans. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [has spoken it because of his own pride]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 18:22 (#7)

לֹא תָגוּר מִמֶּנּוּ

"you shall not be afraid of him"

The implication is that the Israelites should not **be afraid** of that prophet and not respect that prophet. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [do not pay attention to what he said] or [you shall not be afraid of anything he says]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy - Chapter 19 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses' second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Cities of refuge (1–13)
2. Property lines (14)
3. Rules regarding witnesses (15–21)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Witnesses

In the ancient Near East, it was common for a person to be punished by the testimony of a single person, especially if this was an important person. The rules in this chapter give protection to people, especially the poor, by requiring multiple witnesses. This allowed justice to be done. (See: testimony, testify, witness, eyewitness, evidence)

Cities of refuge

Verses 1–13 discuss cities of refuge, which are towns to which a killer could flee. These verses address both cases where the killer accidentally kills another person and cases where the killer plans the murder. In those times, a close family member of the deceased would be obligated to take revenge for the killing of his family member by finding and killing the manslayer (someone who accidentally kills another human being). Yahweh provides protection for the killer who killed accidentally so that he will not be punished too harshly. (See: refuge, refugee, shelter, sheltered; and avenge, avenger, revenge, vengeance)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"you" and "your" singular and plural

Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Generic nouns in hypothetical situations

This chapter gives instructions and warnings for the Israelites. In these hypothetical conditions, singular nouns like "man," "witness," and "neighbor" represent those groups of people in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could clarify that these terms refer to any person who fulfills the hypothetical situation. (See: Generic Noun Phrases; and Connect — Hypothetical Conditions)

Deuteronomy 19:1 (#1)

יַכְרִ֗ית יְהוָ֤ה אֱלֹהֶ֙יךָ֙ אֶת־הַגּוֹיִ֔ם

“Yahweh your God cuts off the nations”

Here, **cuts off** means to completely destroy or eliminate so that a people group will not have descendants. Moses is speaking of Yahweh destroying the people who live in Canaan as if he were cutting them off, as one would cut a branch from a tree so it could no longer grow new leaves. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God eliminates the nations]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 19:1 (#2)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 19:1 (#3)

אֶת־אַרְצָ֑ם

“their land”

The pronoun **their** refers to the other nations. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the territory of those nations]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:2 (#1)

תַּבְדִּ֣יל

“you shall select”

See the discussion in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for more information about translating **shall**.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:2 (#2)

נֹתֵ֥ן לְךָ֖ יְרֻשָּׁתָֽהּ

“is giving to you to possess it”

The expression **is giving to you to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression as is modeled in the UST.

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 19:3 (#1)

תָּכִ֣ין לְךָ֔ הַדָּ֖רֶךְ

“You shall prepare for yourself a road”

The implication is that the Israelites must build roads in between those cities so that it would be easy for people to travel to those cities. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Build a road for ease of travel]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:3 (#2)

וְשִׁלַּשְׁתָּ֞ אֶת־גְּבֻ֣ול אַרְצְךָ֗

“and make the borders of your land three”

The implication is that the Israelites must divide their **land** into **three** regions. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and separate your land into three regions]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:4 (#1)

דְּבַ֣ר

“is} the matter of”

Alternate translation: [is what you must do concerning]

Deuteronomy 19:4 (#2)

יַכֶּ֥ה

“strikes”

Here, **strikes** means “kills.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:4 (#3)

אֶת־רֵעֵ֖הוּ

“his neighbor”

Here, **neighbor** means “fellow Israelite.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 19:4 (#4)

בִּבְלִי־דַ֥עַת

“without knowledge”

Here, **knowledge** represents “intention.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [unintentionally]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:4 (#5)

וְהוּא לֹא־שֹׂנֵא לוֹ מִתְּמֹל שִׁלְשֹׁם

“and he did not hate him from previous times”

The implication is that the killer had no reason to kill and did not plan to kill the person. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and he did not hate him previously and did not plan to kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:5 (#1)

אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ & אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“with} his neighbor & his neighbor”

Here, **neighbor** means “fellow Israelite.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with his fellow Israelite … his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 19:5 (#2)

הַבַּרְזֶל

“the iron”

Moses assumes that readers will know **the iron** refers to the ax head which was the blade and was made out of iron. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the blade of the ax]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:5 (#3)

וְנָשַׁל הַבַּרְזֶל מִן־הָעֵץ וּמָצָא אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ

“and the iron detaches from the wood and finds his neighbor”

Here Moses speaks of **the iron** part of the ax as if it were a person who could find something. He means that the metal part of the ax hits and cuts the **neighbor**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the iron detaches from the wood and hits his neighbor]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 19:5 (#4)

הֹוּא

“he”

The pronoun **he** refers to the “killer.” It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the killer]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:5 (#5)

וָחָי

“and live”

The implication is that the family members of the dead person would try to kill the manslayer in revenge. The people of those **cities** would protect the killer so that he can **live**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the avenger would not be able to kill him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#1)

פֶּן

“Lest”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites instructions about fleeing to a city of refuge so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [In case]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#2)

יִרְדֹּף גֹּאֵל הַדָּם אַחֲרֵי הָרֹצֵחַ כִּי־יֵחַם לְבָבוֹ וְהִשִּׂיגוֹ כִּי־יִרְבֶּה הַדֶּרֶךְ

“the avenger of blood pursue after the killer when his heart is heated and overtake him, because the way is long”

The implication is that, if there are no roads to the cities of refuge, it will be difficult for a manslayer to travel to a safe city. Then, the avenger of blood might overtake the killer before the killer arrives at the city.

You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers, as modeled by the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#3)

לִבָּבוֹ & וְהִכָּהוּ

“his heart & and he strike him”

The pronouns **his** and **he** refer to “the avenger of blood.” It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the heart of the avenger ... and the avenger strike him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#4)

יֵחַם לִבָּבוֹ

“his heart is heated”

Moses is using **heart is heated** as a common expression of his culture to mean “is angry.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he is burning with anger] or [he is angry]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#5)

וְהִכָּהוּ נֶפֶשׁ

“and he strike him {to} the life”

Moses is using **strike him to the life** as a common expression of his culture to mean “mortally wound him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he does him in] or [and he mortally wound him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#6)

וְלוֹ אֵין מִשְׁפַּט־מָוֶת כִּי לֹא שֹׂנֵא הוּא לוֹ מִתְמֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם

“and he did not have a judgment of death, for he had not hated him from previous times”

The implication is that a killer who killed accidentally does not deserve execution. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [though that man did not deserve to die since he unintentionally killed the other person and was not his enemy, and he had not planned to hurt the man]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:6 (#7)

לֹא שֹׂנֵא הוּא לוֹ מִתְמֹל שִׁלְשׁוֹם

“he had not hated him from previous times”

See how you translated the phrase “he did not hate him from previous times” in 19:4 where it occurs with the same meaning.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:7 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 19:7 (#2)

מְצַוְּךָ לֵאמֹר שָׁלֹשׁ עָרִים תַּבְדִּיל לָךְ

“command you, saying, ‘Select three cities for yourself”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [command you to select three cities for yourself]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 19:7 (#3)

שָׁלֹשׁ עָרִים תַּבְדִּיל לָךְ

“Select three cities for yourself”

The expression **Select three cities for yourself** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [Select three cities]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 19:8 (#1)

יַרְחִיב יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֶת־גְּבֻלְךָ

“Yahweh your God enlarges your borders”

The implication is that Yahweh will enlarge the **borders** of Israel by enabling them to possess more land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God gives you more land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:8 (#2)

נִשְׁבַּבַּע לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

“he has sworn to your fathers”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from earlier in the sentence if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [he has sworn to your fathers that he would do]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 19:8 (#3)

לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ & לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

“to your fathers & to your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST. See how you translated the phrase “your fathers” in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 19:9 (#1)

כִּי־תִשְׁמֹר֨ אֶת־כָּל־הַמִּצְוָ֜ה הַזֹּ֗את לַעֲשֹׂתָהּ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אָנֹכִ֤י מְצַוְּךָ֙ הַיּ֔וֹם לְאַהֲבָ֣ה אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ וְלָלֶ֣כֶת בִּדְרָכָ֑יו כָּל־הַיָּמִ֔ים

“if you keep all these commandments to do them, which I am commanding you today—to love Yahweh your God and to walk in his ways all of the days”

If it is more natural in your language to simplify the relationship between the hypothetical conditions, you could do so by moving this portion to the beginning of verse 8. See the UST for an example.

See: Verse Bridges

Deuteronomy 19:9 (#2)

אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ֙

“I am commanding you”

Moses is telling the Israelites the commands from Yahweh. Yahweh is the original source of the commands. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [I am commanding you on behalf of Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:9 (#3)

וְלָלֶ֣כֶת בִּדְרָכָ֑יו

“and to walk in his ways”

Here Moses is speaking of **commandments** as if they were **ways** a person should **walk in**. He is saying that obeying Yahweh’s commandments is like walking on those ways. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to obey all his commandments]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 19:9 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֔ים

“all of the days”

Moses is using **all of the days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “forever” or “always.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [forever] or [always]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:9 (#5)

וְיָסַפְתָּ֥ לְךָ֖ עוֹד֙ שָׁלֹ֣שׁ עָרִ֔ים עַ֖ל הַשָּׁלֹ֥שׁ הָאֵֽלֶּה

“then you shall add three more cities for yourself, more than these three”

The implication is that the Israelites must choose **three more cities** of refuge in the part of the land that Yahweh will give them later. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [then you shall add three more cities for yourself in that additional land, besides these three cities]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:10 (#1)

וְלֹֽא־יִשָּׁפֵ֤ךְ דָּם־נָקִי֙ & וְהָיָ֥ה עָלֶ֖יךָ דָּמִֽים

“Then you shall not spill innocent blood & and bloodshed be upon you”

These phrases are both part of the result of adding three new cities of refuge. Use a connector or connectors in your language that makes it clear that these

phrases are the result of adding three new cities of refuge. Alternate translation: [That would keep you from spilling innocent blood ... which would make you guilty of murder]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 19:10 (#2)

וְלֹֽא יִשָּׁפֵ֤ךְ דָּם֙ נָקִ֔י

“Then you shall not spill innocent blood”

Moses is using **spill ... blood** as a common expression of his culture to mean “kill someone.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Then you shall not kill an innocent person]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:10 (#3)

וְלֹֽא יִשָּׁפֵ֤ךְ דָּם֙ נָקִ֔י

“Then you shall not spill innocent blood”

The implication is that, if the Israelites choose certain cities for people who kill someone accidentally to flee to, then the avengers of blood will not be able to kill them. As a result, Israelites will keep innocent people from dying. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And so you will help prevent the spilling of innocent blood by choosing cities of refuge]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:10 (#4)

וְהָיְתָ֥ה עָלֶ֖יךָ דָּמִֽים

“and bloodshed be upon you”

Moses is using **bloodshed be upon you** as a common expression of his culture to mean “you be considered guilty of murder.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you be guilty of murder]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:11 (#1)

לוֹ & עָלָ֖יו וְהִכָּ֣הוּ & וָמֵ֑ת

“him & against him and strikes him & and he dies”

The pronouns **him** and **he** refer to the “neighbor.” It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [his neighbor ... against him and strikes him ... and his neighbor dies]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:11 (#2)

וְכִֽי־יִהְיֶ֥ה אִישׁ֙

“And if there is a man”

Moses is introducing a possible situation in which a man murdered someone and flees to a city of refuge. The instructions for what the elders should do if that situation occurs are described in verse 12. Express this possible situation in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If it should happen that a man]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 19:11 (#3)

וְקָ֥ם עָלָ֖יו

“and rises up against him”

Moses is using **rises up against** as a common expression of his culture to mean “attacks.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and attacks him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:11 (#4)

וְהִכָּ֣הוּ נֶ֔פֶשׁ

“and strikes him {to} the life”

See how you translated the phrase “strike him to the life” in 19:6.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:11 (#5)

וְנָ֖ס

“and he flees”

The pronoun **he** refers to the “man who hates his neighbor.” It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the killer flees]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:12 (#1)

וְשָׁלְחוּ זִקְנֵי עִירוֹ

“then the elders of his city shall send out”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [then the elders of his city shall send a representative out]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 19:12 (#2)

עִירוֹ & אֹתוֹ & אֹתוֹ & וָמֵת

“his city & him & him & then he shall die”

The pronouns **his**, **him**, and **he** refer to the killer. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the killer’s city ... the killer ... him ... then the killer shall die]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:12 (#3)

מִשָּׁם

“from there”

Here, **there** refers to the city of refuge that the killer fled to. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [from the city of refuge]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:12 (#4)

וְנָתְנוּ אֹתוֹ בְּיַד גֹּאֵל הַדָּם

“and give him into the hand of the avenger of blood”

Here, **hand** represents the control of the avenger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and give him into the custody of the avenger of blood]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:12 (#5)

גֹּאֵל הַדָּם

“the avenger of blood”

Here, **blood** represents “killing.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the avenger of killing]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:12 (#6)

וָמֵת

“then he shall die”

The implication is that “the redeemer of blood” will execute the killer. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [then the avenger of blood shall execute him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:13 (#1)

לֹא־תָחוֹס עֵינְךָ עָלָיו

“Your eye shall not pity him”

Moses is using **eye shall not pity him** as a common expression of his culture to mean “do not feel sorry for him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Do not let your heart soften towards him] or [Do not have compassion on him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:13 (#2)

דַּם

“the blood of”

See how you translated “blood” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [the guilt of killing]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:13 (#3)

הַנָּקִי

“the innocent”

Moses is using the adjective **innocent** as a noun to mean innocent people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you could translate this word with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [people who did nothing wrong]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 19:14 (#1)

לֹא תַסִּיג גְּבֻל רֵעֶךָ

“You shall not displace the boundary of your neighbor”

The implication is that someone would **displace the boundary** of their **neighbor** in order to take their neighbor’s land as their own. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [You must not take land away from your neighbor by changing the boundary of his land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:14 (#2)

גְּבֻ֣ל

“the boundary of”

Here, **boundary** represents stones or other objects that people use to mark the boundary of their land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the boundary markers of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:14 (#3)

גָּבְל֣וּ רִאשֹׁנִ֔ים

“he first set the bounds”

The implication is that previous generations divided the land into portions and placed stones to mark the boundaries of each portion of land. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [previous generations set the bounds]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:14 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר גָּבְל֖וּ רִאשֹׁנִ֑ים

“of which he first set the bounds”

The expression **of which he first set the bounds** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [which he first set]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 19:14 (#5)

בְּנַחֲלָתְךָ֛

“in your inheritance”

Here, **inheritance** refers to the specific portion of land that each family receives. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in the portion of land]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:14 (#6)

בָּאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ נֹתֵ֤ן לְךָ֙ לְרִשְׁתָּ֔הּ

“in the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you to possess it”

The expression **in the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you to possess it** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [in the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 19:15 (#1)

לֹא־ יָקוּם֩ עֵ֨ד אֶחָ֜ד בְּאִ֗ישׁ

“One witness shall not rise up against a man”

Here Moses is using **rise up against** as a common expression of his culture to mean “attack” or in this context, “bring a case against.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [One witness shall not bring a case against another man]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:15 (#2)

לְכָל־ עָוֹן֙ וּלְכָל־ חַטָּ֣את

“for any iniquity, or for any sin”

The terms **iniquity** and **sin** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [for any sin]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 19:15 (#3)

בְּכָל־ חֵ֥טְא אֲשֶׁ֖ר יֶחֱטָ֣א

“in any sin that he sins”

For emphasis, Moses is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You

may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in any sin that he commits]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 19:15 (#4)

פִּי & פִּי

“the mouth of & the mouth of”

Here, **mouth** represents the words that someone says. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the testimony of ... the testimony of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:15 (#5)

יָקוּם דָּבָר

“a matter may be raised”

Moses is using **a matter may be raised** as a common expression of his culture to mean “a case against someone may be brought.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a case may be brought against someone]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:15 (#6)

יָקוּם דָּבָר

“a matter may be raised”

The expression **be raised** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [may a judge hear a case]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 19:16 (#1)

יָקוּם & בְּאִישׁ

“rises up against a man”

See how you translated the similar phrase “rise up against” in the previous verse 19:15. Alternate translation: [brings a legal case against a man]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 19:16 (#2)

כִּי

“if”

Moses is introducing a possible condition in this verse, and he gives the consequence in the next verse in which men who have a controversy must go before Yahweh, the priests, and the judges. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [In the case that]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 19:17 (#1)

וְעָמְדָה שְׁנֵי־הָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־לָהֶם הָרִיב

“then the two men who have the controversy shall stand”

Here, **stand** means “present the case.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning explicitly. Alternate translation: [then the two men who have the controversy shall bring their case]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:17 (#2)

לִפְנֵי & לִפְנֵי

“to the face of & to the faces of”

Here, **face** represents the presence of Yahweh and **faces** represents the presence of the **priests** and **judges**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the presence of ... before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 19:17 (#3)

וְהַשֹּׁפְטִים אֲשֶׁר יִהְיוּ

“and the judges who will be”

The implication is that there will be **judges** at the place of worship who will make decisions for all of Israel. The **judges** served for a limited period of time, then other judges replaced them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and the judges who will be in office]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:17 (#4)

יִהְיוּ בַיָּמִים הָהֵם

“will be in those days”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply the implied words if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will be serving at the place of worship in those days]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 19:18 (#1)

וְהִנֵּה עֵד־שֶׁקֶר

“and behold, {if the} witness {is} false”

Moses is describing a possible condition in which the people are to do the punishment described in verse 19 only if the judges first discover that the witness is false. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and suppose that they discover that the witness is false]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 19:18 (#2)

בְּאָחִיו

“against his brother”

Moses is using the term **brother** to describe someone who is descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [against his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 19:19 (#1)

לוֹ & זָמַם & לְאָחִיו

“to him & he had planned & to his brother”

The pronouns **him**, **he**, and **his** refer to the false witness mentioned in the previous verse who falsely “testified against his brother.” It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [to the false witness ... he had planned ... to his brother]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 19:19 (#2)

וּבָעַרְתָּ הָרָע מִקִּרְבֶּךָ

“and you shall remove the evil from among you”

See how you translated this same phrase in 13:5.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 19:20 (#1)

וְהַנִּשְׁאָרִים

“Then the remnant”

Here, **remnant** refers to the rest of the people. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Then everyone else]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 19:20 (#2)

יִשְׁמְעוּ וְיִרָאוּ

“will hear and fear”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words from the context if it would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [will hear about the punishment and fear that they might also be punished]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 19:20 (#3)

וְלֹא־יֹסִפוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת עוֹד כַּדָּבָר הָרָע הַזֶּה

“and will not continue to do anymore as this evil thing”

The expression **and will not continue to do anymore as this evil thing among you** contains extra information that would be unnatural to express in some languages. If this is true of your language, you could shorten the expression. Alternate translation: [and will no longer do such an evil thing as this]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 19:21 (#1)

וְלֹא תָחוֹס עֵינֶךָ

“And your eyes shall not have pity”

Moses is using **your eyes shall not have pity** as a common expression of his culture to mean “do not feel sorry for him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And do not let your heart soften towards him] or [And do not have compassion on him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy - Chapter 20 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses' second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Instructions for going to war (1–20)
2. Encouragement and exemptions from battle (1–9)
3. Rules for sieges and warfare (10–20)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Yahweh's protection in battle

Israel was not to fear the military might of other nations. Their confidence was to be in Yahweh, who was the true source of their strength and protection. This divine reliance is highlighted by the priest, rather than a military commander, addressing the soldiers before battle, reminding them of Yahweh's presence and power to save them. (See: trust, trusted, trustworthy, trustworthiness; and priest, priesthood)

Holy war and the conquest of Canaan

The conquest of the land that Yahweh had promised them was a unique event in Israel's history, considered a form of holy war with specific, God-given rules. This warfare was presented as Yahweh's judgment against the sinfulness of the Canaanite peoples. The command for complete destruction of these peoples was to prevent them from leading Israel into sin. (See: Promised Land; and holy, holiness, unholy, sacred; and sin, sinful, sinner, sinning)

Exemptions from military service

In ancient Israelite society, certain men were excused from military service. This chapter outlines several reasons for exemption, including recently building a new house, planting a new vineyard and not yet enjoying its fruit, being newly engaged to a woman, or being fearful. These exemptions ensured that important life events were honored and that the army consisted of willing and courageous soldiers.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Use of "you"

Throughout this chapter, Moses is addressing the entire nation of Israel.

- **Singular "you" addressing the crowd:** Most often, Moses uses the singular form of "you" (e.g., 20:1 "When **you** go out ... **you** shall not fear," 20:10 "When **you** draw near ... **you** shall call"). This is a common Hebrew rhetorical device where the community is addressed as a single entity.
- **Plural "you":** The priest, when addressing the people in 20:3–4, uses the plural form of "you" (e.g., 20:3 "your hearts," "of them," 20:4 "your God," "with you," "for you," "your enemies," "save you"). The officers also use plural forms when they address the people (e.g., 20:18 "teach you").

If addressing a crowd with a singular "you" is unnatural in your language, consistently use the plural form.

"what man is there"

This phrase, used multiple times in verses 5–8 (e.g., "Who is the man that has built a new house"), introduces rhetorical questions. These questions are not seeking information but are designed to identify categories of men who are to be excused from battle, emphasizing Yahweh's desire for a dedicated fighting force. (See: Rhetorical Question)

"soften your hearts"/"heart ... will not melt"

In 20:3, "You shall not soften your hearts" is an idiom meaning "do not be afraid." Similarly, in 20:8, the phrase "the heart of his brother will not melt like his heart" means his fellow soldiers will not become afraid like he is. The heart here represents courage. If these idioms are not clear, translate them with their plain meaning. (See: Idiom; and Metonymy)

"mouth of the sword"

The expression "by the mouth of the sword" in 20:13 is an idiom meaning to kill with a sword, often implying complete destruction in battle. Translate this with a natural equivalent in your language. (See: Idiom)

"For is the tree of the field a man?"

This rhetorical question in 20:19 emphasizes that trees are not enemies to be attacked during a siege. It implies that since trees are not human combatants, they should not be indiscriminately destroyed, especially if they provide food. (See: Rhetorical Question; and Personification)

Deuteronomy 20:1 (#1)

וְרָאִ֣יתָ סּ֔וּס וָרֶ֖כֶב

"and see horses and chariots"

The implication is that an army with **horses and chariots** was a very strong army, so anyone who was fighting that army would be afraid. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and see a strong army with horses and chariots]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 20:1 (#2)

עַ֖ם

“a people”

Here, **people** represents the army of that people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a people whose army is]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 20:1 (#3)

מֵהֶ֑ם

“of them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the army of the people group. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [of their army]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 20:1 (#4)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 20:1 (#5)

הַמַּעַלְךָ֙ מֵאֶ֣רֶץ מִצְרָ֔יִם

“who raised you up from the land of Egypt”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh bringing the Israelites out of Egypt as if Yahweh were raising the people up. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who brought you from the land of Egypt]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 20:2 (#1)

וְהָיָ֔ה

“And it will be”

Here Moses is using the word translated **And it will be** to introduce an instruction. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing instructions. Alternate translation: [And it must be]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 20:2 (#2)

הָעָ֔ם

“the people”

Here, **the people** represents the army of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the soldiers]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 20:3 (#1)

יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Israel”

The priest is using **Israel** to represent all the fighting men of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [soldiers of Israel]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 20:3 (#2)

אַל־יֵרַ֥ךְ לְבַבְכֶ֖ם

“You shall not soften your hearts”

The speaker is using **soften your hearts** as a common expression of his culture to mean “be afraid.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall not be afraid]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 20:3 (#3)

אַל־תִּירְא֣וּ וְאַל־תַּחְפְּז֔וּ וְאַל־תַּעַרְצ֖וּ

“You shall not fear or panic or be terrified”

The terms **fear or panic or be terrified** mean similar things. Moses is using these three terms together to emphasize how important it is for the Israelites to be brave when facing their enemies in battle. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express this emphasis with fewer words. Alternate translation: [You shall not be afraid in any way] or [You shall not let fear overcome you]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 20:3–4 (#1)

אַל־יֵרַךְ לְבַבְכֶם אַל־תִּירְאוּ וְאַל־תַּחְפְּזוּ וְאַל־תַּעַרְצוּ מִפְּנֵיהֶם: כִּֽי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הַהֹלֵךְ עִמָּכֶם לְהִלָּחֵם לָכֶם עִם־אֹיְבֵיכֶם לְהוֹשִׁיעַ אֶתְכֶם

“You shall not soften your hearts. You shall not fear or panic or be terrified of them, for Yahweh your God goes with you to fight for you against your enemies, to save you”

If it would be more natural in your language to state the reason before the result, you may rearrange the order of these sentences. Combine Deuteronomy 20:3–4 into a verse bridge to keep related information together. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God goes with you to fight for you against your enemies, to save you. Therefore you shall not soften your hearts. You shall not fear or panic or be terrified of them]

See: Verse Bridges

Deuteronomy 20:4 (#1)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:5 (#1)

וְדִבְּרוּ הַשֹּׁטְרִים אֶל־הָעָם לֵאמֹר מִי־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר בָּנָה בַּיִת־חָדָשׁ וְלֹא חֲנָכוֹ יֵלֵךְ

“And the officers shall speak to the people, saying, ‘Who {is} the man who has built a new house and has not dedicated it? Let him go”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this quotation in such a way that there is not a quotation within a quotation. This quote continues until the end of verse seven. Alternate translation: [And the officers shall ask the people if there is any man who has built a new house and has not dedicated it. They shall tell him to go]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 20:5 (#2)

מִי־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר בָּנָה בַּיִת־חָדָשׁ וְלֹא חֲנָכוֹ יֵלֵךְ וְיָשֹׁב לְבֵיתוֹ

“Who {is} the man who has built a new house and has not dedicated it? Let him go and return to his house”

Moses is using a question form followed by an instruction phrase in verses 5–8 for listing those exempted from military service. This pattern creates a formal, rhythmic structure in these military instructions. If your language would not use a pattern of phrases in this way, you could express these as statements rather than questions. Alternate translation: [Any man who has built a new house and has not dedicated it should go and return to his house] or [If a man has built a new house and has not dedicated it, he must return home]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 20:5 (#3)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 20:5 (#4)

מִי־הָאִישׁ

“Who {is} the man”

Here, **the man** represents men in general, not a specific man. Moses is referring to any Israelite soldier who fits this description. The same pattern occurs in verses 6–8 with other categories of men who may return home. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Is there any man]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 20:5 (#5)

וְלֹא חֲנָכוֹ

“and has not dedicated it”

The expression **dedicated it** refers to an ancient Israelite practice of ceremonially setting apart a new house, likely through a religious ceremony asking for God’s blessing before moving in. (Nothing more is known about this than appears in this text.) Moses assumes his audience would understand this cultural practice. If this information is not clear to your readers, you could make it more explicit. Alternate trans-

lation: [and has not dedicated it in a special ceremony] or [and has not formally celebrated its completion with a ceremony]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 20:5 (#6)

פֶּן־יָמוּת֙ בַּמִּלְחָמָ֔ה וְאִ֥ישׁ אַחֵ֖ר יַחְנְכֶֽנּוּ

“lest he die in battle and another man dedicate it”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise, he may die in battle and another man will dedicate it]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:6 (#1)

וּמִי־הָאִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁר־נָטַ֣ע כֶּ֔רֶם וְלֹ֥א חִלְּלֽוֹ יֵלֵ֖ךְ וְיָשֹׁ֣ב לְבֵיתֽוֹ

“And who {is} the man who has planted a vineyard and has not put it into use? Let him go and return to his house”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate the question as a statement or as an exclamation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [Any man who has planted a vineyard and has not put it into use should go and return to his house] or [If a man has planted a vineyard and has not put it into use, he must return home]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 20:6 (#2)

וּמִי־הָאִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁר־נָטַ֣ע כֶּ֔רֶם וְלֹ֥א חִלְּלֽוֹ יֵלֵֽךְ

“And who {is} the man who has planted a vineyard and has not put it into use? Let him go”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [And if there is any man who has planted a vineyard and has not put it into use, let him go]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 20:6 (#3)

וּמִי־הָאִ֣ישׁ

“And who {is} the man”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate **the man** in a way that represents men in general, not a specific man, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [Is there any man] or [Is there anyone among you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 20:6 (#4)

פֶּן־יָמוּת֙

“lest he die”

See how you translated “lest” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [otherwise he may die]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:7 (#1)

וּמִי־הָאִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁר־אֵרַ֣שׂ אִשָּׁ֔ה וְלֹ֥א לְקָחָ֖הּ יֵלֵ֑ךְ וְיָשֹׁ֖ב לְבֵיתֽוֹ

“And who {is} the man who is engaged {to} a woman and has not taken her? Let him go and return to his house”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate the question as a statement or as an exclamation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [Any man who is engaged to a woman and has not taken her should go and return to his house] or [If a man is engaged to a woman and has not taken her, he must return home]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 20:7 (#2)

וּמִי־הָאִ֣ישׁ אֲשֶׁר־אֵרַ֣שׂ אִשָּׁ֔ה וְלֹ֥א לְקָחָ֖הּ יֵלֵֽךְ

“And who {is} the man who is engaged {to} a woman and has not taken her? Let him go”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate this quotation in such a way that there would not be a quotation within a quotation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [And if there is any man who is engaged to a woman and has not taken her, let him go]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 20:7 (#3)

וּמִי־הָאִ֣ישׁ

“And who {is} the man”

See how you translated the phrase “who is the man” in the previous verse.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 20:7 (#4)

וְלֹ֥א לְקָחָ֖הּ

“and has not taken her”

Moses is referring to marriage and the consummation of marriage in a polite way by using the phrase **has not taken her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and has not yet married her] or [and has not completed the marriage with her]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 20:7 (#5)

פֶּן־יָמוּת֙

“lest he die”

See how you translated “lest” in the two previous verses. Alternate translation: [otherwise he may die]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:8 (#1)

וְיָסְפ֤וּ הַשֹּׁטְרִים֙ לְדַבֵּ֣ר אֶל־הָעָ֔ם וְאָמְר֗וּ מִי־הָאִ֤ישׁ הַיָּרֵא֙ וְרַ֣ךְ הַלֵּבָ֔ב יֵלֵ֖ךְ וְיָשֹׁ֣ב לְבֵית֑וֹ וְלֹ֤א יִמַּס֙ אֶת־לְבַ֣ב אֶחָ֔יו כִּלְבָבֽוֹ

“And the officers shall continue to speak to the people and say, ‘Who {is} the man who fears and {is} soft of heart? Let him go and return to his house, and the heart of his brother will not melt like his heart”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And the officers shall continue to ask the people if there is any man who fears and is soft of heart. They shall tell him to go and return to his house, and the heart of his brother will not melt like his heart]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 20:8 (#2)

וְאָמְר֗וּ

“and say”

The term **and say** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 20:8 (#3)

מִי־הָאִ֤ישׁ הַיָּרֵא֙ וְרַ֣ךְ הַלֵּבָ֔ב יֵלֵ֖ךְ וְיָשֹׁ֣ב לְבֵית֑וֹ

“Who {is} the man who fears and {is} soft of heart? Let him go and return to his house”

If you decided in the previous verse to translate the question as a statement or as an exclamation, you can continue doing that here. Alternate translation: [Any man who fears and is soft of heart should go and return to his house] or [If a man fears and is soft of heart, he must return home]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 20:8 (#4)

מִי־הָאִ֤ישׁ

“Who {is} the man”

See how you translated this phrase in the previous verse.

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 20:8 (#5)

הַיָּרֵא֙ וְרַ֣ךְ הַלֵּבָ֔ב

“who fears and {is} soft of heart”

The terms **fears** and **is soft of heart** mean similar things. Moses is using these two terms together to emphasize the idea of a soldier lacking courage in battle. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express this emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [who is too frightened to fight bravely] or [who lacks courage for battle]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 20:8 (#6)

וְלֹ֤א יִמַּס֙ אֶת־לְבַ֣ב אֶחָ֔יו כִּלְבָבֽוֹ

“and the heart of his brother will not melt like his heart”

The speakers are using **melt ... his heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “become afraid.” The image of a melting heart portrays courage dissolving into fear. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that he will not make his fellow soldiers lose their courage as well] or [to prevent his fear from spreading to the other soldiers]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 20:9 (#1)

כְּכַלֹּ֣ת הַשֹּׁטְרִ֗ים לְדַבֵּ֤ר אֶל־הָעָם֙ וּפָקְד֣וּ שָׂרֵ֔י צְבָאוֹת֙ בְּרֹ֣אשׁ הָעָ֔ם

“as the officers finish speaking to the people, then they shall appoint leaders of the armies as heads of the people”

The phrase **as the officers finish speaking to the people, then they shall appoint leaders** shows a sequence of events with one action following the other. The word “then” indicates that the appointment of leaders happens after the officers finish their speech. If your language has a different way to show this sequence of events, you can use that in your translation. Alternate translation: [after the officers finish speaking to the people, they shall appoint leaders of the armies as heads of the people] or [the officers will first finish speaking to the people and afterward they will appoint leaders of the armies as heads of the people]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:9 (#2)

בְּרֹ֣אשׁ הָעָ֔ם

“as heads of the people”

Here Moses is speaking as if the military leaders were actually the **heads** of the people. Just as the head controls and directs the body, these leaders would command and direct the people in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [leaders who will command the people] or [those who will have authority over the soldiers]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 20:10 (#1)

כִּֽי־תִקְרַ֣ב אֶל־עִ֔יר לְהִלָּחֵ֥ם עָלֶ֖יהָ וְקָרָ֣אתָ אֵלֶ֑יהָ לְשָׁלֽוֹם

“When you draw near to a city to fight against it, then you shall call to it for peace”

Here, **city** and **it** represent the people living in the city. Moses is using the place to refer to its inhabitants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Verses 11–13 continue to refer to the inhabitants in this way. Alternate translation: [When you approach a city to attack the people who live there, first offer them terms of peace] or [When you draw near to a city to fight against its inhabitants, then you shall call to them offering peace]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 20:10 (#2)

לְשָׁלֽוֹם

“for peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to surrender peacefully] or [to agree to peaceful terms]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 20:11 (#1)

שָׁלֹ֔ם

“Peace”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. The word **Peace** is a short response that means the city agrees to surrender peacefully. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [We agree to peace] or [We will surrender peacefully]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 20:11 (#2)

שָׁלֹ֔ם

“Peace”

The single word **Peace** represents the city’s entire response to Israel’s offer. Different languages indicate direct speech in different ways. In your translation, use the punctuation and quotation indicators that are natural for representing this brief response in your language. Alternate translation: [“We accept your peace terms,”] or [that they agree to peace]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 20:11 (#3)

וּפָתְחָ֥ה לָ֖ךְ

“and opens to you”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. It is implied that the city opens its gates to allow the Israelite army to enter. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and opens its gates to you] or [and allows you to enter the city]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 20:11 (#4)

כָּל־הָעָ֖ם הַנִּמְצָ֣א־בָּ֑הּ

“all the people found in it”

The expression **found in it** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [all the people in the city]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 20:12 (#1)

לֹ֣א תַשְׁלִ֤ים עִמָּךְ֙ וְעָשְׂתָ֣ה עִמְּךָ֔ מִלְחָמָ֖ה

“it does not make peace with you and makes war with you”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **peace** and **war**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [it does not surrender peacefully to you and instead fights against you] or [it does not agree to surrender to you and decides to attack you instead]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 20:13 (#1)

וּנְתָנָ֥הּ יְהוָ֛ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ בְּיָדֶ֑ךָ

“and Yahweh your God will give it into your hand”

Here Moses uses the phrase **give it into your hand** as if the city were an object that Yahweh could physically place into the Israelites’ hands. The “hand” represents power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh your God will help you defeat it] or [and Yahweh your God will enable you to conquer it]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 20:13 (#2)

לְפִי־חָ֖רֶב

“by the mouth of the sword”

Moses is using **mouth of the sword** as a common expression of his culture to mean “to kill everyone” or “to completely destroy in battle.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by putting them to the sword] or [by killing every one]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 20:14 (#1)

רַ֣ק הַנָּשִׁ֗ים וְהַטַּ֙ף֙ וְהַבְּהֵמָ֔ה וְכֹ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר יִהְיֶ֥ה בָּעִ֛יר כָּל־שְׁלָלָ֑הּ

“But the women and the children and the cattle and everything that is in the city, all its spoil”

Moses lists specific items and then summarizes them as “all its spoil” to emphasize that the Israelites could take everything valuable from the conquered city. This kind of list followed by a summary term is a way to communicate completeness. You may need to structure this differently in your language to sound natural while conveying the same meaning. Alternate translation: [But all the valuable things in the city—the women, the children, the livestock, and everything else there] or [But everything that can be taken as plunder from the city, including the women, children, livestock, and all other possessions]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 20:14 (#2)

וְאָכַלְתָּ֞ אֶת־שְׁלַ֣ל

“and you shall consume the spoil of”

Moses is using **consume the spoil** as a common expression of his culture to mean “to use and enjoy the plunder taken from enemies.” This does not mean to literally eat everything, but rather to benefit from and make use of the captured goods. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and make use of the plunder of] or [and benefit from everything you have taken from]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 20:15 (#1)

הַגּוֹיִ֖ם־הָאֵ֑לֶּה הֵנָּ֖ה

“these nations here”

It might seem that the expression **these nations here** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. Moses is referring to the Canaanite nations that were living in the land that the Israelites were about to enter. Your readers might not know which nations Moses means, so you may need to make this information explicit. Alternate translation: [the Canaanite nations that are living in the land that Yahweh is giving you] or [these nations that currently occupy the land]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 20:16 (#1)

נַחֲלָֽה

“as} an inheritance”

Moses compares the land that Yahweh is giving to the Israelites to **an inheritance** that parents pass down to their children. Just as children permanently receive property from their parents, the Israelites would permanently receive the land from Yahweh. If this metaphor would be unclear in your language, you could express the meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [as your permanent possession] or [as land that will belong to you and your descendants permanently]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 20:17 (#1)

הַחֲרֵ֣ם תַּחֲרִימֵ֔ם

“devoting, you shall devote them”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **devote** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. The repetition emphasizes that the Israelites must completely devote, or destroy, these nations without exception. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. See how you translated “devoted” at 2:34. Alternate translation: [you must completely devote them] or [you must utterly destroy them]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 20:18 (#1)

לְמַ֨עַן אֲשֶׁ֜ר לֹא־יְלַמְּד֣וּ אֶתְכֶ֗ם לַעֲשׂ֛וֹת כְּכֹ֥ל תּוֹעֲבֹתָ֖ם

“so that they do not teach you to do like any of their abominations”

Here, **so that** marks **they do not teach you to do like any of their abominations** as the goal or purpose of the command to destroy these nations in the previous verse. Moses is explaining that the Israelites must destroy these nations to prevent them from teaching the Israelites to worship false gods. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order to prevent them from teaching you to do the detestable things] or [to make sure they cannot teach you to imitate their disgusting practices]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:18 (#2)

וְחָטָאתֶ֖ם לַיהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“for you will sin against Yahweh your God”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Moses explains that the reason the Israelites should not learn the practices of these nations is that doing so would be sinning against Yahweh. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because doing these things would be sinning against Yahweh your God] or [which would cause you to sin against Yahweh your God]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:18 (#3)

תּוֹעֲבֹתָ֑ם

“their abominations”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abominations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [their detestable practices] or [their rituals that God hates]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 20:19 (#1)

לְהִלָּחֵ֥ם עָלֶ֖יהָ לְתָפְשָׂ֑הּ

“battling against it to capture it”

Here, **to capture it** marks this clause as the goal or purpose of **battling against it**. Moses describes the purpose of the military actions against the city. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [battling against it in order to capture it] or [fighting against it with the goal of taking it]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:19 (#2)

כִּ֣י מִמֶּ֔נּוּ תֹּאכֵ֑ל

“for you shall eat from them”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Moses gives the reason why the Israelites should not destroy the trees during a siege—because these trees provide food. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alter-

nate translation: [because you shall eat from them] or [since they will provide food for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 20:19 (#3)

כִּֽי־ הָאָדָם֙ עֵ֣ץ הַשָּׂדֶ֔ה לָבֹ֥א מִפָּנֶ֖יךָ בַּמָּצֽוֹר

“For is the tree of the field a man to come from your face in the siege”

Moses is using the question form to emphasize that trees are not human enemies who can attack the Israelites. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement. Alternate translation: [For the tree of the field is not a man who can fight against you.] or [Remember, the trees in the field are not people who can attack you.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 20:19 (#4)

לָבֹ֥א מִפָּנֶ֖יךָ בַּמָּצֽוֹר

“to come from your face in the siege”

Moses is using **from your face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to come on account of the siege]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 20:20 (#1)

אֹתָ֥ו תַּשְׁחִ֖ית וְכָרָ֑תָּ

“you shall destroy it and cut down”

The terms **destroy it** and **cut down** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis to make clear that the Israelites may completely remove non-food trees. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [completely cut it down] or [chop it down for your use]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 20:20 (#2)

הָעִ֣יר אֲשֶׁר־ הִ֤וא עֹשָׂה֙ עִמְּךָ֔ מִלְחָמָ֖ה

“the city which it makes war with you”

Here, **the city** and **it** represent the people who are actually fighting. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the city where people are fighting against you] or [the city whose inhabitants are at war with you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 20:20 (#3)

עַ֥ד רִדְתָּ֖הּ

“until it falls”

Moses is using the term **falls** to mean “surrenders” or “is captured.” The city is described as falling when its defenses are overcome. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [until you capture the city] or [until the city surrenders to you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 21 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Atonement for unsolved murder

Verses 1–9 outline a specific ritual for atoning for a murder when the killer is unknown. This involved the elders of the nearest town, a heifer that had never worked, and a valley with running water that had not been cultivated. Breaking the heifer’s neck was a symbolic act to cleanse the land and the community from the guilt of the shed blood, demonstrating the seriousness with which unexplained deaths were treated and the need for communal responsibility. (See: Symbolic Action)

Treatment of female captives of war

Verses 10–14 provide instructions for an Israelite man who wishes to marry a woman taken captive in war. She was to be given a month to mourn her parents, shave her head, and trim her nails. These actions symbolized her transition from her old life and her grief. If the man later decided he did not want her, he had to let her go free and could not sell her, recognizing the humiliation she had already endured.

Rights of the firstborn son

Verses 15–17 address the inheritance rights of the firstborn son, even if he was the son of a less-loved wife. The firstborn was entitled to a double portion of the father’s estate, and this right could not be transferred to the son of a more favored wife. This upheld the

principle of justice and the accepted customs about how the oldest son inherited things.

Dealing with a rebellious son
Verses 18–21 describe a judicial process for a persistently rebellious son who disobeys his parents despite discipline. Such a son was to be brought before the elders at the city gate and, if found guilty, stoned to death by the men of the city. This severe punishment was to remove "the evil" from the community and serve as a deterrent.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Use of "you"
Throughout this chapter "you" is singular. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

"elders and your judges"
In 21:2, the terms "your elders and your judges" refer to distinct but related leadership roles. Elders were respected older men involved in local governance, while judges had a more formal role in adjudicating legal cases. If these specific roles are not familiar, use terms for similar leadership positions in your culture or a descriptive phrase. (See: Translate Unknowns)

"Cover, Yahweh, your people Israel"
In 21:8, the elders pray, "Cover, Yahweh, your people Israel." The word "Cover" is a metaphor asking Yahweh to forgive and protect his people from the guilt of the unsolved murder.

"beginning of his strength"
The phrase "he is the beginning of his strength" in 21:17, referring to the firstborn son, is a metaphor for the father's first demonstration of his ability to produce offspring.

Deuteronomy 21:1 (#1)

כִּי־יִמָּצֵא חָלָל בָּאֲדָמָה֙ אֲשֶׁר֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ נֹתֵ֥ן לְךָ֖ לְרִשְׁתָּ֑הּ נֹפֵ֣ל בַּשָּׂדֶ֔ה לֹ֥א נוֹדַ֖ע מִכֵּ֥ה הַכֹּֽהוּ

"If one slain is found in the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you to possess it, fallen in the field, {and} it is not known who has struck him"

Moses is describing a possible condition in which someone is found murdered and the killer is unknown. The instructions for what they should do if this situation occurs is described in verses 2–9. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Suppose someone is found murdered in the land that Yahweh your God is giving you to possess, lying in a field, and no one knows who killed him]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 21:1 (#2)

כִּי־יִמָּצֵא חָלָל

"If one slain is found"

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If someone finds a dead person]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:1 (#3)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

"Yahweh your God"

See how you translated the phrase "Yahweh your God" in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 21:1 (#4)

לֹ֥א נוֹדַ֖ע מִכֵּ֥ה הַכֹּֽהוּ

"and} it is not known who has struck him"

The expression **it is not known** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and no one knows who killed him] or [and you cannot identify who attacked him]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:2 (#1)

וּמָדְד֣וּ אֶל־הֶֽעָרִ֗ים

"and they shall measure to the cities"

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they shall measure the distance from where the body was found to the cities]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 21:2 (#2)

הֶחָלָ֖ל

“the slain”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. The same occurs in the next verse. Alternate translation: [the slain person’s body] or [the location where the murdered person was found]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 21:3 (#1)

עֶגְלַ֣ת בָּקָ֔ר אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־עֻבַּ֖ד בָּ֑הּ

“a heifer of the herd, one that has not been put to work”

The expression **has not been put to work** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a heifer of the herd, one that no one has ever used for work]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:4 (#1)

אֵיתָ֔ן אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יֵעָבֵ֖ד בּ֑וֹ וְלֹ֣א יִזָּרֵ֔עַ

“with running water, that has not been worked in, nor sown”

This describes a place that should be completely natural and untouched by human cultivation. This symbolizes innocence and purity in this ritual for dealing with an unresolved murder. You may want to explain this symbolism in a footnote.

Deuteronomy 21:4 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־יֵעָבֵ֖ד בּ֑וֹ וְלֹ֣א יִזָּרֵ֔עַ

“that has not been worked in, nor sown”

The expression **that has not been worked in, nor sown** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [where no one has ever plowed or planted seeds]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:4 (#3)

וְעָרְפ֥וּ־שָׁ֛ם אֶת־הָעֶגְלָ֖ה בַּנָּחַ֑ל

“and there they shall break the neck of the heifer in the valley”

Breaking the neck of a heifer was a symbolic action that showed that the community was dealing with the guilt of an unsolved murder even though they were not responsible for it. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and there in the valley the elders shall break the neck of the heifer to show that they are free from guilt for the murder]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 21:5 (#1)

הַכֹּהֲנִ֗ים בְּנֵ֤י לֵוִי֙

“the priests, the sons of Levi”

The phrases **the priests** and **the sons of Levi** mean similar things. Moses is using the two phrases together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the Levitical priests]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 21:5 (#2)

וְנִגְּשׁ֖וּ

“And & shall come forward”

Alternate translation: [And … must come to the valley]

Deuteronomy 21:5 (#3)

כִּ֣י

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 21:5 (#4)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

Even though Moses is speaking to a group of people, the Israelites, **your** is singular in this verse. If the singular forms of this pronoun would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural form in your translation.

See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups

Deuteronomy 21:5 (#5)

בְּשֵׁ֣ם יְהוָ֔ה

“in the name of Yahweh”

Here, **in the name of Yahweh** represents “with Yahweh’s authority.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with Yahweh’s authority and as his representatives]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 21:5 (#6)

וְעַל־פִּיהֶ֖ם יִהְיֶ֣ה כָל־רִ֑יב וְכָל־נָֽגַע

“and upon their mouth is every dispute and every assault”

Here, **mouth** represents “authority.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and they have the authority to make decisions about every dispute and case of assault]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 21:6 (#1)

יִרְחֲצ֣וּ אֶת־יְדֵיהֶ֗ם עַל־הָעֶגְלָ֛ה

“shall wash their hands over the heifer”

The elders washing their hands over the heifer was a symbolic action that showed they were declaring their innocence in the death of the murdered person. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [shall, in order to declare their innocence, wash their hands over the heifer]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 21:6 (#2)

הָעֶגְלָ֖ה הָעֲרוּפָֽה

“the heifer whose neck was broken”

The expression **was broken** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [the heifer whose neck the elders broke]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:7 (#1)

וְעָנ֖וּ וְאָמְר֑וּ

“and they shall respond and say”

Here the elders are responding to a situation, not to something that someone said. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and they shall say in response to the murder situation]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 21:7 (#2)

וְעָנ֖וּ וְאָמְר֑וּ

“and they shall respond and say”

The term **and say** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [and they shall respond] or [and they shall answer]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 21:7 (#3)

יָדֵ֣ינוּ לֹ֤א שפכה אֶת־הַדָּ֨ם הַזֶּ֔ה

“Our hands have not spilled this blood”

The elders are using one part of their bodies **Our hands**, to mean all of them in the act of spilling the blood. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [We have not spilled this blood]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 21:7 (#4)

יָדֵ֣ינוּ לֹ֤א שפכה אֶת־הַדָּ֨ם הַזֶּ֔ה

“Our hands have not spilled this blood”

Here the phrase **spilled this blood** is being used as a common expression of this culture to mean “kill this person.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Our hands have not killed this person]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 21:7 (#5)

וְעֵינֵ֖ינוּ לֹ֥א רָאֽוּ

“and our eyes have not seen”

The elders are using one part of their bodies **our eyes**, to mean all of them in the act of seeing the murder. If

it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [nor have we seen it]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 21:7 (#6)

לֹא רָאוּ

“have not seen”

The elders are leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [have not seen it happen] or [have not seen who killed this person]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 21:8 (#1)

כַּפֵּר

“Cover”

Here the elders are speaking as if Yahweh could literally **Cover** his people Israel. They are asking God to protect his people from guilt. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Forgive] or [Show mercy to]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 21:8 (#2)

וְאַל־תִּתֵּן דָּם נָקִי בְּקֶרֶב עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“and do not put the blood of the innocent in the midst of your people Israel”

The speakers are using **put the blood of the innocent in the midst of your people Israel** as a common expression of their culture to mean “hold your people responsible for the murder of an innocent person.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and do not hold your people Israel accountable for the death of this innocent person] or [and do not charge your people Israel with the guilt of this murder]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 21:8 (#3)

דָּם נָקִי

“the blood of the innocent”

Moses is using the adjective **innocent** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the blood of the person who has not done anything wrong]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 21:8 (#4)

וְנִכַּפֶּר לָהֶם הַדָּם

“And the blood will be covered for them”

The expression **be covered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Then Yahweh will cover the guilt of this bloodshed and forgive his people] or [Then Yahweh will remove their guilt for this death]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:8 (#5)

וְנִכַּפֶּר לָהֶם הַדָּם

“And the blood will be covered for them”

Here Moses is speaking as if the guilt of shedding **blood** were actually something that could be **covered**. This refers to the guilt of bloodshed being forgiven or hidden from sight. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they will be forgiven for the death of this person] or [And Yahweh will remove their guilt for this bloodshed]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 21:9 (#1)

כִּי־תַעֲשֶׂה הַיָּשָׁר

“when you do right”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **right**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when you do what Yahweh considers righteous]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 21:9 (#2)

הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“right in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the phrase “in the eyes of” in 4:25. Alternate translation: [what is right in Yahweh’s judgment]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 21:10 (#1)

וּנְתָנוֹ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּיָדֶךָ

“and Yahweh your God gives them into your hands”

Here Moses is speaking as if the enemies were actually objects which could be placed **into your hands**. This expression represents God giving the Israelites victory over their enemies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled by the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 21:10 (#2)

וְשָׁבִיתָ שִׁבְיוֹ

“and you take its captive captive”

In this verse, the word **captive** is singular in form, but it refers to all the enemies as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form. Alternate translation: [and you take its captives captive]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 21:10 (#3)

וְשָׁבִיתָ שִׁבְיוֹ

“and you take its captive captive”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **captive**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and you take them away as people you have captured]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 21:12 (#1)

וְגִלְּחָה֙ אֶת־רֹאשָׁ֔הּ וְעָשְׂתָ֖ה אֶת־צִפָּרְנֶֽיהָ

“And she shall shave her head and do her nails”

The instructions to **shave her head and do her nails** was a symbolic action that showed a transition from her prior identity to her new status, and was also part of mourning practices. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And she shall shave her head and trim her nails as part of her mourning and transition to her new life]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 21:13 (#1)

תָּבֹא֙ אֵלֶ֔יהָ

“you shall go in to her”

Moses is referring to sexual intimacy in a polite way by using the phrase **go in to her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [you shall become intimate with her] or [you shall have sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 21:14 (#1)

תַּ֣חַת אֲשֶׁ֔ר עִנִּיתָ֖הּ

“in return for humiliating her”

The implication is that the man has already humiliated the woman by taking her captive, making her change her appearance and identity, having sexual relations with her, and then rejecting her. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in return for having already humiliated her by taking her captive, changing her identity, and then rejecting her]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 21:15 (#1)

כִּֽי־תִהְיֶ֨יֶן לְאִ֜ישׁ שְׁתֵּ֣י נָשִׁ֗ים הָאַחַת֙ אֲהוּבָ֔ה וְהָאַחַ֖ת שְׂנוּאָ֑ה וְיָלְד֨וּ־לוֹ֙ בָּנִ֔ים הָאֲהוּבָ֖ה וְהַשְּׂנוּאָ֑ה וְהָיָ֞ה הַבֵּ֣ן הַבְּכֹר֗ לַשְּׂנוּאָֽה

“If a man has two wives, one loved and one hated, and they have borne him sons, the loved and the hated, and it happens that the firstborn son {is} of the hated”

Moses is describing a possible condition in which the events in verse 16 will take place only if a man has two wives and the firstborn son belongs to the wife he does not love. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Suppose a man has two wives, one whom he loves and one whom he does not love, and both have given him sons, and the firstborn son belongs to the wife he does not love]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 21:15 (#2)

הָאַחַ֖ת אֲהוּבָ֑ה וְהָאַחַ֖ת שְׂנוּאָֽה

“one loved and one hated”

The terms **loved** and **hated** are passive verbal forms. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the man loves one wife more than he loves the other wife]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:15 (#3)

הָאֶהוּבָה וְהַשְּׂנוּאָה וְהָיָה הַבֵּן הַבְּכֹר לַשְּׂנִיאָה

“the loved and the hated, and it happens that the firstborn son {is} of the hated”

Moses is using the adjectives **loved** and **hated** as nouns to mean certain kinds of wives. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [both the wife he loves and the wife he does not love, and if the firstborn son’s mother happens to be the wife he does not love]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 21:16 (#1)

אֶת־בֶּן־הָאֲהוּבָה

“the son of the beloved”

Moses is using the adjective **beloved** as a noun to mean a certain kind of wife. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the son of the beloved wife]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 21:16 (#2)

עַל־פְּנֵי בֶן־הַשְּׂנוּאָה

“upon the face of the son of the hated”

Moses is using **upon the face of** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in preference to” or “instead of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [instead of the son of the wife he does not love] or [at the expense of the son of the wife he does not love]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 21:16 (#3)

בֶּן־הַשְּׂנוּאָה

“the son of the hated”

Moses is using the adjective **hated** as a noun to mean a certain kind of wife. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. This phrase repeats in the next verse. Alternate translation: [the son of the wife he does not love]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 21:17 (#1)

פִּפְיִ שְׁנַיִם בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־יִמָּצֵא לוֹ

“a double portion of all that is found of his”

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [a double portion of all that he owns]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:17 (#2)

כִּי־הוּא רֵאשִׁית אֹנִוֹ

“for he {is} the beginning of his strength”

By **the beginning of his strength**, Moses means the man’s first demonstration of his ability to father children. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers as modeled in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 21:17 (#3)

לוֹ מִשְׁפַּט הַבְּכֹרָה

“the regulation of the firstborn {is} his”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **regulation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [he has the legal rights that belong to a firstborn son] or [he is entitled to what the law requires for a firstborn son]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 21:18 (#1)

כִּי־יִהְיֶה לְאִישׁ בֵּן סוֹרֵר וּמוֹרֶה

“If a man has a stubborn and rebellious son”

Moses is describing a possible condition of having a rebellious son. The instructions for what they should do in this situation is described in verses 19–21. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If it should happen that a man has a stubborn and rebellious son]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 21:18 (#2)

אֵינֶנּוּ שֹׁמֵעַ בְּקֹלָ֣ם & וְלֹ֥א יִשְׁמַ֖ע אֲלֵיהֶֽם

“who will not listen to the voice of & but he will not listen to them”

Here Moses assumes that readers will know that the word translated as **listen** includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [who will not obey the voice of … but he will not obey them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 21:18 (#3)

אֵינֶנּוּ שֹׁמֵעַ בְּקֹלָ֣ם אָבִ֔יו וּבְקֹ֖ל אִמּ֑וֹ

“who will not listen to the voice of his father or the voice of his mother”

Here, **the voice** represents the commands or instructions the parents give. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [who will not obey his parents’ instructions]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 21:18 (#4)

וְיִסְּר֥וּ אֹת֛וֹ וְלֹ֥א יִשְׁמַ֖ע אֲלֵיהֶֽם

“and they chastise him, but he will not listen to them”

Moses uses the word **but** here to indicate a contrast between the parents’ discipline and the son’s continued disobedience. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and even though they discipline him, he still will not obey them]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 21:20 (#1)

וְאָמְר֗וּ אֶל־זִקְנֵ֤י עִירוֹ֙ בְּנֵ֣נוּ זֶ֔ה סוֹרֵ֥ר וּמֹרֶ֖ה אֵינֶ֣נּוּ שֹׁמֵ֣עַ בְּקֹלֵ֑נוּ זוֹלֵ֖ל וְסֹבֵֽא

“And they shall say to the elders of his city, ‘This son of ours {is} stubborn and rebellious; he will not listen to our voice; {he is} a glutton and a drunkard”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Then the parents must explain to the elders of the city that their son is stubborn and rebellious, that he will not obey them, and that he is a glutton and a drunkard.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 21:20 (#2)

אֵינֶ֣נּוּ שֹׁמֵ֣עַ בְּקֹלֵ֑נוּ

“he will not listen to our voice”

Here, **our voice** represents the parents’ instructions or commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [he will not obey our instructions]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 21:21 (#1)

וּבָעַרְתָּ֥ הָרָ֖ע מִקִּרְבֶּֽךָ

“and you shall remove the evil from among you”

See how you translated this same phrase in 13:5.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 21:21 (#2)

וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל יִשְׁמְע֥וּ וְיִרָֽאוּ

“And all Israel will hear and fear”

The words **And all Israel will hear and fear** indicate the result of executing the rebellious son. If it would be clearer in your language, you could make this logical relationship explicit. Alternate translation: [As a result, all Israel will hear about this punishment and be afraid to behave in the same way]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 21:22 (#1)

מִשְׁפַּט־מָ֖וֶת

“a judgment of {which is} death”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **judgment**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a crime that requires the death penalty] or [an offense for which he deserves to die]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 21:22 (#2)

וְהוּמָֽת

“and he is put to death”

The expression **is put to death** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and you execute him] or [and you kill him]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:23 (#1)

לֹא־תָלִ֨ין נִבְלָתֹ֜ו עַל־הָעֵ֗ץ כִּ֤י־קָבֹר֙ תִּקְבְּרֶ֣נּוּ בַּיֹּ֔ום הַה֖וּא כִּֽי־קִלְלַ֣ת אֱלֹהִ֔ים תָּלֽוּי

“his corpse shall not remain on the tree. Instead, you shall surely bury him that day; for cursed of God {is} a hanged man”

The word **for** indicates that what follows, **cursed of God is a hanged man**, is the reason for the command that came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases to put the reason before the command. Alternate translation: [because a hanged man is cursed by God, his corpse shall not remain on the tree. Instead, you shall surely bury him that day]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 21:23 (#2)

קִלְלַ֣ת אֱלֹהִ֔ים תָּלֽוּי

“cursed of God {is} a hanged man”

The expression **cursed of God** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [God curses anyone who hangs on a tree]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 21:23 (#3)

וְלֹ֥א תְטַמֵּ֛א אֶת־אַדְמָתְךָ֖ אֲשֶׁר־ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ נֹתֵ֥ן לְךָ֛ נַחֲלָֽה

“And you shall not defile your land that Yahweh your God is giving to you {as} an inheritance”

Here Moses connects not leaving a corpse on a tree to not defiling the land that God is giving to the Israelites. This connection shows purpose or goal. In your language, you may need to express this relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [You must do this so that you do not defile the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you as an inheritance]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy - Chapter 22 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five.

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Maintaining order and integrity

Many laws in this chapter aim to maintain order, compassion, and integrity within the Israelite community. These include returning lost property (22:1–3), helping a fallen animal (22:4), preserving distinct gender roles in dress (22:5), showing compassion to mother birds (22:6–7), ensuring safety in home construction (22:8), and avoiding prohibited mixtures in agriculture and clothing (22:9–11). These laws reflect Yahweh’s concern for justice, kindness, and holiness in everyday life.

Purity and separation

The prohibitions against mixing seeds in a vineyard (22:9), plowing with an ox and a donkey together (22:10), and wearing clothing woven of wool and linen together (22:11) symbolize the importance of maintaining distinctions and purity. These laws served as tangible reminders for Israel to remain a people set apart for Yahweh, distinct from surrounding nations and their practices.

Marital purity and justice in accusations

A significant portion of the chapter (22:13–29) deals with issues of marital purity, accusations of premarital sex, adultery, and rape. The laws provide procedures for verifying a bride’s virginity if questioned and prescribe severe penalties for false accusations, adultery, and sexual violence. These laws aimed to protect the integrity of marriage, ensure justice, and remove evil from the community. The requirement for a bloodstained cloth as proof of virginity (22:15–17) was a specific cultural practice.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Use of “you”

Throughout this chapter “you” is singular except for where noted in verse 24. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of “you.” If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use

the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Repetition for emphasis (reduplication)
Moses uses repetition of verb forms for emphasis in several commands.

Euphemisms for sexual relations
This chapter uses several euphemisms for sexual intercourse.

"uncover the hem of his father"
The idiom in 22:30, "he shall not uncover the hem of his father," means to have sexual relations with his father's wife, thereby violating his father's marriage and honor. If this idiom is not clear, translate it with its plain meaning. (See: Idiom)

Deuteronomy 22:1 (#1)

אָחִֽיךָ

"your brother"

Moses is using the term **brothers** to describe people who are descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 22:1 (#2)

נִדָּחִ֖ים

"be scattered"

The expression **be scattered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [wandering away]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 22:1 (#3)

וְהִתְעַלַּ֥מְתָּ מֵהֶ֖ם

"and hide yourself from them"

Here Moses is speaking as if a person could literally **hide yourself from them** when seeing lost animals. This is a metaphor for deliberately ignoring something that needs attention and avoiding responsibility. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. This same phrasing appears in verses 3–4 as well. Alternate translation: [pretend you do not see them] or [deliberately ignore your responsibility to help]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 22:1 (#4)

וְהִתְעַלַּ֥מְתָּ

"and hide yourself"

The word **yourself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Moses is emphasizing that a person should not deliberately avoid helping when they see a lost animal. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [pretend not to see them] or [deliberately ignore them]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 22:1 (#5)

הָשֵׁ֣שָׁב תְּשִׁיבֵ֔ם

"Returning, you shall return them"

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **return** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. This emphasizes the obligation to definitely return the lost animal. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you must certainly return them] or [you absolutely must return them]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 22:2 (#1)

וְאִם־לֹ֤א קָרֹ֙וב אָחִ֣יךָ אֵלֶ֔יךָ וְלֹ֥א יְדַעְתּ֖וֹ וַאֲסַפְתּ֑וֹ

"And if your brother {is} not near to you, or you do not know him, then gather it"

Moses is describing a possible condition in which someone would only take the lost animal to his home if the owner either lives far away or is unknown to the finder. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And if you do not know who owns the animal or the owner lives far away from you, then bring it home]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 22:3 (#1)

וְכֵ֣ן תַּעֲשֶׂ֗ה לַחֲמֹרֹו֙ וְכֵ֣ן תַּעֲשֶׂ֔ה לְשִׂמְלָתֹ֖ו וְכֵ֣ן תַּעֲשֶׂ֑ה לְכָל־אֲבֵדַ֣ת אָחִ֗יךָ אֲשֶׁר־תֹּאבַ֤ד מִמֶּ֙נּוּ֙ וּמְצָאתָ֔הּ

"And thus you shall do for his donkey; and thus you shall do for his clothing; and thus you shall do for

every lost thing of your brother, which is lost from him and you have found it”

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive. He repeats “and thus you shall do” for different items to emphasize that this principle applies to all lost possessions, not just livestock. Use a form in your language that someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive. Alternate translation: [Do the same for his donkey, his clothing, and anything else your fellow Israelite loses that you find]

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 22:4 (#1)

הָקֵ֥ם תָּקִ֖ים עִמּֽוֹ

“lifting, you shall lift it up”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **lift** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. This emphasizes the obligation to definitely help the fallen animal. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you must certainly help it up] or [you absolutely must assist in getting it back on its feet]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 22:5 (#1)

תּוֹעֲבַ֣ת

“are} an abomination”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. The term refers to something that disgusts or deeply offends Yahweh. Alternate translation: [are detestable] or [are greatly offensive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 22:5 (#2)

יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“to Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10. Alternate translation: [to Yahweh, the God we worship]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 22:6 (#1)

לְפָנֶ֔יךָ

“to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents being in front of something. Moses is using this expression to describe something an Israelite might encounter directly in their path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of you] or [along your way]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:7 (#1)

שַׁלֵּ֣חַ תְּשַׁלַּ֔ח אֶת־הָאֵ֖ם

“Sending, you shall send {away} the mother”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **send** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. This emphasizes the absolute requirement to release the mother bird. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [You must certainly let the mother bird go free] or [You absolutely must release the mother bird]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 22:7 (#2)

לְמַ֣עַן ׀ יִֽיטַב־לָ֗ךְ וְהַאֲרַכְתָּ֥ יָמִֽים

“so that it may go well with you, and you may prolong {your} days”

Here, **so that** marks **it may go well with you, and you may prolong your days** as the goal or purpose of following the command to release the mother bird. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [for if you do this, then things will go well for you and you will have a long life] or [by doing this, you will ensure prosperity and a long life]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 22:7 (#3)

וְהַאֲרַכְתָּ֥ יָמִֽים

“and you may prolong {your} days”

See how you translated the phrase “prolong your days” in 4:26. Alternate translation: [and you may live for many years] or [and you may have a long life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:8 (#1)

מַעֲקֶה לְגַגֶּךָ

“a railing for your roof”

A **railing** is a kind of protective barrier or wall built around the edge of a flat roof to prevent people from falling off. In ancient Israel, roofs were typically flat and used as living spaces, making safety features necessary. If your readers would not be familiar with what a railing is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [a protective fence around the edge of your flat roof] or [a safety barrier surrounding the perimeter of your rooftop]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 22:8 (#2)

וְלֹא־תָשִׂים דָּמִים בְּבֵיתֶךָ

“and you will not bring blood on your house”

Here, **and** marks **you will not bring blood on your house** as the goal or purpose of making a railing for the roof. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [so that you will not be responsible for the death] or [in this way, you will prevent becoming liable for someone’s death]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 22:8 (#3)

וְלֹא־תָשִׂים דָּמִים בְּבֵיתֶךָ

“and you will not bring blood on your house”

Here, **blood** represents guilt for someone’s death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in order to avoid being guilty of causing someone’s death]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:8 (#4)

כִּי־יִפֹּל הַנֹּפֵל מִמֶּנּוּ

“if one who falls should fall from it”

Moses is describing a possible condition in which homeowners would be responsible for bloodguilt only if someone falls from their roof without a railing. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [should anyone ever fall from your roof and die] or [in case someone were to fall from your roof and die]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 22:9 (#1)

לֹא־תִזְרַע כַּרְמְךָ כִּלְאָיִם

“You shall not plant your vineyard with two kinds of seed”

Planting a vineyard with two kinds of seed was a symbolic action that showed the importance of maintaining separation and purity. This prohibition represented how Israel was to remain distinct and set apart from other nations, not mixing their religious and cultural practices with those of surrounding peoples. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [You shall not mix different types of seed in your vineyard to show that you must remain pure and unmixed with other nations]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 22:9 (#2)

פֶּן־תִּקְדַּשׁ הַמְלֵאָה הַזֶּרַע אֲשֶׁר תִּזְרָע וּתְבוּאַת הַכָּרֶם

“lest all the produce of the seed that you have sown and the yield of the vineyard be set apart”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [otherwise all the produce of the seed that you have sown and the yield of the vineyard will be set apart]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 22:9 (#3)

תִּקְדַּשׁ

“be set apart”

This could mean: (1) the crops would become dedicated to Yahweh, and sent to the priests and Levites for their food. Alternate translation: [be dedicated to Yahweh] or (2) the crops would be defiled and could not be eaten by anyone or offered to Yahweh. Alternate translation: [be defiled and have to be destroyed]

Deuteronomy 22:11 (#1)

צֶמֶר וּפִשְׁתִּים

“wool and linen”

The term **wool** is a kind of soft, curly fiber that grows on sheep, and **linen** is a kind of fabric made from flax plant fibers. If your readers would not be familiar with what wool and linen are, you could use the names of similar materials that your readers would recognize, or you could use more general terms. Alternate translation: [animal fiber and plant fiber] or [sheep hair fabric and flax plant fabric]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 22:12 (#1)

גְּדִלִים

“tassels”

The term **tassels** is used for a kind of decorative bunch of threads or cords that are tied together at one end and hang freely at the other end. These were attached to the corners of garments for religious purposes to help Israelites remember God’s commandments. If your readers would not be familiar with what a tassel is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [decorative thread bundles] or [hanging cord ornaments]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 22:13 (#1)

וּבָא אֵלֶיהָ

“and he goes in to her”

Moses is referring to sexual relations in a polite way by using the phrase **he goes in to her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and he consummates the marriage with her] or [and he has sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:13 (#2)

כִּי־יִקַּח אִישׁ אִשָּׁה

“If a man takes a wife”

Moses is introducing a possible condition that he describes in this verse and the next. The instruction for what the parents should do if this condition happens comes in verse 15. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a situation such as this.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 22:14 (#1)

וְשָׂמָם לָהּ עֲלִילוֹת דְּבָרִים

“and accuses her of shameful things”

Moses is referring to sexual immorality in a polite way by using the phrase **accuses her of shameful things**. This refers to a husband claiming his wife was not a virgin before marriage. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and accuses her of immoral behavior before marriage] or [and claims she was sexually active before they married]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:14 (#2)

וְהוֹצִיא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רָע

“and brings against her a bad name”

Here, **name** represents “reputation.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and damages her reputation] or [and spreads rumors that harm how others view her]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:14 (#3)

וְאָמַר אֶת־הָאִשָּׁה הַזֹּאת לָקַחְתִּי וָאֶקְרַב אֵלֶיהָ וְלֹא־מָצָאתִי לָהּ בְּתוּלִים

“and says, ‘I took this woman, and I came near to her, and I did not find her virginity”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [and publicly declares that he took this woman and came near to her but did not find her virginity]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 22:14 (#4)

וָאֶקְרַב אֵלֶיהָ

“and I came near to her”

The husband is referring to sexual relations in a polite way by using the phrase **I came near to her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or

you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and I was intimate with her] or [and I had sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:15 (#1)

אֶת־בְּתוּלֵ֥י הנער

“the virginity of”

Here, **virginity of the girl** represents physical evidence of the girl’s virginity, which would typically be a cloth with bloodstains from the wedding night. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [evidence of the girl’s virginity] or [the bloodstained cloth that proves the girl was a virgin]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:16–17 (#1)

וְאָמַ֣ר אֲבִ֣י הַנַּעֲרָ֗ה אֶל־הַזְּקֵנִים֙ אֶת־בִּתִּ֣י נָתַ֔תִּי לָאִ֥ישׁ הַזֶּ֖ה לְאִשָּׁ֑ה וַיִּשְׂנָאֶ֕הָ: וְהִנֵּה־ה֥וּא שָׂ֛ם עֲלִילֹ֥ת דְּבָרִ֖ים לֵאמֹ֑ר לֹֽא־מָצָ֤אתִי לְבִתֵּךְ֙ בְּתוּלִ֔ים וְאֵ֖לֶּה בְּתוּלֵ֣י בִתִּ֑י

“QUOTE_NOT_FOUND: וְאָמַ֣ר אֲבִ֣י הַנַּעֲרָ֗ה אֶל־הַזְּקֵנִים֙ אֶת־בִּתִּ֣י נָתַ֔תִּי לָאִ֥ישׁ הַזֶּ֖ה לְאִשָּׁ֑ה וַיִּשְׂנָאֶ֕הָ: וְהִנֵּה־ה֥וּא שָׂ֛ם עֲלִילֹ֥ת דְּבָרִ֖ים לֵאמֹ֑ר לֹֽא־מָצָ֤אתִי לְבִתֵּךְ֙ בְּתוּלִ֔ים וְאֵ֖לֶּה בְּתוּלֵ֣י בִתִּ֑י”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting the father of the bride (level 2) explaining what the groom said (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation.

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 22:17 (#1)

עֲלִילֹ֥ת דְּבָרִ֖ים & בְּתוּלִֽים

“shameful things & virginity”

See how you translated the phrase “shameful things” in verse 14 and the term “virginity” in verse 15.

Deuteronomy 22:17 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֖י

“to the faces of”

Moses is using the expression **to the faces of** to mean “before” or “in the presence of” the elders. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [before] or [to show]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:19 (#1)

וְעָנְשׁ֗וּ אֹת֛וֹ & כִּֽי־הוֹצִ֥יא שֵׁ֖ם רָ֑ע עַ֚ל בְּתוּלַ֣ת יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“and they shall fine him & because he has brought a bad name upon a virgin of Israel”

The word **because** introduces the reason for the punishment that is described. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases and combine them at the beginning of the verse, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [and for bringing a bad name upon a virgin of Israel, they shall fine him]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 22:19 (#2)

מֵאָ֣ה כֶ֔סֶף

“100 silvers”

100 silvers refers to a common monetary unit for Israelites. You could try to express this in terms of modern money values, but if you did, that could cause your Bible translation to become outdated and inaccurate, since those values can change over time. Instead, you might say something general like “100 silver coins,” or “100 pieces of silver,” or use the biblical term in the text and explain the value in a note.

See: Biblical Money

Deuteronomy 22:19 (#3)

שֵׁ֖ם רָֽע

“a bad name”

See how you translated the expression “a bad name” in 22:14.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:20 (#1)

וְאִם־אֱמֶ֥ת הָיְתָ֖ה הַדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֑ה

“But if this thing is true”

Moses uses the word **But** here to indicate a contrast between the previous case (where the accusation against the girl was false) and this case (where the accusation might be true). In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language.

Alternate translation: [However, if this accusation is true]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 22:20 (#2)

וְאִם־אֱמֶ֣ת הָיָ֔ה הַדָּבָ֖ר הַזֶּֽה

“But if this thing is true”

Moses is describing a possible situation in which certain consequences will follow only if the accusation against the young woman is true. The description of the possible situation begins in verse 13 and the consequences are described in verse 21. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But should this accusation prove true]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 22:20 (#3)

לֹא־נִמְצְא֥וּ בְתוּלִ֖ים לנער

“virginity was not found in the girl”

The expression **was not found** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that the man did not find proof that the girl was a virgin]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 22:20 (#4)

לֹא־נִמְצְא֥וּ בְתוּלִ֖ים לנער

“virginity was not found in the girl”

See how you translated this similar situation in 22:14–15. Alternate translation: [evidence was not found proving that the young woman had kept herself pure until marriage]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 22:21 (#1)

וּבָעַרְתָּ֥ הָרָ֛ע מִקִּרְבֶּ֖ךָ

“and you shall remove the evil from among you”

See how you translated this same phrase in 13:5.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 22:22 (#1)

כִּֽי־יִמָּצֵ֞א אִ֣ישׁ

“If a man is found”

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If someone finds a man]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 22:22 (#2)

שֹׁכֵ֥ב ׀ עִם

“lying with”

Moses is referring to sexual intercourse in a polite way by using the phrase **lying with**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [having intimate relations with] or [having sex with]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:22 (#3)

וּבָעַרְתָּ֥ הָרָ֖ע מִיִּשְׂרָאֵֽל

“and you shall remove the evil from Israel”

See how you translated this similar phrase in the previous verse.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 22:23 (#1)

כִּֽי יִהְיֶ֨ה נער בְּתוּלָ֜ה

“If {there} is a virgin girl”

Moses is introducing a possible situation in this verse and in the next verse he gives the instructions for what to do if this situation occurs. Express this possible condition in a way that would be natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If it should happen that a virgin girl who is]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 22:23 (#2)

וְשָׁכַ֥ב עִמָּ֖הּ

“and lies with her”

Moses is referring to sexual intercourse in a polite way by using the phrase **lies with her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [and is intimate with her] or [and has sexual relations with her]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:24 (#1)

עַל־דְּבַרׇ אֲשֶׁר לֹא־צָעֲקָה

“on account of the matter that she did not cry out”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [because she did not cry out for help when she was attacked]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 22:24 (#2)

וְהוֹצֵאתֶם

“then you shall take”

The word **you** is plural here. So use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 22:24 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־עִנָּה אֶת־אֵשֶׁת רֵעֵהוּ

“that he humiliated the wife of his neighbor”

Although the woman was only engaged, not yet married, she was called a “wife” because in Israelite culture, an engaged woman was legally considered to belong to her future husband. Some cultures might need to explain this concept in a footnote.

Deuteronomy 22:24 (#4)

וּבָעַרְתָּ הָרָע מִקִּרְבֶּךָ

“and you shall remove the evil from among you”

See how you translated this same phrase in 13:5.

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 22:26 (#1)

חֵטְא מָוֶת

“sin of death”

Moses is using **sin of death** as a common expression of his culture to mean “an offense deserving the death penalty.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [offense deserving death] or [crime worthy of execution]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 22:26 (#2)

כִּי כַּאֲשֶׁרׇ יָקוּם אִישׁ עַל־רֵעֵהוּ וּרְצָחֹו נֶפֶשׁ כֵּן הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה

“For as a man rises up against his neighbor and murders him, the life, thus {is} this matter”

This is referring to the situation described in 21:1 and following.

Deuteronomy 22:28 (#1)

וְנִמְצָאוּ

“and they are discovered”

The expression **are discovered** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [if somebody finds out what happened]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 22:29 (#1)

חֲמִשִּׁים כָּסֶף

“50 silvers”

See how you translated the similar expression in 22:19.

See: Biblical Money

Deuteronomy 22:29 (#2)

עִנָּהּ

“he has violated her”

Moses is referring to sexual assault by using the phrase **violated her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [he dishonored her] or [he forced her to have sexual relations]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:30 (#1)

לֹא־יִקַּח & אֶת־אֵשֶׁת אָבִיו

“shall not take the wife of his father”

Moses is referring to sexual relations with a father’s wife in a polite way by using the phrase **take the wife of his father**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to

this in your language or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [shall not marry his father's wife] or [shall not have sexual relations with his father's wife]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 22:30 (#2)

וְלֹ֥א יְגַלֶּ֖ה כְּנַ֥ף אָבִֽיו

"and he shall not uncover the hem of his father"

Moses is using **uncover the hem of his father** as a common expression of his culture to mean "dishonor his father." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he shall not dishonor his father's marriage bed]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy - Chapter 23 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses' second speech, which began in chapter five.

1. Exclusions from the assembly of Yahweh (1–8)
2. Those with physical defects (1)
3. Those born of intermarriage (2)
4. Ammonites and Moabites (3–6)
5. Edomites and Egyptians (7–8)
6. Maintaining holiness in the military camp (9–14)
7. Various laws concerning social and religious conduct (15–25)
8. Protecting escaped slaves (15–16)
9. Prohibition of cultic prostitution (17–18)
10. Laws on charging interest (19–20)
11. Fulfilling vows (21–23)
12. Gleaning from a neighbor's field (24–25)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The assembly of Yahweh

The phrase "assembly of Yahweh" (or "Yahweh's people" in the simplified text) appears multiple times at the beginning of this chapter (1, 2, 3, 8). This term refers to the formal, convened community of Israel, particularly when gathered for religious worship, legal decisions, or important communal matters. Exclusion from this assembly meant being barred from full participation in these central aspects of Israelite life and worship. The reasons for exclusion outlined in this chapter relate to physical wholeness (reflecting the holiness required in Yahweh's presence), lineage (not having pure Israelite heritage), and historical relationships with other nations. These rules emphasized the holiness and separateness of Yahweh's people.

Maintaining holiness and purity

Several laws in this chapter are concerned with maintaining holiness and purity, both within the community generally and specifically within the military camp. The exclusion of certain individuals from the assembly (1–8) and the detailed instructions for camp sanitation (9–14) highlight the idea that Yahweh's presence required a clean and set-apart environment. Uncleanness, whether physical or ritual, was incompatible with the presence of a holy God.

Treatment of foreigners and vulnerable people

The chapter includes laws concerning the treatment of escaped slaves (15–16), prohibiting their return to their masters and ensuring their protection. It also distinguishes between charging interest to fellow Israelites (forbidden) and foreigners (permitted) (19–20).

Cultic prostitution and vows

The strong prohibition against cultic prostitution (17–18), both male and female, and the refusal to accept money earned from such practices for vows, underscores Yahweh's rejection of Canaanite religious practices, which often involved sexual rituals. The laws regarding vows (21–23) emphasize the seriousness of making a promise to Yahweh and the obligation to fulfill it.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Use of "you"

Throughout this chapter "you" is singular except for where noted in verse 4. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 23:2 (#1)

דֹּ֣ור עֲשִׂירִ֔י & לֹ֥ו

"his tenth generation"

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **tenth generation**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use.

Alternate translation: [to generation number ten] or [after ten successive generations, he]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 23:3 (#1)

עַד־עוֹלָם

“until forever”

Moses says **until forever** as an extreme statement for emphasis. In this context, it does not mean literally “for eternity” but rather refers to an indeterminate future time, specifically for ten generations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [for all generations to come] or [permanently]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 23:4 (#1)

עַל־דְּבַר אֲשֶׁר

“on account of the matter that”

The phrase **on account of the matter that** introduces the reasons for God’s command that the Ammonites and Moabites could not enter the assembly of Yahweh. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a connecting word or phrase that shows that the information that follows gives the reasons for the prohibition that came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:4 (#2)

בְּצֵאתְכֶם & אֶתְכֶם

“you & when you had come out”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 23:4 (#3)

בַּלֶּחֶם וּבַמַּיִם

“with bread and with water”

Here, **bread and water** represent food and drink in general. Moses uses these basic items to refer to all the provisions that travelers would need. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with provisions] or [with the food and drink you needed]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 23:4 (#4)

אֶת־בִּלְעָם & בְּעוֹר

“Balaam & Beor”

The words **Balaam** and **Beor** are the names of men. Balaam was a prophet, and Beor was his father.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 23:4 (#5)

אֲרַם נַהֲרַיִם

“in} Aram Naharaim”

The name **Aram Naharaim** means “Aram of the two rivers” (Euphrates and Tigris) and is in the region later called “Mesopotamia.”

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 23:4 (#6)

לְקַלְלֶךָּ

“to curse you”

Here, **to curse you** marks this phrase as the goal or purpose of the Ammonites and Moabites hiring Balaam. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order to curse you] or [with the intention of cursing you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:5 (#1)

וְלֹא־אָבָה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיַּהֲפֹךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְךָ אֶת־הַקְּלָלָה לִבְרָכָה כִּי אֲהֵבְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“But Yahweh your God was not willing to listen to Balaam, and Yahweh your God turned the curse into a blessing for you, because Yahweh your God loved you”

The word **because** introduces the reason for what came before. If it would be clearer in your language, you could reverse the order and put the reason first. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God loved you, so he was not willing to listen to Balaam and turned the curse into a blessing for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:5 (#2)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ & יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ & יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Yahweh your God & Yahweh your God & Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 23:5 (#3)

וְלֹא־אָבָה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶל־בִּלְעָם

“But Yahweh your God was not willing to listen to Balaam”

Moses uses the word **But** here to indicate a contrast between the Ammonites’ and Moabites’ intention to curse Israel and Yahweh’s refusal to allow it. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [However, Yahweh your God was not willing to listen to Balaam]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:5 (#4)

וְלֹא־אָבָה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶל־בִּלְעָם

“But Yahweh your God was not willing to listen to Balaam”

By **was not willing to listen to Balaam**, Moses means “would not do what Balaam said.” See the discussion of “listen” in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information about this. Alternate translation: [But Yahweh your God would not do what Balaam asked] or [But Yahweh your God refused to do what Balaam wanted]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 23:5 (#5)

וַיַּהֲפֹךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְךָ אֶת־הַקְּלָלָה לִבְרָכָה

“and Yahweh your God turned the curse into a blessing for you”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **curse** and **blessing**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh your God changed what would have harmed you into what helped you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 23:6 (#1)

שְׁלֹמָם וְטֹבָתָם

“their peace or their prosperity”

Moses is referring to any good things by naming two major components, **peace** and **prosperity**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their well-being] or [anything good for them]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 23:6 (#2)

שְׁלֹמָם וְטֹבָתָם

“their peace or their prosperity”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **peace** and **prosperity**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [for them to live peacefully or to prosper]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 23:6 (#3)

כָּל־יָמֶיךָ לְעוֹלָם

“all your days, to forever”

Moses is using **all your days, to forever** as a common expression of his culture to mean “continuously throughout all time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for all time to come] or [perpetually]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 23:7 (#1)

לֹא־תְתַעֵב אֲדֹמִי כִּי־אָחִיךָ הוּא

“You shall not detest an Edomite, for he {is} your brother”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [You shall not detest an Edomite because he is your brother]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:7 (#2)

כִּי־אָחִיךָ הוּא

“for he {is} your brother”

Here Moses is speaking of an Edomite as if he were actually a **brother** to an Israelite. He means that the Edomites were descendants of Esau, who was the

brother of Jacob, the ancestor of the Israelites. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for he comes from our relative Esau]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 23:7 (#3)

לֹא־תְתַעֵב מִצְרִי כִּי־גֵר הָיִיתָ בְאַרְצוֹ

“you shall not detest an Egyptian, because you were a foreigner in his land”

The word **because** introduces the reason for the command not to detest Egyptians. If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [since you were foreigners in the land of Egypt, do not detest the Egyptians]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:8 (#1)

בָּנִים אֲשֶׁר־יִוָּלְדוּ לָהֶם

“The sons that are born to them”

Here the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [descendants that are born to them] or [children that are born to them]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 23:8 (#2)

בָּנִים אֲשֶׁר־יִוָּלְדוּ לָהֶם

“The sons that are born to them”

The expression **are born** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [The sons who become part of their families] or [The sons who come from their families]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 23:8 (#3)

דּוֹר שְׁלִישִׁי

“the third generation”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **the third generation**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [after three generations]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 23:10 (#1)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Here, **a man** represents any man in general, not a specific man. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any man] or [anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 23:10 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִהְיֶה טָהוֹר מִקְרֵה־לָיְלָה

“who is not clean, happening {at} night”

Moses is referring to a man having a nocturnal emission in a polite way by using the phrase **not clean, happening at night**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [who becomes unclean because of something that happens while he sleeps] or [who has a bodily discharge during the night]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 23:11 (#1)

יִרְחַץ בַּמָּיִם

“he shall bathe himself in water”

The word **himself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [he shall bathe in water]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 23:13 (#1)

וְיָתֵד תִּהְיֶה לְזִדֶךָ

“and you shall have a spade”

The term **spade** refers to a digging tool. In this context, it may have been a small shovel or simply a stick that soldiers would carry with them to dig holes and cover their excrement. If your readers would not be familiar with this kind of tool, you could use the name of a similar tool that your readers would recognize, or you

could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and you shall use a digging tool]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 23:13 (#2)

בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ חֻץ

“when you are sitting yourself out”

Moses is referring to defecating in a polite way by using the phrase **sitting yourself out**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [when you relieve yourself] or [when you go to attend to your needs]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 23:13 (#3)

וְשַׁבְתָּ

“and put back”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and put the dirt back]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 23:14 (#1)

כִּי׀

“For”

For indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. This verse gives the reason for all the instructions about cleanliness in verses 1–13. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:14 (#2)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מִתְהַלֵּךְ ׀ בְּקֶרֶב מַחֲנֶךָ

“Yahweh your God walks in the midst of your camp”

Here Moses is speaking of **Yahweh** walking **in the midst of your camp** as if God were physically moving around in the Israelite camp. This image represents God’s active presence with his people and his close involvement in their affairs. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God is present among you in your camp] or [Yahweh your God is actively watching over you in your camp]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 23:14 (#3)

לְהַצִּילְךָ וְלָתֵת אֹיְבֶיךָ לְפָנֶיךָ

“to give you victory and to give your enemies to your faces”

Here, **to give you victory and to give your enemies to your faces** marks the goal or purpose of **Yahweh your God walks in the midst of your camp**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order to make you victorious and to deliver your enemies into your power]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:14 (#4)

וְלָתֵת אֹיְבֶיךָ לְפָנֶיךָ

“and to give your enemies to your faces”

The phrase **to your faces** represents “into your power” or “into your presence.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and to give your enemies into your power] or [and to deliver your enemies to you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 23:14 (#5)

וְשָׁשַׁב מֵאַחֲרֶיךָ

“and turn away from you”

Moses is using the phrase **and turn away from you** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to keep their camp holy so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [or else he will turn away from you] or [lest he turn away from you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:15 (#1)

עֶבֶד

“a slave”

Here Moses is not referring to a specific **slave**. He means slaves in general. If it would be helpful to your

readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any slave]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 23:16 (#1)

בְּאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ

“in one of your gates”

Here the term **gates** refers to the entire city or town. See how you translated the similar phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [in one of your towns]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 23:16 (#2)

בַּטּוֹב לוֹ

“as good to him”

Moses is using **as good to him** as a common expression of his culture to mean “as he pleases” or “wherever he wants.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [wherever he pleases] or [wherever he wants to live]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 23:17 (#1)

קְדֵשָׁה & קָדֵשׁ

“female cultic prostitute & male cultic prostitute”

The term **cultic prostitute** refers to someone who engaged in sexual acts as part of the worship of pagan gods. This practice was common in ancient Canaanite religion but was forbidden in Israel. If your readers would not be familiar with what a cultic prostitute is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [woman who performs sexual acts in pagan worship … man who performs sexual acts in pagan worship] or [female temple prostitute who serves false gods … male temple prostitute who serves false gods]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 23:18 (#1)

וּמְחִיר כֶּלֶב

“or the price of a dog”

Moses assumes that readers will know that he is referring to a male prostitute by using the word **dog**. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [or money earned from a man who sells himself for sex]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 23:18 (#2)

בֵּבֵית יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“into} the house of Yahweh your God”

Moses is speaking of the temple of Yahweh as if it were a **house** in which he lived. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [into Yahweh’s temple] or [into the sacred temple of Yahweh your God]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 23:18 (#3)

לְכָל־נֶדֶר

“for any vow”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [when making any vow] or [to fulfill any vow to Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 23:18 (#4)

תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“are} abominations to Yahweh your God”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the idea of **abominations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [are detestable to Yahweh your God] or [greatly offend Yahweh your God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 23:19 (#1)

נֶגֶשׁ כֶּסֶף נֶגֶשׁ אׇכֶל נֶגֶשׁ כׇּל־דָּבָר אֲשֶׁר יִשָּׁךְ

“interest of money, interest of food, interest of each thing that is charged interest”

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses in **interest of money, interest of food, interest of each thing that is charged interest** to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive and overwhelming. Use a form in your language that

someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive and overwhelming. Alternate translation: [interest of any kind at all]

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 23:19 (#2)

לְאָחִ֖יךָ

“to your brother”

Here Moses is using the term **brother** to describe people who are descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 23:19–20 (#1)

וּלְאָחִ֑יךָ

“but to your brother”

See how you translated “to your brother” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [but to your fellow Israelite] or [but to another Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 23:20 (#1)

לַנָּכְרִ֔י

“to a foreigner”

Moses is not referring to a specific **foreigner**. He means non-Israelites in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to any foreigner]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 23:20 (#2)

לְמַ֣עַן יְבָרֶכְךָ֣ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ

“so that Yahweh your God may bless you”

Here, **so that** marks **Yahweh your God may bless you** as the goal or purpose of the instruction about charging or not charging interest. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that Yahweh your God may bless you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:20 (#3)

בְּכֹ֖ל מִשְׁלַ֣ח יָדֶ֑ךָ

“in all the sending out of your hand”

Moses is using **in all the sending out of your hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean “in everything that you do” or “in all your activities.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in all your activities]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 23:21 (#1)

תִּדֹּ֥ר נֶ֖דֶר

“you vow a vow”

Moses is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [you make a solemn vow]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 23:21 (#2)

כִּ֣י דָרֹ֤שׁ יִדְרְשֶׁ֙נּוּ֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ מֵעִמָּ֑ךְ וְהָיָ֥ה בְךָ֖ חֵֽטְא

“for, requiring, Yahweh your God shall require it from you; and it would be sin for you”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because Yahweh your God will surely require it from you, and it would be sin for you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 23:21 (#3)

דָּרֹ֥שׁ יִדְרְשֶׁ֙נּוּ֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“requiring, Yahweh your God shall require it”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **require** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God will absolutely require it]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 23:21 (#4)

וְהָיָ֥ה בְךָ֖ חֵֽטְא

“and it would be sin for you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sin**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and you would be sinning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 23:21 (#5)

וְהָיָ֥ה בְךָ֖ חֵֽטְא

“and it would be sin for you”

The pronoun **it** refers to not fulfilling the vow. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and not fulfilling the vow would be sin for you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 23:22 (#1)

וְכִֽי־ תֶחְדַּ֥ל לִנְדֹּ֖ר לֹֽא־יִהְיֶ֥ה בְךָ֖ חֵֽטְא

“And if you refrain from vowing, it will not be sin for you”

The implication is that if someone does not make a vow to God, they cannot be guilty of breaking it. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [But, if you do not make a vow, you will not sin because you will not have a vow to fulfill]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 23:22 (#2)

לֹֽא־יִהְיֶ֥ה בְךָ֖ חֵֽטְא

“it will not be sin for you”

See how you translated “sin” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [you would not be sinning]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 23:23 (#1)

מוֹצָ֣א שְׂפָתֶ֔יךָ & נָדָ֕בָה אֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבַּ֖רְתָּ בְּפִֽיךָ

“What has gone out from your lips & a vow that you have spoken with your mouth”

The phrases **What has gone out from your lips** and **a vow that you have spoken with your mouth** mean similar things. Moses is using these expressions together to emphasize the binding nature of spoken vows. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express this with a single phrase at the beginning and leave the second phrase off. Alternate translation: [What you have solemnly promised]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 23:23 (#2)

מוֹצָ֣א שְׂפָתֶ֔יךָ

“What has gone out from your lips”

Moses is using **What has gone out from your lips** as a common expression of his culture to mean “what you have promised.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What you have promised] or [The promise you have made]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 23:23 (#3)

תִּשְׁמֹ֖ר וְעָשִׂ֑יתָ

“you shall keep and do”

The terms **keep** and **do** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [you shall absolutely fulfill]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 23:24 (#1)

כְּנַפְשְׁךָ֣ שָׂבְעֶ֔עָךְ

“as your spirit {is} satisfied”

Moses is using **as your spirit is satisfied** as a common expression of his culture to mean “as much as you want.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as much as you want to eat] or [until you are satisfied]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 23:24 (#2)

כֶּלְיְךָ֖

“your vessel”

A **vessel** is a kind of container. If your readers would not be familiar with what a vessel is, you could use

the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [your basket] or [your bag]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 23:25 (#1)

בְּקָמַת

“in the stalks of”

Here, **stalks** represents the grain growing in a field. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [into the grain field of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 23:25 (#2)

וְחֶרְמֵשׁ לֹא תָנִיף

“but you shall not wave a sickle”

A **sickle** is a kind of curved blade with a handle that people use to cut grain. If your readers would not be familiar with what a sickle is, you could use the name of a similar tool that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [but you shall not use a harvesting blade] or [but you shall not use a cutting tool]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy - Chapter 24 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter contains a series of laws related to family life, justice, and the protection of vulnerable people. The laws emphasize fairness, compassion, and remembering Israel’s own history of slavery in Egypt.

1. Divorce and restrictions on remarriage (1–4)
2. A newly married man’s exemption from public duties (5)
3. Protection of essential property from being taken as collateral (6)
4. Punishment for kidnapping (7)
5. Instructions about skin diseases and the role of the priests (8–9)
6. Regulations for lending and returning pledges (10–13)
7. Fair treatment and prompt payment of hired workers (14–15)
8. Individual responsibility for sin (16)
9. Justice for foreigners, orphans, and widows (17–18)
10. Provision for the poor through gleaning laws (19–22)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Divorce and Remarriage

The chapter begins with regulations about divorce. A husband could give his wife a written certificate of divorce, but once she remarried, her first husband was forbidden from taking her back. This was considered an abomination before Yahweh and was tied to the holiness of the land.

Protection of the Vulnerable

Throughout the chapter there is a repeated concern for the poor, the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow. These groups were especially vulnerable, and the Israelites were commanded to protect and provide for them. The laws about pledges, fair wages, and gleaning harvests all served to safeguard these groups.

Justice and Fairness

The chapter reinforces principles of justice:

- Essential tools for survival, such as a millstone, could not be taken as collateral.
- Each person was to be held responsible only for their own sin, not for the guilt of family members.
- Justice must not be denied to foreigners, orphans, or widows.

Remembering Egypt

The commands are tied back to Israel’s own experience: “You were slaves in Egypt, and Yahweh your God redeemed you.” This memory served as the foundation for treating others with compassion and fairness.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Abstract Nouns

Terms such as “divorce,” “abomination,” “righteousness,” and “sin” are expressed as abstract nouns. If your language does not use abstract nouns, you may need to translate these ideas with verbal or descriptive expressions.

Figures of Speech

This chapter includes several figures of speech:

- **Hand** used to represent receiving a document.
- **Life** used to represent livelihood or survival.
- **Brothers** to represent fellow Israelites.
- **Judgment** spoken of as if it could be bent or twisted.

Metonymy and Synecdoche
Several terms represent broader ideas:

- **House** represents family life.
- **Land** represents the people who live in it.
- **Millstone** represents all essential tools for survival.
- **Hands** represent a person's work.

Cultural Practices
Some commands mention cultural practices unfamiliar to modern readers, such as harvesting by beating olive trees or gathering sheaves of grain. These can be translated with general terms for harvesting if needed.

Logical Connections
The chapter frequently uses connectors to show sequence, purpose, or result. For example, instructions about paying wages are given "so that" the worker will not cry out to Yahweh. Be sure to make these logical relationships clear in translation.

Use of "you"
Throughout this chapter "you" is singular except for where noted in verses 8–9. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Generic Nouns in Hypothetical Situations
This chapter gives instructions and warnings for the Israelites. In these hypothetical conditions, singular nouns such as "man," "witness," and "neighbor" are used to represent people in general, not specific individuals. If it would be clearer in your language, you may translate them in a way that shows they refer to anyone who fits the situation.

Deuteronomy 24:1 (#1)

כְּרִיתֻת

"divorce"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **divorce**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [ending the marriage]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 24:1 (#2)

וְנָתַתָן בְּיָדָהּ

"and put {it} into her hand"

Moses is using **hand** to represent the woman receiving and taking possession of the divorce document. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [give it to her directly]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 24:2 (#1)

וְיָצְאָה מִבֵּיתוֹ וְהָלְכָה וְהָיְתָה לְאִישׁ־אַחֵר

"And she shall go out from his house, and she may go and be another man's"

The word **and** introduces events that happened in sequence. First, the woman would leave her husband's house, and then she would be free to marry another man. If your language needs to show this sequence clearly, you could use a word that emphasizes the order of events. Alternate translation: [After she leaves his house, she may go and be another man's]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:2 (#2)

וְהָיְתָה לְאִישׁ־אַחֵר

"and be another man's"

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and become another man's wife]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 24:3 (#1)

וְנָתַתָן בְּיָדָהּ

"and puts {it} into her hand"

See how you translated the similar expression, "put it into her hand," in 24:1.

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#1)

אַחֲרֵי אֲשֶׁר הֻטַּמָּאָה

"after she has become impure"

The implication is that after a woman has been divorced from her first husband and has married (and thus had sex with) another man, she has become ceremonially unclean in relation to her first husband. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [after

she has married another man and so has become ritually unclean for her first husband]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#2)

אַחֲרֵי֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הֻטַּמָּ֔אָה

“after she has become impure”

The expression **has become impure** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [after someone has defiled her] or [after she has defiled herself]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#3)

כִּי־תוֹעֵבָ֥ה הִ֖וא

“for it {is} an abomination”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because it is an abomination]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#4)

תוֹעֵבָ֥ה

“an abomination”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abomination**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [repulsive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#5)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Yahweh. This means that the action would be done where Yahweh could observe and judge it. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh] or [in Yahweh’s sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#6)

וְלֹ֥א תַחֲטִ֖יא אֶת־הָאָ֑רֶץ

“and you shall not cause the land to sin”

Here, **land** represents the people who live in the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and you shall not cause the people in the land to sin]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:4 (#7)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 24:5 (#1)

וְלֹא־יַעֲבֹ֥ר עָלָ֛יו לְכָל־דָּבָ֖ר

“neither shall pass onto him any matter”

Moses is using **neither shall pass onto him any matter** as if a public duty or obligation were something that could be handed to a man. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [nor shall any other responsibility be required of him] or [nor shall he be given any other public duties]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:5 (#2)

נָקִ֥י יִהְיֶ֛ה לְבֵית֖וֹ

“he shall be free for his house”

Here, **house** represents his home and family life. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [he shall be free to attend to his household] or [he shall be free to focus on his family life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:6 (#1)

רֵחַ֥יִם וָרָ֖כֶב

“a mill or an upper millstone”

A **mill** was a tool made of two heavy stones used for grinding grain into flour, and an **upper millstone** was the top stone that turned against the bottom stone. If your readers would not be familiar with what these are, you could use a more general term. Alternate

translation: [grinding stones or even one of the stones needed for grinding]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 24:6 (#2)

רֵחַיִם וָרָכֶב

“a mill or an upper millstone”

Moses is using **a mill or an upper millstone** to represent all essential tools that a family needs to make food. This emphasizes how serious it would be to take either of these items. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [any essential equipment for preparing food]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 24:6 (#3)

נֶפֶשׁ הוּא חֹבֵל

“it {is} a life for a pledge”

Here Moses is speaking of taking someone’s millstone as if it were taking their **life**. This is because the millstone was essential for preparing food and thus sustaining life. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that would be like taking away their livelihood]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:7 (#1)

כִּי־יִמָּצֵא אִישׁ

“If a man is found”

The expression **is found** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [If anyone discovers a man] or [If people find out about a man who is]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 24:7 (#2)

גֹּנֵב נֶפֶשׁ

“stealing a life”

Here Moses is speaking of kidnapping a person as if it were **stealing a life**. This emphasizes the severity of the crime since it deprives someone of their freedom. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [taking someone captive] or [seizing a person]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:7 (#3)

מֵאֶחָיו מִבְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“from his brothers from the sons of Israel”

Here Moses is speaking of members of the Israelite community as if they were actual **brothers**. The expressions **brothers** and **sons of Israel** mean similar things, and Moses uses them together to emphasize that these are fellow members of the covenant community. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from among his fellow Israelites] or [from among the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:7 (#4)

וּבָעַרְתָּ הָרָע מִקִּרְבֶּךָ

“and you shall remove the evil from among you”

See how you translated this same phrase in 13:5. Alternate translation: [and you will stop any of your people from doing this evil act]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 24:8 (#1)

לִשְׁמֹר מְאֹד וְלַעֲשׂוֹת

“to firmly keep and do”

The terms **firmly keep** and **do** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to follow exactly]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 24:8 (#2)

הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם

“the priests, the Levites”

Moses is not distinguishing these **priests** from other priests who are not **Levites**. Moses is reminding the people that the priests come from the tribe of Levi. Be sure that this is clear in your translation. Alternate translation: [the priests, who are from the tribe of Levi] or [the Levitical priests]

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 24:8 (#3)

אַתֶּכֶם & תִּשְׁמְרוּ

“you & you shall keep”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 24:9 (#1)

לְמִרְיָם

“to Miriam”

Miriam is the name of a woman, the sister of Moses and Aaron.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 24:9 (#2)

בְּצֵאתְכֶם

“when you were coming out”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 24:10 (#1)

בְּרֵעֲךָ

“to your neighbor”

Here, neighbor means “fellow Israelite.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [any fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:13 (#1)

הָשֵׁבֹ תָּשִׁיב

“Returning, you shall return”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **return** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [You must definitely restore] or [You must completely restore]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 24:13 (#2)

וְשָׁכַב בְּשַׂלְמָתוֹ וּבֵרֲכֶךָּ

“and he will sleep in his cloak and bless you”

Here, **and** marks **he will sleep in his cloak and bless you** as the goal or purpose of restoring his pledge. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [so that he may sleep in his cloak and bless you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:13 (#3)

צְדָקָה

“righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [considered right]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 24:13 (#4)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“to the face of Yahweh your God”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh and subject to his evaluation. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated “to the face of Yahweh” in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in Yahweh your God’s sight] or [before Yahweh your God]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:14 (#1)

עָנִי וְאֶבְיוֹן

“poor and needy”

The terms **poor** and **needy** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [desperately poor]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 24:14 (#2)

מֵאַחֶיךָ

“from your brothers”

Here Moses is using the term **brothers** to describe people who are descended from the same ancestor.

If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from your fellow descendants of Israel] or [from your fellow Israelites who are related to you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:14 (#3)

בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:15 (#1)

בְּיוֹמוֹ

“In his day”

Moses is using the expression **In his day** as a common expression of his culture to mean “on the same day he works.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [That same day] or [Before his work day ends]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 24:15 (#2)

עָלָיו

“on it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the act of giving him his wages. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [before you give him his wages]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 24:15 (#3)

כִּֽי־עָנִי הוּא

“for he {is} poor”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because he is poor]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:15 (#4)

וְאֵלָיו הוּא נֹשֵׂא אֶת־נַפְשׁוֹ

“and he lifts up his life to it”

Here Moses is speaking as if the worker’s **life** were something he could physically lift up toward his wages. This means that the worker depends completely on his wages for survival. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he depends on it for survival] or [and he relies on these wages to live]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:15 (#5)

וְלֹא־יִקְרָא עָלֶיךָ אֶל־יְהוָה וְהָיָה בְךָ חֵטְא

“Then he will not call against you to Yahweh and have it be for you a sin”

The word **Then** introduces an outcome that Yahweh does not want to happen. Because of this, he first tells the Israelites to pay workers on time so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [Do this so that he will not cry out to Yahweh against you and it become a sin for you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:15 (#6)

וְהָיָה בְךָ חֵטְא

“and have it be for you a sin”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sin**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and it would be sinful for you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 24:16 (#1)

לֹא־יוּמְתוּ אָבוֹת עַל־בָּנִים וּבָנִים לֹא־יוּמְתוּ עַל־אָבוֹת אִישׁ בְּחֶטְאוֹ יוּמָתוּ

“Fathers shall not be put to death on account of sons, and sons shall not be put to death on account of fathers. A man shall be put to death for his sin”

The expression **be put to death** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is the community. Alternate translation: [You must not execute fathers because of their sons’ sins, and you

must not execute sons because of their fathers' sins. You must execute a person only for his own sin]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 24:16 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ

"A man"

Moses is not referring to a specific **man**. He means people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Each person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 24:17 (#1)

לֹ֥א תַטֶּ֖ה מִשְׁפַּ֣ט

"You shall not twist the judgment of"

Here Moses is speaking of **judgment** as if it were a straight object that could be physically twisted or bent. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [You shall not deny justice to] or [You shall not treat unfairly in court]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 24:17 (#2)

גֵּ֛ר יָת֥וֹם & אַלְמָנָ֑ה

"the foreigner {or} the fatherless & a widow"

Here, **the foreigner**, **the fatherless**, and **a widow** represent these types of people in general, not specific individuals. This pattern continues throughout the chapter. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any foreigner or orphan ... any widow]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 24:18 (#1)

עַל־כֵּ֣ן אָנֹכִ֔י מְצַוְּךָ֖

"Therefore, I command you"

The word translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [Because of this, I command you] or [For this reason, I command you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:18 (#2)

אֶת־הַדָּבָ֖ר הַזֶּֽה

"this word"

Here, **word** represents what Moses commanded by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what I have told you] or [this instruction]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:19 (#1)

עֹ֔מֶר

"a sheaf"

A **sheaf** is a bundle of cut stalks of grain that have been tied together. If your readers would not be familiar with what a sheaf is, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [some of the cut grain stalks]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 24:19 (#2)

לְמַ֗עַן יְבָרֶכְךָ֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

"so that Yahweh your God may bless you"

Here, **so that** marks **Yahweh your God may bless you** as the goal or purpose of leaving the forgotten sheaf for the foreigner, fatherless, or widow. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that Yahweh your God may bless you] or [with the purpose that Yahweh your God may bless you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 24:19 (#3)

בְּכֹ֖ל מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה יָדֶ֑יךָ

"in all the work of your hands"

Here, **hand** represents the ability of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in all your activities] or [in everything you accomplish]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 24:20 (#1)

תַּחְבֹּ֥ט זֵיתְךָ֖

"you beat your olive tree"

Here, **beat your olive tree** refers to harvesting olives by striking the tree branches with poles to make the olives fall to the ground. If your readers would not be familiar with this method of harvesting, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [you harvest your olive tree] or [you knock the olives from your tree]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 24:22 (#1)

וְזָכַרְתָּ֣ כִּי־עֶ֔בֶד הָיִ֖יתָ בְּאֶ֣רֶץ מִצְרָ֑יִם עַל־כֵּ֗ן אָנֹכִ֛י מְצַוְּךָ֖ לַֽעֲשׂ֥וֹת אֶת־הַדָּבָ֖ר הַזֶּֽה

“And you shall remember that you were a slave in the land of Egypt. Therefore, I command you to do this word”

See how you translated the similar expressions in 24:18.

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy - Chapter 25 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues Moses’ second speech which continues to teach about justice in Israel. (See: just, justice, unjust, injustice, justify, justification)

1. Laws of Justice and Punishment (1–3)
2. Care for Working Animals (4)
3. Levirate Marriage Law (5–10)
4. Modesty in Physical Disputes (11–12)
5. Honest Weights and Measures (13–16)
6. Command to Remember Amalek (17–19)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“a perfect and just weight you must have”

In the ancient Near East, money was weighted on a scale. If a person’s scale measured the weight incorrectly, they were robbing people.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Use of “you”

Throughout this chapter “you” is singular except for where noted in verse 17. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of “you.” If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Generic nouns in hypothetical situations

This chapter gives instructions and warnings for the Israelites. In these hypothetical conditions, singular nouns like “man,” “witness,” and “neighbor” represent those groups of people in general, not a specific person.

Deuteronomy 25:1 (#1)

אֶת־הַצַּדִּ֖יק & אֶת־הָרָשָֽׁע

“the righteous & the wicked”

Moses is using the adjectives **righteous** and **wicked** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with equivalent phrases. Alternate translation: [those who are righteous ... those who are wicked]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 25:2 (#1)

הָרָשָׁ֑עַ

“the wicked”

See how you translated “the wicked” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [the wicked person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 25:2 (#2)

בִּבְנֵ֥ן הַכִּסֹּֽת

“a son of striking”

Moses is using **a son of striking** as a common expression of his culture to mean that a person deserves to be beaten. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [someone who deserves to be beaten] or [someone who should be beaten]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:2 (#3)

וְהִכָּ֥הוּ

“and be beaten”

The expression **be beaten** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [someone should beat him]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 25:2 (#4)

לְפָנָ֖יו

“to his face”

Here, **to his face** represents being in front of the judge who is watching. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in front of him] or [while he watches]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:2 (#5)

רִשְׁעָתֽוֹ

“for} his wickedness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for the wicked things he has done]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 25:3 (#1)

פֶּן־יֹסִ֥יף לְהַכֹּתוֹ֙ עַל־אֵ֣לֶּה מַכָּ֔ה רַבָּ֖ה וְנִקְלָ֣ה אָחִ֑יךָ לְעֵינֶֽיךָ

“lest he add his striking of him {with} many {more} blows than these, and your brother is humiliated before your eyes”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the judge an instruction to follow so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [in order to prevent him from giving any more blows than these and humiliating your brother before your eyes]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 25:3 (#2)

אָחִ֑יךָ

“your brother”

Moses is using the term **brother** to describe someone who is descended from the same ancestor. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your fellow Israelite] or [this person]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 25:3 (#3)

וְנִקְלָ֣ה אָחִ֑יךָ

“and your brother is humiliated”

The expression **is humiliated** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and he becomes ashamed] or [and he feels deep shame]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 25:3 (#4)

לְעֵינֶֽיךָ

“before your eyes”

See how you translated the phrase “before your eyes” in 1:30. Alternate translation: [in your sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:4 (#1)

לֹֽא־תַחְסֹ֥ם שׁ֖וֹר בְּדִישֽׁוֹ

“You shall not muzzle an ox in his threshing”

A **muzzle** is a device put over an animal’s mouth to prevent it from eating, and **threshing** is the process of separating grain from its stalks by having an animal walk on it or pull a heavy object over it. If your readers would not be familiar with these practices, you could use more general terms or explain them in a footnote. Alternate translation: [You shall not put a covering over an ox’s mouth while it is separating grain] or [You shall not prevent an ox from eating while it is trampling the grain]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 25:5 (#1)

לֹֽא־תִהְיֶ֞ה אֵ֣שֶׁת־הַמֵּ֗ת הַחוּצָה֙ לְאִ֣ישׁ זָ֔ר

“the wife of the dead man shall not be for a strange man from outside”

Moses is giving instructions for what should happen to the widow in the possible situation in which **brothers live together and one of them dies, and he does not have a son**. Use a connector that makes it clear that this is what to do if that situation happens. Alternate translation: [then the wife of the dead man shall not marry a strange man from outside]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 25:5 (#2)

יְבָמָהּ יָבֹא עָלֶיהָ

“Her brother-in-law shall go in to her”

Moses is referring to sexual relations in a polite way by using the phrase **go in to her**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [have sexual relations with her] or [marry her and consummate the marriage]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 25:5 (#3)

יְבָמָהּ

“Her brother-in-law”

Your language may have its own term or expression for the relationship described in **brother-in-law**. Alternate translation: [The brother of her dead husband]

See: Kinship

Deuteronomy 25:5 (#4)

וְיִבְּמָהּ

“and {be} her brother-in-law”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and perform the duty of a brother-in-law to her]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 25:6 (#1)

הַבְּכוֹרִ

“the firstborn”

If your language would not represent this number in a form such as **the firstborn**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [the son born before others]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 25:6 (#2)

יָקוּם עַל־שֵׁשֵׁם אָחִיו הַמֵּת

“will rise up upon the name of his brother who died”

The phrase **will rise up upon the name of his brother who died** is a common expression of this culture to mean “will carry on the family line of his deceased brother.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will be considered the son of his dead uncle] or [will legally represent his dead uncle’s family line]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:6 (#3)

וְלֹא־יִמָּחֶה שְׁמוֹ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל

“and his name will not be wiped out from Israel”

Here Moses is speaking of a man’s name as if it were an inscription that could be **wiped out**. He means that people would no longer remember that man as part of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his name will not disappear from Israel] or [and his name will not be forgotten in Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 25:6 (#4)

וְלֹא־יִמָּחֶה שְׁמוֹ

“and his name will not be wiped out”

The expression **will not be wiped out** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is God. Alternate translation: [God will not let his name disappear]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 25:6 (#5)

שְׁמוֹ

“his name”

Here, **name** represents the person’s family line continued through his descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [his memory] or [his line of descendants]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:7 (#1)

הַשַּׁעְרָה אֶל־הַזְּקֵנִים

“to the gate to the elders”

Moses assumes that readers will know that city leaders conducted public business at **the gate** of the city. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the place where the elders meet]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 25:7 (#2)

לְהָקִים לְאָחִיו שֵׁם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל

“to raise up for his brother a name in Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression “will rise up upon the name of his brother who died” in the previous verse.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:7 (#3)

לְאָחִיו שֵׁם

“for his brother a name”

Here, **a name** represents having sons who will continue a family line. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [a son to continue his family line] or [descendants to carry on his family name]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:7 (#4)

לֹא אָבָה יַבְמִי

“he is not willing {to be} my brother-in-law”

See how you translated the related expression, “be her brother-in-law” in verse 5.

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 25:8 (#1)

וְעָמַד

“If he stands”

By **he stands**, Moses means that the man presents himself formally before the elders to give his testimony. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [If he comes before them to testify] or [If he presents himself before them]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 25:9 (#1)

וְחָלְצָה נַעֲלוֹ מֵעַל רַגְלוֹ וְיָרְקָה בְּפָנָיו

“and take off his sandal from his foot and spit in his face”

The actions **take off his sandal from his foot and spit in his face** were symbolic actions by which the widow showed that her brother-in-law would not receive any of his brother’s property because he had refused to fulfill his duty and was bringing shame on himself and his brother’s house. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of these actions in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and remove his sandal and spit in his face to show that he had brought disgrace on himself]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 25:9 (#2)

לְעֵינֵי הַזְּקֵנִים

“before the eyes of the elders”

Here, **before the eyes** represents sight or witnessing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with the elders as witnesses] or [in the sight of the elders]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:9 (#3)

לֹא־יִבְנֶה אֶת־בֵּית אָחִיו

“does not build up the house of his brother”

Here Moses is speaking of having children and continuing a family line as if it were **building up a house**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [does not continue his brother’s family line] or [does not provide descendants for his brother]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 25:9 (#4)

וְעָנְתָה וְאָמְרָה

“And she shall respond and say”

The term **and say** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [And she shall respond]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 25:9 (#5)

וְעָנְתָה֙ לֹ֣ו וְאָֽמְרָ֔ה

“And she shall respond and say”

The widow is expected to **respond** with the following statement as part of this legal action against her brother-in-law rather than as an answer to what someone said to her. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And she shall explain her action by saying]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 25:10 (#1)

וְנִקְרָ֥א שְׁמ֖וֹ

“And his name will be called”

The expression **be called** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And people will call him] or [And people will then say about him]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 25:10 (#2)

שְׁמ֖וֹ

“his name”

Here, **name** represents the man’s family line. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [his family] or [his line of descendants]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:10 (#3)

בֵּ֣בֵית חֲלֻ֔לוּץ הַנָּֽעַל

“The house of the sandal taken off”

Here Moses is speaking of this man’s family as if it were physically a **house**, and he refers to the man’s disgrace by referring to the **sandal** that his brother’s widow removed from his foot. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The family of the disgraced man] or [The family of the man who refused his duty]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 25:11 (#1)

וְאָחִ֥יו

“and his brother”

Here Moses is using the term **brother** to describe fellow Israelites who are not necessarily siblings. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [fellow Israelite] or [another man]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 25:11 (#2)

מִיַּ֖ד מַכֵּֽהוּ

“from the hand of his attacker”

Here, **hand** represents the power or control of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the control of his attacker] or [from his attacker’s grasp]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:12 (#1)

לֹ֣א תָחֹ֔וס עֵינֶ֖ךָ

“your eye shall have no pity”

The expression **your eye shall have no pity** is a common expression of this culture that means “do not show mercy” or “do not feel sorry for her and let her go unpunished.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [show her no mercy] or [punish her without pity]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:13 (#1)

אֶ֥בֶן וְאָ֖בֶן

“a stone and a stone”

Moses is using **a stone and a stone** as a common expression of his culture to refer to two different stones of different weights, **a large and a small**, used for weighing goods. This refers to a **stone** people used as a standard weight. Merchants could deceive and cheat their customers by using stones of different weights that he pretends are the same. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [unequal weights]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:14 (#1)

אֵיפָה וְאֵיפָה

“an ephah and an ephah”

Moses is using **an ephah and an ephah** as a common expression of his culture to refer to two different measurements, **a large and a small**, used for measuring amounts of grain. The **ephah** was a standard measure for weighing grain. This is referring to different measurements that someone pretends are the same in order to deceive and cheat someone else. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [unequal measurements]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:15 (#1)

אֶבֶן שְׁלֵמָה וָצֶדֶק & אֵיפָה שְׁלֵמָה וָצֶדֶק

“A perfect and just stone & a perfect and just ephah”

The terms **perfect** and **just** expresses a single idea. The word **perfect** tells more about **just**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [A completely accurate weight ... a completely accurate measure]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 25:15 (#2)

יַאֲרִיכוּ יָמֶיךָ

“your days will be long”

See how you translated the similar phrase “prolong your days” in 4:26. Alternate translation: [you will enjoy many years] or [you will have a long life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:15 (#3)

לְמַעַן יַאֲרִיכוּ יָמֶיךָ

“so that your days will be long”

Here, **so that** marks God’s promise of long life as the goal or purpose of having honest weights and measures. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order to live many years]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 25:15 (#4)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 25:16 (#1)

כִּי

“For”

The word **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [This is because] or [The reason for this is that]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 25:16 (#2)

תוֹעֲבַת & עָוֶל

“injustice {are} an abomination”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **injustice** and **abomination**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [these unjust things and act wickedly are detestable]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 25:17 (#1)

אֵת אֲשֶׁר־עָשָׂה לְךָ עֲמָלֵק

“what Amalek did to you”

Here, **what Amalek did to you** represents what the Amalekite people did to the ancestors of those Moses is addressing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as modeled in the UST.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 25:17 (#2)

בְּצֵאתְכֶם

“as you came out”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 25:18 (#1)

עָיֵף וְיָגֵעַ

“were} faint and weary”

The terms **faint** and **weary** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [were completely exhausted]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 25:18 (#2)

וְלֹא יָרֵא אֱלֹהִים

“and he did not fear God”

Moses is using **did not fear God** as a common expression of his culture to mean “showed no respect for what God required.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he had no moral principles] or [and he was willing to do terrible things because he did not respect God]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 25:19 (#1)

בְּהָנִיחַ & לְךָ

“has given to you rest”

Here Moses is speaking of security from enemies as if it were physical **rest**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has made you secure] or [has given you peace]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 25:19 (#2)

תִּמְחֶה֙ אֶת־זֵ֣כֶר עֲמָלֵ֔ק מִתַּ֖חַת הַשָּׁמָ֑יִם

“you shall wipe out the memory of Amalek from under the heavens”

Moses speaks of destroying the Amalekites as if that would **wipe out** the memory of these people like words written on paper. Yahweh means that he will remove the memory of everything about them. See how you translated the very similar phrase “wipe out their name from under the heavens” in 9:14. Alternate translation: [you must destroy the Amalekites so that nobody will remember them anymore]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 26 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter concludes Moses’ second speech, which began in chapter five, and recalls the great events of Israel’s history when Yahweh brought them out of Egypt.

1. Firstfruits offering ceremony (1–11)
2. Third year tithe declaration (12–15)
3. Covenant affirmation (16–19)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

“you” and “your” singular and plural

Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of “you.” If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Generic nouns

This chapter gives instructions for the Israelites. In these conditions, singular nouns like “Levite” or “widow” represent those groups of people in general, not a specific person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could clarify that these terms refer to any person who fulfills the situation.

“the place that Yahweh will choose”

Moses uses phrases such as this to refer to the future place where the temple will be built. These phrases emphasize that Yahweh will be the one who decides where the Israelites will build his temple as well as how they will worship him. (See: temple, house, house of God)

“voice”

Throughout this chapter, the Hebrew word “voice” frequently refers to what people said or declared rather than the literal sound of their voice.

Deuteronomy 26:1 (#1)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 26:1 (#2)

וִירִשְׁתָּ֥הּ וְיָשַׁבְתָּ֖ בָּ֑הּ

“and you possess it and live in it”

The terms **possess it** and **live in it** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and you make it your permanent home]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:2 (#1)

לְשַׁכֵּן שְׁמוֹ שָׁם

“to make his name stay there”

See the discussion of the phrase **in the place that Yahweh will choose to make his name stay** in the Introduction to Deuteronomy. See how you translated the expression “to make his name stay there” in 12:11. Alternate translation: [for you to come into his presence] or [for his presence to be]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:3 (#1)

לַאֲבֹתֵינוּ

“to our fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:4 (#1)

לִפְנֵי מִזְבַּח

“to the face of the altar of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of the altar. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before the altar of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#1)

וְעָנִיתָ וְאָמַרְתָּ

“And you shall respond and say”

Moses is instructing the people to **respond** with the following statement as part of this ceremony, rather than to answer what someone said to them. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [After the priest does that, say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#2)

וְעָנִיתָ וְאָמַרְתָּ

“And you shall respond and say”

The phrase **and say** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent both verbs explicitly. Alternate translation: [And you shall say]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#3)

לִפְנֵי ׀ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“to the face of Yahweh your God”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh your God] or [before Yahweh your God]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#4)

אֲרַמִּי אֹבֵד אָבִי

“My father {was} a wandering Aramean”

The speaker assumes that readers will know that he is referring to his ancestor, Jacob, who lived for many years in Aram Naharaim before settling in Egypt. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [My ancestor was Jacob, who lived as a foreigner in Aram] or [My ancestor was Jacob, who wandered in the land of Aram]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#5)

וַיֵּרֶד

“And he went down”

In keeping with what is usual for his language and culture, the speaker is marking travel for change in elevation. If this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [And he went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#6)

וַיְהִי־שָׁ֫ם

“and there he became”

Here, **he** represents Jacob’s descendants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and there Jacob’s descendants became] or [and there the Israelites became]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:5 (#7)

גָּדוֹל עָצוּם

“a great, mighty”

The terms **great** and **mighty** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [a very powerful]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:6 (#1)

וַיָּרֵ֣עוּ אֹתָ֔נוּ הַמִּצְרִ֖ים וַיְעַנּ֑וּנוּ

“And the Egyptians treated us badly and afflicted us”

The terms **treated us badly** and **afflicted us** mean similar things. The speaker is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And the Egyptians mistreated us severely]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:6 (#2)

אֹתָ֔נוּ

“us”

By **us**, the speaker means to include both himself and his listeners, so use the inclusive form of that word if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Deuteronomy 26:6 (#3)

וַיִּתְּנ֥וּ עָלֵ֖ינוּ עֲבֹדָ֥ה קָשָֽׁה

“And they set hard work upon us”

Here the speaker is speaking of the hard labor that the Egyptians required the Israelites to do as if it were an object that they could **set upon** them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they forced us to do hard labor] or [And they oppressed us with hard labor]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:7 (#1)

וַנִּצְעַ֖ק אֶל־יְהוָ֑ה

“And we cried out to Yahweh”

The Israelites are using **cried out** as a common expression of their culture to mean “we prayed urgently for help.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And we prayed desperately to Yahweh] or [And we called to Yahweh for help]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 26:7 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֥ע יְהוָ֛ה אֶת־קֹלֵ֖נוּ

“and Yahweh heard our voice”

The speaker is using **heard our voice** as a common expression of his culture to mean “heard us when we prayed” or “responded to our prayer.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh answered our prayer]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 26:7 (#3)

אֶת־קֹלֵ֑נוּ

“our voice”

Here, **voice** represents what the Israelites said when they prayed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [our prayer] or [our cry for help]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:7 (#4)

אֶת־עָנְיֵ֥נוּ וְאֶת־עֲמָלֵ֖נוּ וְאֶת־לַחֲצֵֽנוּ

“our affliction and our labor and our oppression”

The terms **affliction** and **labor** and **oppression** are abstract nouns. If your language does not use abstract nouns for these ideas, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [how badly they treated us and how hard they made us work and how they oppressed us]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 26:8 (#1)

בְּיָ֣ד חֲזָקָ֔ה וּבִזְרֹ֥עַ נְטוּיָ֖ה

“with a mighty hand and with an outstretched arm”

See how you translated the similar phrase “by a mighty hand and by an outstretched arm” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [by showing his mighty power]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:8 (#2)

בְּיָ֣ד חֲזָקָ֔ה וּבִזְרֹ֥עַ נְטוּיָ֖ה

“with a mighty hand and with an outstretched arm”

Here the expressions **mighty hand** and **outstretched arm** represent Yahweh’s great power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with his overwhelming power] or [by showing his mighty power]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:8 (#3)

וּבְמֹרָ֣א גָדֹ֑ל

“and with great fearsomeness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fearsomeness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [in a way that caused people to be very afraid]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 26:9 (#1)

אֶ֣רֶץ זָבַ֥ת חָלָ֖ב וּדְבָֽשׁ

“a land flowing with milk and honey”

See how you translated the phrase “a land flowing with milk and honey” in 6:3.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:10 (#1)

הִנֵּ֨ה

“behold”

The speaker is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [look] or [see here]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:10 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ וְהִשְׁתַּחֲוִ֖יתָ לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ

“to the face of Yahweh your God and bow down to the face of Yahweh your God”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of Yahweh your God and bow down before Yahweh your God]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:11 (#1)

וּלְבֵיתֶֽךָ

“and to your house”

Here, **your house** represents an entire household living together. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and to your household]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:11 (#2)

וְהַלֵּוִ֖י וְהַגֵּ֣ר אֲשֶׁ֑ר בְּקִרְבֶּֽךָ

“and the Levite and the foreigner who {is} among you”

Here, **the Levite** and **the foreigner** represent Levites and foreigners in general, not specific individuals. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and any Levites and foreigners who are among you] or [and all the Levites and foreigners who are among you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 26:12 (#1)

לַֽעֲשֵׂר֙ אֶת־כָּל־מַעְשַׂ֣ר

“tithing all the tithe of”

Moses is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [gathering all the tithes of] or [the collection of all your offerings of]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 26:12 (#2)

בַּשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁלִישִׁשִׁת

“in the third year”

If your language would not represent a number in a form such as **in the third year**, you could represent this number in a form that your language would use. Alternate translation: [in year three]

See: Ordinal Numbers

Deuteronomy 26:12 (#3)

בַּשָּׁנָה הַשְּׁלִישִׁשִׁת שְׁנַת הַמַּעֲשֵׂר

“in the third year (the year of tithing”

The **year of tithing** refers to a special offering collected every three years that the Israelites give as an additional tithe for the poor. See this instruction in 14:28. If your readers would not be familiar with what a year of tithing is, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [in the third year, when a special tithe was collected for the poor]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 26:12 (#4)

לַלֵּוִי לַגֵּר֙ לַיָּתֹ֔ום וְלָאַלְמָנָ֑ה

“to the Levite, to the foreigner, to the fatherless, and to the widow”

Moses is not referring to specific **Levites**, **foreigners**, **fatherless**, or **widows**. He means these groups of people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [to all the Levites, foreigners, orphans, and widows]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 26:12 (#5)

בִּשְׁעָרֶ֔יךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within your gates” in 5:14. Alternate translation: [in any of your communities] or [among your people]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:13 (#1)

הַקֹּ֖דֶשׁ

“the things set apart”

The word translated as **the things set apart** is referring to those things that were considered sacred or dedicated to God. Here it refers to a kind of offering, the tithe, that people dedicated to God from their harvest. If your readers would not be familiar with this phrase, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [the sacred tenth portion] or [the holy tithe]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 26:13 (#2)

לִפְנֵ֣י

“to the face of”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of or in the presence of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [in the presence of] or [before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 26:13 (#3)

לֹ֣א־עָבַ֔רְתִּי מִמִּצְוֹתֶ֖יךָ וְלֹ֥א שָׁכָֽחְתִּי

“I have not transgressed any of your commandments, neither have I forgotten”

The speaker is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I have not transgressed any of your commandments, neither have I forgotten your commandments]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 26:14 (#1)

בְּאֹנִ֔י

“in my mourning”

A **mourning** here refers to a state of ritual uncleanness that occurred when someone had contact with a dead body. During this time, a person was not allowed

to handle holy things. If your readers would not be familiar with this concept, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [while I was ritually unclean] or [during a time when I was ceremonially impure]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 26:14 (#2)

בְּטָמֵֽא

“in sin”

The phrase **in sin** refers to any condition that would have made a person ritually unclean or unacceptable to God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this meaning more clearly. Alternate translation: [while I was ritually unclean]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 26:14 (#3)

נָתַתִּי מִמֶּנּוּ לְמֵֽת

“have I given from it to the dead”

The phrase **given from it to the dead** refers to making offerings to the spirits of dead people. This was a pagan religious practice that was forbidden in Israel. If your readers would not be familiar with this practice, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [have I offered any of it in worship of the dead] or [have I used any of it as offerings to dead people]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 26:14 (#4)

שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקוֹל֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֔י עָשִׂ֖יתִי כְּכֹ֥ל אֲשֶׁ֖ר צִוִּיתָֽנִי

“I have listened to the voice of Yahweh my God; I have done according to all that you have commanded me”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [I have carefully done everything that you, Yahweh my God, have commanded me]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 26:14 (#5)

שָׁמַעְתִּי בְקוֹל֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֔י

“I have listened to the voice of Yahweh my God”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [I have obeyed Yahweh my God]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 26:14 (#6)

אֱלֹהָ֔י

“my God”

See how you translated this same phrase in 4:5.

See: Distinguishing Versus Informing or Reminding

Deuteronomy 26:15 (#1)

מִמְּעוֹן֙ קָדְשְׁךָ֔ מִן־הַשָּׁמַ֖יִם

“from your holy habitation, from the heavens”

The phrase **from the heavens** identifies the location of God’s **holy habitation**. If it would be clearer in your language, you could combine these phrases into a single expression. Alternate translation: [from your sacred dwelling in heaven]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 26:15 (#2)

אֶ֣רֶץ זָבַ֥ת חָלָ֖ב וּדְבָֽשׁ

“a land flowing with milk and honey”

See how you translated the phrase “a land flowing with milk and honey” in 6:3.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:16 (#1)

אֶת־הַחֻקִּ֥ים הָאֵ֛לֶּה וְאֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּטִ֖ים

“these statutes and ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes” and “ordinances” in 4:1.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:16 (#2)

וְשָׁמַרְתָּ֣ עָשִׂ֔יתָ אוֹתָ֖ם

“and you shall keep and do them”

The terms **keep** and **do** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the

emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and you shall carefully obey them]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:16 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל־נַפְשֶׁךָ

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

See how you translated the same phrase, “with all your heart and with all your soul,” in 4:29. Alternate translation: [with all of your being] or [wholeheartedly]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 26:17 (#1)

וְלָלֶכֶת בִּדְרָכָיו וְלִשְׁמֹר חֻקָּיו וּמִצְוֹתָיו וּמִשְׁפָּטָיו וְלִשְׁמֹעַ בְּקֹלוֹ

“and to walk in his ways and to keep his statutes and his commandments and his ordinances, and to listen to his voice”

The phrases **walk in his ways** and **keep his statutes and his commandments and his ordinances** and **listen to his voice** mean basically the same thing. The second and third phrases emphasize the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and it would be good to show this to your readers by including all three phrases in your translation, if possible. If it is helpful, you could connect the phrases in a way that shows that the second and third phrases are repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [follow his ways by obeying all his commands and doing everything he tells you]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 26:17 (#2)

וְלָלֶכֶת בִּדְרָכָיו

“and to walk in his ways”

Here Moses is speaking of the **commandments** of Yahweh as if they were **ways** or a path that the people should **walk** on. He means that obeying those commandments is like walking on that path. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you shall live as he wants you to] or [and you shall obey his instructions]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:17 (#3)

חֻקָּיו וּמִצְוֹתָיו וּמִשְׁפָּטָיו

“his statutes and his commandments and his ordinances”

See how you translated the terms “statutes,” “commandments,” and “ordinances” in 5:31.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 26:17 (#4)

וְלִשְׁמֹעַ בְּקֹלוֹ

“and to listen to his voice”

See how you translated the phrase “listen to his voice” in 4:30.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 26:18 (#1)

לְעַם סְגֻלָּה

“a people for a possession”

Here Moses is speaking of the Israelites as if they were a valuable **possession** that belonged to Yahweh. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a people who belong completely to him] or [a treasured people]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:19 (#1)

וְלִתְּתְךָ עֶלְיוֹן עַל כָּל־הַגּוֹיִם

“and he will set you high above all the nations”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh making Israel admired among other nations as if he would physically **set** them **high above all the nations**. He means that the other nations will consider them great and worthy of admiration. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will make look up to you other nations] or [and he will make you admired by all the other nations]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 26:19 (#2)

וּלְשֵׁם

“and for a name”

Moses is using the term **name** to represent the nation's reputation. Alternate translation: [and for a good reputation]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 27 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter begins Moses' third speech to the Israelites.

1. Instructions for construction the altar (1–8)
2. Covenant curses (9–26)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Cursed is the one ... And all the people shall say, 'Amen.'

This phrase framing is repeated several times in this chapter. This repetition serves as a warning to the Israelites when they will live in the land that Yahweh had promised them. This is part of the covenant Yahweh made with Moses. Translate it the same way each time.

Use of "you"

Throughout this chapter "you" is singular except for where noted in verses 1–2, 4, 12. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 27:1 (#1)

וַיְצַו מֹשֶׁה וְזִקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"And Moses and the elders of Israel commanded"

The word **And** introduces a new section of Moses' instructions. If it would be clearer in your language, you could use a connecting word that specifically signals the start of a new topic. Alternate translation: [Then Moses and the elders of Israel commanded] or [Now Moses and the elders of Israel commanded]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 27:1 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

"saying"

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly since **commanded** already implies speaking. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 27:1 (#3)

אָנֹכִי מְצַוֶּה

"I command"

The pronoun **I** refers to Moses. Even though Moses and the elders are both commanding the people, Moses is the only one speaking. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I, Moses, command]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 27:1 (#4)

מְצַוֶּה אֶתְכֶם הַיּוֹם

"command you today"

The word **you** is plural here because Moses is addressing the Israelites, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Deuteronomy 27:2 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם אֲשֶׁר תַּעַבְרוּ אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּן אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ נֹתֵן לְךָ וְהֵקַמְתָּ

"on the day when you cross the Jordan to the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you, then you shall erect"

Moses expected the Israelites to erect these stones at the same time as when they crossed the Jordan. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could describe the time relationship more explicitly. Alternate translation: [as soon as you cross the Jordan into the land that Yahweh your God is giving to you, you shall erect]

See: Connect — Simultaneous Time Relationship

Deuteronomy 27:2 (#2)

תַּעַבְרוּ

"you cross"

The word **you** is plural here because Moses is addressing the Israelites, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Deuteronomy 27:2 (#3)

יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 27:2 (#4)

וְשַׂדְתָּ אֹתָם בַּשִּׂיד

“and plaster them with plaster”

A **plaster** is a kind of material made from lime, sand, and water that hardens after it dries. If your readers would not be familiar with what plaster is, you could use a more general term or explain it in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and cover them with a smooth coating] or [and coat them with a material that hardens]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 27:2 (#5)

וְשַׂדְתָּ אֹתָם בַּשִּׂיד

“and plaster them with plaster”

Moses is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [and thoroughly cover them with a lime coating] or [and completely coat them with plaster]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 27:3 (#1)

לְמַעַן אֲשֶׁר־ תָּבֹא אֶל־הָאָרֶץ

“so that you may go into the land”

Here, **so that** marks entering the land as the goal or purpose of writing the law on the stones. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order to enter the land]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 27:3 (#2)

אֶרֶץ זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבָשׁ

“a land flowing with milk and honey”

See how you translated the phrase “a land flowing with milk and honey” in 6:3.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 27:3 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵי־ אֲבֹתֶיךָ

“the God of your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the God of your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 27:4 (#1)

בְּהַר עֵיבָל

“on Mount Ebal”

This is a mountain near Mount Gerizim near the town of Shechem. See how you translated it in 11:29.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 27:4 (#2)

בְּעָבְרְכֶם & תָּקִימוּ & אֶתְכֶם

“when you have crossed & erect & you”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 27:4 (#3)

וְשַׂדְתָּ אוֹתָם בַּשִּׂיד

“and plaster them with plaster”

See how you translated this in 27:2.

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 27:5 (#1)

לֹא־ תָנִיף עֲלֵיהֶם בַּרְזֶל

“you shall not brandish an iron tool on them”

The implication is that an iron tool would shape or carve the stones, and this would make them unacceptable as an altar to Yahweh. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [you shall not shape these stones with an iron tool]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 27:7 (#1)

לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“to the face of Yahweh your God”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in front of Yahweh. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion about this phrase. See how you translated it in 1:45. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh your God]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 27:10 (#1)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֖ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“And listen to the voice of Yahweh your God”

Here, **voice** represents what Yahweh says or commands. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And hear what Yahweh your God commands] or [And hear what Yahweh your God says]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 27:10 (#2)

אֶת־מִצְוֹתָ֥ו וְאֶת־חֻקֹּתָ֖יו

“his commandments and statutes”

See how you translated the similar expression “his statutes and his commandments” in 4:40.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 27:12 (#1)

הַ֣ר גְּרִזִ֔ים

“Mount Gerizim”

A small mountain north of Mount Ebal. See how you translated this in 11:29.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 27:12 (#2)

בְּעָבְרְכֶ֖ם

“when you have crossed”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 27:12 (#3)

שִׁמְעֹ֣ון וְלֵוִ֔י וִיהוּדָ֖ה וְיִשָּׂשכָ֑ר וְיֹוסֵ֖ף וּבִנְיָמִֽן

“Simeon and Levi and Judah and Issachar and Joseph and Benjamin”

Moses is using **Simeon and Levi and Judah and Issachar and Joseph and Benjamin** to represent the tribes that were descended from these men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 27:12 (#4)

וְיֹוסֵֽף

“and Joseph”

The name **Joseph** combines the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh, who were descendants of Joseph.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 27:13 (#1)

וְאֵ֖לֶּה יַעַמְד֣וּ עַל־הַקְּלָלָ֑ה

“And these shall stand for the curse”

The implication is that the tribes who are to stand on Mount Ebal will listen to the curse statements that are listed in verses 15–26. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And these tribes shall stand to hear the curses]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 27:13 (#2)

רְאוּבֵ֥ן גָּ֛ד וְאָשֵׁ֖ר וּזְבוּלֻ֑ן דָּ֥ן וְנַפְתָּלִֽי

“Reuben, Gad and Asher and Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali”

Moses is using **Reuben, Gad and Asher and Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali** to represent the tribes descended from these men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 27:14 (#1)

וְעָנְנ֥וּ הַלְוִיִּ֖ם וְאָמְר֣וּ

“And the Levites shall respond and say”

Moses is instructing the Levites to **respond** with the following statement as part of this ceremony, rather than as an answer to what someone said to them. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [And the Levites shall say]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 27:14 (#2)

וְעָנְנוּ הַלְוִיִּם וְאָמְרוּ

“And the Levites shall respond and say”

The phrase **and say** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly. Alternate translation: [And the Levites shall respond]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 27:14 (#3)

כָּל־אִישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל

“all the men of Israel”

Here the masculine term **men** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [all the people of Israel]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 27:15 (#1)

אָרוּר הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר

“Cursed is the man who”

The expression **Cursed is the man who** contains a passive verbal form that appears in every verse through verse 26. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form as modeled in the UST or in another way that is natural in your language.

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:15 (#2)

אָרוּר הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר & וְעָנְנוּ כָל־הָעָם וְאָמְרוּ אָמֵן

“Cursed is the man who & And all the people shall answer and say, ‘Amen”

Throughout this passage, Moses and the Levites use a repeated pattern: they declare a curse and the people respond with **Amen**. If your language has a way of repeating patterns of speech and response, you could use it here.

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 27:15 (#3)

הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר

“is the man who”

The speakers are not referring to a specific **man** but rather any person in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [is anyone who]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 27:15 (#4)

וּמַסֵּכָה

“or cast figure”

A **cast figure** is a kind of idol made by pouring hot metal into a mold. If your readers would not be familiar with what a cast figure is, you could use the name of a similar thing that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [or metal idol] or [or statue made from melted metal]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 27:15 (#5)

מַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵי חָרָשׁ

“the work of the hands of a craftsman”

The Levites are using one part of a person, his **hands**, to mean all of him in the act of making idols. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [what a craftsman has made]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 27:15 (#6)

אָמֵן

“Amen”

The word **Amen** is a Hebrew word. You will need to decide if you will use this word in its Hebrew form or if you will instead translate the meaning into your language. Either approach has broad support. If you use the Hebrew word, you could spell it the way it sounds in your language and then put the translation in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Let it be so] or [We agree]

See: Copy or Borrow Words

Deuteronomy 27:16 (#1)

אָרוּר מַקֵּלֶה

“Cursed is the one who dishonors”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who dishonors]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:17 (#1)

אָרוּר מַסִּיג

“Cursed is the one who displaces”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who displaces]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:17 (#2)

מַסִּיג גְּבוּל רֵעֵהוּ

“is the one who displaces the boundary of his neighbor”

The implication is that a person moves **boundary** markers in order to steal land from a neighbor. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [is the one who steals land from his neighbor by moving the boundary markers]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 27:18 (#1)

אָרוּר מַשְׁגֶּה

“Cursed is the one who misleads”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who misleads]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:19 (#1)

אָרוּר מַטֶּה

“Cursed is the one who twists”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who twists]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:19 (#2)

מַטֶּה מִשְׁפַּט

“is the one who twists a judgment of”

Here the speakers are describing **judgment** as if it were something that could be physically twisted. By this expression, they are referring to someone who is perverting justice. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is the one who perverts justice of] or [is the one who makes an unfair judgment of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 27:19 (#3)

גֵּר־יָתוֹם וְאַלְמָנָה

“a foreigner, fatherless, or widow”

The Levites are referring to all vulnerable people by naming three representative groups, **a foreigner**, **fatherless**, and **widow**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [anyone who is helpless]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 27:19 (#4)

גֵּר־יָתוֹם וְאַלְמָנָה

“a foreigner, fatherless, or widow”

Here, **a foreigner, fatherless, or widow** represent vulnerable people in general, not specific individuals. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any vulnerable person]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 27:20 (#1)

אָרוּר שֹׁכֵב

“Cursed is the one who lies”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who lies]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:20 (#2)

שֹׁכֵב עִם

“is the one who lies with”

See how you translated “lies with” in 22:23. Alternate translation: [is the one who sleeps with] or [is the one who is intimate with]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 27:20 (#3)

אֵשֶׁת אָבִיו

“the wife of his father”

The phrase **the wife of his father** refers to a woman who is married to a man’s father but who is not the man’s mother. Your language may have its own term or expression for this relationship. Alternate translation: [his stepmother]

See: Kinship

Deuteronomy 27:20 (#4)

גִּלָּה כְּנַף אָבִיו

“he has uncovered the hem of his father”

The Levites are using **uncovered the hem of his father** as a common expression of their culture to mean “disrespect his father by violating his father’s marriage rights.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [has disrespected his father]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 27:21 (#1)

אָרוּר שֹׁכֵב

“Cursed is the one who lies”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who lies]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:21 (#2)

שֹׁכֵב עִם

“is the one who lies with”

See how you translated “lies with” in 22:23. Alternate translation: [is the one who sleeps with] or [is the one who is intimate with]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 27:22 (#1)

אָרוּר שֹׁכֵב

“Cursed is the one who lies”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who lies]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:22 (#2)

שֹׁכֵב עִם

“is the one who lies with”

See how you translated “lies with” in 22:23. Alternate translation: [is the one who sleeps with] or [is the one who is intimate with]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 27:22 (#3)

אֲחֹתוֹ בַּת־אָבִיו אוֹ בַת־אִמּוֹ

“his sister, the daughter of his father, or the daughter of his mother”

The implication is that this means any kind of **sister**, whether from the same mother and father, or sharing only one parent. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [his sister, whether they share both parents or only one]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 27:22 (#4)

שֹׁכֵב עִם

“is the one who lies with”

See how you translated “lies with” in 22:23. Alternate translation: [is the one who sleeps with] or [is the one who is intimate with]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 27:23 (#1)

אָרוּר שֹׁכֵב

“Cursed is the one who lies”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who lies]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:23 (#2)

שֹׁכֵב עִם

“is the one who lies with”

See how you translated “lies with” in 22:23. Alternate translation: [is the one who sleeps with] or [is the one who is intimate with]

Deuteronomy 27:23 (#3)

חֹתַנְתּוֹ

“his mother-in-law”

Your language may have its own term or expression for the relationship described by **mother-in-law** which here means the mother of a man’s wife. Alternate translation: [his wife’s mother]

See: Kinship

Deuteronomy 27:24 (#1)

אָרוּר מַכֵּה

“Cursed is the one who strikes”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who strikes]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:24 (#2)

מַכֵּה רֵעֵהוּ בַּסָּתֶר

“is the one who strikes his neighbor secretly”

Here the term **strikes** means attacking with the intent to kill. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [is the one who murders his neighbor in secret]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 27:25 (#1)

אָרוּר לֹקֵחַ

“Cursed is the one who takes”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one who takes]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:25 (#2)

לְהַכּוֹת נֶפֶשׁ דָּם נָקִי

“to strike a life of innocent blood”

The Levites are using **to strike a life of innocent blood** as a common expression of the culture to mean “to murder an innocent person.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to murder an innocent person]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 27:25 (#3)

דָּם נָקִי

“innocent blood”

Here, **innocent blood** represents the life of an innocent person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [an innocent person] or [someone who has done nothing wrong]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 27:26 (#1)

אָרוּר

“Cursed is the one”

See how you translated the similar passive expression, “Cursed is the man who” in 27:15. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh curse the one]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 27:26 (#2)

אֶת־דִּבְרֵי הַתּוֹרָה־הַזֹּאת

“the words of this law”

Here, **words** represents the commands of the law. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the commands of this law] or [the requirements of this law]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 28 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter details the covenantal blessings for obedience and curses for disobedience that Moses presents to the people of Israel. The structure is a clear, though unbalanced, rhetorical parallel, with the curses section being significantly longer and more detailed than the blessings.

Structure and Formatting

1. The Blessings for Obedience (1–14)
2. Promises of exaltation and comprehensive blessings in fertility, provision, and daily life (1–8)

3. Promises of establishment as God's holy people, resulting in victory and economic leadership (9–14)
4. The Curses for Disobedience (15–68)
5. Initial curses as a direct reversal of the blessings (15–19)
6. Curses of disease, military defeat, and exile (20–37)
7. Curses of agricultural ruin and subjugation by foreigners (38–48)
8. The ultimate horror of a foreign invasion, siege, and cannibalism (49–57)
9. Curses of extraordinary plagues, worldwide scattering, and a final return to slavery in Egypt (58–68)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Covenant blessings and curses
This chapter is a classic example of a suzerain-vassal treaty format common in the ancient Near East. A powerful king or suzerain (in this case, Yahweh) would make a treaty with a lesser nation or vassal (Israel). This treaty outlined the benefits of loyalty (blessings) and the severe consequences of rebellion (curses). The life and prosperity of the entire nation were tied directly to their collective obedience to their covenant relationship with God.

Listening to the voice
A key, repeated phrase in this chapter is "if you listen to the voice of Yahweh your God" (v. 1, 2, 15, 45, 62). This concept, also found in 4:30, goes beyond simply hearing. It signifies a deep, active obedience and a commitment to live according to all of God's commands as laid out in the law. This is the central condition upon which all the blessings and curses depend.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Use of "you"
Throughout this chapter "you" is singular except for where noted in verses 14, 62–63, & 68. Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Passive voice for blessings and curses
The phrases "Blessed you will be" and "Cursed you will be" are in the passive voice. The one doing the blessing or cursing is not explicitly stated in these phrases. However, the context of the entire chapter makes it clear that the agent is God. If a passive construction is unnatural in your language, it could be translated in the active voice, such as "God will bless you" or "God will curse you."

The word "faces"
The Hebrew word for "faces" appears frequently in this chapter with a range of meanings. It is often used to mean "before you" or "in your presence" when describing enemies being defeated or fleeing (v. 7, 25). It can also refer to a person's demeanor ("fierce of face," v. 50) or be part of an expression meaning "because of" ("from the faces of your wicked deeds," v. 20). Translators should focus on the specific meaning in each context rather than translating the word literally every time.

Deuteronomy 28:1 (#1)

וְהָיָ֔ה

"And it will be"

Here, **And it will be** marks a transition to a new section about blessings. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this section relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [Now] or [Next]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 28:1 (#2)

שָׁמֹ֣וֹעַ תִּשְׁמַ֗ע

"listening you listen"

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **listen** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you listen carefully] or [you really listen]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 28:1 (#3)

תִּשְׁמַ֗ע

"you listen"

Here the word **listen** means to intentionally hear and obey. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [you are obedient]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 28:1 (#4)

בְּקוֹל֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“to the voice of Yahweh your God”

Here, **voice** represents the words that Yahweh spoke, which include his commands. See the discussion about this in the introduction to this chapter for further information. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to what Yahweh you God says]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:1 (#5)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 28:1 (#6)

וּנְתָנְךָ֣ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ עֶלְי֔וֹן עַ֖ל כָּל־גּוֹיֵ֥י

“then Yahweh your God will set you high above all the nations of”

Here Moses is speaking of making Israel prominent and powerful among other nations as if he would physically **set you high above all the nations**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the same expression in 26:19. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh your God will make you more prominent than all the other nations] or [then Yahweh your God will make you more powerful than all the other nations]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:2 (#1)

וּבָ֣אוּ עָלֶ֔יךָ כָּל־הַבְּרָכ֖וֹת הָאֵ֑לֶּה וְהִשִּׂיגֻ֖ךָ

“And all these blessings will come upon you and reach you”

Here Moses is speaking of **blessings** as if they were living beings that could **come upon** and **reach** a person by chasing and capturing them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give you all these blessings]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 28:2 (#2)

וּבָ֣אוּ עָלֶ֔יךָ כָּל־הַבְּרָכ֖וֹת הָאֵ֑לֶּה וְהִשִּׂיגֻ֖ךָ כִּֽי־תִשְׁמַ֥ע בְּקֹ֖ל יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ

“And all these blessings will come upon you and reach you, if you listen to the voice of Yahweh your God”

Moses is presenting a possible condition, that Yahweh will only bless the Israelites if they listen to and obey what Yahweh said. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. It may be helpful to reorder this sentence so that the conditional statement is first. Alternate translation: [If you listen to the voice of Yahweh your God, then all these blessings will come on you and reach you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 28:2 (#3)

תִּשְׁמַ֥ע בְּקֹ֖ל יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ

“you listen to the voice of Yahweh your God”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [you listen and obey what Yahweh your God says]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 28:3 (#1)

בָּר֥וּךְ אַתָּ֖ה בָּעִ֑יר וּבָר֥וּךְ אַתָּ֖ה בַּשָּׂדֶֽה

“Blessed you {will be} in the city, and blessed you {will be} in the field”

Moses is referring to all places where the Israelites will live and work by naming two major components, **the city** and **the field**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Blessed you will be everywhere you go]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:3 (#2)

בָּר֥וּךְ אַתָּ֖ה בָּעִ֑יר וּבָר֥וּךְ אַתָּ֖ה

“Blessed you {will be} in the city, and blessed you {will be”

The expression **Blessed you will be** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another

way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is God. The same form also occurs in verses 4–6. Alternate translation: [God will bless you in the city and] or [You will receive God's blessing both in the city and]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:4 (#1)

פְּרִי־בִטְנְךָ וּפְרִי אַדְמָתְךָ וּפְרִי בְהֶמְתֶּךָ שְׁגַר אֲלָפֶיךָ וְעַשְׁתְּרוֹת צֹאנֶךָ

"the fruit of your womb and the fruit of your land and the fruit of your cattle, the increase of your cattle and the young of your flock"

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses **the fruit of your womb and the fruit of your land and the fruit of your cattle, the increase of your cattle and the young of your flock** to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive and overwhelming. Use a form in your language that someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive and overwhelming.

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 28:4 (#2)

פְּרִי־בִטְנְךָ וּפְרִי אַדְמָתְךָ וּפְרִי בְהֶמְתֶּךָ

"the fruit of your womb and the fruit of your land and the fruit of your cattle"

Here Moses is speaking as if children, crops, and livestock were **fruit**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your children and your crops and your livestock]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:4 (#3)

שְׁגַר אֲלָפֶיךָ וְעַשְׁתְּרוֹת צֹאנֶךָ

"the increase of your cattle and the young of your flock"

The terms **increase** and **young** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the abundant offspring of your livestock]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:5 (#1)

טַנְאֲךָ וּמִשְׁאַרְתֶּךָ

"your basket and your kneading trough"

A **basket** is a kind of woven container used for holding food or other items, and a **kneading trough** is a kind of container used for mixing and kneading bread dough. If your readers would not be familiar with what these items are, you could use the names of similar things that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [your food containers and your bread-making bowls] or [the containers you use for food and bread]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 28:5 (#2)

טַנְאֲךָ וּמִשְׁאַרְתֶּךָ

"your basket and your kneading trough"

Here, **your basket and your kneading trough** represents all of your food and provisions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all your food supplies]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:6 (#1)

בְּבֹאֶךָ וּבָרוּךְ אַתָּה בְּצֵאתֶךָ

"in your coming in and blessed you {will be} in your going out"

Moses is referring to all of a person's activities by naming two extremes, **coming in** and **going out**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everywhere you may go]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:7 (#1)

יִתֵּן יְהוָה אֶת־אֹיְבֶיךָ הַקָּמִים עָלֶיךָ נִגָּפִים לִפָּנֶיךָ

"Yahweh shall let your enemies who rise up against you be struck down to your faces"

The expression **be struck down** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is God. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will strike down to your faces your enemies who rise up against you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:7 (#2)

נִגָּפִים

“be struck down”

Here, **be struck down** means to be defeated in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [be defeated] or [be conquered]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:7 (#3)

לְפָנֶיךָ & לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your faces & to your faces”

Here, **to your faces** represents being in your presence or in front of you. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before you ... before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:7 (#4)

וּבְשִׁבְעָה דְרָכִים יָנוּסוּ לְפָנֶיךָ

“but will flee to your faces seven ways”

Moses says **seven ways** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [but will flee to your faces in many different directions] or [but will flee to your faces in complete panic]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 28:8 (#1)

יְצַו יְהוָה אִתְּךָ אֶת־הַבְּרָכָה

“Yahweh will command for you the blessing”

Here Moses is speaking of **the blessing** as if it were a living thing that could receive and obey a command. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will cause you to be blessed] or [Yahweh will bring blessing to you]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 28:8 (#2)

מִשְׁלַח יָדֶךָ

“the sending out of your hand”

Moses is using **the sending out of your hand** as a common expression of his culture to mean “all of your work and undertakings.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your endeavors] or [that you do]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:9 (#1)

יְקִימְךָ יְהוָה לוֹ לְעַם קָדוֹשׁ כַּאֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע־לָךְ כִּי תִשְׁמֹר אֶת־מִצְוֹת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ וְהָלַכְתָּ בִּדְרָכָיו

“Yahweh will establish you as his sanctified people, as he has sworn to you, if you keep the commandments of Yahweh your God and walk in his ways”

Moses is presenting a possible condition, that Yahweh will only establish the Israelites as his sanctified people if they obey Yahweh’s commandments. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. It may be helpful to reorder this sentence so that the conditional statement is first. Alternate translation: [If you keep the commandments of Yahweh your God and walk in his ways, then Yahweh will establish you as his sanctified people, as he has sworn to you]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 28:9 (#2)

וְהָלַכְתָּ בִּדְרָכָיו

“and walk in his ways”

Moses is speaking of the **commandments** of Yahweh as if they were **ways** or paths that the person should **walk** on. He means that obeying those commandments is like walking on that path. See how you translated the similar expression in 5:33. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and obey them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:10 (#1)

שֵׁם יְהוָה נִקְרָא עָלֶיךָ

“the name of Yahweh is called upon you”

Moses is using **the name of Yahweh is called upon you** as a common expression of his culture to mean “you belong to Yahweh and are identified as his people.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression

from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you are Yahweh's people] or [you are identified as belonging to Yahweh]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:10 (#2)

שֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה נִקְרָא עָלֶיךָ

"the name of Yahweh is called upon you"

The expression **is called** is a passive verbal form. If your language does not use the passive form in this way, you can state this in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has called you by his name]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:11 (#1)

וְהוֹתִרְךָ יְהוָה לְטוֹבָה

"And Yahweh will make you abound in prosperity"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **prosperity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will make you very prosperous] or [And Yahweh will cause you to have many good things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:11 (#2)

בִּפְרִי־בִטְנְךָ וּבִפְרִי־בְהֶמְתְּךָ וּבִפְרִי אַדְמָתֶךָ

"in the fruit of your womb and in the fruit of your cattle and in the fruit of your ground"

See how you translated the similar expression in 28:4.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:11 (#3)

לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

"to your fathers"

Here, **your fathers** represents your ancestors. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the phrase "your fathers" in 1:8.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:12 (#1)

יִפְתַּח יְהוָה ׀ לְךָ אֶת־אוֹצָרוֹ הַטּוֹב אֶת־הַשָּׁמַיִם

"Yahweh will open to you his treasure, the good of the heavens"

Here Moses is speaking of **the heavens** as if they were a physical place where he stored **his treasure** that Yahweh will open to provide rain. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will provide abundant rain from the heavens] or [Yahweh will give you the sky's good gift of rain]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:12 (#2)

מַעֲשֵׂה יָדֶךָ

"the work of your hand"

Moses is using one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of him in the act of working. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [of your own work]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:13 (#1)

וּנְתָנְךָ יְהוָה לְרֹאשׁ וְלֹא לְזָנָב וְהָיִיתָ רַק לְמַעְלָה וְלֹא תִהְיֶה לְמָטָּה כִּי־תִשְׁמַע אֶל־מִצְוֹת ׀ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ הַיּוֹם לִשְׁמֹר וְלַעֲשׂוֹת

"And Yahweh will set you as head, and not as tail, and you will be only above, and you will not be beneath, if you listen to the commandments of Yahweh your God that I am commanding you today, to keep and do"

Moses is presenting a possible condition beginning with the phrase, that Yahweh will only do the things described in this verse if the Israelites obey Yahweh's commandments. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. It may be helpful to reorder this sentence so that the conditional statement is first. Alternate translation: [If you listen to the commandments of Yahweh your God that I am commanding you today, to keep and do, then Yahweh will set you as head, and not as tail; and you will be only above, and you will not be beneath]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 28:13 (#2)

וּנְתָנְךָ יְהוָה לְרֹאשׁ וְלֹא לְזָנָב וְהָיִיתָ רַק לְמַעְלָה וְלֹא תִהְיֶה לְמָטָּה

“And Yahweh will set you as head, and not as tail, and you will be only above, and you will not be beneath”

These two phrases **Yahweh will set you as head, and not as tail** and **you will be only above, and you will not be beneath** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and you will be in a position of honor and not of shame]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 28:13 (#3)

וּנְתָנְךָ יְהוָה לְרֹאשׁ וְלֹא לְזָנָב

“And Yahweh will set you as head, and not as tail”

Here Moses is comparing Israel’s status among nations to the **head** and **tail** of an animal. He means that the Israelites will be leaders among the nations, not followers. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will make you the leader of nations, and not the follower]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:13 (#4)

וְהָיִיתָ֣ רַ֣ק לְמַ֔עְלָה וְלֹ֥א תִהְיֶ֖ה לְמָ֑טָּה

“and you will be only above, and you will not be beneath”

Here Moses is speaking of Israel’s status among nations as if it were **above** and not **beneath** in physical position. He means that the Israelites will be in a position of authority, not subservience. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will be in authority and not subservient]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:13 (#5)

לִשְׁמֹ֥ר וְלַעֲשׂ֖וֹת

“to keep and do”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [to keep them and do them]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:13 (#6)

לִשְׁמֹ֥ר וְלַעֲשׂ֖וֹת

“to keep and do”

The terms **keep** and **do** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [to carefully obey them]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:14 (#1)

וְלֹ֣א תָס֗וּר מִכָּל־הַדְּבָרִים֩ אֲשֶׁ֨ר אָנֹכִ֜י מְצַוֶּ֤ה אֶתְכֶם֙ הַיּ֔וֹם יָמִ֖ין וּשְׂמֹֽאול

“and you do not turn away from any of the words that I am commanding you today, right or left”

Moses is speaking as if the Israelites had literally been walking behind God but then could **turn away** to walk in a different direction from him. He means that they should not stop living in the manner in which God wants people to live. See how you translated the similar expression, “Do not turn aside, right or left” in 5:32. Alternate translation: [and you do not disobey Yahweh’s commands that I am giving you today]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:14 (#2)

וְלֹ֣א תָס֗וּר

“and you do not turn away”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context of the previous verse if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and if you do not turn away]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:14 (#3)

אֶתְכֶם֩

“you”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of 'You' — Singular

Deuteronomy 28:14 (#4)

יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאול

"right or left"

Moses is referring to all possible directions of turning away by naming two extremes, **right** and **left**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in any direction] or [at all]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:14 (#5)

לָלֶכֶת אַחֲרֵי אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים לְעָבְדָם

"going after other gods to serve them"

Here Moses is speaking of choosing to worship other gods as if it were literally **going after** them. He is using the image of following someone to mean being devoted to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [choosing other gods to serve them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:15 (#1)

וְהָיָה אִם

"And it will happen, if"

Here the phrase **And it will happen, if** introduces a shift from the previous blessings to the curses that will follow disobedience. If the connection between this statement and the previous one is not clear, you may want to use a different connecting word to show how this statement relates to what comes before it. Alternate translation: [However, if]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 28:15 (#2)

וּבָאוּ עָלֶיךָ כָּל־הַקְּלָלוֹת הָאֵלֶּה וְהִשִּׂיגוּךָ

"then all these curses will come upon you and reach you"

Here Moses is speaking of **curses** as if they were living beings that could **come upon you and reach you** like hostile pursuers who could chase and capture a person. See how you translated the same phrase "will come upon you and reach you" in relation to blessings in verse 2. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then all these curses will certainly affect you] or [then you will experience all these curses]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 28:16 (#1)

אָרוּר אַתָּה

"Cursed you {will be"

The expression **Cursed you will be** contains a passive verbal form that occurs here and in verses 17–19. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will curse you] or [You will experience Yahweh's curse]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:16 (#2)

בָּעִיר & בַּשָּׂדֶה

"in the city & in the field"

See how you translated these same phrases in verse 3.

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:17 (#1)

טַנְאֲךָ וּמִשְׁאַרְתֶּךָ

"your basket and your kneading trough"

See how you translated this in verse 5. Alternate translation: [all your food supplies]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:18 (#1)

פְּרִי־בִטְנְךָ וּפְרִי אַדְמָתֶךָ שְׁגַר אֲלָפֶיךָ וְעַשְׁתְּרוֹת צֹאנֶךָ

"the fruit of your womb and the fruit of your ground, the increase of your cattle, and the young of your flock"

See how you translated this in verse 4.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:19 (#1)

בְּבֹאֶךָ & בְּצֵאתֶךָ

"in your coming in & in your going out"

See how you translated this in verse 6

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#1)

יְשַׁלַּ֨ח יְהוָ֜ה ׀ בְּךָ֣ אֶת־הַמְּאֵרָ֗ה אֶת־הַמְּהוּמָה֙ וְאֶת־הַמִּגְעָ֔רַת בְּכָל־מִשְׁלַ֖ח יָדְךָ֣ אֲשֶׁ֣ר תַּעֲשֶׂ֑ה

“Yahweh will send against you curses, confusion, and rebukes in all the sending out of your hand that you will do”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **curses**, **confusion**, and **rebukes**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will curse you, confuse you, and rebuke you in everything you do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#2)

אֶת־הַמְּאֵרָ֗ה אֶת־הַמְּהוּמָה֙ וְאֶת־הַמִּגְעָ֔רַת

“curses, confusion, and rebukes”

The terms **curses**, **confusion**, and **rebukes** mean similar things. Moses is using the three terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [severe judgment] or [complete disaster]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#3)

מִשְׁלַ֖ח יָדְךָ֣

“the sending out of your hand”

See how you translated “the sending out of your hand” in verse 8. Alternate translation: [your endeavors] or [that you do]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#4)

עַ֚ד הִשָּׁמְדְךָ֔ וְעַד־אֲבָדְךָ֖ מַהֵ֑ר

“until you are destroyed and until you perish quickly”

The terms **are destroyed** and **perish** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [until you are quickly and completely destroyed]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#5)

עַ֚ד הִשָּׁמְדְךָ֔

“until you are destroyed”

The expression **are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [until Yahweh destroys you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#6)

מִפְּנֵ֖י רֹ֣עַ מַעַלְלֶ֑יךָ

“from the faces of your wicked deeds”

Moses is using **from the faces** as a common expression of his culture to mean “because of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [because of your wicked deeds]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:20 (#7)

עֲזַבְתָּ֥נִי

“you will have forsaken me”

The pronoun **me** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [you will have forsaken Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 28:21 (#1)

יַדְבֵּ֤ק & בְּךָ֙ אֶת־הַדָּ֔בֶר

“will make the plague cling to you”

Here Moses is speaking of **the plague** as if it were a living thing that could **cling to** a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will make the plague remain with you] or [will make the plague stay upon you]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 28:21 (#2)

עַ֚ד כַּלֹּתֹ֔ו אֹתְךָ֖

“until he has finished you”

Moses is referring to complete destruction in a polite way by using the phrase **has finished you**. Depending

on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [until he has completely destroyed you]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 28:22 (#1)

יַכְּכָה

“will strike {you”

Moses is speaking as if Yahweh will actually **strike** or hit the Israelites with these plagues. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will cause you to suffer]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:22 (#2)

בַּשַּׁחֶפֶת וּבַקַּדַּחַת וּבַדַּלֶּקֶת וּבֶחָרְחֻר וּבַחֶרֶב וּבַשִּׁדָּפוֹן וּבִירַקְרָקוֹן

“with emaciation and with fever and with inflammation and with fiery heat and with a sword and with scorching winds and with mildew”

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses, **with emaciation and with fever and with inflammation and with fiery heat and with a sword and with scorching winds and with mildew** to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive and overwhelming. Use a form in your language that someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive and overwhelming.

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 28:22 (#3)

בַּשַּׁחֶפֶת וּבַקַּדַּחַת וּבַדַּלֶּקֶת & וּבִירַקְרָקוֹן

“with emaciation and with fever and with inflammation & and with mildew”

The terms **emaciation**, **fever**, **inflammation**, and **mildew** refer to various diseases and afflictions. The term **emaciation** describes a wasting disease that causes the body to become extremely thin. The term **fever** describes a condition that causes the body temperature to rise. The term **inflammation** describes a condition that causes parts of the body to become swollen and painful. Here the term **mildew** is describing a fungal disease that can affect crops. If your readers would not be familiar with these specific conditions, you could use more general terms. Alternate translation: [with wasting diseases and with high fever and with painful swelling ... and with crop disease]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 28:22 (#4)

וּבַחֶרֶב

“and with a sword”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if he would physically strike the people **with a sword**. He means that he will cause people to die violently in war. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and with violent death in war]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:22 (#5)

וְרָדְפוּךָ עַד אָבְדֶךָ

“And they will pursue you until you perish”

Here Moses is speaking of all these terrible things as if they were living things that could **pursue** people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [These will continue to affect you until you perish]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 28:23 (#1)

וְהָיוּ שָׁמֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר עַל־רֹאשְׁךָ נְחֹשֶׁת וְהָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־תַּחְתֶּיךָ בַּרְזֶל

“And your skies that {are} over your head shall be bronze, and the earth that {is} under you {shall be} iron”

Here Moses is speaking of the **skies** as if they were **bronze** and of the **earth** as if it were **iron**. He means that the sky will become hard like bronze and will not give rain, and the ground will become hard like iron and will not produce crops. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the sky above you will give no rain and the ground beneath you will be too hard to plow]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:24 (#1)

אֶת־מְטַר אַרְצְךָ אָבָק וְעָפָר

“the rain of your land {to be} powder and dust”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if **the rain of your land** were **powder and dust**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your

translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [no rain to fall on your land, only powder and dust]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:24 (#2)

עַד֙ הִשָּׁמְדֶ֔ךָ

“until you are destroyed”

The expression **are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [until Yahweh destroys you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:25 (#1)

יִתֶּנְךָ֣ יְהוָ֔ה ׀ נָג֖וּף לִפְנֵ֣י אֹיְבֶ֑יךָ בְּדֶ֤רֶךְ אֶחָד֙ תֵּצֵ֣א אֵלָ֔יו וּבְשִׁבְעָ֥ה דְרָכִ֖ים תָּנ֣וּס לְפָנָ֑יו

“Yahweh shall let you be struck down to the faces of your enemies; you will go out one way against him but will flee to his face seven ways”

See how you translated the similar sentence in verse 7.

Deuteronomy 28:26 (#1)

נִבְלָתְךָ֔

“your corpse”

In this verse, the word **corpse** is singular in form, but it refers to all the Israelites as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “corpse” as modeled in the UST.

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:26 (#2)

וְאֵ֖ין מַחֲרִֽיד

“and there will be none to startle {them”

By **there will be none to startle them**, Moses means that no one will be alive to drive away the scavenging birds and wild animals from the corpses. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and no one will be left alive to chase them away] or [and no one will remain to frighten them off]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 28:27 (#1)

בִּשְׁחִ֣ין מִצְרַ֔יִם

“with the boils of Egypt”

In the phrase **the boils of Egypt**, Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [with boils like those that afflicted Egypt] or [with the same boils that struck Egypt]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:27 (#2)

בִּשְׁחִ֣ין מִצְרַ֔יִם וּבַעֳפָלִ֖ים וּבַגָּרָ֣ב וּבֶחָ֑רֶס

“with the boils of Egypt and with ulcers and with rash and with itch”

The terms **boils**, **ulcers**, **rash**, and **itch** refer to various kinds of skin diseases. If your readers would not be familiar with what these conditions are, you could use more general terms or explain them in a footnote. Alternate translation: [with painful skin diseases and sores that cause itching]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 28:27 (#3)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר לֹא־תוּכַ֖ל לְהֵרָפֵֽא

“from which you are not able to be healed”

The expression **to be healed** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [from which you cannot recover] or [which no one can heal]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:28 (#1)

וּבְתִמְהֹ֥ון לֵבָֽב

“and with confusion of heart”

Here, **heart** represents the mind or the ability to think clearly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and with confusion of mind]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:28 (#2)

וּבְתִמְהֹנ֥וֹן לֵבָֽב

“and with confusion of heart”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **confusion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and with confused hearts] or [and will confuse your thinking]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:29 (#1)

כַּאֲשֶׁ֨ר יְמַשֵּׁ֤שׁ הָעִוֵּר֙ בָּאֲפֵלָ֔ה

“like the blind grope in the darkness”

Here Moses is making a comparison. The point of this comparison is that just as **the blind grope in the darkness** and cannot find their way, so the people **will be groping about at noon** and will not be able to find their way or succeed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as helplessly as blind people grope in the darkness]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 28:29 (#2)

אֶת־דְּרָכֶ֖יךָ

“your ways”

Here Moses is speaking of how a person lives as if that were **ways** or paths that the person was walking along. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in what you do] or [in your endeavors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:29 (#3)

וְהָיִ֣יתָ אַ֔ךְ עָשׁ֥וּק וְגָזוּל֙

“And you shall again be oppressed and robbed”

The expression **you shall again be oppressed and robbed** uses passive verbal forms. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will again allow your enemies to oppress and rob you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:29 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִ֑ים

“all of the days”

See how you translated the expression “all of the days” in 4:40. Alternate translation: [forever]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:31 (#1)

שׁוֹרְךָ֥ טָבוּחַ֙ לְעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“Your ox {will be} slain before your eyes”

The expression **will be slain** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Someone will slaughter your ox before your eyes]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:31 (#2)

לְעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“before your eyes”

See how you translated the phrase “before your eyes” in 1:30. Alternate translation: [in your sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:31 (#3)

חֲמֹרְךָ֥ גָּזוּל֙

“Your donkey will be robbed”

The expression **will be robbed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Enemies will steal your donkey] or [People will take your donkey away]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:31 (#4)

מִלְּפָנֶ֑יךָ

“from to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents what is in front of a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from right in front of you] or [while you watch helplessly]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:31 (#5)

צֹאנְךָ֥ נְתֻנ֖וֹת לְאֹיְבֶ֑יךָ

“Your sheep {will be} given to your enemies”

The expression **will be given** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give your sheep to your enemies] or [Your enemies will take your sheep]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:32 (#1)

בָּנֶ֣יךָ וּבְנֹתֶ֗יךָ נְתֻנִים֙ לְעַ֣ם אַחֵ֔רֶת

“Your sons and your daughters {will be} given to other peoples”

The expression **will be given** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give your sons and your daughters to other peoples] or [Other peoples will take your sons and your daughters away]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:32 (#2)

וְעֵינֶ֥יךָ רֹא֖וֹת וְכָלוֹת֑ אֲלֵיהֶ֗ם

“and your eyes will look on and will long for them”

Here Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and your eyes will look on your sons and daughters and will long for them]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:32 (#3)

וְעֵינֶ֥יךָ רֹא֖וֹת וְכָלוֹת֑ אֲלֵיהֶ֗ם

“and your eyes will look on and will long for them”

Here Moses is using one part of a person, **your eyes**, to mean all of you in the act of watching and longing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will watch and will long for them]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 28:33 (#1)

עַ֣ם

“A nation”

Here, **a nation** represents the people of that nation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The people of a nation]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:33 (#2)

פְּרִ֣י אַדְמָתְךָ֔ וְכָל־יְגִיעֲךָ֖ יֹאכַ֣ל

“will eat the fruit of your land and all your labor”

Here, **the fruit of your land and all your labor** represents the crops and goods that result from working the land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the crops you have produced and everything you have worked to make]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:33 (#3)

וְהָיִ֥יתָ רַ֛ק עָשׁ֥וּק וְרָצ֖וּץ

“and you will be only oppressed and crushed”

The terms **oppressed** and **crushed** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and you will only be mistreated] or [and you will only suffer harm]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:33 (#4)

כָּל־הַיָּמִֽים

“all the days”

Moses is using **all the days** as a common expression of his culture to mean “continually” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have this meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [continually] or [always]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:34 (#1)

מִמַּרְאֵ֖ה עֵינֶ֑יךָ אֲשֶׁ֥ר תִּרְאֶֽה

“from the view of your eyes that you will see”

It might seem that the expression **from the view of your eyes that you will see** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your

language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [from all that you will see]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 28:35 (#1)

יַכְּכָה יְהוָה בִּשְׁחִין רָע

“Yahweh will strike {you} with bad boils”

See how you translated this in verse 22.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:35 (#2)

מִכַּף רַגְלְךָ וְעַד קָדְקֳדֶךָ

“from the bottom of your foot and to the top of your head”

Moses is referring to all of the body by naming two extremes, **the bottom of your foot** and **the top of your head**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all over your body]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:36 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר תָּקִים עָלֶיךָ

“that you will raise up over yourself”

The pronoun **yourself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [whom you will choose as your king,]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 28:36 (#2)

אַתָּה וַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

“you nor your fathers”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [neither you nor your fathers have known that nation]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:36 (#3)

וַאֲבֹתֶיךָ

“nor your fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [nor any of your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:36 (#4)

עֵץ וְאָבֶן

“of} wood and stone”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [that are made of wood and stone]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:37 (#1)

לְשַׁמָּה לְמָשָׁל וְלִשְׁנִינָה

“a horror, a proverb, and a taunt”

This is poetic language. Here Moses lists three terms that describe the shameful condition Israel will become among the nations. If your language has a way to indicate poetry, you could use it here. Alternate translation: [an object of terror, stories, and scorn]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 28:37 (#2)

לְשַׁמָּה לְמָשָׁל וְלִשְׁנִינָה

“a horror, a proverb, and a taunt”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **horror**, **proverb**, and **taunt**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [something that horrifies people, something that people make proverbs about, and something that people mock]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:37 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר־יְנַהֶגְךָ יְהוָה שָׁמָּה

“where Yahweh will drive you there”

It might seem that the expression **where Yahweh will drive you there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where Yahweh will drive you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 28:40 (#1)

וְשֶׁ֣מֶן לֹ֤א תָסׂוּךְ֙ כִּֽי־יִשַּׁ֣ל זֵיתֶ֔ךָ

“but you will not grease yourself {with} the oil, for your olives will become detached”

The implication is that the **olives** will **become detached**, or fall, from the trees before they are ripe enough to produce **oil**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [but you will not be able to make oil to grease yourself with, for your olives will fall] or [but you will not grease yourself with oil from your olives, for they will fall]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 28:40 (#2)

יִשַּׁ֣ל זֵיתֶ֔ךָ

“your olives will become detached”

The expression **will become detached** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will cause your olives to fall off]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:42 (#1)

יְיָרֵ֥שׁ הַצְּלָצַ֖ל

“the crickets will take possession”

Here, **take possession** represents consuming or destroying. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the crickets will devour them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:42 (#2)

יְיָרֵ֥שׁ הַצְּלָצַ֖ל

“the crickets will take possession”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [the crickets will take possession of them]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:42 (#3)

הַצְּלָצַ֖ל

“the crickets”

The term **crickets** refers to a type of small jumping insect, similar to a grasshopper or locust. If your readers would not be familiar with what crickets are, you could use the name of a similar insect that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [insects] or [destructive insects]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 28:43 (#1)

הַגֵּ֣ר אֲשֶׁ֣ר בְּקִרְבְּךָ֔

“The foreigner who {is} among you”

Moses is not referring to a specific **foreigner**. He means foreigners in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any foreigner who lives among you]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 28:43 (#2)

יַעֲלֶ֥ה עָלֶ֛יךָ מַ֥עְלָה מָ֖עְלָה וְאַתָּ֣ה תֵרֵ֣ד מַ֑טָּה מָּֽטָּה

“will rise up above you higher {and} higher, and you will descend lower {and} lower”

Here Moses is speaking of social status as if it were physical position, with **rise up above you higher and higher** meaning that foreigners will gain increasing social status, wealth, and power, and **descend lower and lower** meaning that the Israelites will lose social status, wealth, and power. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will become more and more influential than you, while you become less and less influential]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:44 (#1)

הֽוּא־יִהְיֶ֥ה לְרֹ֖אשׁ וְאַתָּ֥ה תִּֽהְיֶ֖ה לְזָנָֽב

“he will be the head, and you will be the tail”

Here Moses is speaking of the foreigner’s and the Israelite’s status as if they were the **head** and **tail** of an animal. This means foreigners will have more

power and authority than the Israelites. See how you translated the similar phrase, “as head, and not as tail,” in verse 13.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:45 (#1)

וּבָ֣אוּ עָלֶ֗יךָ כָּל־הַקְּלָלֹ֤ות הָאֵלֶּה֙ וּרְדָפֻ֣וךָ֔ וְהִשִּׂיגֻ֖וךָ

“And all these curses will come upon you and pursue you and reach you”

Moses is speaking of **all these curses** as if they were living things that could **come upon you and pursue you and reach you** like hostile pursuers who could chase and capture a person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And all these curses will happen to you and affect you continually and completely overwhelm you]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 28:45 (#2)

מִצְוֹתָ֖יו וְחֻקֹּתָ֑יו

“his commandments and his statutes”

The terms **commandments** and **statutes** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. See how you translated the similar expression “his statutes and his commandments” in 4:40. Alternate translation: [his commandments] or [his statutes]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:46 (#1)

לְאֹ֥ות וּלְמֹופֵ֖ת

“as signs and as wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [as amazing displays] or [as extraordinary demonstrations]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:46 (#2)

וּבְזַרְעֲךָ֖

“and on your seed”

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites’ offspring were **seed**. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this use of the term “seed.” Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and on your descendants] or [and on your offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:47 (#1)

בְּשִׂמְחָ֗ה וּבְטֹ֤וב לֵבָב֙ מֵרֹ֣ב כֹּ֔ל

“with joyfulness and with gladness of heart from the abundance of everything”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **joyfulness** and **gladness**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [joyfully and gladly because you had an abundance of everything]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:47 (#2)

בְּשִׂמְחָ֗ה וּבְטֹ֤וב לֵבָב֙

“with joyfulness and with gladness of heart”

The terms **joyfulness** and **gladness of heart** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [with great joy] or [with deep happiness]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:47 (#3)

וּבְטֹ֤וב לֵבָב֙

“and with gladness of heart”

Here, **heart** represents a person’s inner being and emotions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and with gladness in your inner being] or [and with an attitude of gladness]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:48 (#1)

וְנָתַ֥ן עֹ֛ל בַּרְזֶ֖ל עַל־צַוָּארֶ֑ךָ

“And he will put a yoke of iron on your neck”

Here Moses is speaking as if the enemy’s oppression were **a yoke of iron** placed on the Israelites’ necks. This image emphasizes that the oppression will be harsh, inescapable, and degrading, like the heavy iron

yoke that would be put on a work animal. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will make you slaves under harsh and inescapable oppression]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:49 (#1)

יִשָּׂא יְהוָה עָלֶיךָ גּוֹי

“Yahweh will lift up a nation against you”

Here Moses is using speaking as if Yahweh were going to **lift up a nation** physically into a higher place than Israel. He means that Yahweh will bring them to a position of power over Israel. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will bring a nation against you] or [Yahweh will raise up a nation against you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:49 (#2)

מֵרָחוֹק מִקְצֵה הָאָרֶץ

“from far away, from the end of the earth”

Moses says **from the ends of the earth** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [from a very distant land]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 28:49 (#3)

כַּאֲשֶׁר יְדָאֶה הַנָּשֶׁר

“like an eagle flies”

The point of this comparison is that just as **an eagle flies** swiftly and attacks suddenly, so this nation will attack swiftly and suddenly. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [attacking swiftly like an eagle swooping down on its prey]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 28:50 (#1)

עַז פָּנִים

“fierce of face”

Moses is using **fierce of face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “cruel and intimidating in appearance.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that is ruthless] or [that is cruel and intimidating]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:50 (#2)

לֹא־יִשָּׂא פָנִים לְזָקֵן

“does not lift up a face for the elder”

Moses is using **lift up a face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “be partial to someone.” When he uses “does not lift up a face for the elder,” he means “does not show respect for” or “does not show favor to.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [shows no respect for the elder] or [treats the elder without honor]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:51 (#1)

וְאָכַל & הַאֲבִידְךָ

“And it will eat & it causes & to perish”

Both occurrences of the pronoun **it** refer to the “nation” mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 28:51 (#2)

פְּרִי בְהֶמְתְּךָ וּפְרִי־אַדְמָתְךָ

“the fruit of your cattle and the fruit of your land”

See how you translated the similar expression “the fruit of your land and the fruit of your cattle” in verse 4.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:51 (#3)

עַד הִשָּׁמְדְךָ

“until you are destroyed”

The expression **are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [until the nation destroys you] or [until you perish]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:52 (#1)

וְהֵצַר & וְהֵצַר

“And it will besiege & And it will besiege”

Both occurrences of the pronoun **it** refer to the “nation” mentioned in the verse 50. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 28:52 (#2)

בְּכָל־שְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within all your gates”

Moses is using one part of a city or town, the **gates**, to mean walled cities or towns in general. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [within all your cities] or [within all your towns]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 28:53 (#1)

פְּרִי־בִטְנְךָ

“the fruit of your womb”

Moses is using **fruit of your womb** as a common expression of his culture to mean “your children.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your own children]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:54 (#1)

הָאִישׁ הָרַךְ בְּךָ וְהָעָנֹג מְאֹד

“The tender man among you and the very delicate”

The terms **tender** and **very delicate** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [The most gentle man among you]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 28:54 (#2)

הָאִישׁ הָרַךְ

“The tender man”

Moses is not referring to a specific **tender man**. He means any man who has lived a pampered life in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Any pampered man] or [Even a man who is tender]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 28:54 (#3)

תֵּרַע עֵינוֹ בְּאָחִיו

“his eye will do wrong against his brother”

Moses is using **his eye will do wrong against** as a common expression of his culture to mean “he will look with malice and act selfishly toward.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will be selfish toward his brother] or [he will act with malice toward his brother]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:54 (#4)

וּבְאֵשֶׁת חֵיקוֹ

“and against the wife of his bosom”

Moses is using **the wife of his bosom** as a common expression of his culture to mean “his beloved wife” or “his dear wife.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and against his own dear wife]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:54 (#5)

וּבְיֶתֶר בָּנָיו אֲשֶׁר יוֹתִיר

“and against the remainder of his children who remain”

It might seem that the expression **remainder of his children who remain** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten. Alternate translation: [and against the remainder of his children]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:55 (#1)

מִבְּלִלִי הִשְׁאִיר־לוֹ

“since nothing remains for himself”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [since nothing remains for himself to eat]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:55 (#2)

לוֹ

“for himself”

The word **himself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [for him]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 28:55 (#3)

בְּכָל־שְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within all your gates”

See how you translated the same expression in verse 52.

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 28:56 (#1)

וְהָעֲנֻגָּה

“and delicate woman”

Moses is not referring to a specific **delicate woman**. He means delicate women in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and any delicate woman]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 28:56 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־נִסְּתָה כַף־רַגְלָהּ הַצֵּג עַל־הָאָרֶץ

“who would not attempt to set the bottom of her foot on the ground”

Moses says **would not attempt to set the bottom of her foot on the ground** as an extreme statement for emphasis. It could mean that the woman has always had servants to carry her places or that she’s always had shoes to protect her feet from the cold and dirt of the ground. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [who has always been carried everywhere] or [who has always had clean, warm feet]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 28:56 (#3)

תֵּרַע עֵינָהּ בְּאִישׁ חֵיקָהּ

“her eye will do wrong against the husband of her bosom”

See how you translated the similar expression “his eye will do wrong against his brother and against the wife of his bosom” in verse 54.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:57 (#1)

בֶּחְסֵר־כֹּל

“for} lack of anything else”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [for lack of anything else to eat]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:57 (#2)

בְּמָצוֹר וּבְמָצוֹק אֲשֶׁר יָצִיק לְךָ אוֹיִבְךָ בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“in the siege and in the distress which your enemy will set upon you within your gates”

Here Moses is speaking of **the distress** as if it were something physical that an enemy could **set upon** people. He means that the enemy will cause the people to experience distress. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the siege and in the distress that your enemy will cause you to experience within your gates]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:57 (#3)

בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase “within all your gates” in verse 52.

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 28:58 (#1)

אִם־לֹא תִשְׁמֹר לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת־כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת

“If you do not keep doing all the words of this law”

Here, **If you do not keep doing all the words of this law** introduces the first part of a possible condition. Yahweh will only do the things in verse 59 if this condition happens. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [Suppose you do not keep doing all the words of this law]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 28:58 (#2)

הַכְּתוּבִ֖ים

“that are written”

The expression **are written** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [that Yahweh has given me to write]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:58 (#3)

אֶת־הַשֵּׁ֣ם הַנִּכְבָּ֔ד וְהַנּוֹרָ֖א הַזֶּ֑ה אֵ֚ת יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶֽיךָ

“this glorious and feared name, Yahweh your God”

Here, **name** represents Yahweh himself, including his character, power, and reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God himself, who is glorious and to be revered]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:58 (#4)

אֶת־הַשֵּׁ֣ם הַנִּכְבָּ֔ד וְהַנּוֹרָ֖א הַזֶּֽה

“this glorious and feared name”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **glorious** and **feared**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [this name that brings glory and terror] or [this name that people glorify and revere]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 28:59 (#1)

זַרְעֶ֑ךָ

“your seed”

See how you translated the expression “your seed” in verse 46. Alternate translation: [your offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:59 (#2)

וְחֳלָיִ֖ים רָעִ֥ים וְנֶאֱמָנִֽים

“and great and enduring sicknesses”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they will be great and enduring sicknesses]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 28:60 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר יָגֹ֖רְתָּ מִפְּנֵיהֶ֑ם

“of which you were afraid of their faces”

Moses is using **of which you were afraid of their faces** as a common expression of his culture to mean “which you feared” or “which terrified you.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [which you feared]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 28:61 (#1)

כָּל־חֳלִ֥י וְכָל־מַכָּ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹֽא כָתוּב֮

“every sickness and every plague that {is} not written”

Moses is saying **every sickness and every plague that is not written** as a generalization for emphasis. If it would be clearer in your language, you could express the emphasis in a different way. Alternate translation: [many other sicknesses and plagues that are not written]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 28:61 (#2)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר לֹֽא כָתוּב֮ בְּסֵ֣פֶר הַתּוֹרָ֣ה הַזֹּ֔את

“that {is} not written in the scroll of this law”

The expression **is not written** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate trans-

lation: [that I have not written in the scroll of this law] or [that this law does not record]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:61 (#3)

עַד הִשָּׁמְדֶךָ

“until you are destroyed”

The expression **are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [until they destroy you]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:62 (#1)

וְנִשְׁאַרְתֶּם & הֱיִיתֶם & כִּי־לֹא שָׁמַעְתָּ

“And you shall remain & you were & because you did not listen”

The words translated **you shall remain** and **you were** are plural here because Moses is addressing the Israelites as a group, but **you did not listen** is singular because it refers to each individual Israelite. So use the plural form for the first two phrases and the singular form for the last phrase in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 28:62 (#2)

הֱיִיתֶם כְּכוֹכְבֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם לָרֹב

“you were like the stars of the heavens in number”

Here Moses is making a comparison between the number of Israelites and **the stars of the heavens**. The point of this comparison is that just as **the stars of the heavens** are countless, so were the Israelites numerous in the past. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [you were as countless as the stars of the heavens] or [you were very numerous]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 28:63 (#1)

אַתֶּם

“you”

The word **you** is plural throughout most of this verse because Moses is addressing the Israelites as a group. However, in the final clause the **you** is singular, referring to the nation of Israel as a single entity. Use the appropriate form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 28:63 (#2)

כַּאֲשֶׁר־שָׂשׂ יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם לְהֵיטִיב אֶתְכֶם וּלְהַרְבּוֹת אֶתְכֶם כֵּן
יָשִׂישׂ יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם לְהַאֲבִיד אֶתְכֶם וּלְהַשְׁמִיד אֶתְכֶם

“as Yahweh rejoiced over you in doing you good, and in multiplying you, so Yahweh will rejoice over you in causing you to perish and in destroying you”

Moses uses the word **so** here to indicate a contrast between Yahweh’s past joy in blessing Israel and his future joy in punishing them. This creates a shocking reversal of expectations—the same divine joy that once brought blessing will bring destruction. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [just as Yahweh rejoiced over you in doing you good and in multiplying you, in the same way Yahweh will rejoice over you in causing you to perish and in destroying you]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Deuteronomy 28:63 (#3)

וְנִסַּחְתֶּם מֵעַל הָאֲדָמָה

“And you will be torn away from the land”

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites were plants that would be **torn away** from the soil. He means that they will be forcibly removed from the land. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And you will be forcibly removed from the land] or [And you will be driven out of the land]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:63 (#4)

וְנִסַּחְתֶּם מֵעַל הָאֲדָמָה

“And you will be torn away from the land”

The expression **you will be torn away from the land** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will tear you away from the land]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 28:64 (#1)

מִקְצֵה הָאָרֶץ וְעַד־קְצֵה הָאָרֶץ

“from {one} end of the earth and to the {other} end of the earth”

Moses is referring to all of the earth by naming two extremes, **one end of the earth** and **the other end of the earth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [everywhere on earth] or [to the farthest places on earth]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:65 (#1)

מָנוֹחַ לְכַף־רַגְלֶךָ

“rest for the sole of your foot”

Moses is using one part of a person, the **sole of your foot**, to mean all of him in the act of finding rest. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [there will be no rest for you]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 28:65 (#2)

לֵב רַגָּז וְכִלְיוֹן עֵינַיִם וְדַאֲבוֹן נָפֶשׁ

“a trembling heart and failing eyes and a mourning spirit”

Here, **a trembling heart**, **failing eyes**, and **a mourning spirit** represent fearfulness, hopelessness, and deep sadness. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use equivalent expressions or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [fearfulness, hopelessness, and despair] or [constant fear, lost hope, and deep sadness]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:66 (#1)

חַיֶּיךָ תְּלֻאִים לְנֶגְדֶּךָ

“your life will hang before you”

Here Moses is speaking as if the people’s lives could physically **hang** precariously, as if suspended by a thread. He means that their lives will constantly be at risk and they will live in uncertainty about their survival. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your life will constantly be at risk] or [you will live in constant danger]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 28:66 (#2)

לַיְלָה וְיוֹמָם

“night and day”

Moses is referring to all times by naming two extremes, **night** and **day**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [all the time] or [constantly]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 28:67 (#1)

בַּבֹּקֶר תֹּאמַר׀ מִי־יִתֵּן עֶרֶב וּבָעֶרֶב תֹּאמַר מִי־יִתֵּן בֹּקֶר

“In the morning you will say, ‘Who gives evening?’ and in the evening you will say, ‘Who gives morning”

Moses is using the question form to express the people’s despair and longing for relief from their suffering. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [In the morning you will say, ‘I wish it were evening!’ and in the evening you will say, ‘I wish it were morning!’]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 28:67 (#2)

מִפַּחַד לְבָבְךָ אֲשֶׁר תִּפְחָד

“because of the fear in your hearts that you fear”

Moses is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [because of the great fear you feel]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 28:67 (#3)

וּמִמַּרְאֵה עֵינֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר תִּרְאֶה

“and the view of your eyes that you will see”

It might seem that the expression **from the view of your eyes that you will see** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [all that you will see]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 28:68 (#1)

אָמַרְתִּי

“I had said”

Here the pronoun **I** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh had said] or [he had said]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 28:68 (#2)

בַּדֶּרֶךְ֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אָמַ֔רְתִּי לְךָ֖ לֹא־תֹסִ֣יף עֹ֑וד לִרְאֹתָ֣הּ

“by the route which I had said to you, ‘You will not continue to see it again”

Here, **see** represents experiencing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [by the route which he had said to you, ‘You will not go there again.’]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 28:68 (#3)

וְהִתְמַכַּרְתֶּ֣ם שָׁ֔ם לְאֹיְבֶ֖יךָ לַעֲבָדִ֣ים וְלִשְׁפָחֹ֑ות וְאֵ֖ין קֹנֶֽה

“And there you will sell yourselves to your enemies as male slaves and female slaves, but there will be no buyers”

Moses says **but there will be no buyers** as an overstatement for emphasis. This is the climax of the judgment prophecies, expressing poetic irony: the people will be so desperate that they will try to sell themselves back into slavery, but they will be so numerous and so worthless as slaves that no one will buy them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [If you were to try to sell yourselves to your enemies as slaves, your people will be so numerous and so worthless that you would find no one willing to buy you]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 28:68 (#4)

וְהִתְמַכַּרְתֶּ֣ם

“And & you will sell yourselves”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy - Chapter 29 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is a summary of what Yahweh has done for the Israelites and a warning of what will happen if they worship other gods.

1. History (2–9)
2. Extent of covenant (10–15)
3. Warnings against covenant breaking (16–29)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

- verse one may connect to chapter 28 more than chapter 29
- the concept of “nose” for anger occurs frequently
- the verb “cut” is used in relation to a covenant to mean “make a covenant”
- there are several references to curses written in the book which require care because the phrase is passive and readers may have trouble identifying who wrote them, when they were written and what book Moses is referring to

Use of “you”

Throughout this chapter “you” is a mix of singular and plural. The majority are plural. All are singular in verses 3 and 12–13. Verses 5 and 11 are a mix, see notes there.

Deuteronomy 29:1 (#1)

אֵ֚לֶּה דִּבְרֵ֣י & בְּחֹרֵ֔ב

“These {are} the words of & at Horeb”

In some translations this verse appears at the end of chapter 28 and other translations, at the beginning of chapter 29. You may wish to follow the convention of a locally accepted translation. This reflects that this verse could (1) look ahead to everything in chapter 29. Use a natural form in your language that indicates that it applies to what follows such as ending punctuation. Alternate translation: [These are the words of … at Horeb:] or (2) refer back to everything in chapter 28. Alternate translation: [Those were the words of … at Horeb]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 29:1 (#2)

הַבְּרִ֗ית אֲשֶׁ֨ר־צִוָּ֤ה יְהוָה֙ אֶת־מֹשֶׁ֔ה לִכְרֹ֖ת אֶת־בְּנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“the covenant that Yahweh commanded Moses to cut {with} the sons of Israel”

Moses is using **cut** and **covenant** as part of a common expression of his culture, "to cut a covenant," which means "to make" or "establish" a covenant. See how you translated the phrase "cut a covenant" in 5:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the covenant that Yahweh commanded Moses to make with the sons of Israel] or [the covenant that Yahweh commanded Moses to establish with the sons of Israel]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:1 (#3)

אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

"with} the sons of Israel"

Here, **sons** means "descendants." Moses is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as Israel. See how you translated the phrase "sons of Israel" in 4:44. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with the descendants of Israel] or [with the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:1 (#4)

הַבְּרִית אֲשֶׁר־כָּרַת אִתָּם

"the covenant that he had cut with them"

See how you translated the similar expression using "covenant" and "cut with" in the first phrase of this verse. Alternate translation: [the covenant that he had made with them]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:1 (#5)

בְּחֹרֵב

"at Horeb"

Horeb is the name of a mountain that is also known as Mount Sinai. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Exodus 32.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 29:2 (#1)

אֶל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל

"to all Israel"

Here the word **Israel** represents the people of the nation of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your language or plain language. Alternate translation: [to all the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 29:2 (#2)

וַיֹּאמֶר

"and said"

The term **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 29:2 (#3)

לְעֵינֵיכֶם

"before your eyes"

See how you translated the phrase "before your eyes" in 1:30. Alternate translation: [in your sight]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 29:3 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר רָאוּ עֵינֶיךָ

"that your eyes saw"

Moses is using one part of a person, the **eyes**, to mean all of the person in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [that you saw]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 29:4 (#1)

עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

"until this day"

See how you translated the phrase "until this day" in 2:22. Alternate translation: [until this present time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 29:4 (#2)

לָכֶם לֵבָב לָדַעַת וְעֵינַיִם לִרְאוֹת וְאָזְנַיִם לִשְׁמֹעַ

"to you a heart to know or eyes to see or ears to hear"

Here, **a heart to know or eyes to see or ears to hear** represents the ability to understand and comprehend

all that someone sees or hears. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you understanding of all you see and hear]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 29:4 (#3)

לֵבָב֙ לָדַ֣עַת וְעֵינַ֔יִם לִרְאֹ֖ות וְאָזְנַ֑יִם לִשְׁמֹ֥עַ

“a heart to know or eyes to see or ears to hear”

These three phrases **a heart to know** and **eyes to see** and **ears to hear** mean basically the same thing. The second and third emphasize the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by including all three phrases in your translation. If it is helpful, you could combine the phrases in a way that shows that the second and third phrases are repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [understanding all that you see and hear]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 29:5 (#1)

וָאוֹלֵ֖ךְ

“And I have led”

This is the beginning of what Yahweh said. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark that this is a direct quote of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [He said, ‘And I have led]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 29:5 (#2)

וְנַעֲלְךָ֣ & רַגְלֶֽךָ

“and your sandals & your feet”

The word **you** in **your sandals** and **your feet** is singular, so use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction. In **led you**, **your clothes**, and **on you** they are plural.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 29:5–6 (#1)

וָאוֹלֵ֖ךְ אֶתְכֶ֑ם & כִּֽי־אֲנִ֖י יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“And I have led you & that I {am} Yahweh your God”

In verses 5–6 there is a shift of who is speaking. It seems that Moses directly quotes Yahweh. You may choose to mark these verses as a second level direct quotation or change it to refer to Yahweh indirectly. Alternate translation: [And he has lead you ... that Yahweh is your God.]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 29:6 (#1)

יְהוָ֥ה אֱלֹהֵיכֶֽם

“am} Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 29:7 (#1)

וַנַּכֵּֽם

“and we struck them down”

Here, **struck them down** represents defeating them in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and we conquered them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 29:9 (#1)

וּשְׁמַרְתֶּ֣ם אֶת־דִּבְרֵי֮ הַבְּרִית֒ הַזֹּ֣את וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֣ם אֹתָ֑ם

“And you shall keep the words of this covenant and do them”

The terms **keep** and **do** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [And you shall carefully obey this covenant]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 29:10 (#1)

לִפְנֵ֖י יְהוָֽה

“to the face of Yahweh”

Here, **to the face of** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before Yahweh] or [in the presence of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 29:10 (#2)

רָאשֵׁיכֶ֣ם שִׁבְטֵיכֶ֗ם זִקְנֵיכֶם֙ וְשֹׁטְרֵיכֶ֔ם כֹּ֖ל אִ֥ישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“your chiefs, your tribes, your elders, and your officers, all the men of Israel”

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses from here through the next verse to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive. Use a form in your language that someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive.

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 29:11 (#1)

מֵחֹטְבֶ֥ךָ עֵצֶ֖יךָ עַ֣ד שֹׁאֵ֑ב מֵימֶֽיךָ

“from him who cuts your wood to him who draws your water”

The author is referring to all kinds of labor performed by foreigners among them by naming two specific types of work, **cuts your wood** and **draws your water**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [including those who do all kinds of work for you]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 29:11 (#2)

בְּקֶ֣רֶב מַחֲנֶ֔יךָ & עֵצֶ֖יךָ & מֵימֶֽיךָ

“among you in your camp & your wood & your water”

The word **you** and the last two words **your** are singular here, so use the singular form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 29:12 (#1)

לְעָבְרְךָ֙ בִּבְרִיתֹ֔

“to enter into the covenant of”

Here Moses is speaking of being part of a covenant as if it were **entering into** a physical location. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to join the covenant of] or [to become part of the covenant of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:12 (#2)

כֹּרֵ֥ת

“is cutting”

See how you translated the similar expression “to cut” as it relates to “the covenant” in verse 1.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:13 (#1)

הָקִ֤ים־אֹתְךָ֙ הַיּ֔וֹם & לְעָ֑ם

“he may raise you up today into a people”

Here Moses is speaking of God establishing the Israelites as his covenant people as if he would **raise** them **up** physically to a high place. This image suggests that God established them in a position of honor and distinction. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he may establish you today as a people]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:13 (#2)

לַאֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ

“to your fathers”

Here Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:14 (#1)

אָנֹכִ֣י כֹרֵ֔תֹ

“am I cutting”

See how you translated the similar expression “to cut” as it relates to “the covenant” in verse 1.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:15 (#1)

וְאֶת֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֵינֶ֔נּוּ פֹּ֥ה עִמָּ֖נוּ הַיּֽוֹם

“and {with} those who are not here with us today”

The implication is that Moses is referring to the future descendants of the Israelites who are present. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and with our future generations]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 29:17 (#1)

אֶת־שִׁקּוּצֵיהֶ֖ם

“their abominations”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abominations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the abominable things they did] or [their disgusting practices]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 29:18 (#1)

פֶּן־יֵ֣שׁ בָּכֶ֔ם אִ֥ישׁ

“lest there is among you a man”

Moses is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives the Israelites an instruction to follow in verse 9. They should “keep the words of this covenant” so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [so that there will not be among you a man]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 29:18 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ אוֹ־אִשָּׁ֗ה אֹ֚ו מִשְׁפָּחָ֔ה אוֹ־שֵׁ֖בֶט

“a man or woman or clan or tribe”

Here, **a man or woman or clan or tribe** represents people in general at every level of society, not specific individuals or groups. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [any person or family or tribal group] or [anyone at any level of your community]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Deuteronomy 29:18 (#3)

אֲשֶׁר֩ לְבָבֹ֨ו פֹנֶ֜ה הַיֹּ֗ום מֵעִמָּ֙נוּ֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“whose heart is turning away today from Yahweh”

Moses uses the **heart** to represent where a person’s will and emotions exist. He is speaking of disobeying Yahweh as if one **is turning away** from walking on a path that follows Yahweh. You may have comparable expressions in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who decides today to disobey Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:18 (#4)

פֶּן־יֵ֣שׁ בָּכֶ֔ם

“lest there is among you”

Moses is continuing to describe the undesired outcome of not keeping his covenant introduced at the beginning of this verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose of the instruction. Alternate translation: [so that there will not be among you]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 29:18 (#5)

שֹׁ֣רֶשׁ פֹּרֶ֥ה רֹ֖אשׁ וְלַעֲנָֽה

“a root bearing gall and wormwood”

Here Moses is speaking of a person who disobeys Yahweh as if that person were **a root bearing gall and wormwood**. This image emphasizes how such a person will produce bitter and harmful consequences for the community. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a person who brings trouble and bitterness]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:18 (#6)

רֹ֖אשׁ וְלַעֲנָֽה

“gall and wormwood”

The terms **gall** and **wormwood** are kinds of bitter plants. If your readers would not be familiar with what gall and wormwood are, you could use the names of similar plants that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [bitter and poisonous plants]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#1)

וְהִתְבָּרֵ֤ךְ בִּלְבָבֹו֙

“then he will bless himself in his heart”

The word **himself** is used here to indicate that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. The person who blesses and the person who receives the blessing are the same individual. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence.

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#2)

וְהִתְבָּרֵ֤ךְ בִּלְבָבֹו֙

“then he will bless himself in his heart”

Moses is using **bless himself in his heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean "congratulate himself" or "think that he will be safe." If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then he will tell himself that he will be fine] or [then he will convince himself that nothing bad will happen to him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#3)

לֵאמֹֽר׃

"saying"

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#4)

שָׁלֹ֤ום יִהְיֶה־לִּי֙ כִּֽי־בִשְׁרְרָ֣ות לִבִּ֔י אֵלֵ֖ךְ

"I will have peace, though I walk in the stubbornness of my heart"

Here this person is speaking of living as if it were literally **walking**. He also uses **heart** to refer to where one's stubborn desires exist. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will have peace, though I live according to the stubbornness of my heart] or [I will have peace, though I follow my stubborn desires]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#5)

כִּֽי־בִשְׁרְרָ֣ות לִבִּ֔י אֵלֵ֖ךְ

"though I walk in the stubbornness of my heart"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **stubbornness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [even though I stubbornly insist on doing what I want]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#6)

סְפּ֥וֹת הָרָוָ֖ה אֶת־הַצְּמֵאָֽה

"the wet {and} the dry are swept away"

Here Moses is speaking of people as if they were **wet** and **dry** land. Surprisingly, both the dry (wicked) and the wet (righteous) will be swept away even though typically only dry things can be swept easily. He uses **swept away** as an image that means that everyone will be destroyed, both the righteous and the wicked. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [everyone is destroyed together] or [all people are swept away]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:19 (#7)

סְפּ֥וֹת הָרָוָ֖ה אֶת־הַצְּמֵאָֽה

"the wet {and} the dry are swept away"

The expression **are swept away** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will sweep away the wet and the dry]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 29:20 (#1)

יֶעְשַׁ֨ן אַף־יְהוָ֜ה וְקִנְאָתוֹ֙ בָּאִ֣ישׁ הַהֽוּא

"the nose of Yahweh and his jealousy will smolder against that man"

The phrase **the nose of Yahweh ... will smolder** is a common expression that means that Yahweh is very angry. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, in his jealousy, will be very angry with that man]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:20 (#2)

יֶעְשַׁ֨ן אַף־יְהוָ֜ה וְקִנְאָתוֹ֙ בָּאִ֣ישׁ הַהֽוּא

"the nose of Yahweh and his jealousy will smolder against that man"

The phrase **the nose of Yahweh and his jealousy** expresses a single idea. The word **jealousy** tells more about **nose**. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh's jealous anger will smolder against that man]

See: Hendiadys

Deuteronomy 29:20 (#3)

וְרָבְצָה בּוֹ כָּל־הָאָלָ֛ה הַכְּתוּבָ֖ה בַּסֵּ֣פֶר הַזֶּ֑ה

“and all the curses written in this book will rest on him”

Here Moses is speaking as if the curses were objects that could physically **rest on** a person. He means that the curses will affect that person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and all the curses written in this book will affect him] or [and all the curses written in this book will happen to him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:20 (#4)

כָּל־הָאָלָ֛ה הַכְּתוּבָ֖ה בַּסֵּ֣פֶר הַזֶּ֑ה

“all the curses written in this book”

The expression **written in this book** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Moses. Alternate translation: [that I have written in this book]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 29:20 (#5)

וּמָחָ֥ה יְהוָ֖ה אֶת־שְׁמ֑וֹ

“and Yahweh will wipe out his name”

Here Moses is speaking as if Yahweh would literally **wipe out** someone’s name the way a person might erase writing. Moses means that Yahweh will completely destroy that person so that no one will remember him. See how you translated the similar expression “wipe out their name from under the heavens” in 9:14. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh will completely destroy him so he will be forgotten]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:21 (#1)

הַכְּתוּבָ֔ה בְּסֵ֖פֶר הַתּוֹרָ֣ה הַזֶּ֑ה

“written in this book of the law”

The expression **written in this book of the law** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Moses. Alternate translation: [that I wrote in this book of the law]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 29:22 (#1)

בְּנֵיכֶם֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר יָקֻ֔מוּ מֵאַחֲרֵיכֶ֑ם

“your children who will rise up after you”

Here Moses is speaking of future generations being born as if they were people who would literally **rise up** from the ground. He means the children who will be born in future generations. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your children who will be born after you] or [the generation of those who are not yet born]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:23 (#1)

גָּפְרִ֥ית וָמֶ֖לַח שְׂרֻפָ֣ה כָל־אַרְצָ֑הּ

“All its land {is} sulfur and burning salt”

Here, **All its land** is an overstatement for emphasis. The land is not literally **sulfur and burning salt** but there is so much that nothing will grow. Covering the land with sulfur and salt would poison the land and make it unusable for growing anything on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Its land is poisoned with sulfur and burning salt]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 29:23 (#2)

בְּאַפּ֖וֹ וּבַחֲמָתֽוֹ

“in his nose and in his wrath”

Here the terms **nose** and **wrath** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [in his great anger]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 29:23 (#3)

בְּאַפּ֖וֹ

“in his nose”

Here, **in his nose** refers to part of a common expression of this culture, “the burning of his nose” which means that Yahweh is angry. If this phrase does not

have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his anger]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:24 (#1)

מָּ֣ה חֲרִי־הָאַ֣ף הַגָּדֹ֣ול הַזֶּ֑ה

“What {is} the heat of this great nose”

The author is using **the heat of this great nose** as a common expression of his culture to mean “this great anger.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What is this great anger] or [What is this fierce wrath]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:25 (#1)

אֶת־בְּרִ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה אֱלֹהֵ֖י אֲבֹתָ֑ם אֲשֶׁ֥ר כָּרַ֖ת עִמָּֽם

“the covenant of Yahweh, the God of their fathers, that he cut with them”

Moses is using **covenant** and **cut** as part of a common expression of his culture, “to cut a covenant,” which means “to make” or “establish” a covenant. See how you translated the phrase “cut a covenant” in 5:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the covenant that Yahweh established with their fathers]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:26 (#1)

וְלֹ֥א חָלַ֖ק לָהֶֽם

“and they had no portion of”

Here Moses is speaking as if these gods were something the people could have a **portion of**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and that they never belonged to]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:27 (#1)

וַיִּֽחַר־אַ֤ף יְהוָה֙

“So the nose of Yahweh burned”

See how you translated the similar phrase “the nose of Yahweh your God burn” in 6:15.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:27 (#2)

לְהָבִ֣יא עָלֶ֔יהָ אֵ֥ת־כָּל־הַקְּלָלָ֖ה הַכְּתוּבָ֑ה בַּסֵּ֥פֶר הַזֶּֽה

“to bring on it all the curses written in this book”

The expression **all the curses written in this book** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Moses. Alternate translation: [all the curses that Moses wrote in this book]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 29:28 (#1)

וַיִּתְּשֵׁ֤ם יְהוָה֙ מֵעַ֣ל אַדְמָתָ֔ם

“and Yahweh has torn them away from their land”

Here the author is speaking as if Yahweh had literally **torn** the Israelites away from their land, as someone might tear a piece of cloth or uproot a plant. The author means that Yahweh forcibly removed them from their land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh has forcibly removed them from their land]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 29:28 (#2)

בְּאַ֥ף

“in nose”

See how you translated the similar expression “in his nose” in verse 23.

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 29:28 (#3)

וַיַּשְׁלִכֵ֖ם אֶל־אֶ֣רֶץ אַחֶ֑רֶת

“and has thrown them into another land”

Here Moses is speaking as if God had literally **thrown** the Israelites into another land. He means that God forcefully removed them from their homeland and

sent them into exile. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and has forcefully sent them into another land]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 30 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Moses assures the Israelites that Yahweh will forgive them even if he has sent them into exile and tells them they have a choice; obedience and life, or disobedience and death.

1. Assurance of pardon (1–10)
2. Assurance that Yahweh's law is not too hard (11–14)
3. Reiteration of promises and threats (15–20)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Extended use of negative to make a positive point
From verses 11–13 Moses uses negative, extreme statements and questions that he does not expect an answer to in order to make a strong point to the opposite extreme which is stated in verse 14. If your language would not use these forms to create such an emphasis consider how your language would achieve the same result. (See Litotes; Hyperbole; and Rhetorical Question)

Words for the law

- statutes
- ordinances
- commandments

Moses uses several words to refer to the law that Yahweh commanded the Israelites to obey. It is unclear what the differences are between these terms. If your language has different terms for the law, you could use them here to differentiate between the different Hebrew words. (See: Translate Unknowns)

"you" and "your"
The most significant challenge with "you" forms in this chapter is making it clear to your audience when Moses is speaking about the current generation of Israelites and when he is speaking about future Israelites. In both cases, he uses "you" because he is referring to the nation as one across time. For the most part, from verses 1–10, he uses "you" to mean the future, potential Israelites who will rebel against Yahweh, whom Yahweh will punish, and who repent and are restored to the land. This future generation is introduced in 29:22.

Throughout this chapter "you" is singular except for where noted in verses 18–19.

"voice"
Throughout this chapter, the Hebrew word "voice" frequently refers to what Yahweh has commanded.

"return to Yahweh"
In this chapter "return" is used frequently to refer to the future Israelites changing their minds, that is, repenting, and also to refer to resuming worshipping Yahweh instead of false gods.

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#1)

וְהָיָהׇ

"And it will be"

Moses is using the phrase **And it will be** to mark a change in what he is telling the Israelites. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for marking this sort of change.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#2)

כִּי

"if"

The word **if** here introduces the first part of a possible condition that extends through verse 2. Moses is describing what will happen if the Israelites experience both blessings and curses, are scattered among the nations, and then repent. Yahweh will only do the things described in verse 3 if this condition happens. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen.

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#3)

יָבֹאוּ עָלֶיךָ כָּל־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה

"all these things have come on you"

Here Moses is speaking of the blessings and curses as if they were things that could physically **come on** the people. He means that the people will experience these blessings and curses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all these things happen to you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#4)

נָתַתִּי

"I have set"

Here Moses is speaking as if he had literally **set** physical objects in front of the Israelites. He means that he is presenting them with choices or options. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have presented] or [I have given]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#5)

לְפָנֶיךָ

“to your faces”

Here, **to your faces** represents “in front of you” or “before you.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#6)

וַהֲשֵׁבֹתָ֖ אֶל־לְבָבֶ֑ךָ

“and you return to your heart”

Moses is using **return to your heart** as a common expression of his culture to mean “think seriously about these things” or “reflect deeply on what has happened.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you think seriously about these things] or [and you reflect on what has happened]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#7)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר הִדִּיחֲךָ֔ יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ שָׁמָּ֔ה

“where Yahweh your God has driven you there”

It might seem that the expression **where Yahweh your God has driven you there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where Yahweh your God has driven you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 30:1 (#8)

יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֶ֑יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 30:2 (#1)

וְשַׁבְתָּ֣ עַד־יְהוָ֔ה

“and you return to Yahweh”

Moses is speaking of the Israelites as if they had been walking away from God but could **return** to walk back to him. He means that they should stop living in ways that are displeasing to God and instead live in the manner in which God wants people to live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and once again you begin to obey Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:2 (#2)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֥ בְקֹלֹ֖ו

“and listen to his voice”

Moses assumes that readers will know that **listen** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obey.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [listen to and obey his voice]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 30:2 (#3)

וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֥ בְקֹלֹ֖ו

“and listen to his voice”

Here, **his voice** represents what God said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and listen to what he commands]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 30:2 (#4)

וּבָנֶ֑יךָ

“and your sons”

Here the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense that includes both men and women. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women. Alternate translation: [children]

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Deuteronomy 30:2 (#5)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ֖ וּבְכָל־נַפְשֶׁ֑ךָ

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

Moses is referring to all of a person by naming two major components, **heart** and **soul**. These terms are used together to mean “completely” or “wholeheartedly.” See how you translated the expression “with all your heart and with all your soul” in 4:29. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with all your being] or [wholeheartedly]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 30:3 (#1)

וְשָׁ֣ב יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֣יךָ אֶת־שְׁבוּתְךָ֔

“then Yahweh your God will turn back your captivity”

Here Moses is speaking as if captivity were a physical object that God could **turn back**. Moses means that God will end their captivity and restore them to their land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then Yahweh your God will end your captivity] or [then Yahweh your God will restore you from captivity]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:3 (#2)

וְרִחֲמֶ֑ךָ

“and have compassion on you”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **compassion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and be merciful to you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 30:3 (#3)

וְשָׁ֣ב וְקִבֶּצְךָ֗

“and he will return and gather you”

The terms **return** and **gather** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [and he will allow you to return]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 30:3 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֥ר הֱפִיצְךָ֖ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֣יךָ שָׁמָּ֑ה

“where Yahweh your God has scattered you there”

It might seem that the expression **where Yahweh your God has scattered you there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [where Yahweh your God has scattered you]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 30:4 (#1)

מִשָּׁ֑ם

“from there”

This verse introduces the consequence of the condition proposed in the previous verse. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the consequence of this possible condition. Alternate translation: [then from there]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 30:4 (#2)

בִּקְצֵ֥ה הַשָּׁמָ֖יִם

“in the end of the heavens”

Moses says **in the end of the heavens** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [in the farthest places] or [at the ends of the earth]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 30:5 (#1)

אֲבֹתֶ֔יךָ & מֵאֲבֹתֶ֖יךָ

“your fathers & more than your fathers”

Here Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestors ... more than he did for them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:5 (#2)

וְהִרְבְּךָ֖ מֵאֲבֹתֶ֑יךָ

“and will multiply you more than your fathers”

As explained in the introduction to this chapter, Moses is using **you** and **your** to refer to a future generation of Israelites. The **fathers** who **possessed the land** refer to the current generation of Israelites (who Moses is addressing) who are about to possess the land. Moses is saying their descendants, after Yahweh’s judgment,

will be even larger than the Israelites' current population. Alternate translation: [and will make those descendants more than you]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Deuteronomy 30:6 (#1)

וּמָלַ֣ל יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ אֶת־לְבָבְךָ֙ וְאֶת־לְבַ֣ב זַרְעֶ֔ךָ

"And Yahweh your God will circumcise your heart and the heart of your seed"

Here Moses is speaking as if God would literally perform the physical act to **circumcise** the **heart** of the Israelites and **the heart of your seed** (their descendants). He means that God will remove whatever prevents them from loving and obeying him completely. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh your God will enable you and your descendants to love him wholeheartedly] or [And Yahweh your God will change your heart and the heart of your descendants]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:6 (#2)

זַרְעֶ֔ךָ

"your seed"

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites' offspring were **seed**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this use of the term "seed." Alternate translation: [your descendants] or [your offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:6 (#3)

לְאַהֲבָ֞ה אֶת־יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ֙ וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁךָ֔ לְמַ֥עַן חַיֶּֽיךָ

"to the love of Yahweh your God with all your heart and with all your soul, so that you may live"

Here, **to the love of** marks **so that you may live** as the goal or purpose of **Yahweh your God will circumcise your heart and the heart of your seed**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [so that you will love Yahweh your God with all your heart and with all your soul, and so that you may live]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 30:6 (#4)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ֙ וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁךָ֔

"with all your heart and with all your soul"

See how you translated the expression "with all your heart and with all your soul" in verse 2. Alternate translation: [with all your being] or [wholeheartedly]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 30:7 (#1)

וְנָתַ֣ן יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ אֵ֚ת כָּל־הָאָל֣וֹת הָאֵ֔לֶּה עַל־אֹיְבֶ֖יךָ

"And Yahweh your God will put all these curses on your enemies"

Here Moses is speaking as if the curses were objects that God could physically **put** on Israel's enemies. He means that God will cause these curses to happen to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh your God will cause all these curses to happen to your enemies]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:8 (#1)

וְאַתָּ֣ה תָשׁ֔וּב וְשָׁמַעְתָּ֖ בְּקֹ֣ול יְהוָ֑ה

"And you will return and listen to the voice of Yahweh"

See how you translated "return to Yahweh your God and listen to his voice" in verse 2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 30:8 (#2)

אֶת־כָּל־מִצְוֹתָ֖יו אֲשֶׁ֣ר אָנֹכִ֑י מְצַוְּךָ֖

"all his commandments that I am commanding you"

Moses is using a construction in which a verb **commanding** and its object **commandment** come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [all his commandments that I am giving you]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 30:9 (#1)

וְהוֹתִירְךָ֣ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ בְּכֹ֨ל ׀ מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה יָדֶ֔ךָ

"And Yahweh your God will give you prosperity in all the work of your hand"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **prosperity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh your God will make you prosper in all the work of your hand] or [And Yahweh your God will cause all the work of your hand to succeed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 30:9 (#2)

בִּפְרִי־בִטְנְךָ֣ וּבִפְרִ֤י בְהֶמְתְּךָ֙ וּבִפְרִ֣י אַדְמָתְךָ֔

“and in the fruit of your womb and in the fruit of your cattle and in the fruit of your ground”

See how you translated the similar expressions “the fruit of your womb and the fruit of your land and the fruit of your cattle” in 28:4.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:9 (#3)

לְטוֹבָ֑ה

“for goodness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **goodness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because he is good to you] or [because it is good]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 30:9 (#4)

כִּֽי־ ׀ יָשׁ֣וּב יְהוָ֗ה לָשׂ֤וּשׂ עָלֶ֙יךָ֙ לְטֹ֔וב כַּאֲשֶׁר־שָׂ֖שׂ עַל־אֲבֹתֶֽיךָ

“for Yahweh will again rejoice over you for goodness, as he rejoiced over your fathers”

See how you translated the similar expression “Yahweh rejoiced over you in doing you good” in 28:63.

Deuteronomy 30:10 (#1)

כִּֽי־ תִשְׁמַ֣ע בְּקוֹל֮ יְהוָה֒ אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“if you listen to the voice of Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God and listen to his voice” in verse 2.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 30:10 (#2)

מִצְוֹתָ֖יו וְחֻקֹּתָ֑יו

“his commandments and his statutes”

See how you translated the similar expression “his statutes and his commandments” in 4:40.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 30:10 (#3)

בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ֖ וּבְכָל־נַפְשֶֽׁךָ

“with all your heart and with all your soul”

See how you translated the expression “with all your heart and with all your soul” in verse 2. Alternate translation: [with all your being] or [wholeheartedly]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 30:11 (#1)

הַמִּצְוָ֥ה הַזֹּ֛את אֲשֶׁ֥ר אָנֹכִ֖י מְצַוְּךָ֑

“this commandment that I am commanding you”

See how you translated the similar phrase “all his commandments that I am commanding you” in verse 8.

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 30:11 (#2)

לֹ֥א־נִפְלֵ֛את הִוא֖ מִמְּךָ֑ וְלֹ֥א רְחֹקָ֖ה הֽוּא

“is not {too} wonderful for you, and it is not far away”

Moses is emphasizing a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with mild expressions that are the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in a strong way. Alternate translation: [is very simple for you, and it is very close to you]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 30:12 (#1)

לֹ֥א בַשָּׁמַ֖יִם הִ֑וא

“It {is} not in heaven”

Moses says **It is not in heaven** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [It is not so far away that it is in heaven] or [It is not unreachable, as if it were in heaven]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 30:12 (#2)

לֵאמֹ֔ר

“saying”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [so that you might say] or [as if to say]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 30:12 (#3)

מִמִּי יַעֲלֶה־לָּנוּ הַשָּׁמַיְמָה וְיִקָּחֶהָ לָּנוּ וְיַשְׁמִעֵנוּ אֹתָהּ וְנַעֲשֶׂנָּה

“Who will go up for us to heaven and take it to us and cause us to hear it, and let us do it”

Here Moses is using the question form to emphasize that the people of Israel think that Yahweh’s commands are too difficult for them to know. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this question as a statement. Alternate translation: [Someone must travel to heaven to learn God’s commands and then return to tell us what they are so we can obey them.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 30:12–13 (#1)

לֹא בַשָּׁמַיִם הִוא & וְלֹא־מֵעֵבֶר לַיָּם הִוא

“It {is} not in heaven & And it {is} not beyond the sea”

Moses is referring to all inaccessible places by naming two extremes, **in heaven** (vertical extreme) and **beyond the sea** (horizontal extreme). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [It is not in the sky … And it is not across the ocean] or [It is not far above you … And it is not far away from you]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 30:13 (#1)

וְלֹא־מֵעֵבֶר לַיָּם הִוא

“And it {is} not beyond the sea”

Moses says **it is not beyond the sea** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [And it is not in some far away place across the sea]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 30:13 (#2)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [as if to say] or [that is, saying]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 30:13 (#3)

מִמִּי יַעֲבָר־לָּנוּ אֶל־עֵבֶר הַיָּם וְיִקָּחֶהָ לָּנוּ וְיַשְׁמִעֵנוּ אֹתָהּ וְנַעֲשֶׂנָּה

“Who will go over to beyond the sea for us and take it to us and cause us to hear it and let us do it”

Moses is using the question form to continue to emphasize the idea from the previous verse that the people of Israel think Yahweh’s commands are too difficult to know. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Someone must travel across the sea to learn God’s commands and then return and tell us what they are.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 30:14 (#1)

קָרֹוב אֵלֶיךָ הַדָּבָר מְאֹד

“the word {is} very near to you”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh’s commandment as if it were physically **very near** to them. He means that the commandment is easily accessible and understandable, not distant or difficult to obtain. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh’s commandment is easily accessible to you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:14 (#2)

הַדָּבָר

“the word”

Here Moses is using the term **the word** to represent the commandment, mentioned in verse 11, that Yahweh had given using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this commandment]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 30:14 (#3)

בְּפִיךָ וּבִלְבָבְךָ

“in your mouth and your heart”

Here, **mouth** and **heart** represent speaking and thinking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [ready for you to speak and think about]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 30:15 (#1)

נָתַתִּי לְפָנֶיךָ & אֶת־הַחַיִּים וְאֶת־הַטּוֹב וְאֶת־הַמָּוֶת וְאֶת־הָרָע

“I have set to your faces life and good and death and evil”

Here Moses is speaking as if he had literally **set** physical objects in front of the Israelites. He means that he is presenting them with choices or options. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am presenting to you life and good and death and evil] or [I am giving you the choice between life and good and death and evil]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:15 (#2)

נָתַתִּי לְפָנֶיךָ

“I have set to your faces”

See how you translated the same phrase, “set to your faces” in verse 1.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 30:15 (#3)

אֶת־הַחַיִּים וְאֶת־הַטּוֹב וְאֶת־הַמָּוֶת וְאֶת־הָרָע

“life and good and death and evil”

By **life and good and death and evil**, Moses means they are being given choices to obey God, which leads to life and blessing, or to disobey God, which leads to death and cursing. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to choose what will give you life and what is good, or what will bring you death and what is evil]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 30:16 (#1)

לָלֶכֶת בִּדְרָכָיו

“to walk in his ways”

Here Moses is speaking of how a person lives as if that were to **walk** along God’s **ways**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to live as he wants you to live] or [to obey him in how you live]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:16 (#2)

מִצְוֹתָיו וְחֻקֹּתָיו וּמִשְׁפָּטָיו

“his commandments and his statutes and his ordinances”

See how you translated the similar phrase, “the commandment and the statutes and the ordinances” in 5:31.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 30:17 (#1)

יִפְנֶה לְבָבְךָ

“your heart turns away”

Moses uses the **heart** to represent where a person’s will and inner commitment exist. He is speaking of disobeying Yahweh as if one **turns away** from walking on a path that follows Yahweh. You may have comparable expressions in your language, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you decide to disobey Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:17 (#2)

וְלֹא תִשְׁמָע

“and you do not listen”

See how you translated “listen” in verse 2. Alternate translation: [and you do not listen and obey]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 30:17 (#3)

וְנִדַּחְתָּ

“but are drawn away”

The expression **are drawn away** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [but you turn away] or [but you go astray]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 30:18 (#1)

הִגַּדְתִּי

“I announce”

This verse introduces the consequence of the condition proposed in the previous verse. Use a natural form in your language for introducing the consequence of this possible condition. Alternate translation: [In that case, I announce]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Deuteronomy 30:18 (#2)

לָכֶם֙ & תֹּאבֵדֻ֔ון & תַּאֲרִיכֻ֖ן

“to you & you will perish; you will & prolong”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 30:18 (#3)

אָבֹ֤בֶד תֹּאבֵדֻון

“perishing you will perish”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **perish** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you will certainly perish]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 30:18 (#4)

לֹא־תַאֲרִיכֻ֣ן יָמִים֮ עַל־הָאֲדָמָ֒ה

“you will not prolong {your} days in the land”

Here Moses is emphasizing a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with a mild expression that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in a strong way. Alternate translation: [you will die soon in the land]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 30:18 (#5)

לֹא־תַאֲרִיכֻ֣ן יָמִים֮

“you will not prolong {your} days”

See how you translated the phrase “prolong your days” in 4:26. Alternate translation: [you will not be able to live for a long time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 30:19 (#1)

הַעִידֹ֨תִי בָכֶ֜ם הַיּ֣וֹם֮ אֶת־הַשָּׁמַ֣יִם וְאֶת־הָאָ֒רֶץ

“I call the heavens and the earth to witness against you today”

Here Moses is speaking of **the heavens and the earth** as if they were living beings that could serve as witnesses. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I solemnly declare before all creation]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 30:19 (#2)

בָכֶ֔ם

“against you”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 30:19 (#3)

הַחַיִּ֣ים וְהַמָּ֔וֶת נָתַ֥תִּי לְפָנֶ֖יךָ הַבְּרָכָ֣ה וְהַקְּלָלָ֑ה

“I have set to your faces life and death, the blessings and the curses”

See how you translated the similar expression “the blessings and the curses that I have set to your faces” in verse 1 and “I have set to your faces life and good and death and evil” in verse 15.

Deuteronomy 30:19 (#4)

וְזַרְעֶֽךָ

“and your seed”

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites’ offspring were **seed**. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this use of the term “seed.” Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and your offspring]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:20 (#1)

לִשְׁמֹ֥עַ בְּקֹלֹ֖ו

“to listen to his voice”

See how you translated the phrase “listen to his voice” in 4:30.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 30:20 (#2)

וּלְדָבְקָה־בּוֹ

“and to cling to him”

See how you translated the similar phrase “to him you shall cling” in 10:20. Alternate translation: [and to maintain a good relationship with him]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 30:20 (#3)

כִּֽי־הוּא חַיֶּיךָ֙ וְאֹרֶךְ יָמֶ֔יךָ

“for he {is} your life and the length of your days”

Here, **your life and the length of your days** represents Yahweh, who is the one who gives life and length of days. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for he is the source of your life and long days] or [for he gives you life and enables you to live long]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 31 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

1. Joshua will lead after Moses (1–8)
2. Command to read the law regularly (8–13)
3. Final instructions and warnings (14–29)
4. Song (31:30–32:44)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Final instructions

In the Ancient Near East, it was common for an important leader to give instructions for his people to follow after his death. In this chapter, Moses begins his final words to the people of Israel. These are words that he wants them to remember long after he is gone. This section served to make a smooth transition to Joshua’s leadership.

Translation issues in this chapter

singular and plural issues

- Plural and singular forms of “you” are mixed in this chapter. Most are singular but in verses 5, 13, and 28–29, all are plural while there is a mix in verse 12 and 26–27 (see notes).
- In verses 16–21, Yahweh speaks about “this people” but frequently uses singular pronouns (“he,” “him,” “his”) rather than plural pronouns (“they,” “them,” “their”) to refer to them. This is because Hebrew often treats a collective noun like “people” grammatically as singular, even though it refers to a group. The ULT preserves this singular form to reflect the original Hebrew. For example, in verse 16, Yahweh says “this people will rise up” but then “he is going” and “he will forsake me.” In verse 17, there is even a shift within the same verse, “my nose will burn against **him**, and I will forsake **them.**” This mixing of singular and plural when referring to the same group may seem inconsistent in some languages. If using singular pronouns to refer to a group would be confusing or unnatural in your language, you could use plural pronouns throughout these verses to refer to the people of Israel.

Order of events

There are a few events in this chapter that may seem out of order or repeated: Joshua presented by Moses before Yahweh commissions him, Moses gives the law to the Levites twice, Moses announces his old age & retirement before Yahweh tells him it is time to die. It may be helpful to view 31:1–12 as an introduction to chapters 31–34 with the more detailed narration beginning from verse 13. It may also help to consider the chapter thematic within a certain time frame instead of strictly chronological within that same time frame.

Deuteronomy 31:1 (#1)

כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“all Israel”

In this verse, the word **Israel** is singular in form, but it refers to all the people of Israel as a group. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the plural form of “Israel.” Alternate translation: [all the Israelites]

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 31:2 (#1)

לֹֽא־אוּכַ֤ל עֹוד֙ לָצֵ֣את וְלָבֹ֔וא

“I am not able anymore to go out and come in”

Moses is referring to all of his normal activities by naming two major components, **go out** and **come in**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I am not able anymore to carry out my duties]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 31:3 (#1)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“Yahweh your God”

See how you translated the phrase “Yahweh your God” in 1:10.

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 31:3 (#2)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ הוּא֙ & יְהוֹשֻׁ֣עַ הוּא֙

“Yahweh your God, he & Joshua, he”

Moses is stating the pronoun **he** separately after **Yahweh your God** and **Joshua**, even though the subject is already stated. He is doing that to emphasize that these are the ones who will lead the people. If a speaker of your language would use explicit pronouns for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the emphasis here. Alternate translation: [It is Yahweh your God who ... It is Joshua who]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 31:3 (#3)

לְפָנֶ֑יךָ & מִלְּפָנֶ֑יךָ & לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“to your faces & from to your faces & to your faces”

Here, **to your faces** represents being in front of you or ahead of you. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before you ... from before you ... before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:4 (#1)

לְסִיחֹ֥ן וּלְעֹ֖וג מַלְכֵ֣י הָאֱמֹרִ֑י וּלְאַרְצָֽם

“to Sihon and to Og, the kings of the Amorites, and to their land”

Here, **their land** represents the people who lived in that land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to Sihon and to Og, the kings of the Amorites, and to their people]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:4 (#2)

לְסִיחֹ֥ן וּלְעֹ֖וג מַלְכֵ֣י הָאֱמֹרִ֑י

“to Sihon and to Og, the kings of the Amorites”

The words **Sihon** and **Og** are the names of men, and **Amorites** is the name of a people group.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 31:5 (#1)

וּנְתָנָ֥ם יְהוָ֖ה לִפְנֵיכֶ֑ם

“And Yahweh will give them to your faces”

Moses is using **give them to your faces** as a common expression of his culture to mean “give you victory over them” or “deliver them into your power.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this similar phrase “give them to your face” in 7:2. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will give you victory over them] or [And Yahweh will hand them over to you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:5 (#2)

וַעֲשִׂיתֶ֣ם לָהֶ֔ם כְּכָל־הַמִּצְוָ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוִּ֑יתִי אֶתְכֶֽם

“and you shall do to them according to all the commandments that I commanded you”

By **all the commandments that I commanded you**, Moses means the commands to completely destroy the Canaanite nations and not spare anyone or anything devoted to destruction. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. See 7:2 and 20:16–17 for more information. Alternate translation: [and you shall completely destroy them as I have commanded you]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 31:5 (#3)

הַמִּצְוָ֖ה אֲשֶׁ֣ר צִוִּ֑יתִי

“the commandments that I commanded”

Moses is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of showing the emphasis. Alternate translation: [the commandments that I have given you]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 31:6 (#1)

חִזְק֥וּ וְאִמְצ֖וּ

“Be strong and courageous”

The terms **strong** and **courageous** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Be very brave]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:6 (#2)

אַל־תִּירְאוּ וְאַל־תַּעַרְצוּ מִפְּנֵיהֶם

“you shall not fear, and you shall not be afraid of their faces”

The terms **fear** and **be afraid** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [do not be afraid of them at all]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:6 (#3)

מִפְּנֵיהֶם

“of their faces”

Here, **their faces** represents the people themselves, their presence, or their intimidating appearance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [of them] or [of their presence]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:6 (#4)

כִּֽי ׀ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ הֽוּא־הַהֹלֵךְ֙ עִמָּ֔ךְ

“for Yahweh your God, he goes with you”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [since Yahweh your God goes with you]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 31:6 (#5)

לֹ֥א יַרְפְּךָ֖ וְלֹ֥א יַעַזְבֶֽךָּ

“he will not fail you nor forsake you”

The terms translated **not fail** and **nor forsake** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [he will always be faithful to you] or [he will certainly stay by your side]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:7 (#1)

לְעֵינֵ֣י כָל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“in the eyes of all Israel”

Moses is using the term **eyes** to mean sight. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in the sight of all Israel] or [before all Israel]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:7 (#2)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“and said”

The term **and said** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 31:7 (#3)

חֲזַ֥ק וֶאֱמָ֖ץ

“Be strong and courageous”

See how you translated the same expression in verse 6.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:7 (#4)

לַאֲבֹתָ֔ם

“to their fathers”

Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to their ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:8 (#1)

הַהֹלֵ֥ךְ לְפָנֶ֖יךָ ׀

“he goes to your faces”

Here, **to your faces** represents being in front of you or before you. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [he goes before you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:8 (#2)

לֹ֣א יַרְפְּךָ֔ וְלֹ֥א יַעַזְבֶ֖ךָּ

“he will not fail you nor abandon you”

See how you translated the similar expression “he will not fail you nor forsake you” in verse 6.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:8 (#3)

לֹ֣א תִירָ֔א וְלֹ֥א תֵחָֽת

“you shall not fear, and you shall not be dismayed”

The terms **fear** and **be dismayed** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [you shall not be frightened]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:9 (#1)

אֶת־הַתּוֹרָ֣ה הַזֹּ֔את

“this law”

Here, **this law** represents the written document containing Yahweh’s covenant instructions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [this written document] or [these written instructions]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:9 (#2)

בְּנֵ֣י לֵוִ֔י

“the sons of Levi”

Here the author is speaking as if the priests were Levi’s **sons**. He means that they are descendants of Levi. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:10 (#1)

שֶׁ֣בַע שָׁנִ֔ים

“seven years”

Translate this number according to the conventions of your own language and culture. Alternate translation: [7 years]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 31:10 (#2)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 31:10 (#3)

מִקֵּ֖ץ ׀ שֶׁ֣בַע שָׁנִ֑ים בְּמֹ֥עֵד שְׁנַת־הַשְּׁמִטָּֽה

“At the end of seven years, at the appointed time of year of the remission”

See the passage about the **year of remission** which begins in 15:1.

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 31:10 (#4)

מִקֵּ֖ץ ׀ שֶׁ֣בַע שָׁנִ֑ים בְּמֹ֥עֵד שְׁנַת־הַשְּׁמִטָּֽה

“At the end of seven years, at the appointed time of year of the remission”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **remission**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [At the end of seven years, during the year when debts are forgiven]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 31:11 (#1)

כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵ֗ל

“all Israel”

See how you translated the similar expression in verse 1.

See: Collective Nouns

Deuteronomy 31:11 (#2)

אֶת־פְּנֵי֙ יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהֶ֔יךָ

“before} the face of Yahweh your God”

Here, **the face of Yahweh your God** represents being in the presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before the presence of Yahweh your God] or [before Yahweh your God]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:11 (#3)

בְּאָזְנֵיהֶם

“in their ears”

Moses is using the term **ears** to mean hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that all Israel can hear it]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:12 (#1)

בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ

“within your gates”

See how you translated the phrase **within your gates** in 5:14. Alternate translation: [within your community]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:12 (#2)

לְמַעַן יִשְׁמְעוּ וּלְמַעַן יִלְמְדוּ וְיָרְאוּ אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם וְשָׁמְרוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת־כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת

“so that they may hear and so that they may learn and fear Yahweh your God and keep doing all the words of this law”

Here, **so that** marks what follows as the goal or purpose of the instruction to **Assemble the people**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that they may hear and learn and fear Yahweh your God and keep doing all the words of this law]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 31:12 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“your God”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 31:12 (#4)

אֶת־כָּל־דִּבְרֵי הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת

“all the words of this law”

Moses is using **words** to represent everything contained in the law. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all the requirements of this law] or [everything in this law]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 31:13 (#1)

וּבְנֵיהֶם

“And their sons”

Here Moses is using the term **sons** to mean “descendants.” Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:14 (#1)

הֵן

“Behold”

Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus Moses’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:14 (#2)

וַאֲצַוֶּנּוּ

“and I will command him”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will command him to lead Israel]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#1)

הִנְּךָ

“Behold”

Here Yahweh is using the term **Behold** to focus Moses’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Listen carefully] or [Pay attention]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#2)

שֹׁכֵב עִם־אֲבֹתֶיךָ

“you will sleep with your fathers”

Yahweh is referring to death in a polite way by using the phrase **you will sleep with your fathers**. Depending on what is helpful in your language, you could use a polite way of referring to this in your language, or you could state this plainly. Alternate translation: [you will die and be buried with your ancestors]

See: Euphemism

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#3)

שֹׁכֵב עִם־אֲבֹתֶיךָ

“you will sleep with your fathers”

Here Yahweh is speaking of Moses’ ancestors as if they were his **fathers**. Your language may have comparable expressions that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will die and join your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#4)

וְקָם֩ הָעָ֨ם הַזֶּ֜ה וְזָנָ֗ה

“and this people will rise up and whore”

Here Yahweh is using **rise up** as a common expression of the culture to mean “begin to act” or “proceed to act.” He does not mean that the people will get out of bed or stand up from a seated position. If this expression does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and this people will then proceed to whore] or [and this people will begin to whore]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#5)

וְזָנָה ׀ אַחֲרֵי ׀ אֱלֹהֵי נֵכַר

“and whore after the strange gods”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if the Israelites worshiping foreign gods were going to **whore after the strange gods**. He means that they will be unfaithful to him by worshiping other gods, just as a wife would be unfaithful to her husband by being with other men. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and be unfaithful to me by worshiping the foreign gods] or [and act like an unfaithful wife by chasing after the foreign gods]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#6)

הַהוּא & וְעָזָבַנִי & אִתּוֹ

“he & And he will forsake me & with him”

From here through verse 21, the pronouns **he** and **him** refer to **this people** which in the original is a singular noun. Sometimes the plural pronouns “they” or “them” also occur. See the discussion of this issue in the introduction to this chapter for more information. If it would be helpful, you may want to use plural pronouns throughout as is modeled in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#7)

הָאָ֣רֶץ אֲשֶׁ֣ר הוּא־בָ֣א שָׁ֔מָּה בְּקִרְבּ֑וֹ

“of the land in the midst of which he is going to there”

It might seem that the expression **of the land in the midst of which he is going to there** contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language. If so, you could shorten it. Alternate translation: [of the land which he is going into]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#8)

וְהֵפֵ֥ר אֶת־בְּרִיתִ֖י

“and break my covenant”

Here, God is speaking of the **covenant** as if it were an object that could be physically **broken**. He means that the people will disobey the covenant or fail to fulfill their obligations under it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and disobey my covenant] or [and violate my covenant]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:16 (#9)

אֶת־בְּרִיתִ֣י אֲשֶׁ֣ר כָּרַ֣תִּי אִתּ֑וֹ

“my covenant that I have cut with him”

Yahweh is using **covenant** and **cut** as part of a common expression of this culture, “to cut a covenant,” which means “to make” or “establish” a covenant. See how you translated the phrase “cut a covenant” in 5:2. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate trans-

lation: [my covenant that I have made with them] or [my covenant that I have established with him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#1)

וְחָרָה אַפִּי בוֹ בַיּוֹם־הַהוּא

“And on that day, my nose will burn against him”

Yahweh is using the phrase **my nose will burn against him** as a common expression of the culture to mean that he is angry. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning or state the meaning plainly. See how you translated the similar phrase “the nose of Yahweh your God burn against you” in 6:15. Alternate translation: [And on that day, I will be angry with him] or [And on that day, my anger will burn against him]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#2)

וַעֲזַבְתִּים & מֵהֶם

“and I will forsake them & from them”

Unlike most of the other pronouns in verses 16–20, here the words for **them** are plural even though they also refer to the singular noun in verse 16 which is translated “this people.” See the discussion of this issue in the introduction to this chapter for more information. If you chose to translate the pronouns in verse 16 as plural, you may want to use plural pronouns throughout this section as is modeled in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#3)

וְהִסְתַּרְתִּי פָנַי

“and hide my face”

Yahweh is speaking as if he were physically going to **hide** his **face** from the Israelites. He means that he will withdraw his favor and protection from them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and withdraw my favor] or [and remove my protection]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#4)

וְהָיָה לֶאֱכֹל

“and he will be devoured”

The expression **will be devoured** is a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will allow his enemies to devour him]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#5)

וְהָיָה לֶאֱכֹל

“and he will be devoured”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the Israelites experiencing destruction and defeat as if they were going to be **devoured** by a wild animal. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will be destroyed] or [and he will be defeated by his enemies]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#6)

וּמְצָאָהוּ רָעוֹת רַבּוֹת וְצָרוֹת וְאָמַר בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא הֲלֹא & מְצָאוּנִי הָרָעוֹת הָאֵלֶּה

“and many evils and troubles will find him. And he will say on that day, ‘Have not these evils found me”

Here Moses is speaking of **evils and troubles** as if they were living things that could search for and **find** people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will experience many evils and troubles. And he will say on that day ‘Have I not experienced these]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#7)

הֲלֹא עַל כִּי־אֵין אֱלֹהַי בְּקִרְבִּי מְצָאוּנִי הָרָעוֹת הָאֵלֶּה

“Have not these evils found me because my God is not in my midst”

The Israelites are using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [These have surely found me because my God is not in my midst!] or [It is because my God is not in my midst that these have found me.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 31:17 (#8)

עַל֙ כִּי־אֵ֣ין אֱלֹהַ֔י בְּקִרְבִּֽי

“because my God is not in my midst”

The phrase **in my midst** does not mean that Yahweh has a physical body that lives with the Israelites. It means that Yahweh has a special relationship with the Israelites. You could include this information if it would be helpful for your readers. See how you translated the similar phrase “in your midst” in 6:15. Alternate translation: [because my God is no longer protecting me] or [because my God has left me alone]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 31:18 (#1)

וְאָנֹכִ֗י הַסְתֵּ֤ר אַסְתִּיר֙

“And hiding, I will hide”

Here Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **hide** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [And I will certainly hide] or [And indeed, I will hide]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 31:18 (#2)

אַסְתִּ֣יר פָּנַ֔י

“will hide my face”

See how you translated the same phrase “hide my face” in the previous verse. Alternate translation: [will remove my protection]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:18 (#3)

פָּנָ֖ה אֶל־אֱלֹהִ֣ים אֲחֵרִ֑ים

“he will have turned to other gods”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if the Israelites will have literally been walking behind him but then **will have turned** away to walk in a different direction toward other gods. He means that they will stop worshiping and obeying him and start worshiping other gods instead. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he will have abandoned me for other gods] or [he will no longer worship me but will worship other gods]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:19 (#1)

לָכֶ֔ם

“for yourselves”

Here the word **yourselves** indicates that the indirect object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [for you and the people]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 31:19 (#2)

שִׂימָ֥ה בְפִיהֶ֖ם

“Put it in their mouths”

Here Yahweh is using the term **mouth** to refer to singing with their mouths. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Make them learn and sing it]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:19 (#3)

לְמַ֨עַן תִּֽהְיֶה־לִּ֤י הַשִּׁירָה֙ הַזֹּ֣את לְעֵ֔ד

“so that this song may be a witness for me”

Here, **so that** marks **this song may be a witness for me against the sons of Israel** as the goal or purpose of **write this song for yourselves and teach it to the sons of Israel. Put it in their mouths**. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that this is the purpose. Alternate translation: [in order that this song may be a witness for me]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 31:19 (#4)

תִּֽהְיֶה & הַשִּׁירָה֙ הַזֹּ֣את לְעֵ֔ד

“this song may be a witness”

Here Yahweh is speaking of **this song** as if it were a living thing that could serve as **a witness** in a legal proceeding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [this song may serve as evidence] or [this song may serve as testimony]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:19 (#5)

אֶת־בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” Moses is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as **Israel**. See how you translated the phrase “sons of Israel” in 4:44. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to the people of Israel] or [to the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:20 (#1)

לַאֲבֹתָיו

“to his fathers”

Here Yahweh is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:20 (#2)

זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבָשׁ

“flowing with milk and honey”

See how you translated the phrase “a land flowing with milk and honey” in 6:3. Alternate translation: [a rich and fertile land] or [a very productive land]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:20 (#3)

וְשָׂבַע וְדָשֵׁן

“and becomes satisfied and fat”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the Israelites as if they would become physically **fat**. He means that they will become prosperous and comfortable. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and becomes satisfied and prosperous]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:20 (#4)

וּפָנָה אֶל־אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים

“then he will turn to other gods”

See how you translated the similar expression “he will have turned to other gods” in verse 18.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:20 (#5)

וַעֲבָדוּם וְנִנְאֲצוּנִי

“and they will serve them and they will despise me”

Unlike most of the other pronouns in verses 16–20, here the words for **they** are plural even though they also refer to the singular noun in verse 16 which is translated “this people.” See the discussion of this issue in the introduction to this chapter for more information. If you chose to translate the pronouns from verse 16 forward as plural, you may want to use plural pronouns throughout this section as is modeled in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 31:20 (#6)

וְהֵפֵר אֶת־בְּרִיתִי

“and he will break my covenant”

See how you translated the same expression “break my covenant” in verse 16.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#1)

כִּי־תִמְצֶאןָ אֹתוֹ רָעוֹת רַבּוֹת וְצָרוֹת וְעָנְתָה הַשִּׁירָה הַזֹּאת לְפָנָיו לְעֵד כִּי לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ כִּי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת־יִצְרוֹ אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֹשֶׂה הַיּוֹם בְּטֶרֶם אֲבִיאֶנּוּ

“when many evils and troubles find him, then this song will testify to his face as a witness (for it will not be forgotten from the mouths of his seed). For I know the intent that he is making today, before I have brought him”

As in most of this section starting in verse 16, the pronouns **him**, **his**, and **he** refer to “this people” which in the original is a singular noun. If you chose to translate them as plural, you may want to continue to use plural pronouns here as is modeled in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#2)

כִּי־תִמְצֶאןָ אֹתוֹ רָעוֹת רַבּוֹת וְצָרוֹת

“when many evils and troubles find him”

Here Moses is speaking of **many evils and troubles** as if they were living things that could actively search for and **find** the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly.

See how you translated the similar expression, “many evils and troubles will find him” in verse 17. Alternate translation: [when many evils and troubles happen to him] or [when many evils and troubles come upon him]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#3)

רָעוֹת & וְצָרוֹת

“evils and troubles”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **evils** and **troubles**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [evil things and troubling things] or [bad things and difficult things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#4)

וְׁעָנְתָה הַשִּׁירָה הַזֹּאת לְפָנָיו לְעֵד

“then this song will testify to his face as a witness”

Here Moses is speaking of **this song** as if it were a living thing that could **testify**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then this song will serve as evidence against him] or [then this song will prove his guilt]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#5)

לְפָנָיו

“to his face”

Here, **to his face** represents being in front of the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [before him]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#6)

לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ כִּי

“for it will not be forgotten from the mouths of his seed”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because it will not be forgotten from the mouths of his seed]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#7)

לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ

“it will not be forgotten from the mouths of his seed”

Here Yahweh is using **it will not be forgotten from the mouths of his seed** as a common expression of this culture to mean that their descendants will continue to speak about it and remember it. If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his descendants will not forget this song]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#8)

לֹא תִשָּׁכַח מִפִּי זַרְעוֹ

“it will not be forgotten from the mouths of his seed”

The expression **will not be forgotten** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [his descendants will always remember it and recite it]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#9)

יָדַעְתִּי אֶת־יִצְרוֹ אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֹשֶׂה

“I know the intent that he is making”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **intent**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I know what he plans to do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 31:21 (#10)

הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי

“the land that I promised”

Here the author has left out some words that a sentence would ordinarily need in many languages. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [the land that I promised to give to him]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 31:22 (#1)

אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“to the sons of Israel”

See how you translated the same expression in verse 19.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:23 (#1)

חֲזַק וֶאֱמָץ

“Be strong and courageous”

See how you translated the same expression in verse 6.

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:23 (#2)

נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי לָהֶם

“I swore to them”

Here Moses is leaving out some of the words that a sentence would normally need in many languages. If it would be helpful in your language, you could supply these words from the context. Alternate translation: [I swore to give to them]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 31:23 (#3)

וַיְצַו

“And he commanded”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers as modeled in the UST.

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 31:24 (#1)

וַיְהִי

“And it happened”

The author is using the phrase translated as **And it happened** to introduce a new event in the story. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Deuteronomy 31:25 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 31:26 (#1)

וְהָיָה־שָׁם בְּךָ לְעֵד

“and {it} will be there as a witness against you”

Here Moses is speaking of **the scroll** as if it were a living thing that could testify **as a witness** in a court of law. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and it will serve as evidence against you] or [and it will prove your guilt]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:26 (#2)

אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

“your God”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 31:27 (#1)

אֶת־מָרְיְךָ

“your rebellion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rebellion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how rebellious you are] or [that you rebel]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 31:27 (#2)

עָרְפְּךָ הַקְּשָׁשֶׁה

“your hard neck”

See how you translated “stiff of neck” in 9:6. Alternate translation: [how hard-hearted you are] or [how rebellious you are]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:27 (#3)

אֶת־מָרְיְךָ וְאֶת־עָרְפְּךָ הַקְּשָׁשֶׁה

“your rebellion and your hard neck”

The terms **rebellion** and **hard neck** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [your stubborn rebellion]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 31:27 (#4)

עִמָּכֶם & הֱיִתֶם

“with you & you have been”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 31:28 (#1)

בְּאָזְנֵיהֶם

“in their ears”

Here Moses is using one part of the people, their **ears** to mean the people themselves in the act of hearing **these words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to them directly]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 31:28 (#2)

וְאָעִידָה בָּהֶם אֶת־הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת־הָאָרֶץ

“and call the heavens and the earth to witness against them”

See how you translated the similar expression “call the heavens and the earth to witness against you” in 30:19. Alternate translation: [and make this solemn declaration against them with the heavens and the earth as my witnesses]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:29 (#1)

הַשְׁחֵת תַּשְׁחִתוּן

“corrupting, you will corrupt yourselves”

Moses is repeating forms of the verb **corrupt** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [you will certainly corrupt yourselves]

See: Reduplication

Deuteronomy 31:29 (#2)

הַשְׁחֵת תַּשְׁחִתוּן

“corrupting, you will corrupt yourselves”

The word **yourselves** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same people who are doing the corrupting are also being corrupted. Alternate translation: [you will certainly corrupt yourselves]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 31:29 (#3)

וְסַרְתֶּם מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ

“and turn aside from the path”

Here Moses is speaking of disobedience as if the Israelites are literally walking along a path but then they will **turn aside** from that path. The **path** represents the way of life that Moses has just told them to follow. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and disobey the commands]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 31:29 (#4)

וְקָרָאת אֶתְכֶם הָרָעָה

“and disaster will meet you”

Here Moses is speaking of **disaster** as if it were a living thing that could actively **meet** them along the path that they are walking on. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [disaster will come to you]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 31:29 (#5)

אֶת־הָרַע בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה

“evil in the eyes of Yahweh”

See how you translated the phrase **do evil in the eyes of Yahweh** in 4:6. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh considers to be evil]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 31:29 (#6)

בְּמַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵיכֶם

“through the work of your hands”

Here, **the work of your hands** represents the things that the people make and do, particularly idols and acts of worship directed toward them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [through the idols you make and worship] or [through your rebellious actions]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 31:30 (#1)

וַיְדַבֵּר מֹשֶׁה בְּאָזְנֵי

"And Moses spoke in the ears of"

See how you translated the similar expression in verse 28.

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 32 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetic song in 32:1–43.

1. Introduction: Call to hear and praise (1–4)
2. Israel's unfaithfulness despite Yahweh's care (5–18)
3. Yahweh's judgment on Israel (19–27)
4. The foolishness of Israel and their enemies (28–33)
5. Yahweh's vengeance and vindication (34–43)
6. Moses' final exhortation to Israel (44–47)
7. Yahweh commands Moses to ascend Mount Nebo (48–52)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The Song of Moses

This chapter contains a prophetic song that Moses recites to all Israel. The song serves as a witness against Israel, warning them of the consequences of unfaithfulness and assuring them of Yahweh's ultimate justice and compassion.

The Rock

Throughout this song, Yahweh is called "the Rock," a metaphor emphasizing his stability, reliability, and protection. This title contrasts with the false gods of other nations, whose "rock" cannot compare to Israel's Rock.

Jeshurun

Jeshurun is a poetic name for Israel, meaning "upright one." It appears in verse 15, where it is used ironically to describe Israel's rebellion despite their privileged status.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Parallelism

Hebrew poetry often expresses ideas through parallelism, where two or more lines say similar things using different words. This repetition creates emphasis and helps the reader understand the meaning more fully. Parallelism appears frequently throughout the book but is especially used in this and the next poetic chapters. Sometimes the second line restates the first using synonyms for emphasis, as in verse 7, "Remember the days of eternity; consider the years of generation upon generation." Sometimes the first line states the idea positively and the second line states the same idea negatively for emphasis, as in 2:27, "On the road I will go. I will not turn right or left." When translating parallel lines, you may choose to combine them into a single statement or preserve both lines to reflect the poetic style of the original, connecting them with a word that shows repetition rather than addition. Your translation team should decide how to handle parallelism consistently throughout this chapter. (See: Parallelism)

One direct quotation inside another

This chapter contains multiple layers of quotation: Moses quotes Yahweh, and Yahweh quotes what enemies might say. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate or format these passages so that there are no quotations within quotations.

Poetic imagery

This chapter is rich with figurative language, including metaphors (Yahweh as a rock, an eagle, a father), personification (calling heaven and earth to listen), and vivid imagery of judgment (fire, arrows, sword). Translators should preserve the figurative nature of these descriptions. It also uses body parts to represent actions or emotions. For example, "my nose" represents anger, "my hand" represents power, and "in the ears of the people" means in their hearing.

Shifting pronouns

Throughout the song, the pronouns shift between "he," "him," and "they" when referring to Israel. This reflects the poetic style but may be confusing. Pay attention to the context to determine who is being addressed or described.

"you" and "your" singular and plural

Plural and singular forms of "you" are mixed in this chapter. Verse 6 is mixed, see note. Plural forms occur in verses 17, 38, 46–47, and 51. All others are singular.

Speaking about a future event using the past tense
In this prophetic song, Moses often speaks of future events using the past tense, as if they have already happened. For example, in verses 13–14, Moses describes Yahweh's settling and prospering Israel in the promised land as if it was in the past, and from verse 15, he speaks of Israel's future rebellion as if it has already occurred. This rhetorical device emphasizes the certainty of these events. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the future tense in these passages. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy.

Deuteronomy 32:1 (#1)

הַאֲזִינוּ הַשָּׁמַיִם וַאֲדַבֵּרָה וְתִשְׁמַע הָאָרֶץ אִמְרֵי־פִי

"Listen, heavens, and let me speak, and let the earth hear the utterances of my mouth"

These two phrases **Listen, heavens, and let me speak** and **let the earth hear the utterances of my mouth** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. See the introduction to this chapter for more information on parallelism. Alternate translation: [Listen to me, heavens and earth, as I speak]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:1 (#2)

הַאֲזִינוּ הַשָּׁמַיִם & וְתִשְׁמַע הָאָרֶץ

"Listen, heavens & and let the earth hear"

Moses is referring to all of creation by naming two extremes, **heavens** and **earth**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Listen, everything created] or [Hear, everything that exists]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 32:2 (#1)

יַעֲרֹף כַּמָּטָר לִקְחִי תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי כִּשְׂעִירִם עֲלֵי־דֶשֶׁא וְכִרְבִיבִים עֲלֵי־עֵשֶׂב

"Let my teaching drop like rain, my saying mist like dew, like sprinkling on the green, and like downpours on the grass"

Moses is making comparisons between his teaching and various forms of water. The point of this comparison is that just as **rain** and **dew** are gentle and life-giving for plants, so is Moses' **teaching** for the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Let my teaching be gentle and life-giving like rain, my words refreshing like dew, like gentle rain sprinkling on the green plants, and like showers that help the grass grow]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 32:2 (#2)

יַעֲרֹף כַּמָּטָר לִקְחִי תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי כִּשְׂעִירִם עֲלֵי־דֶשֶׁא וְכִרְבִיבִים עֲלֵי־עֵשֶׂב

"Let my teaching drop like rain, my saying mist like dew, like sprinkling on the green, and like downpours on the grass"

These phrases mean basically the same thing. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [Let my teaching fall gently and nourish you like life-giving water]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:2 (#3)

תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי כִּשְׂעִירִם עֲלֵי־דֶשֶׁא וְכִרְבִיבִים עֲלֵי־עֵשֶׂב

"my saying mist like dew, like sprinkling on the green, and like downpours on the grass"

Here Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [let my saying mist like dew, let my teaching be like sprinkling on the green plants, and let my saying be like downpours on the grass]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:3 (#1)

שֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה

"the name of Yahweh"

Here Moses is using the term **name** to represent who Yahweh is and to refer to Yahweh's reputation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh himself] or [the character of Yahweh]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:4 (#1)

הַצּוּר

“The Rock”

Here Moses is speaking of God as if he were a high **Rock** that they could climb up to reach safety from danger. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God, who is like a rock] or [God, who protects us like a rock]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:4 (#2)

כִּֽי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because] or [since]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 32:4 (#3)

דְּרָכָ֣יו

“his ways”

Here Moses is speaking of how God acts as if that were **ways** or paths that he was walking along. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his actions]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:4 (#4)

צַדִּ֥יק וְיָשָׁ֖ר

“righteous and upright”

The terms **righteous** and **upright** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [completely righteous]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:5 (#1)

שִׁחֵ֤ת לֹו֙

“He acted corruptly to him”

The pronoun **He** refers to Israel, while the pronoun **him** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Israel acted corruptly toward Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:5 (#2)

לֹ֣א בָנָ֔יו

“they are} not his sons”

Here Moses is speaking of the people of Israel as Yahweh’s **sons**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they are not his people]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:5 (#3)

דּ֥וֹר עִקֵּ֖שׁ וּפְתַלְתֹּֽל

“they are} a perverse and crooked generation”

The terms **perverse** and **crooked** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [they are a thoroughly corrupt generation]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:6 (#1)

הֲ־לַיהוָ֥ה תִּגְמְל֖וּ־זֹ֑את עַ֚ם נָבָ֣ל וְלֹ֣א חָכָ֔ם הֲלֹ֥וא־ה֖וּא אָבִ֥יךָ קָנָ֑ךְ

“Is} this how you reward Yahweh, people foolish and without wisdom? {Is} he not your father, your shaper”

Moses is using the question form for emphasis and rebuke. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate these questions as statements or as exclamations. Alternate translation: [You foolish and unwise people should not reward Yahweh this way! He is certainly your father, your shaper!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 32:6 (#2)

תִּגְמְל֖וּ

“you reward”

The word **you** is plural here, so use the plural form in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Forms of ‘You’ — Singular

Deuteronomy 32:6 (#3)

עַ֚ם נָבָ֣ל וְלֹ֣א חָכָ֔ם

“people foolish and without wisdom”

The terms **foolish** and **without wisdom** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [very foolish people]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:6 (#4)

אָבִיךָ קָנָנֶךָּ

“your father, your shaper”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh as if he were their **father** and **shaper**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who is like a father to you, the one who formed you] or [your creator and protector]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:6 (#5)

הֲהוּא עָשְׂךָ וַיְכֹנְנֶךָּ

“He made you and established you”

The terms **made** and **established** mean similar things. Moses is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [He brought you into existence]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:7 (#1)

זְכֹר יְמוֹת עוֹלָם בִּבְינוּ שְׁנוֹת דֹּור־וָדֹר

“Remember the days of eternity; consider the years of generation upon generation”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [Remember the days of eternity, yes, consider the years of generation upon generation]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:7 (#2)

יְמוֹת עוֹלָם בִּבְינוּ שְׁנוֹת דֹּור־וָדֹר

“the days of eternity; consider the years of generation upon generation”

Moses is using the terms **days** and **years** to refer to past events and experiences. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the events of ancient times, consider what happened to generation upon generation]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:7 (#3)

שְׁאַל אָבִיךָ וְיַגֶּדְךָ זְקֵנֶיךָ וְיֹאמְרוּ לָךְ

“Ask your father, and he will inform you, your elders, and they will tell you”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [Ask your father and your elders, and they will inform you]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:8 (#1)

בְּהַנְחֵל עֶלְיוֹן גּוֹיִם

“When the Most High gave the nations an inheritance”

Here Moses uses the phrase **gave the nations an inheritance** as if God were distributing property to his heirs, in order to describe how God assigned each nation its territory to live in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [When the Most High assigned the nations their territories] or [When the Most High gave each nation its place to live]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:8 (#2)

בְּנֵי אָדָם

“the sons of man”

Moses is using the term **sons of man** to mean all of humanity. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of people in the world]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:8 (#3)

בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Most ancient manuscripts read “sons of Israel.” The ULT follows that reading. One ancient manuscript reads “sons of God” which refers to heavenly beings. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT. Alternate translation: [the sons of God] or [the angels of God]

See: Textual Variants

Deuteronomy 32:9 (#1)

חֵ֣לֶק יְהוָ֔ה עַמּ֖וֹ יַעֲקֹ֥ב חֶ֖בֶל נַחֲלָתֽוֹ

“the portion of Yahweh {is} his people, Jacob {is} the portion of his inheritance”

Here Moses is speaking as if the people of Israel were **the portion of Yahweh** and **the portion of his inheritance**. He means that Yahweh chose Israel to be his special people, just as a person would choose a portion of land to be his own property. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh chose his people as his own, Jacob as his special possession]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:9 (#2)

יַעֲקֹ֥ב

“Jacob”

Here, **Jacob** represents the people of Israel who were all descendants of the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel] or [the descendants of Jacob]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:10 (#1)

יִמְצָאֵ֖הוּ

“He found him”

Here the pronoun **He** refers to Yahweh and **him** refers to Jacob (Israel). It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh found Jacob] or [Yahweh found Israel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:10 (#2)

יִמְצָאֵ֖הוּ בְּאֶ֣רֶץ מִדְבָּ֑ר וּבְתֹהוּ֙ יְלֵ֣ל יְשִׁמֹ֔ן

“He found him in a wilderness land, and in the barren, howling desert”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by connecting the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [He found him in a wilderness land which was a barren, howling desert]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:10 (#3)

וּבְתֹהוּ֙ יְלֵ֣ל יְשִׁמֹ֔ן

“and in the barren, howling desert”

Moses is speaking of the **desert** as if it were a living thing that could howl. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and in the barren desert where the wind howls] or [and in the barren, desolate desert]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 32:10 (#4)

יְסֹבְבֶ֣נְהוּ יְבוֹנְנֵ֑הוּ

“He surrounded him and gave mind to him”

The expressions **surrounded him** and **gave mind to him** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [He carefully protected him]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:10 (#5)

כְּאִישׁ֥וֹן עֵינֽוֹ

“as the little man of his eye”

The point of this comparison is that just as a person protects **the little man of his eye** (that is the pupil, or the apple of the eye) carefully, so Yahweh watched over his people carefully. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [very carefully] or [with great care, as someone protects his own eye]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 32:11 (#1)

כְּנָ֣שֶׁר יָעִ֗יר קִנּ֙וֹ֙ עַל־גּוֹזָלָ֔יו יְרַחֵ֖ף יִפְרֹ֣שׂ כְּנָפָ֑יו יִקָּחֵ֙הוּ֙ יִשָּׂאֵ֣הוּ עַל־אֶבְרָתֽוֹ

“Like an eagle rouses his nest, over his young he hovers, {He} spread his wings, {he} took him, carried him on his pinions”

Here Moses is making a comparison between Yahweh and an eagle. The point of this comparison is that just as **an eagle** trains and protects its young, so Yahweh trained and protected Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly as is modeled in the UST.

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 32:11 (#2)

אֶבְרָתוֹ

“his pinions”

A **pinions** refers to the outer flight feathers of a bird’s wing. If your readers would not be familiar with what pinions are, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [his wings]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 32:12 (#1)

יְהוָה בָּדָד יַנְחֶנּוּ

“Yahweh alone led him”

The pronoun **him** refers back to “his people, Jacob” from verse 9. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh alone led his people, Jacob]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:13 (#1)

יַרְכִּבֵהוּ עַל־במותי אָרֶץ

“He caused him to ride on heights of the land”

Moses is using the past tense to describe something that is going to happen in the future in order to show that the event will certainly happen. While the perspective of the entire song is from a future singer, in the time frame of Deuteronomy 32 the song here shifts from looking back at the Israelites’ ancestors to looking to the future at their descendants (in verses 13–21). If it would be clearer in your language, you could use the future tense in verses 13–21. Alternate translation: [He will cause him to ride on heights of the land]

See: Irregular Use of Tenses

Deuteronomy 32:13 (#2)

יַרְכִּבֵהוּ עַל־במותי אָרֶץ

“He caused him to ride on heights of the land”

Here Moses is speaking of giving Israel control of the strategic, elevated parts of the land as if he were physically causing him to **ride on heights of the land**. This is an image for giving them victory and security. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He gave him control of the high places of the land] or [He made him victorious over the land’s strongholds]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:13 (#3)

דְּבַשׁ֙ מִסֶּ֣לַע וְשֶׁ֔מֶן מֵֽחַלְמִ֖ישׁ צ֑וּר

“with} honey from the crag, and oil from the flinty stone”

Here Moses is speaking as if Yahweh were physically nourishing them with **honey** from the **crag** or rocky cliff and **oil from the flinty stone**. This image describes miraculous abundance in a land so fertile that it provides these valuable foods even in the most unlikely places. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with honey even from the rocky places, and olive oil even from the stony ground]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:13–14 (#1)

וַיֹּאכַל֙ תְּנוּבֹ֣ת שָׂדָ֔י וַיֵּנִקֵ֥הוּ דְבַשׁ֙ מִסֶּ֣לַע וְשֶׁ֔מֶן מֵֽחַלְמִ֖ישׁ צ֑וּר: חֶמְאַ֤ת בָּקָר֙ וַחֲלֵ֣ב צֹ֔אן עִם־חֵ֖לֶב כָּרִ֑ים וְאֵילֵ֗ים בְּנֵי־בָשָׁן֙ וְעַתּוּדִ֔ים עִם־חֵ֖לֶב כִּלְיֹ֣ות חִטָּ֑ה וְדַם־עֵ֖נָב תִּשְׁתֶּ֥ה־חָֽמֶר

“and fed {him} the fruits of the field, and he nourished him {with} honey from the crag, and oil from the flinty stone,curd of cattle and milk of flocks, with fat of lambs, and rams, sons of Bashan, and goats, with fat kernels of wheat, and the blood of grapes you drank {as} wine”

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive and overwhelming. Use a form in your language that someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive and overwhelming.

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 32:14 (#1)

חֵ֣לֶב כָּרִ֔ים & חֵ֖לֶב כִּלְיֹ֣ות חִטָּ֑ה

“fat of lambs & fat kernels of wheat”

Here, **fat** represents the best and richest part of the lambs and the wheat. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or

plain language. Alternate translation: [the best of the lambs ... the finest wheat]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:14 (#2)

וְאֵילִ֔ים בְּנֵי־בָשָׁ֖ן

“and rams, sons of Bashan”

Moses is using the possessive form to describe **rams** that are characterized by being from **Bashan**. Since Bashan was a region known for its excellent livestock, Moses is speaking of the rams as if they were the offspring of that land. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and rams from the region of Bashan] or [and rams from Bashan]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 32:14 (#3)

וְדַם־עֵנָ֖ב תִּשְׁתֶּ֥ה־חָֽמֶר

“and the blood of grapes you drank {as} wine”

Here Moses is speaking of wine as if it were **the blood of grapes**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you drank wine made from grapes]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:15 (#1)

יְשֻׁרוּן֙

“Jeshurun”

Jeshurun is a poetic name for the nation of Israel. The name means “the upright one,” but its use here is ironic since the verse describes Israel’s rebellion against God. Alternate translation: [Israel]

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 32:15 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁמַ֤ן יְשֻׁרוּן֙ וַיִּבְעָ֔ט

“And Jeshurun fattened and kicked”

Here Moses uses the terms **fattened** and **kicked** to speak of Israel (here called Jeshurun) as if it were a well-fed animal that has become stubborn and rebellious. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Israel became prosperous and rebelled]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:15 (#3)

שָׁמַ֥נְתָּ עָבִ֖יתָ כָּשִׂ֑יתָ

“you were fat, you thickened, you gorged”

The terms **fat**, **thickened**, and **gorged** mean similar things. Moses is using the terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [you were obese]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:15 (#4)

שָׁמַ֥נְתָּ עָבִ֖יתָ כָּשִׂ֑יתָ וַיִּטֹּשׁ֙ אֱלֹ֣וַהּ עָשָׂ֔הוּ וַיְנַבֵּ֖ל צ֥וּר יִשְׁעָתֽוֹ

“you were fat, you thickened, you gorged— and he abandoned the God {who} made him, and he rejected the Rock of his salvation”

In this verse, the pronouns shift between **you** (referring to the Israelites) and **he** and **his** (also referring to the Israelites). It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Israelites were fat, the Israelites thickened, the Israelites gorged—and the Israelites abandoned the God who made them, and the Israelites rejected the Rock of their salvation]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:15 (#5)

צ֥וּר יִשְׁעָתֽוֹ

“the Rock of his salvation”

Here Moses is speaking of God as if he were a high **Rock** that they could climb up to reach safety from danger. The point of this comparison also brings out that God is the strong and reliable source of their **salvation**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. See how you translated this in 32:4. Alternate translation: [the God who saves them powerfully] or [their strong Savior]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:15 (#6)

צ֥וּר יִשְׁעָתֽוֹ

“the Rock of his salvation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the Rock who saved him] or [the Rock who saves]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:16 (#1)

יַקְנִאֻהוּ בְּזָרִים בְּתוֹעֵבֹת יַכְעִיסֻהוּ

“He made him jealous with strangers. With their abominations they angered him”

The pronouns **He** and **their** refer to the Israelites, while the pronouns **him** refer to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The Israelites provoked Yahweh with strangers. With their abominations they angered Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:16 (#2)

בְּזָרִים

“with strangers”

Here, **strangers** represents the foreign gods that the Israelites began to worship. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [with foreign gods]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:16 (#3)

בְּתוֹעֵבֹת

“With their abominations”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **abominations**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [With their detestable practices] or [With what they did that was disgusting to God]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:17 (#1)

אֲבֹתֵיכֶם

“your fathers”

Here Moses is using the term **fathers** to mean “ancestors.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your ancestors]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:18 (#1)

צוּר יְלָדְךָ תֶּיֱשִׁי וַתִּשְׁכַּח אֵאֵל מְחֹלְלֶךָ

“The Rock, your bearer, you neglected and you forgot the God {who} gave you birth”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [You neglected the Rock, your bearer, indeed, you forgot the God who gave you birth]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:18 (#2)

צוּר

“The Rock”

Here Moses is speaking of God as if he were a high **Rock** that they could climb up to reach safety from danger. This image also emphasizes that God is strong, stable, and reliable like a rock. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [God, who is strong and reliable]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:18 (#3)

יְלָדְךָ & אֵאֵל מְחֹלְלֶךָ

“your bearer & the God {who} gave you birth”

Here Moses is speaking of God as if he were their **bearer** that **gave … birth** to the Israelites like a mother. This image refers to God as Creator who also established them as a nation. Your language may have comparable expressions that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [your creator … the God who created you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:19 (#1)

וַיַּ֣רְא יְהוָ֔ה וַיִּנְאָ֑ץ

“And Yahweh saw, and he spurned”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh saw what they were doing and he spurned them]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:19 (#2)

בָּנָיו וּבְנֹתָיו

“his sons and his daughters”

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites were Yahweh’s **his sons and his daughters**. He means that

they are his people, whom he chose and cared for. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his people]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:20 (#1)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אַסְתִּירָה

“And he said, ‘Let me hide”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [And he said that he would hide]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Deuteronomy 32:20 (#2)

אַסְתִּירָה פָנַי֙ מֵהֶ֔ם

“Let me hide my face from them”

Yahweh is speaking as if he were physically going to **hide** his **face** from the Israelites. He means that he will withdraw his favor and protection from them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let me withdraw my favor from them] or [Let me stop protecting them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:20 (#3)

בָּנִ֖ים לֹא־אֱמֻ֣ן בָּ֑ם

“children {with} no faithfulness in them”

Yahweh is speaking as if the Israelites were **children**. He means that his people are immature and unreliable in their relationship with him. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [people who are completely unreliable] or [people who cannot be trusted at all]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:21 (#1)

הֵ֣ם קִנְאֻ֔נִי בְּלֹא־אֵ֖ל כִּעֲסֻ֑נִי בְּהַבְלֵיהֶ֗ם

“They made me jealous with a not-god; angered me by their worthless things”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [They made me jealous with a not-god, indeed, they angered me by their worthless things]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:21 (#2)

וַאֲנִי֙ אַקְנִיאֵ֣ם בְּלֹא־עָ֔ם בְּגֹ֥וי נָבָ֖ל אַכְעִיסֵֽם

“so I will make them jealous with a not-people; by a foolish nation I will anger them”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [so I will make them jealous with a not-people, indeed, I will anger them by a foolish nation]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:22 (#1)

אֵ֣שׁ קָדְחָ֣ה בְאַפִּ֔י

“a fire flares in my nose”

Yahweh is using **a fire flares in my nose** as a common expression of the culture to mean “my anger is very intense.” If this phrase does not have that meaning in your language, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am extremely angry]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 32:22 (#2)

וַתִּיקַ֣ד עַד־שְׁא֔וֹל תַּחְתִּ֑ית וַתֹּ֨אכַל֙ אֶ֣רֶץ וְיבֻלָ֔הּ וַתְּלַהֵ֖ט מוֹסְדֵ֥י הָרִֽים

“and burns to the lowest Sheol, and devours the earth and its yield, and scorches the foundations of the mountains”

Yahweh says **burns to the lowest Sheol, and devours the earth and its yield, and scorches the foundations of the mountains** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [burns with complete destruction and consumes everything thoroughly]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 32:23 (#1)

אַסְפֶּ֥ה עָלֵ֖ימוֹ רָעֹ֑ות חִצַּ֖י אֲכַלֶּה־בָּֽם

“I will increase disasters on them; I will spend my arrows on them”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [I will bring disaster after disaster upon them, yes, I will use up all my arrows against them]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:23 (#2)

חִצַּי אֲכַלֶּה־בָּם

“I will spend my arrows on them”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if his judgments were **arrows** that he would shoot from a quiver until they were all used up. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will use all my judgments against them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:24 (#1)

מְזֵי רָעָב וּלְחֻמֵי רֶשֶׁף וְקֶטֶב מְרִירִי

“wasted {by} hunger and weakened {by} plague and bitter contagion”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [they will be wasted by hunger and weakened by plague and bitter contagion]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:24 (#2)

רָעָב

“by} hunger”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **hunger**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by starving] or [by being hungry]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:24 (#3)

וּלְחֻמֵי רֶשֶׁף וְקֶטֶב מְרִירִי

“and weakened {by} plague and bitter contagion”

The expression **weakened by plague and bitter contagion** contains a passive verbal form. If your language would not use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and plague and bitter contagion weakening them] or [and becoming weak from plague and bitter contagion]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 32:24 (#4)

רֶשֶׁף וְקֶטֶב מְרִירִי

“by} plague and bitter contagion”

The terms **plague** and **bitter contagion** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [by deadly diseases] or [by severe pestilence]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:24 (#5)

וְשֶׁן־בְּהֵמוֹת אֲשַׁלַּח־בָּם עִם־חֲמַת זֹחֲלֵי עָפָר

“and on the teeth of beasts, I will send them, with the poison of crawlers {in the} dust”

Here, **the teeth of beasts** represents attacks by wild animals, and **the poison of crawlers in the dust** represents attacks by venomous snakes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and wild animals and venomous snakes will attack them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:24 (#6)

זֹחֲלֵי עָפָר

“crawlers {in the} dust”

The term **crawlers in the dust** refers to creatures that move along the ground, likely venomous snakes or similar reptiles. If your readers would not be familiar with this description, you could use a more general term or explain it. Alternate translation: [venomous snakes] or [poisonous reptiles that move along the ground]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 32:25 (#1)

מִחוּץ תְּשַׁכֵּל־חָרֶב

“Outside the sword will bereave”

Here, **sword** represents warfare or military attack. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Outside warfare will bereave] or [Outside military attack will bereave]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:25 (#2)

וּמֵֽחֲדָרִ֖ים אֵימָ֑ה

“and in the bedrooms, terror”

Here the author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and in the bedrooms, there will be terror]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:26 (#1)

אַפְאֵיהֶ֔ם אַשְׁבִּ֥יתָה מֵאֱנ֖וֹשׁ זִכְרָֽם

“I would wipe them out. I would remove from mankind their memory”

If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [“I will wipe them out. I will remove from mankind their memory.”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Deuteronomy 32:26 (#2)

אַפְאֵיהֶ֔ם

“I would wipe them out”

The meaning of this phrase in Hebrew is unclear. It may read **I would wipe them out**. The ULT follows that reading. The Hebrew verb may also mean “I would sweep them away” or “I would cut them to pieces.” Other ancient Greek manuscripts read “I would scatter them.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Alternative Readings

Deuteronomy 32:26 (#3)

אַפְאֵיהֶ֔ם

“I would wipe them out”

Moses is speaking of destroying the Israelites completely as if he were physically **wiping them out** like someone wiping away dirt or dust. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I would destroy them completely] or [I would remove them entirely]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:26 (#4)

זִכְרָֽם

“their memory”

Here, **their memory** represents the remembrance of them by other people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the memory of them] or [all remembrance of them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:27 (#1)

לוּלֵ֣י כַּ֠עַס אוֹיֵ֨ב֙ אָגֻ֔ור

“if the provocation of the enemy I did not fear”

Moses is speaking as if this were a hypothetical possibility, but he means that it is actually true. If your language does not state something as a condition if it is certain or true, or if your readers might think that what Moses is saying is uncertain, then you could translate this as a confident statement. Alternate translation: [but I feared the provocation of the enemy]

See: Connect — Factual Conditions

Deuteronomy 32:27 (#2)

כַּ֠עַס אוֹיֵ֨ב֙

“the provocation of the enemy”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **provocation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the enemy provoking me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:27 (#3)

פֶּן־יְנַכְּר֣וּ צָרֵ֔ימוֹ פֶּן־יֹ֥אמְרוּ֙ יָדֵ֣ינוּ רָ֔מָה

“lest their adversaries misjudge, lest they say, “Our hand {is} exalted”

The author is using the word translated as **lest** to introduce an outcome that he does not want to happen. Because of this, he first gives a reason for not completely destroying Israel so that this will not happen. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that avoiding this outcome is the purpose. Alternate translation: [so that their adversaries would not misjudge, so that they would not say, “Our hand is exalted]

See: Connect — Goal (Purpose) Relationship

Deuteronomy 32:27 (#4)

יֹאמְרוּ יָדֵנוּ רָמָה וְלֹא יְהוָה פָּעַל כָּל־זֹאת

“they say, “Our hand {is} exalted, and Yahweh did not carry out all this”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking (level 1) and quoting Yahweh (level 2) telling what the adversaries might say (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation. Alternate translation: [they say that their hand is exalted and that I did not carry out all this.’]

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 32:27 (#5)

יָדֵנוּ רָמָה

“Our hand {is} exalted”

Here, **hand** represents power and strength. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Our own power is great] or [We ourselves are strong]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:28 (#1)

כִּי־גוֹי אֹבַד עֵצוֹת הֵמָּה וְאֵין בָּהֶם תְּבוּנָה

“For a nation devoid of counsel {are} they, and without understanding in them”

The pronouns **they** and **them** may refer either to the Israelites or to their enemies. The ambiguity may be intentional. If it is possible to maintain this ambiguity in your language, you may wish to do so. However, if you must clarify the reference and the context of your translation suggests the enemies are in focus, you could indicate this. Alternate translation: [For those nations are devoid of counsel, and without understanding in them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:28 (#2)

כִּי־גוֹי אֹבַד עֵצוֹת הֵמָּה וְאֵין בָּהֶם תְּבוּנָה

“For a nation devoid of counsel {are} they, and without understanding in them”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [For they are a nation devoid of counsel, indeed, they are without understanding]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:28 (#3)

גּוֹי אֹבַד עֵצוֹת הֵמָּה וְאֵין בָּהֶם תְּבוּנָה

“a nation devoid of counsel {are} they, and without understanding in them”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **counsel** and **understanding**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [a nation that does not know how to plan wisely, and they are not able to understand]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:29 (#1)

לוּ חָכְמוּ יַשְׂכִּילוּ זֹאת

“If they were wise, they would comprehend this”

Moses is making a conditional statement that sounds hypothetical, but he knows that the condition is not true. He is stating it as a condition to show that the nations do not understand what will happen to them. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that the speaker believes is not true. Alternate translation: [Since they are not wise, they do not comprehend this] or [They are not wise, so they do not comprehend this]

See: Connect — Contrary to Fact Conditions

Deuteronomy 32:30 (#1)

אֵיכָכָה יִרְדֹּף אֶחָד אֶלֶף וּשְׁנַיִם יָנִיסוּ רְבָבָה אִם־לֹא כִּי־צוּרָם מְכָרָם וַיהוָה הִסְגִּירֵם

“How could one chase a thousand, or two put to flight ten thousands, unless their Rock sold them, and Yahweh gave them up”

Moses is using the question form to challenge his audience to recognize that Israel’s defeat by its enemies could only happen if God allowed it. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [One could not chase a thousand, or two put ten thousands to flight, unless their Rock sold them and Yahweh gave them up!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 32:30 (#2)

אִם־לֹא כִּי־צוּרָם מְכָרָם וַיהוָה הִסְגִּירֵם

“unless their Rock sold them, and Yahweh gave them up”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [unless their Rock, that is Yahweh, sold them, even gave them up]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:30 (#3)

אִם־לֹ֣א כִֽי־צוּרָ֣ם מְכָרָ֔ם

“unless their Rock sold them”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh as if he were a **Rock** that they could climb up to reach safety from danger and that would be a protection for the Israelites. He is then speaking as if God’s allowing the Israelites to be defeated were the same as if he **sold** them to their enemies. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [unless Yahweh, who protects them like a rock, had allowed them to be defeated]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:30 (#4)

צוּרָ֑ם

“their Rock”

See how you translated the similar expression in verse 4.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:31 (#1)

לֹ֥א כְצוּרֵ֖נוּ צוּרָ֑ם

“not like our Rock {is} their rock”

Moses is speaking of God as if he were a high **Rock** that they could climb up to reach safety from danger. He also uses this image of the false gods of the enemies as if they were a **rock** that those people look to for protection. The point of the comparison is to show the vast difference in power and reliability between Yahweh and the false gods. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [our God is far more powerful and reliable than their gods]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:32 (#1)

כִּֽי־מִגֶּ֣פֶן סְדֹ֔ם גַּפְנָ֖ם וּמִשַּׁדְמֹ֣ת עֲמֹרָ֑ה

“For from the vine of Sodom {is} their vine, and from the vineyards of Gomorrah”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [For their vine comes from Sodom, even from the vineyards of Gomorrah]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:32 (#2)

כִּֽי־מִגֶּ֣פֶן סְדֹ֔ם גַּפְנָ֖ם וּמִשַּׁדְמֹ֣ת עֲמֹרָ֑ה

“For from the vine of Sodom {is} their vine, and from the vineyards of Gomorrah”

Moses is speaking of the enemies’ gods as if they were the **vine** and **vineyards** that produced poisonous fruit. He means that worshiping these gods lead to destructive and evil outcomes. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this as a comparison or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For their gods are like vines from Sodom and vineyards from Gomorrah] or [For their gods come from wickedness like Sodom and Gomorrah]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:32 (#3)

עֲנָבֵ֣מוֹ עִנְבֵי־רוֹ֔שׁ אַשְׁכְּל֥וֹת מְרֹרֹ֖ת לָמֽוֹ

“their grapes are grapes of poison, bitter clusters are to them”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [their grapes are poisonous, indeed the whole grape cluster is bitter]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:32 (#4)

עֲנָבֵ֣מוֹ עִנְבֵי־רוֹ֔שׁ אַשְׁכְּל֥וֹת מְרֹרֹ֖ת לָמֽוֹ

“their grapes are grapes of poison, bitter clusters are to them”

Moses is speaking of the Israelites’ enemies as if they were **grapes** and **clusters** that were poisonous and bitter. He means that these enemies are corrupt and destructive in their character and actions. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a comparable figure of speech or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [their deeds are corrupt and destructive] or [they are poisonous and bitter in their character]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:32 (#5)

כִּי־מִגֶּפֶן סְדֹם גַּפְנָם וּמִשַּׁדְמֹת עֲמֹרָה עֲנָבֵמוֹ עִנְּבֵי־רוֹשׁ אַשְׁכְּלֹת מְרֹרֹת לָמוֹ

“For from the vine of Sodom {is} their vine, and from the vineyards of Gomorrah; their grapes are grapes of poison, bitter clusters are to them”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [For their vine comes from the vine of Sodom, and their vine comes from the vineyards of Gomorrah; therefore their grapes are grapes of poison, and bitter clusters are what they produce]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:32–33 (#1)

כִּי־מִגֶּפֶן סְדֹם גַּפְנָם וּמִשַּׁדְמֹת עֲמֹרָה עֲנָבֵמוֹ עִנְּבֵי־רוֹשׁ אַשְׁכְּלֹת מְרֹרֹת לָמוֹ׃ חֲמַת תַּנִּינִם יֵינָם וְרֹאשׁ פְּתָנִים אַכְזָר

“For from the vine of Sodom {is} their vine, and from the vineyards of Gomorrah; their grapes are grapes of poison, bitter clusters are to them.The venom of serpents {is} their wine, and the cruel poison of vipers”

Moses is speaking of Israel’s enemies using poetic images that build from the source, **vine**, to the finished product, **wine**. He compares their gods to **the vine of Sodom** and **the vineyards of Gomorrah**, which produce **grapes** and **clusters** (people) that are poisonous and bitter, and finally **wine** (actions or delight in actions) that is like **the venom of serpents** and **the cruel poison of vipers**. It would be good to try to maintain this building or layering in your language if it would have the same effect.

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 32:33 (#1)

חֲמַת תַּנִּינִם יֵינָם וְרֹאשׁ פְּתָנִים אַכְזָר

“The venom of serpents {is} their wine, and the cruel poison of vipers”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [Their wine is as poisonous as the venom of serpents, indeed as deadly as the poison of vipers]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:33 (#2)

חֲמַת תַּנִּינִם יֵינָם וְרֹאשׁ פְּתָנִים אַכְזָר

“The venom of serpents {is} their wine, and the cruel poison of vipers”

Moses is speaking of the wickedness of the enemies of the Israelites as if it were the **venom of serpents** and **the cruel poison of vipers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. If not, you could state this as a comparison. Alternate translation: [Their wine is as deadly as the venom of serpents and the cruel poison of vipers] or [Their wine is like the venom of serpents and the cruel poison of vipers]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:33 (#3)

חֲמַת תַּנִּינִם יֵינָם

“The venom of serpents {is} their wine”

Here, **wine** represents what the enemies celebrate and take pleasure in. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [What they celebrate is like the venom of serpents] or [They take pleasure in things as deadly as the venom of serpents]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:33 (#4)

וְרֹאשׁ פְּתָנִים אַכְזָר

“and the cruel poison of vipers”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the cruel poison of vipers is their wine]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:34 (#1)

הֲלֹא־הוּא כָּמֻס עִמָּדִי חָתוּם בְּאוֹצְרֹתָי

“Is it not concealed with me, sealed up among my treasures”

Yahweh is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is indeed concealed with me, sealed up among my treasures!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 32:34 (#2)

הֲלֹא־הִוא כָּמֻס עִמָּדִי

“Is it not concealed with me”

The pronoun **it** refers to the judgment that Yahweh will bring, as clarified in the next verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Is not their punishment concealed with me]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:34 (#3)

הֲלֹא־הִוא

“Is it not”

This is the beginning of what Yahweh said. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark that this is a direct quote of Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh said, ‘Is it not]

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 32:34 (#4)

חָתֻם בְּאוֹצְרֹתָי

“sealed up among my treasures”

Here Yahweh is speaking of his future plans for judgment as if they were a valuable document or object that is **sealed up** and kept safe **among** his **treasures** until the right time. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [safely stored and ready to use at the proper time] or [kept secure until I decide to act]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:35 (#1)

לִי נָקָם וְשִׁלֵּם

“Mine {is} vengeance and recompense”

The terms **vengeance** and **recompense** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Vengeance is mine]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 32:35 (#2)

לִי נָקָם וְשִׁלֵּם

“Mine {is} vengeance and recompense”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **vengeance** and **recompense**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [I am the one who will avenge and repay] or [I will punish and pay back]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:35 (#3)

לְעֵת תָּמוּט רַגְלָם

“at the time when their foot slips”

Here the author is speaking of **the time when their foot slips** to mean a time when they would experience sudden calamity or failure. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when they suddenly fall into disaster] or [when calamity suddenly comes upon them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:35 (#4)

כִּי קָרוֹב יוֹם אֵידָם וְחָחַשׁ עֲתִדֹת לָמוֹ

“for the day of their disaster {is} near, and the things prepared for them hasten”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [for the day of their disaster is near, yes, the things prepared for them hasten]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:35 (#5)

וְחָחַשׁ עֲתִדֹת לָמוֹ

“and the things prepared for them hasten”

Here the author is speaking of **the things prepared for them** as if they were living things that could **hasten** or move quickly toward them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and their doom is approaching rapidly]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 32:35 (#6)

כִּי

“for”

The word translated as **for** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came before. The word **for** gives the reason for the vengeance Yahweh described in verses 34–35. Use a connector in your language that

makes it clear that what follows is a reason for what came before. Alternate translation: [because]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 32:36 (#1)

כִּֽי־יָדִ֤ין יְהוָה֙ עַמּ֔וֹ וְעַל־עֲבָדָ֖יו יִתְנֶחָ֑ם כִּ֚י יִרְאֶ֣ה כִּי־אָ֣זְלַת יָ֔ד וְאֶ֥פֶס עָצ֖וּר וְעָזֽוּב

“For Yahweh vindicates his people, and has compassion on his servants. For he will see that gone is {their} hand, and there are none, kept back or let free”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about Yahweh seeing that his people’s strength is gone before the information about him having compassion on them, and put both of these before the information about him vindicating them. Alternate translation: [For Yahweh will see that gone is their hand, and there are none, kept back or let free. And he will have compassion on his servants and will vindicate his people]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 32:36 (#2)

כִּֽי־יָדִ֤ין יְהוָה֙ עַמּ֔וֹ וְעַל־עֲבָדָ֖יו יִתְנֶחָ֑ם כִּ֚י יִרְאֶ֣ה כִּי־אָ֣זְלַת יָ֔ד וְאֶ֥פֶס עָצ֖וּר וְעָזֽוּב

“For Yahweh vindicates his people, and has compassion on his servants. For he will see that gone is {their} hand, and there are none, kept back or let free”

The word translated as **For** at the beginning of the verse gives the reason why in verses 34–35 Yahweh described his vengeance. The second occurrence of **For** indicates that what follows is a reason for what came in the first part of the verse. Use connectors in your language that make these relationships clear. Alternate translation: [Yahweh does all this to vindicate his people and he has compassion on his servants because he will see that gone is their hand, and there are none, kept back or let free]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Deuteronomy 32:36 (#3)

וְעַל־עֲבָדָ֖יו יִתְנֶחָֽם

“and has compassion on his servants”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **compassion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and will act compassionately toward his servants]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 32:36 (#4)

אָ֣זְלַת יָ֔ד

“gone is {their} hand”

Here, **hand** represents power and strength. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their strength is gone] or [their power has failed]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:36 (#5)

וְאֶ֥פֶס עָצ֖וּר וְעָזֽוּב

“and there are none, kept back or let free”

Moses is referring to all of Yahweh’s people by naming two extremes, those who are **kept back** (confined or imprisoned) and those who are **let free** (at liberty). If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [no one at all is left]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 32:36 (#6)

וְאֶ֥פֶס עָצ֖וּר

“and there are none, kept back”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and there are none left, kept back] or [and there are none remaining, kept back]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 32:37 (#1)

צ֖וּר

“the rock”

See how you translated the similar expression in verse 31.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:37–38 (#1)

אֵ֣י אֱלֹהֵ֔ימוֹ צ֖וּר חָסָ֥יוּ בֽוֹ׃ אֲשֶׁ֣ר חֵ֤לֶב זְבָחֵ֙ימוֹ֙ יֹאכֵ֔לוּ יִשְׁתּ֖וּ יֵ֣ין נְסִיכָ֑ם

“Where {are} their gods, the rock in whom they took refuge,who ate the fat of their sacrifices, drank the wine of their libations”

Yahweh is using the question form to taunt the people and their false gods, who are powerless to help them. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Their gods are nowhere to be found—the rock in whom they took refuge, who ate the fat of their sacrifices, drank the wine of their libations!] or [Their gods cannot help them—the rock in whom they took refuge, who ate the fat of their sacrifices, drank the wine of their libations.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 32:38 (#1)

אֲשֶׁ֣ר חֵ֤לֶב זִבְחֵימוֹ֙ יֹאכֵ֔לוּ יִשְׁתּ֖וּ יֵ֣ין נְסִיכָ֑ם

“who ate the fat of their sacrifices, drank the wine of their libations”

Yahweh actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here. He is speaking of the idols as if they were living beings **who ate the fat of their sacrifices** and **drank the wine of their libations**, when he really means that these idols are lifeless and powerless. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who never ate the fat of your sacrifices or drank the wine of your libations]

See: Irony

Deuteronomy 32:38 (#2)

יָקֻ֖מוּ וְיַעְזְרֻכֶ֑ם יְהִ֥י עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם סִתְרָֽה

“Let them rise up and help you; let them be a shelter over you”

Yahweh actually means to communicate the opposite of the literal meaning of what he is saying here. If a speaker of your language would not do that, you could translate the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [But they will not rise up and help you; they cannot be protection for you]

See: Irony

Deuteronomy 32:38 (#3)

יָקֻ֖מוּ וְיַעְזְרֻכֶ֑ם

“Let them rise up and help you”

Yahweh is using **rise up** as a common expression of the culture to mean “take action” or “come to your aid.” He is not saying the false gods will literally stand up from a seated position. If this expression does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Let them come to your aid and help you] or [Let them take action and help you]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 32:38 (#4)

יְהִ֥י עֲלֵיכֶ֖ם סִתְרָֽה

“let them be a shelter over you”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the false gods as if they were **a shelter** that could physically protect the Israelites. He means that these gods should be the ones to help and protect them, since the Israelites worshiped them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [let them be the ones who protect you] or [let them keep you safe]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:39 (#1)

אֲנִ֣י אֲנִי־ה֔וּא

“I, I {am} he”

Here the pronoun **I** is repeated for emphasis, to make a very strong declaration of God’s unique identity. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [I myself am he] or [I alone am he]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 32:39 (#2)

וְאֵ֥ין מִיָּדִ֖י מַצִּֽיל

“and no one rescues from my hand”

Here, **hand** represents God’s power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and no one rescues from my power] or [and no one can escape my control]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:40 (#1)

כִּ֥י

“for”

Here the word **for** introduces not a reason but an explanation. Alternate translation: [You see,] or [Know that]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Deuteronomy 32:40 (#2)

אֶשָּׂא אֶל־שָׁמַיִם יָדִי

“I lift up my hand to heaven”

Lifting the **hand to heaven** was a symbolic action by which a person showed that they were swearing a solemn oath. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [I swear a solemn oath]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 32:40 (#3)

חַי אָנֹכִי לְעֹלָם

“As} I live forever”

Following the custom of his culture, God is swearing an oath and guaranteeing it by something that he holds sacred, his own eternal existence. Alternate translation: [I swear by my eternal life] or [I vow by my own life, which lasts forever]

See: Oath Formulas

Deuteronomy 32:40 (#4)

חַי אָנֹכִי לְעֹלָם

“As} I live forever”

There are three levels of quotation here. Moses is speaking to the people (level 1) and quoting Yahweh (level 2) who is now quoting himself taking this oath (level 3). Use the appropriate punctuation in your language to mark these levels of quotation. Alternatively, you could translate this so that there is not a third-level quotation as modeled in the UST.

See: Quote Markings

Deuteronomy 32:41 (#1)

אִשְׁשִׁיב נָקָם֙ לְצָרָ֔י וְלִמְשַׂנְאַ֖י אֲשַׁלֵּֽם

“I will return vengeance on my enemies, and I will pay back those who hate me”

See the discussion on parallelism in the introduction to this chapter. Alternate translation: [I will punish my enemies, yes, I will pay back those who hate me]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 32:41 (#2)

בָּרַ֣ק חַרְבִּ֔י

“my glittering sword”

Here Yahweh is speaking of his judgment as if it were a **sword**. The word **glittering** adds to the imagery of a fearsome weapon ready for use. If this image communicates well in your language, please use it. If not, you could express this as a comparison. Alternate translation: [my fearsome judgment, which is like a glittering sword] or [my terrible weapon of judgment]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:41 (#3)

וְתֹאחֵ֥ז בְּמִשְׁפָּ֖ט יָדִ֑י

“and my hand seizes justice”

Here Yahweh is speaking of **justice** as if it were a weapon or tool that his **hand** (representing his power) could take hold of in order to execute judgment. If this image communicates well in your language, you could use it. If not, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I take hold of justice] or [and I am ready to execute justice]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:41 (#4)

וְלִמְשַׂנְאַ֖י אֲשַׁלֵּֽם

“and I will pay back those who hate me”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if he will **pay back** a debt. He means that he will punish those who hate him because they deserve punishment for the evil they have done. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I will punish those who hate me as they deserve]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:42 (#1)

אַשְׁכִּ֤יר חִצַּי֙ מִדָּ֔ם וְחַרְבִּ֖י תֹּאכַ֣ל בָּשָׂ֑ר מִדַּ֤ם חָלָל֙ וְשִׁבְיָ֔ה מֵרֹ֖אשׁ פַּרְעֹ֥ות אֹויֵֽב

“I will make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword will devour flesh, with the blood of the slain and the captives, from the heads of the leaders of the enemy”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the information about **the blood of the slain and the captives** with the information about **my arrows drunk with blood**. Similarly, you may want to put the information about **the heads of the leaders**

of the enemy with the information about **my sword will devour flesh**. Alternate translation: [I will make my arrows drunk with the blood of the slain and the captives, and my sword will devour flesh from the heads of the leaders of the enemy]

See: Information Structure

Deuteronomy 32:42 (#2)

אַשְׁכִּיר חִצַּי מִדָּם וְחַרְבִּי תֹּאכַל בָּשָׂר

“I will make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword will devour flesh”

Yahweh is speaking of his **arrows** and **sword** as if they were living things that could get **drunk** with blood and **devour** flesh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will use my arrows to kill so many people that it will be as if my arrows were drunk with blood, and I will use my sword to kill so many people that it will be as if my sword were devouring their flesh]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 32:42 (#3)

מֵרֹאשׁ פַּרְעוֹת אוֹיֵב

“from the heads of the leaders of the enemy”

Yahweh is speaking of **the heads of the leaders** in a way that could have two meanings. This is poetic wordplay. The word **heads** could refer to the top-ranking leaders themselves, or it could refer to the literal heads of the enemy leaders that would be cut off. If your language has a way to preserve this ambiguity, you could do so. Alternatively, you could express one meaning, with the other in a footnote. Alternate translation: [from the severed heads of the enemy leaders] or [from the highest-ranking enemy leaders]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 32:43 (#1)

הַרְנִנוּ גוֹיִם עַמּוֹ

“Nations, make his people rejoice”

Moses is speaking to **nations** that he knows cannot hear him. He is doing this to communicate to the people listening to him that he feels very strongly about God’s justice and vindication of his people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if he were speaking directly to the people about the nations. Alternate translation: [Let the nations rejoice]

See: Apostrophe

Deuteronomy 32:43 (#2)

הַרְנִנוּ גוֹיִם עַמּוֹ

“Nations, make his people rejoice”

Some ancient manuscripts read **Nations, make his people rejoice**. The ULT follows that reading. Other ancient manuscripts read “Heavens, make his people rejoice, and all sons of God, worship him.” If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Deuteronomy 32:43 (#3)

דַּם־עֲבָדָיו יִקֹּם

“he will avenge the blood of his servants”

Here, **blood** represents the violent deaths of his servants. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the violent deaths of his servants he will avenge]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:43 (#4)

וְכִפֶּר אַדְמָתוֹ עַמּוֹ

“and atone for his land {and} his people”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh atoning for or purifying his land and people as if he will physically **cover** them. This image refers to removing the defilement of sin and bloodshed. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he will atone for his land and his people] or [and he will purify his land and his people]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:44 (#1)

בְּאָזְנֵי הָעָם

“in the ears of the people”

The author is using the term **ears** to mean hearing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that the people could hear]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:46 (#1)

שִׁשְׁימוּ לְבַבְכֶם לְכָל־הַדְּבָרִים

“Set your hearts on all the words”

Moses is using the term **hearts** to represent the people’s attention and commitment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Pay close attention to all the words] or [Commit yourselves to all the words]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:46 (#2)

אָנֹכִי מֵעִיד בָּכֶם

“I bore witness to you”

Moses is speaking of his testimony as if it were something that he physically **bore** or carried to the Israelites. He means that he has faithfully declared God’s message to them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I have declared to you] or [I have testified to you]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:46 (#3)

דִּבְרֵי הַתּוֹרָה הַזֹּאת

“the words of this law”

Moses is using the term **words of this law** to represent what the law expresses by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all that this law says to do] or [everything that God has commanded in the law]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:47 (#1)

לֹא־דָבָר רֵק הוּא מִכֶּם כִּי־הוּא חַיֵּיכֶם

“it {is} no empty thing for you, because it {is} your life”

Moses is emphasizing a positive meaning by using a negative word, **not**, together with a mild expression, **empty**, that is the opposite of the intended meaning. If it would be helpful in your language, you could emphasize the positive meaning in a strong way. Alternate translation: [these instructions are extremely important for you, because obeying them will enable you to live well]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 32:47 (#2)

תַּאֲרִיכוּ יָמִים

“you may prolong {your} days”

See how you translated the phrase “prolong your days” in 4:26. Alternate translation: [you may live for many years] or [you may have a long life]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 32:48 (#1)

לֵאמֹר

“saying”

The term **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 32:49 (#1)

הַר־נְבוֹ

“Mount Nebo”

Mount Nebo is the highest point of the northern part of the Abarim mountain range.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 32:49 (#2)

עַל־פְּנֵי יְרֵחוֹ

“on the face of Jericho”

The author is using the expression **on the face of** as a common expression of the culture to mean “opposite” or “overlooking.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [opposite Jericho] or [overlooking Jericho]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 32:50 (#1)

וְהֵאָסֵף אֶל־עַמֶּיךָ & וַיֵּאָסֶף אֶל־עַמָּיו

“and you will be gathered to your people & and was gathered to his people”

Yahweh is using **gathered to your people** as a common expression of this culture to mean “join your

ancestors in the place of the dead." If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will join your ancestors in the place of the dead ... and joined his ancestors in the place of the dead]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 32:51 (#1)

מְרִיבַ֣ת קָדֵ֔שׁ מִדְבַּר־צִ֑ן

"Meribah {in} Kadesh, {in the} wilderness of Zin"

The words **Meribah** and **Kadesh** are the names of places, and **Zin** is the name of a wilderness region. You could add a footnote to show that this refers to the events described in Numbers 20:1–13.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 32:52 (#1)

מִנֶּ֖גֶד

"from the front"

Here, **from the front** represents being opposite to the land or in front of it. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from a distance] or [from the opposite side]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy - Chapter 33 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Some translations set each line of poetry farther to the right than the rest of the text to make it easier to read. The ULT does this with the poetic lines of Moses' blessings in 33:1–29.

1. The author's introduction to Moses' blessing (1)
2. Yahweh's appearance and giving of the law (2–5)
3. Blessings for individual tribes: Reuben (6), Judah (7), Levi (8–11), Benjamin (12), Joseph (13–17), Zebulun and Issachar (18–19), Gad (20–21), Dan (22), Naphtali (23), Asher (24–25)
4. Praise of Yahweh and blessing for all Israel (26–29)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Tribal Blessings

Moses gives a series of prophetic blessings for each of the tribes of Israel before his death. This follows the pattern of Jacob's blessings to his sons in Genesis 49. The blessings speak of each tribe's future character, territory, and relationship with Yahweh. Notably, the tribe of Simeon is not mentioned.

Jeshurun

Jeshurun is a poetic name for Israel, meaning "upright one." It appears in verses 5 and 26, emphasizing Israel's ideal character as a righteous nation belonging to Yahweh.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

One direct quotation inside another

In this chapter, Moses' blessing contains direct quotations from others, such as the Levites in verse 9. If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate or format these passages so that there are no quotations within quotations. (See Quotes within Quotes)

Poetic imagery

This chapter contains extensive poetic imagery, including metaphors comparing tribes to animals (Joseph as a firstborn ox, Dan as a lion cub, Gad as a lioness) and descriptions of Yahweh riding the heavens. Translators should preserve the figurative nature of these descriptions.

"you" and "your" singular and plural

Even though Moses is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Speaking about a future event using the past tense

This occurs near the end of the chapter, see the book introduction.

Deuteronomy 33:1 (#1)

וְזֹ֣את הַבְּרָכָ֗ה אֲשֶׁ֤ר בֵּרַךְ֙ מֹשֶׁ֣ה אִ֣ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים

"And this {is} the blessing with which Moses, the man of God, blessed"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **blessing**, you could express the same idea in another way or omit it. Alternate translation: [And this is how Moses, the man of God, blessed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:1 (#2)

אִ֣ישׁ הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים

"the man of God"

Moses is using the possessive form **man of God** to describe a person who is characterized by represent-

ing God and speaking his message. This phrase is a title for a prophet. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the man who spoke for God]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 33:1 (#3)

אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” Moses is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as **Israel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Israel] or [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:1 (#4)

לִפְנֵי

“to the face of”

The author is using the expression **to the face of** to mean “before” or “previous to.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [just before] or [immediately before]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#1)

יְהוָה מִסִּינַי בָּא וְזָרַח מִשֵּׂעִיר לָמוֹ הוֹפִיעַ מֵהַר פָּארָן

“Yahweh from Sinai came and rose from Seir to them, shone forth from Mount Paran”

Moses is speaking of Yahweh as if he were the sun that **rose from Seir** and **shone forth from Mount Paran**. If this image communicates well in your language, please use it. If not, you could express this as a comparison. Alternate translation: [Yahweh came from Sinai and appeared to them like the sun rising from Seir and shining from Mount Paran]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#2)

לָמוֹ

“to them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people of Israel. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the people or nation here. Alternate translation: [to the people of Israel] or [to his people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#3)

מִרִבְבֹת קֹדֶשׁ

“with ten thousands of the holy”

Here the author is using the phrase **ten thousands** to refer to a very large number. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or use plain language. Alternate translation: [with a great multitude of holy ones] or [with a vast number of holy ones]

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#4)

קֹדֶשׁ

“the holy”

Moses is using the adjective **holy** as a noun to mean a certain kind of being. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [holy ones] or [holy beings]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#5)

מֵימִינוֹ

“in his right hand”

Here, **right hand** represents power or control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in his power]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#6)

מֵימִינוֹ אשדת לָמוֹ

“in his right hand, a fire of law for them”

The Hebrew is uncertain. This could mean: (1) Yahweh has lightening in his hand. Alternate translation: [in his right hand were flames of fire] or (2) Sinai was covered with fire while Yahweh gave the law to Moses. Alternate translation: [he gave them a law of fire]

See: Textual Variants

Deuteronomy 33:2 (#7)

אשדת

“a fire of law”

Moses is using the possessive form to describe a **law** that is characterized by **fire**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [a fiery law] or [a law given from fire]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#1)

חֹבֵב עַמִּים כָּל־קְדֹשָׁיו בְּיָדֶךָ וְהֵמּוֹ תֻכְּנוּ לְרַגְלֶךָ יִשָּׂא מִדַּבְּרֹתֶיךָ

“he loves the peoples. All his sanctified {are} in your hand, and they will be tied to your feet, he will take from your words”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh in the third person as **he loves** but then shifts to speaking to Yahweh directly in the second person in **your hand**, **your feet**, and **your words**. The people are first referred to as **they** and in the last line as **he**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the third person for Yahweh and plural for the people throughout. Alternate translation: [he loves the peoples. All his sanctified {are} in his hand, and they will be tied to his feet, they will take from his words]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#2)

עַמִּים

“the peoples”

Here, **peoples** represents the tribes of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the tribes of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#3)

קְדֹשָׁיו

“his sanctified”

Moses is using the adjective **sanctified** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [his sanctified ones] or [his holy people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#4)

בְּיָדֶךָ

“are} in your hand”

Here, **hand** represents care and protection. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [are under your care] or [are under your protection]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#5)

וְהֵמּוֹ תֻכְּנוּ לְרַגְלֶךָ

“and they will be tied to your feet”

The phrase **they will be tied to your feet** could mean: (1) the people worship at God’s feet. Alternate translation: [and they bow down at your feet] or (2) the people sit at God’s feet to learn from him. Alternate translation: [and they sit at your feet to receive instruction]

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#6)

יִשָּׂא מִדַּבְּרֹתֶיךָ

“he will take from your words”

Moses is speaking of someone receiving or benefiting from God’s words as if **he will take from your words**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he receives your words] or [he benefits from your words]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:3 (#7)

מִדַּבְּרֹתֶיךָ

“from your words”

Here, **words** represents the instructions or commands spoken by God. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from your commands] or [from your teachings]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:4 (#1)

תּוֹרָה צִוָּה־לָנוּ מֹשֶׁה מוֹרָשָׁה קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב

“A law Moses commanded to us, a possession for the assembly of Jacob”

This verse appears to be Moses quoting something the Israelites had said previously. If your language has its own way of introducing a quotation from another speaker, you could use it here in your translation. Alternate translation: [The Israelites said, ‘Moses commanded a law to us, a possession for us, the assembly of Jacob.’]

See: Introduction of New and Old Participants

Deuteronomy 33:4 (#2)

יַעֲקֹב

“Jacob”

Here, **Jacob** represents the people of Israel who descended from him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:5 (#1)

וַיְהִי בִישֻׁרוּן מֶלֶךְ

“And he became a king in Jeshurun”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh. If this is not clear for your readers, you could use the person’s name here. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh became a king in Jeshurun]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 33:5 (#2)

בִישֻׁרוּן

“in Jeshurun”

See how you translated the name **Jeshurun** in 32:15. Alternate translation: [in Israel]

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 33:5 (#3)

רָאשֵׁי

“the heads of”

Moses is speaking of the **heads** of the people as if they were the physical heads of bodies, when he is referring to the leaders of the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the leaders of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:5 (#4)

יִשְׂרָאֵל

“Israel”

Here, **Israel** represents the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:6 (#1)

יְחִי רְאוּבֵן

“Let Reuben live”

Moses is describing the blessing for the tribe of Reuben before describing the blessings for the other tribes that follow. If it would be helpful in your language, you may wish to make it clear that this begins Moses’ blessings to the individual tribes of Israel. Alternate translation: [And to Reuben he said, “Let Reuben live]

See: Order of Events

Deuteronomy 33:6 (#2)

רְאוּבֵן

“Reuben”

Here, **Reuben** represents the people from the tribe of Reuben. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the people of Reuben]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:6 (#3)

יְחִי רְאוּבֵן וְאַל־יָמֻת

“Let Reuben live and not die”

The terms **live** and **not die** mean the same thing. Moses is using the positive and the negative terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Let Reuben certainly live]

See: Litotes

Deuteronomy 33:6 (#4)

וִיהִי מְתָתָיו מִסְפָּר

“but let his men be few”

The phrase **but let his men be few** is difficult to interpret because the Hebrew allows for multiple understandings. This could mean: (1) While Reuben’s tribe will not disappear, it will be small. Alternate translation: [but may his men be few] or (2) Not only will Reuben’s tribe not disappear, it will be big. Alternate translation: [and may his men not be few] or (3) Even though Reuben’s tribe is now small, may it continue. Alternate translation: [even though his men are few]

Deuteronomy 33:6 (#5)

יְחִי רְאוּבֵן וְאַל־יָמֻת וִיהִי מְתָתָיו מְסְפָּר

“Let Reuben live and not die, but let his men be few”

If your language does not use the third-person imperative **let** in this way, you could express the meaning in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May Reuben live and not die, but may his men be few]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Deuteronomy 33:7 (#1)

לִיהוּדָה

“for Judah”

Here, **Judah** represents the people of the tribe of Judah. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [for the people of Judah]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:7 (#2)

קְקוֹל

“to} the voice of”

Here, **voice** represents the plea or prayer spoken by the voice. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the plea of] or [to the prayer of]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:7 (#3)

וְאֶל־עַמּוֹ תְּבִיאֶנּוּ

“and to his people bring him”

The phrase **to his people bring him** could mean: (1) Moses is asking God to bring Judah safely back to his people after battle. Alternate translation: [and bring him back safely to his people] or (2) Moses is asking God to reunite Judah with his people, perhaps referring to unity within the tribe or with the other tribes. Alternate translation: [and make the tribe live in harmony]

Deuteronomy 33:7 (#4)

יָדָיו רָב לּוֹ

“Let his hand strive for himself”

The word **himself** indicates that the object of the verb is the same as the subject of the verb. Use a way that is natural in your language to indicate that the same person fills two roles in the sentence. Alternate translation: [Let his hand strive on his behalf] or [Let his hands fight for his people]

See: Reflexive Pronouns

Deuteronomy 33:7 (#5)

יָדָיו

“his hand”

Moses is using one part of a person, his **hand**, to mean all of him in the act of striving or fighting. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [him]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 33:7 (#6)

וְעֵזֶר

“and a help”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **help**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and a helper]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:8 (#1)

תֻּמֶּיךָ וְאוּרֶיךָ & חָסִידֶךָ & נִסִּיתוֹ & תְּרִיבֵהוּ

“Your Thummim and your Urim & your faithful & you tested & You strove against him”

Here the pronouns **your** and **you** refer to Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh’s Thummim and Yahweh’s Urim ... Yahweh’s faithful ... Yahweh tested ... Yahweh strove against him]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 33:8 (#2)

תֻּמֶּיךָ וְאוּרֶיךָ

“Your Thummim and your Urim”

The **Thummim** and **Urim** were objects used by the high priest to determine God’s will. If your readers would not be familiar with what these objects were, you could use a more general term or explain them in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Yahweh’s sacred objects for determining his will]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 33:8 (#3)

לְאִישׁ חֲסִידֶךָ & תְּרִיבֶנּוּ

“are to your faithful man & You strove against him”

Here, **your faithful man** and the pronoun **him** represent the tribe of Levi. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [are to your faithful tribe …. You strove against them]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:8 (#4)

בְּמַסָּה

“at Massah”

See how you translated this name in 6:16. You could add a footnote that explains that the name **Massah** means “testing.”

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 33:8 (#5)

מְרִיבָה

“Meribah”

See how you translated this name in 32:51. You could add a footnote that explains that the name **Meribah** means “argue” or “quarrel.”

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 33:9 (#1)

לֹא רְאִיתִיו & לֹא הִכִּיר & לֹא יָדָע

“I have not seen them & he did not acknowledge & he did not know”

Moses is using the expressions **seen**, **acknowledge**, and **know** as common expressions of his culture to mean showing partiality or favoritism to family members. If these phrases do not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I did not show partiality to them … he did not favor … he did not give special treatment to] or [I disregarded them … he paid no special attention to … he treated as strangers]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 33:9 (#2)

כִּי שָׁמְרוּ אִמְרָתֶךָ וּבְרִיתְךָ יִנָּצֹרוּ

“for they guarded your speech and your covenant they kept”

These two phrases **they guarded your speech** and **your covenant they kept** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation. If it is helpful, you could connect the phrases in a way that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [for they carefully guarded your speech, yes, they kept your covenant]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:9 (#3)

שָׁמְרוּ & יִנָּצֹרוּ

“they guarded & they kept”

Here the pronoun **they** refers to the Levites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the Levites guarded … the Levites kept]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 33:9 (#4)

שָׁמְרוּ אִמְרָתֶךָ

“they guarded your speech”

Moses is speaking of obeying God’s commands or **your speech** as if it were an object that could be physically **guarded** or protected. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they obeyed your word] or [they carefully followed your commands]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:10 (#1)

יוֹרוּ מִשְׁפָּטֶיךָ לְיַעֲקֹב וְתוֹרָתְךָ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

“They teach your ordinances to Jacob, and your law to Israel”

These two phrases **your ordinances to Jacob** and **your law to Israel** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. The names **Jacob** and **Israel** both refer to the same people. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [They teach your law to the Israelites]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:10 (#2)

בְּאַפֶּֽךָ

“before your nose”

Here Moses is using the term **nose** to represent the sense of smell, by which God favorably accepts the offering. I If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [for you to smell]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:11 (#1)

וּפֹ֥עַל יָדָ֖יו

“and the work of his hands”

Here, **the work of his hands** represents the ministry and actions that the Levites perform. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and his service] or [and what he does for you]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:11 (#2)

מְחַ֤ץ מָתְנַ֙יִם

“Shatter the loins of”

Moses is using **Shatter the loins** as a common expression of his culture to mean “destroy the strength” or “destroy the power.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Destroy the strength of] or [Break the power of]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 33:11 (#3)

וּמְשַׂנְאָ֖יו

“and haters of him”

Moses is using the adjective **haters** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [and those who hate him]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 33:11 (#4)

קָמָ֥יו & יְקוּמֽוּן

“those who rise up against him & they rise up”

Moses is speaking of people opposing the tribe of Levi as if they were physically **rising up** against them. This was a common expression meaning to rebel or attack. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [those who attack him ... they attack] or [those who rebel against him ... they rebel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:12 (#1)

יְדִ֣יד יְהוָ֔ה

“The beloved of Yahweh”

Moses is using the possessive form to describe **The beloved** as someone who is characterized by being loved by Yahweh. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The one whom Yahweh loves] or [The one who is loved by Yahweh]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 33:12 (#2)

יִשְׁכֹּ֥ן לָבֶ֖טַח

“lives in security”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **security**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [lives securely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:12 (#3)

עָלָ֤יו חֹפֵף֙ עָלָ֔יו כָּל־הַיּ֖וֹם וּבֵ֥ין כְּתֵפָ֖יו שָׁכֵֽן

“beside him. He covers him all the day, and between his shoulders he lives”

The pronoun **him** in the phrase “beside him” refers to Yahweh and both **He** in “He covers” and **he** in “he lives” refer to Yahweh. The second **him** in “covers him” and **his** in “his shoulders” refer to the tribe of Benjamin. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [beside Yahweh. Yahweh covers Benjamin all the day, and between Benjamin’s shoulders Yahweh lives]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 33:12 (#4)

וּבֵ֥ין כְּתֵיפָ֖יו שָׁכֵֽן

“and between his shoulders he lives”

This could have one of two meanings, both of which mean that Yahweh takes care of them. This could mean: (1) Yahweh lives in Jerusalem in the hilly area which was, at least for a time, part of Benjamin’s territory. Those hills are pictured as **shoulders**. Alternate translation: [and on the hills of Benjamin he lives] or (2) Yahweh protects the tribe of Benjamin with his power. Alternate translation: [he lives securely with Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:13 (#1)

וּלְיוֹסֵ֖ף

“And to Joseph”

Here, **Joseph** represents his descendants, the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And to the tribes descended from Joseph] or [And to the descendants of Joseph]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:13 (#2)

מְבֹרֶ֣כֶת יְהוָ֔ה אַרְצ֑וֹ

“Blessed of Yahweh {be} his land”

The expression **Blessed of Yahweh be his land** contains a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh bless his land]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 33:13 (#3)

מִמֶּ֣גֶד שָׁמַ֔יִם מִ֖טָּל וּמִתְּהוֹם֙ רֹבֶ֣צֶת תָּחַ֔ת

“from the bounty of heaven, from dew, and from the deep lying beneath”

Moses uses a repetitive series of clauses describing the various types of **bounty** Yahweh will bless them with that starts here and goes to the middle of verse 16 to communicate that what he is saying should be understood as comprehensive and overwhelming. Use a form in your language that someone would use to describe a situation that is comprehensive and overwhelming.

See: Litany

Deuteronomy 33:13 (#4)

מִ֖טָּל

“from dew”

The term **dew** refers to moisture from the air that forms as small drops of water on cool surfaces during the night. If your readers would not be familiar with what dew is, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [from moisture from the sky]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 33:13 (#5)

וּמִתְּהוֹם֙

“and from the deep”

Here, **the deep** refers to the primeval waters or underground springs believed to lie beneath the earth. If your readers would not be familiar with that usage of the word, you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [and from the underground waters]

See: Translate Unknowns

Deuteronomy 33:14 (#1)

תְּבוּא֣וֹת שָׁ֔מֶשׁ

“the harvest of the sun”

Here, **harvest of the sun** represents crops that are ripened by the sun’s heat and light. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the sun-ripened crops] or [the produce that the sun brings to maturity]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:14 (#2)

גֶּ֥רֶשׁ יְרָחִֽים

“the yield of the moons”

Here, **moons** represents months or seasons. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the produce of each month] or [the crops of each season]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:15 (#1)

וּמֵרֹ֣אשׁ הָרְרֵי־קֶ֔דֶם וּמִמֶּגֶד גִּבְעֹ֖ות עֹולָֽם

“and from the heads of ancient mountains, and from the bounty of eternal hills”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by connecting the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Another approach would be to combine the phrases into one phrase and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and from the heads of ancient mountains, yes, from the bounty of eternal hills]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:15 (#2)

וּמֵרֹ֣אשׁ

“and from the heads of”

Moses is speaking of the mountains as if they had **heads**. He is referring to the tops of the mountains. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and from the tops of] or [and from the peaks of]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:16 (#1)

וּמְלֹאָ֑הּ

“and from its fullness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **fullness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and from everything that fills the earth]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:16 (#2)

שֹׁכְנִ֣י סְנֶ֑ה

“the bush-dweller”

Here, **bush-dweller** is a title for God that refers to the time he appeared to Moses in a burning bush. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who appeared in the bush] or [the one who dwelt in the bush]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:16 (#3)

לְרֹ֣אשׁ יֹוסֵ֔ף וּלְקָדְקֹ֖ד נְזִ֣יר אֶחָֽיו

“on the head of Joseph, and on the top of the head of the prince of his brothers”

Moses is using **head** to represent all of Joseph receiving these blessings. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [upon Joseph himself, and upon the prince of his brothers himself]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 33:16 (#4)

יֹוסֵ֔ף

“Joseph”

Here, **Joseph** represents the two tribes descended from Joseph’s sons, Ephraim and Manasseh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the tribes of Joseph] or [the descendants of Joseph]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:16 (#5)

נְזִ֣יר

“the prince of”

Moses is speaking of Joseph as if he were a **prince** who ruled over his brothers. Moses means that Joseph was distinguished from his brothers and held a position of prominence among them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could express this meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the distinguished one among] or [the most honored one among]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:17 (#1)

בְּכֹ֤ור שֹׁורֹו֙ הָדָ֣ר לֹ֔ו וְקַרְנֵ֥י רְאֵ֖ם קַרְנָ֑יו

“His firstborn ox {is} his majesty, and the horns of a wild ox {are} his horns”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by including both phrases in your translation. If it is helpful, you could connect the phrases in a way that shows that the

second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [He has the majesty of a firstborn ox, indeed he has the horns of a wild ox]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:17 (#2)

בְּכֹור שׁוֹרֹו הֲדָר לֹו

“His firstborn ox {is} his majesty”

Moses is speaking of Joseph’s descendants as if they were a **firstborn ox**, a very powerful animal, whose **majesty** was striking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture. Alternatively, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Joseph’s descendants are majestic and powerful]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:17 (#3)

וְקַרְנֵי רְאֵם קַרְנָיו

“and the horns of a wild ox {are} his horns”

Moses is speaking of Joseph’s descendants as if they were as strong as **a wild ox** with powerful **horns**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and he is as strong as a wild ox]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:17 (#4)

בָּהֶם עַמִּמִּים יְנַגַּח

“With them he will ram the peoples”

Moses is speaking of Joseph’s descendants defeating their enemies as if they were an ox that could **ram** their enemies with its horns. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [With them he will gore the peoples] or [With them he will defeat the peoples]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:17 (#5)

אַפְסֵי־אָרֶץ

“to the ends of the earth”

Moses says **to the ends of the earth** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [to the most distant lands]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 33:17 (#6)

וְהֵמָּה רִבְבֹות אֶפְרַיִם וְהֵמָּה אַלְפֵי מְנַשֶּׁה

“And they {are} the ten thousands of Ephraim, and they {are} the thousands of Manasseh”

The expressions **ten thousands** and **thousands** are large round numbers that indicate Ephraim’s tribe will be more numerous and powerful than Manasseh’s tribe. Translate these numbers according to the conventions of your own language and culture.

See: Numbers

Deuteronomy 33:18 (#1)

שְׂמַח זְבוּלֻן בְּצֵאתֶךָ וְיִשָּׂשכָר בְּאֹהָלֶיךָ

“Rejoice, Zebulun, in your going out, and Issachar, in your tents”

Moses is referring to all of the activities of life by naming two major components, **going out** and **in your tents**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Rejoice, Zebulun, in all you do, whether working or resting]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 33:19 (#1)

הַר

“to} the mountain”

The implication is that the tribes of Zebulun and Issachar will call the people to come **to the mountain** to worship Yahweh. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to come to the mountain to worship Yahweh]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 33:19 (#2)

יִזְבְּחוּ זִבְחֵי־צֶדֶק

“they will sacrifice sacrifices of righteousness”

Moses is using a construction, **sacrifice sacrifices**, in which a verb and its object come from the same root for emphasis. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [they will offer righteous sacrifices] or [they will present proper sacrifices]

See: Poetry

Deuteronomy 33:19 (#3)

זִבְחֵי־צֶֽדֶק

“sacrifices of righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [sacrifices that are right] or [righteous sacrifices]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:19 (#4)

כִּֽי־שֶׁ֭פַע יַמִּ֣ים יִ֑ינָֽקוּ

“For the abundance of the seas they suckle”

The phrase **the abundance of the seas they suckle** could mean: (1) They get food for themselves and to sell from fishing. Alternate translation: [they will gain wealth by fishing in the sea] or (2) They get wealth by being traders going across the sea to other lands. Alternate translation: [they will gain wealth by trading across the sea]

Deuteronomy 33:19 (#5)

יִ֑ינָֽקוּ

“they suckle”

Moses is speaking of the tribes of Zebulun and Issachar obtaining wealth from the sea as if they were infants who **suckle** milk from their mothers. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent metaphor from your culture. Alternatively, you could express the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they draw out] or [they obtain]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:19 (#6)

וּשְׂפוּנֵ֖י טְמוּנֵ֣י חֽוֹל

“and treasures hidden {in the} sand”

The phrase **treasures hidden in the sand** could mean: (1) They will produce things to sell from the sand (like glass). Alternate translation: [and making valuable things from the sand] or (2) They will find things washed up on shore or buried in the sand that are valuable (like from wrecked ships). Alternate translation: [and finding valuable things in the sand]

Deuteronomy 33:20 (#1)

בָּר֣וּךְ מַרְחִ֣יב גָּ֑ד

“Blessed be the increaser of Gad”

The expression **Blessed be** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [May Yahweh bless the one who increases Gad’s territory]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 33:20 (#2)

מַרְחִ֣יב

“the increaser of”

Moses is using the participle **increaser** as a noun to refer to Yahweh, who enlarges Gad’s territory. Your language may use participles in the same way. If not, you can translate this participle with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the one who increases Gad’s territory]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Deuteronomy 33:20 (#3)

כְּלָבִ֣יא שָׁכַ֑ן

“Like a lioness he will live”

The point of this comparison is that just as a **lioness** is fierce and tears its prey, so Gad will be fierce in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [He will live as fiercely as a lioness]

See: Simile

Deuteronomy 33:20 (#4)

זְר֣וֹעַ אַף־קָ֑דְקֹד

“an arm, also a head”

Moses is referring to the whole body by naming two major components, **an arm** and **a head**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [body parts] or [limbs]

See: Merism

Deuteronomy 33:21 (#1)

וַיַּ֣רְא רֵאשִׁית֮ לֹו֒

“And he saw the first for himself”

The phrase **saw the first for himself** was a common expression meaning to choose the best or first portion of the land. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expres-

sion from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he chose the best land for himself] or [And he selected the first portion for himself]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 33:21 (#2)

כִּי־שָׁ֣ם חֶלְקַ֤ת מְחֹקֵק֙ סָפ֔וּן

“for there the portion of a commander {is} reserved”

The expression **is reserved** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [for Yahweh reserved the portion of a commander there] or [for Yahweh set aside the portion of a commander there]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 33:21 (#3)

חֶלְקַ֤ת מְחֹקֵק֙

“the portion of a commander”

The implication is that **the portion of a commander** refers to the best or largest share of land, appropriate for a leader. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [a leader’s large portion] or [the best portion, fit for a commander]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 33:21 (#4)

רָאשֵׁ֣י

“with} the heads of”

Moses is speaking of the leaders of the people as if they were **the heads of the people**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:21 (#5)

צִדְקַ֤ת יְהוָה֙ עָשָׂ֔ה וּמִשְׁפָּטָ֖יו עִם־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“The justice of Yahweh he carried out, and his judgments with Israel”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by connecting the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Another approach would be to combine the phrases into one phrase and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [He carried out the justice of Yahweh, that is, his judgments with Israel]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:21 (#6)

צִדְקַ֤ת יְהוָה֙ עָשָׂ֔ה וּמִשְׁפָּטָ֖יו עִם־יִשְׂרָאֵֽל

“The justice of Yahweh he carried out, and his judgments with Israel”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **justice** and **judgments**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [He did what Yahweh said was just, and he judged Israel as Yahweh commanded] or [He did what was right as Yahweh commanded, and he decided legal cases with Israel according to Yahweh’s laws]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:22 (#1)

גְּג֥וּר אַרְיֵ֖ה

“is} a lion cub”

Moses is speaking of Dan as if it were a **lion cub** to describe the tribe’s strength and vigor. If this image communicates well in your language, please use it. If not, you could express this as a comparison. Alternate translation: [is like a strong young lion] or [is strong and fierce]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:22 (#2)

יְזַנֵּ֥ק

“leaping out”

Moses is speaking of Dan as if the tribe were a **lion cub leaping** out to attack. If this image communicates well in your language, please use it. If not, you could express this as a comparison. Alternate translation: [attacking suddenly like a young lion]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:23 (#1)

שְׂבַ֥ע רָצ֛וֹן וּמָלֵ֖א בִּרְכַּ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“satisfied {with} favor, and full of the blessing of Yahweh”

These two phrases **satisfied with favor** and **full of the blessing of Yahweh** mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. Hebrew poetry was based on this kind of repetition, and you may want to show this to your readers by connecting the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Another approach would be to combine the phrases into one phrase and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [satisfied with favor, yes, full of the blessing of Yahweh]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:23 (#2)

שְׂבַ֣ע רָצ֔וֹן וּמְלֵ֖א בִּרְכַּ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“satisfied {with} favor, and full of the blessing of Yahweh”

Moses is speaking of Naphtali’s abundant blessings as if **favor** and **the blessing of Yahweh** were food or drink with which he could be **satisfied** and **full**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [who has received abundant favor and has been greatly blessed by Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:23 (#3)

שְׂבַ֣ע רָצ֔וֹן וּמְלֵ֖א בִּרְכַּ֣ת יְהוָ֑ה

“satisfied {with} favor, and full of the blessing of Yahweh”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **favor** and **blessing**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [whom Yahweh has favored and blessed greatly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:23 (#4)

יָ֥ם וְדָרוֹ֖ם

“the west and the south”

Moses is speaking of the land around the Sea of Chinnereth (now known as “the Sea of Galilee”) by referring to its location as **the west and the south**. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [the land west and south of here] or [the land around the Sea of Chinnereth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 33:24 (#1)

בָּר֣וּךְ מִבָּנִ֔ים אָשֵׁ֖ר

“Blessed among sons {is} Asher”

The phrase **Blessed among sons is Asher** could mean: (1) a hope that Asher is more blessed than his brother (tribes). Alternate translation: [May Asher be more blessed than the other tribes] or (2) a hope that Asher’s sons bless the tribe more than the sons of other tribes. Alternate translation: [May Asher’s sons bless them more than other people are blessed by their sons.]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 33:24 (#2)

וְטֹבֵ֥ל בַּשֶּׁ֖מֶן רַגְלֽוֹ

“and bathe in oil his foot”

Moses says **bathe in oil his foot** as an overstatement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [have olive oil in great abundance]

See: Hyperbole

Deuteronomy 33:25 (#1)

בַּרְזֶ֥ל וּנְחֹ֖שֶׁת מִנְעָלֶ֑יךָ

“Iron and bronze your gate-bolts”

Moses is speaking of the strength and security of Asher’s defenses as if the bolts of their gates were made of **iron and bronze**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Your defenses will be as strong as iron and bronze] or [You will be firmly secured]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:25 (#2)

וּכְיָמֶ֖יךָ דָּבְאֶֽךָ

“and as your days, your security”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate

translation: [and as your days continue, so will your security continue]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 33:26 (#1)

יְשֻׁרוּן

“Jeshurun”

See how you translated the name **Jeshurun** in 32:15. Alternate translation: [Israel]

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 33:26 (#2)

רֹכֵב שָׁמַיִם֙ בְּעֶזְרֶ֔ךָ וּבְגַאֲוָתֹ֖ו שְׁחָקִֽים

“riding the heavens to your help, and in his majesty {on} the clouds”

These two phrases mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [riding majestically through the heavens to your help]

See: Parallelism

Deuteronomy 33:26 (#3)

רֹכֵב שָׁמַיִם֙ בְּעֶזְרֶ֔ךָ וּבְגַאֲוָתֹ֖ו שְׁחָקִֽים

“riding the heavens to your help, and in his majesty {on} the clouds”

Moses is speaking of God as if he were **riding the heavens** and traveling **on the clouds** like a warrior riding a chariot to battle. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [traveling through the sky to help you like a majestic warrior in his chariot]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:26 (#4)

רֹכֵב שָׁמַיִם֙ בְּעֶזְרֶ֔ךָ וּבְגַאֲוָתֹ֖ו שְׁחָקִֽים

“riding the heavens to your help, and in his majesty {on} the clouds”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [riding the heavens to your help, and riding in his majesty on the clouds]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 33:26 (#5)

בְּעֶזְרֶ֔ךָ וּבְגַאֲוָתֹ֖ו

“to your help, and in his majesty”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **help** and **majesty**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [to help you, and majestically] or [to help you, majestic]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:27 (#1)

מְעֹנָה֙ אֱלֹהֵ֣י קֶ֔דֶם

“A refuge {is} the God of ancient days”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **refuge**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The God of ancient days shelters his people]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:27 (#2)

מְעֹנָה֙

“A refuge”

Moses is speaking of God as if he were a **refuge** or shelter. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [A protector]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:27 (#3)

זְרֹעֹ֥ת עוֹלָ֖ם

“are} the eternal arms”

Moses is speaking of God’s support as if he were holding his people up with **eternal arms**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [is eternal support] or [is everlasting strength]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:27 (#4)

וַיְגָ֣רֶשׁ & וַיֹּ֣אמֶר

“And he thrust out & and he said”

Moses is using the past tense to refer to events that will happen in the future. He is doing this to emphasize the certainty that these things will happen. If it

would be helpful in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [And he will thrust out ... and he will say]

See: Predictive Past

Deuteronomy 33:27 (#5)

מִפָּנֶיךָ

“from your faces”

Here the phrase **from your faces** could: (1) represent “from your presence,” Alternate translation: [from before you] or (2) be a common expression of the culture that means [on your account] or [on your behalf] Alternate translation: [on your behalf]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 33:27 (#6)

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר הַשְׁמֵ֔ד

“and he said, ‘Destroy”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as an indirect quotation. Alternate translation: [and he told you to destroy them]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Deuteronomy 33:28 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁכֹּ֥ן יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל בֶּ֣טַח בָּדָ֑ד עֵ֖ין יַעֲקֹ֥ב

“And Israel dwelt {in} safety secure, the spring of Jacob”

Moses is using a past tense form, **dwelt**, to refer to something that will happen in the future. He is doing this to show that the event will certainly happen. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use the future tense. Alternate translation: [And Israel will dwell in safety secure, the spring of Jacob]

See: Predictive Past

Deuteronomy 33:28 (#2)

וַיִּשְׁכֹּ֥ן יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל בֶּ֣טַח בָּדָ֑ד עֵ֖ין יַעֲקֹ֥ב

“And Israel dwelt {in} safety secure, the spring of Jacob”

Moses is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And Israel dwelt in safety secure, and the spring of Jacob also dwelt in safety] or [And Israel dwelt in safety alone, the spring of Jacob dwelt secure]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 33:28 (#3)

עֵ֥ין יַעֲקֹֽב

“the spring of Jacob”

Here, **spring of Jacob** represents the descendants of Jacob, pictured as flowing from him like water from a spring. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the offspring of Jacob]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 33:28 (#4)

אֶל־אֶ֥רֶץ דָּגָ֖ן וְתִירֹ֑שׁ

“in a land of grain and new wine”

Together, the terms **grain** and **new wine** represent God’s material blessings and provision for his people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in a land with plentiful food and drink] or [in a land with abundant harvests]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#1)

אַשְׁרֶ֖יךָ יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“Your happiness, Israel”

Moses is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling of joy. You can use an exclamation point here if your language can express this feeling in that way or there may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [How happy you are, Israel.]

See: Exclamations

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#2)

מִֽי־כָמ֣וֹךָ עַ֔ם נוֹשַׁ֥ע בַּיהוָ֖ה מָגֵ֣ן עֶזְרֶ֑ךָ וַאֲשֶׁר־חֶ֣רֶב גַּאֲוָתֶ֔ךָ

“Who {is} like you, a people saved by Yahweh, the shield of your help, and who {is} the sword of your majesty”

Moses is using the question form to emphasize that no other people are like Israel. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [No one is like you, a people saved by Yahweh, the shield of your help, and the sword of your majesty!] or [Certainly no people

are like you, whom Yahweh has saved! He is the shield of your help and the sword of your majesty.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#3)

נוֹשַׁ֣ע בַּיהוָ֔ה

“saved by Yahweh”

The expression **saved** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [whom Yahweh has saved]

See: Active or Passive

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#4)

מָגִנָּ֥ן עֶזְרֶ֖ךָ

“the shield of your help”

Here Moses is speaking of Yahweh as if he were a **shield** that protects and helps Israel. If this image communicates well in your language, please use it. If not, you could express this as a comparison. Alternate translation: [the one who protects you and helps you like a shield]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#5)

מָגִנָּ֥ן עֶזְרֶ֖ךָ

“the shield of your help”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **help**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the shield who helps you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#6)

חֶ֣רֶב גַּאֲוָתֶ֑ךָ

“the sword of your majesty”

Moses is speaking of Yahweh bringing Israel majesty and triumph as if he were a **sword** used in a victorious battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who brings you triumph] or [the one who gives you victory]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#7)

חֶ֣רֶב גַּאֲוָתֶ֑ךָ

“the sword of your majesty”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **majesty**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the sword with which you act majestically] or [the sword that shows how majestic you are]

See: Abstract Nouns

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#8)

עַל־בָּמוֹתֵ֖ימוֹ תִּדְרֹֽךְ

“on their backs will trample”

Here the author is speaking of completely defeating their enemies as if they would **trample** their enemies' **backs**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [will completely defeat them]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#9)

וְיִכָּחֲשׁ֣וּ אֹיְבֶ֔יךָ לָ֑ךְ

“And your enemies will fawn over you”

Moses is using **fawn over you** as a common expression of his culture to mean that their enemies would submit out of fear or feign obedience. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And your enemies will cower before you] or [And your enemies will submit to you in fear]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 33:29 (#10)

בָּמוֹתֵ֖ימוֹ

“their backs”

The word **backs** could mean: (1) the backs of the enemies, indicating that Israel will subjugate them. Alternate translation: [them] (2) the high places where the enemies worship, indicating that Israel will destroy their places of worship. Alternate translation: [their high places]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy - Chapter 34 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter may have been written by Joshua, since it records Moses' death.

1. Moses views the promised land from Mount Nebo (1–3)
2. Yahweh's final words to Moses (4)
3. The death, burial, and mourning of Moses (5–8)
4. Joshua succeeds Moses as leader (9)
5. The author's tribute to Moses (10–12)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Laying on of hands
Moses laid his hands on Joshua to transfer authority to him. This symbolic action showed that Joshua would now lead Israel in Moses' place.

"face to face"
The phrase "face to face" describes Moses' unique relationship with Yahweh. Unlike other prophets who received visions or dreams, Moses spoke with Yahweh directly and personally.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

"to this day"
The author uses the phrase "to this day" in verse 6 to refer to the time when this book was written, not to the time when Moses died. The translator should be aware that "to this day" refers to a time that is now in the past. See the book introduction.

representative language
This chapter uses body parts to represent actions or the whole person. For example, "to your eyes" means that Moses saw it himself, "the mouth of Yahweh" represents Yahweh's command, and "before the eyes of all Israel" means in their presence or sight.

seed
In verse 4, the term "seed" is used with the meaning "descendants." This is a word picture. Just as plants produce seeds that grow into more plants, so people can have offspring. See the book introduction.

"you" and "your" singular and plural
Even though the speaker is addressing all the Israelites, he uses the singular forms of "you." If the singular forms of these pronouns would not be natural in your language, you could use the plural forms in your translation. (See: Singular Pronouns that refer to Groups)

Deuteronomy 34:1 (#1)

וַיַּ֣עַל מֹשֶׁ֔ה

"Then Moses went up"

In keeping with what is usual for his language and culture, the author uses **went up** to mark travel for change in elevation. If this expression contains extra information that would not be natural to express in your language, you can shorten it. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of the phrase "went up." Alternate translation: [Then Moses went]

See: Making Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information Explicit

Deuteronomy 34:1 (#2)

הַ֨הָר נְבֹ֜ו

"Mount Nebo"

See how you translated this name in 32:49.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 34:1 (#3)

הַפִּסְגָּ֗ה

"Pisgah"

See how you translated this name in 3:17.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 34:1 (#4)

עַל־פְּנֵ֣י

"against the face of"

Here, **against the face of** represents being in front of or across from Jericho. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [across from] or [overlooking]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 34:4 (#1)

לְזַרְעֲךָ֑

"to your seed"

Here Moses is speaking as if the Israelites' offspring were **seed**. See the Introduction to Deuteronomy for a discussion of this use of the term "seed." Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [offspring] or [future generations]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 34:4 (#2)

לֵאמֹֽר

“saying”

Here the word **saying** introduces a direct quotation. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language. It may not be necessary to represent this term explicitly.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Deuteronomy 34:4 (#3)

בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ

“to your eyes”

Yahweh is using one part of a person, his **eyes**, to mean all of him in the act of seeing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that you have seen it with your own eyes]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 34:5 (#1)

פִּ֣י יְהוָ֑ה

“the mouth of Yahweh”

The author is using one part of Yahweh, his **mouth**, to represent Yahweh himself in the act of speaking or commanding. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the command of Yahweh] or [what Yahweh commanded]

See: Synecdoche

Deuteronomy 34:6 (#1)

וַיִּקְבֹּ֥ר אֹתוֹ

“And he buried him”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh, and the pronoun **him** refers to Moses. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh buried Moses]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Deuteronomy 34:6 (#2)

בֵּ֖ית פְּעֹ֑ור

“Beth Peor”

See how you translated this name in Deuteronomy 3:29.

See: How to Translate Names

Deuteronomy 34:6 (#3)

עַ֚ד הַיֹּ֣ום הַזֶּ֔ה

“to this day”

See how you translated the similar phrase “until this day” in 2:22. Alternate translation: [right up to this time]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 34:6 (#4)

עַ֚ד הַיֹּ֣ום הַזֶּ֔ה

“to this day”

The author assumes that readers will know that **to this day** refers to the time when this book was written, not to the time when Moses died. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [to the time when this account was written]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 34:7 (#1)

בֶּן־מֵאָ֥ה וְעֶשְׂרִ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה

“was} a son of 120 years”

The author is using **a son of 120 years** as a common expression of the culture to indicate Moses’s age. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [had lived 120 years]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 34:7 (#2)

לֹֽא־כָהֲתָ֥ה עֵינֹ֖ו

“his eye was not dim”

The author is speaking of Moses’s eyesight as if his **eye** were something that could become **dim**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his eyesight was still strong] or [he still had good eyesight]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 34:7 (#3)

וְלֵחֹה

“nor had his vigor fled”

The author is speaking of **vigor** as if it were a living thing that could flee. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [his vigor was not gone] or [his strength had not left him]

See: Personification

Deuteronomy 34:9 (#1)

וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ & מָלֵא רוּחַ חָכְמָה

“And Joshua & was} full of the spirit of wisdom”

The author is speaking of Joshua as if he were a container and **the spirit of wisdom** were a substance that could fill that container. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And Joshua ... had great wisdom] or [And Joshua ... was very wise]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 34:9 (#2)

רוּחַ חָכְמָה

“the spirit of wisdom”

The author is using the possessive form to describe a **spirit** that is characterized by **wisdom**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [wisdom] or [a spirit that gave him wisdom] or [a wise spirit]

See: Possession

Deuteronomy 34:9 (#3)

סָמַךְ & אֶת־יָדָיו עָלָיו

“had laid his hands on him”

Moses’ **laying his hands on** Joshua was a symbolic action by which Moses showed that he was transferring authority to Joshua. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [had laid his hands on him to commission him as leader] or [had laid his hands on him to give him authority]

See: Symbolic Action

Deuteronomy 34:9 (#4)

בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the sons of Israel”

Here, **sons** means “descendants.” Moses is identifying the Israelites as descendants of their ancestor Jacob, who was also known as **Israel**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 34:9 (#5)

וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ אֵלָיו בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל

“And the sons of Israel listened to him”

Here the word **listen** means to intentionally hear and obey. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. See the discussion about this in the Introduction to Deuteronomy for further information. Alternate translation: [And the sons of Israel were obedient to him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Deuteronomy 34:9 (#6)

כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה

“what Yahweh had commanded Moses”

The author is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh had commanded Moses to command the Israelites]

See: Ellipsis

Deuteronomy 34:10 (#1)

וְלֹא־קָם נָבִיא & כְּמֹשֶׁה

“And a prophet like Moses has not arisen”

The author is speaking of a prophet appearing or beginning to function as if he were **arisen**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And a prophet like Moses has not appeared] or [And a prophet like Moses has not come forward]

See: Metaphor

Deuteronomy 34:10 (#2)

פָּנִים אֶל־פָּנִים

“face to face”

The author is using **face to face** as a common expression of his culture to mean “personally” or “directly.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [directly]

See: Idiom

Deuteronomy 34:11 (#1)

הָאֹתֹת וְהַמֹּפְתִים

“the signs and wonders”

The terms **signs** and **wonders** mean similar things. The author is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [the miraculous signs]

See: Doublet

Deuteronomy 34:12 (#1)

הַיָּד הַחֲזָקָה

“the mighty hand”

Here the word **hand** represents God’s power. See how you translated the similar phrase “a mighty hand” in 4:34. Alternate translation: [the mighty power]

See: Metonymy

Deuteronomy 34:12 (#2)

לְעֵינֵי

“before the eyes of”

Here, **before the eyes** represents sight or witnessing. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the sight] or [in the presence]

See: Metonymy